

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

12 Step TRANSFORMATION

Curriculum

Version 7.21

Steps 1 through 12 (plus pre-step lessons)



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**I pray that your partnership with us in the faith may be effective
in deepening your understanding of every good thing we share
for the sake of Christ. *Philemon (1):6***

**The Definition of Insanity is
Going to 12 Step Meetings
but not Working the 12 Steps.**

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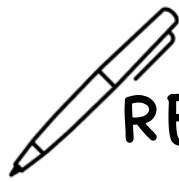
I was trying to make the steps work for me
instead of me working the steps.

-Joshua Van Sciver, Resilients in Recovery Leader

Resilients in Recovery® is a Christ-centered 12-step recovery ministry directed by Stanton and Ariella Robertson. From its beginning, RnR has held that real recovery is whole-person: God's aim is not merely to stop a behavior but to make a person new in body, soul, and spirit.

- **The physical dimension** — rest, food, movement, and health — is treated as genuine spiritual stewardship, since our bodies are God's temple.
- **The soul** — our mind, will, and emotions — is renewed as we surrender old patterns and let God change the way we think.
- **The spirit** is awakened and deepened through surrender, Scripture, prayer, and community.

The RESILIENTS framework was developed to give participants memorable, biblical principles that reinforce the Steps across all of these dimensions. A separate workshop exists to integrate them — to help participants see that growth in one area supports growth in the others, and that God is at work to sanctify the whole person.



WELCOME TO THE RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® CURRICULUM!



Congratulations on your choice!
**The Starter Section of the Resilients in Recovery®
Curriculum contains the following:**

 **A Pre Reading Section**

 **The Pre-Step**

 **Step 1**

The remainder of the steps can be added when you finish with the Pre-step and Step 1 with your sponsor (or step leader).

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY

12 Step TRANSFORMATION Curriculum — Version 7.1

PARTICIPANT GUIDE — TABLE OF CONTENTS

STEPS & KEY SECTIONS — QUICK REFERENCE

All page numbers refer to the printed page numbers shown in the header of each page in your notebook.

SECTION / STEP	STEP STARTS	KEY TERMS	TOP 10 THINGS I LEARNED	COMPREHENSION & ESSAY
Pre-Reading Section	35	35	59	84
Pre-Step	61	64	87	84
Step 1 — Admitting Powerlessness	93	96	147	141
Step 2 — Believing in a Higher Power	157	160	196	192
Step 3 — Turning Will Over to God	201	204	218	214
Step 4 — Moral Inventory	223	226	323	317
Step 5 — Examining & Confessing Faults	333	336	349	345
Step 6 — Openness to Change	353	356	376	371
Step 7 — Humbly Asking God	381	384	402	398
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Step 10 — Continuing Inventory	469	470	512	509
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Step 12 — Carrying the Message	543	546	—	563

Note: Step 12 Top 10 list is included within the Comprehension/Essay section beginning on page 561. The Pre-Reading Top 10 list (p. 59) covers the pre-reading material only; the Pre-Step Top 10 list (p. 87) covers the Pre-Step lessons.

GETTING TO KNOW YOU/ GETTING TO YOUR STEP LEADER/ SPONSOR IN RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY

Purpose of this Assignment: Welcome to Resilients in Recovery! This first exercise is about sharing your story openly and honestly with your Step Leader or Sponsor. Sharing builds trust, helps them understand and support you better, and starts the process of seeing your own resilience—the ways you've survived, adapted, and kept going despite challenges. Recovery thrives on connection, hope, and self-honesty. This isn't about perfection; it's about showing up as you are today.

Instructions:

- Take your time—there's no rush. Aim for 1–3 pages (or more if needed).
- You can hand-write on extra notebook pages here, type it out, dictate it into your phone and email it, or read it aloud in your first meeting with your sponsor/step leader.
- Be as detailed as feels safe and comfortable right now. You can always add more later.
- Include both the challenging parts and the positive ones: your strengths, moments of joy, people who helped, and ways you've shown resilience (even small ones).
- End by reflecting on what brought you to this program and what you hope to gain.

Key Areas to Cover (Use These as Prompts—Write in Your Own Words):

1. **Childhood and Family/Home Life**
 - What was your home or family situation like growing up? (e.g., relationships with parents/caregivers/siblings, stability, any moves, love/support vs. struggles/conflicts)
 - Any early experiences that shaped you—for better or worse?
2. **School, Friends, and Growing Up**
 - Schools attended, how you did academically/socially, key friendships or influences.
 - Moves to new places, changes in environment, or big life shifts.
3. **Introduction to Substances, Behaviors, or Challenges**
 - When and how were you first introduced to alcohol, drugs, or other addictive behaviors?

- What role did they play over time? Any early encounters with law enforcement, consequences, or turning points?

4. Church/Spirituality, Beliefs, and Positive Influences

- Any involvement in church, faith, or spiritual practices? How did beliefs evolve?
- People, activities, hobbies, or moments that brought hope, joy, purpose, or strength?

5. Adulthood Up to Now

- Key events, relationships, jobs, achievements, losses, or patterns in your life.
- Times of resilience—moments you overcame hardship, helped others, or kept going.

6. How I Got Here

- What led to
- -- your decision to join Resilients in Recovery?
- Describe your life right now: What's working? What's unmanageable or painful?
- What strengths or resilient qualities do you already see in yourself (even if small)?

Final Reflection (Short Paragraph): Looking back at your story, what stands out about your ability to survive and keep moving forward? What are you hoping this program and your relationship with your sponsor/step leader will help you build?

Tips for Completion:

- Write freely—don't edit for grammar or "right" answers.
- If certain parts feel too hard, note "more to share later" and move on.
- Share this with your sponsor/step leader soon—it's the start of a supportive partnership.
- Remember: Your story matters. It shows courage just by writing/sharing it.

[illegible]



Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1. Read items A through L in this coming section (before the next Action List). Select any 2 of the 12 items from the Book of Hebrews that you would start doing for your recovery TODAY Circle and the two you choose and fill out the implementation plan.		
	2. Complete the Preassessment		
	3. Write a letter to your younger self (Dear Younger Me)		
	4. Fill out the "Meetings I will Attend Sheet" even if you need to change it later		
	5. Call or text your sponsor or step leader each night this week to report on the progress from that day. Do not miss a night. Texting early/ late is OK. But report by 11:pm.		
	6. Turn to the Transcript Pages at the very end of your notebook and complete / fill in the dates of any of those events that have already passed. You may have to make you best guess for some.		
	7. Begin to learn the Serenity Prayer (full version) on and say it daily. Also say it when you are stressed or challenged. (You might copy the text into your phone).		
	8. Read. "How it Works"		
	9. Date your action list at the top of this page (with today's date) for what you will accomplish this week.		
	10.		

Generally, at every meeting, we will go over what you accomplished from this weeks Action List.

That means that you will also generally work up to the page BEFORE the next action list for each meeting. That is how you will be prepared for weekly step leader/ sponsor meetings as you work the 12 Steps. (In other words, these "action list" pages are like bookmarks between meetings.)

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY – PRE-ASSESSMENT

This short form helps us meet you exactly where you are. There are **no right or wrong answers** — everything you share just helps us support you better.

Part 1: Previous Recovery Experience

Have you ever participated in a recovery program before? (This includes 12-Step programs such as Alcoholics Anonymous (AA), Narcotics Anonymous (NA), SMART Recovery, treatment programs, counseling, or any other structured recovery support.)

- ☐ No – This will be my first time working any recovery program.
- ☐ Yes – I have some experience with recovery programs or 12-Step work.
- ☐ Yes – I have a lot of experience or have worked a recovery program (including 12-Step) for a significant time.

(If yes) Feel free to share a little more (optional):

Which program(s)? _____

Roughly when / how long? _____

Part 2: Where Are You Today (and right now)? (Stage of Resilient Change)

1. Precontemplation (Not Ready) I don't really see this as a problem right now — or even if I do, I'm not interested in dealing with it or making any changes.

2. Contemplation (Thinking About It) I'm open to thinking and talking about this issue with you, but I'm not ready to make any changes at this time.

3. Preparation (Getting Ready) I have decided I want to make changes and I'm preparing to start. I haven't acted yet, but I'd like help figuring out how to begin.

4. Early Action (Taking First Steps) I've started making some changes and I'm working on building new habits. I need support to keep going, but I'm not fully committed to long-term maintenance yet.

5. Late Action (Building Momentum) I'm actively working on my recovery and making good progress. I'm moving toward stability but still need help to reach full maintenance.

6. Maintenance (Staying Strong) I've made significant changes and I'm focused on maintaining my recovery. Life keeps bringing challenges, and I'm committed to staying resilient and handling whatever comes my way.



Write a letter to your younger self. What would you tell yourself? What advice would you give yourself (at a younger age)

Dear _____ :

Step Assignment



Letter of Release

Keeping What Matters — Releasing What Harmed You — Filling the Space with Recovery

Instructions: You may have been asked elsewhere to write a "goodbye letter" to your former self. Here, we reframe that assignment. You are not saying goodbye to who you are — you are releasing the role that old coping patterns played in your life. Complete all three sections below. Work through this with your Step Leader or sponsor.

"I am not losing you. I am losing the weight you were carrying."

Part 1 — What I Am Keeping

Which parts of yourself, even from your hardest years, are you proud of or want to carry forward? (Faith, humor, loyalty, resilience, love for family...)

Part 2 — What I Am Releasing

What did that version of you believe or lean on that led toward addiction? Not who you were — what you used to cope.

Part 3 — What Fills the Space

If the old coping mechanism is gone, what is here now instead? (Sponsor, faith, prayer, RESILIENTS principles, honesty, community...)



Closing Letter

Using what you wrote above, write your full Letter of Release below. Begin with “Dear _____,” and close in your own words — not a goodbye, but a release.

Participant Signature / Date	Step Leader / Sponsor Signature / Date	



Weekly Planner of What Meetings I will Attend

The intent of this page is to get you into a weekly routine such that every Tuesday you attend the same meeting(s), every Friday you attend the same meeting(s), etc.

- Include those meetings you can choose as well as required meetings like House meetings, Drug court meetings, Sponsor meetings, etc.
- INCLUDE WHAT DAYS (AND TIMES) that you will work on your own recovery in your Step Notebook to prepare for weekly step study meetings.



	MEETINGS	TIME	LOCATION
MONDAYS	_____	_____	_____
	_____	_____	_____
TUESDAYS	_____	_____	_____
	_____	_____	_____
WED	_____	_____	_____
	_____	_____	_____
THURSDAYS	_____	_____	_____
	_____	_____	_____
FRIDAYS	_____	_____	_____
	_____	_____	_____
SATURDAYS	_____	_____	_____
	_____	_____	_____
SUNDAYS	_____	_____	_____
	_____	_____	_____

A Prayer for Serenity

**God, grant me the Serenity
to accept the things I cannot change.
The courage to change the things I can,
and the wisdom to know the difference.
Living one day at a time,
enjoying one moment at a time;
Accepting hardship as a pathway to peace;
Taking, as Christ did, this sinful world as it is;
not as I would have it;
Trusting that You, God, will make all things right
if I surrender to Your will;
So that I may be reasonably happy in this life
and supremely happy with You, God, forever in the next.**

Amen

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY STARTING IN THE BOOK OF HEBREWS

CHOOSE TWO IN ITEMS A through L TO IMPLEMENT STARTING NOW. CIRCLE THE TWO YOU CHOOSE AND FILL OUT THE IMPLEMENTATION PLAN. IT IS POSSIBLE THAT YOU MIGHT REWORD SOME OF THE IMPLEMENTATION PLAN. CALL OR TEXT YOUR SPONSOR OR STEP LEADER EACH NIGHT THIS WEEK TO REPORT ON THE PROGRESS FROM THAT DAY.

A. Seek ultimate help from your higher power (Hebrews 4:14-16): Right away, identify one trusted source of higher support Jesus Christ,

Start by setting aside 5 minutes each morning to verbally or in writing ask for strength, confessing one specific weakness you're facing that day, and repeat it nightly to build the habit.

My Implementation Plan: I'll start this on _____ (date), at _____ (time). My plan is to use a journal app on my phone to write down my morning prayer or request for strength, including the specific weakness (like "resisting late-night scrolling"), and do the same at night before bed. To make sure my sponsor knows I've done it, I'll screenshot my journal entries each day and text them to him by 11 PM, so he can review and discuss them during our weekly check-in call.

B. Persevere through trials (Hebrews 2:1; 3:6): Immediately create a "perseverance anchor"—a short mantra or verse like "Hold fast" written on your phone's lock screen or a sticky note on your mirror.

When a craving or setback hits today, pause, read it aloud, and commit to one small action (like a walk or calling a friend) instead of giving in, tracking how many times you use it this week.

My Implementation Plan: I'll start this on _____ (date), at _____ (time). My plan is to set "Hold fast" as my phone's lock screen wallpaper. From then onward, whenever a trial hits, I'll note the time, the trigger, and the alternative action I took in a notes app, aiming to use it at least once daily if needed. My sponsor will know I've done it because I'll share my weekly tally (e.g., "Used it 5 times this week") via email every Sunday evening, and he can ask me to elaborate on specific entries during our meetings.



C. Enter into true rest (Hebrews 4:1-11): Start today by scheduling a 10-minute "rest ritual" in your day—sit quietly without distractions, breathe deeply, and visualize releasing one old habit's grip.

Do this before bed; use a free app like Calm for guided breathing if needed, and make it non-negotiable to foster peace over constant hustle.

My Implementation Plan: I'll start this on _____ (date), at _____ (time). My plan is to set a daily alarm on my phone for the ritual, download the Calm app if I haven't already, and log the session in a habit-tracking app with a quick note on what habit I visualized releasing. To verify with my sponsor, I'll send him a weekly summary report every Friday via text, listing the dates I completed the ritual and one example visualization per day, so he can spot-check during our calls.

D. Examine yourself honestly (Hebrews 4:12-13): Right now, grab a notebook and do a quick "trigger audit": List three recent situations that tempted you, what thoughts led to them, and one alternative response.

Do this daily for a week, reviewing it with a trusted accountability partner to sharpen self-awareness and spot patterns early.

My Implementation Plan: I'll start this on _____ (date), at _____ (time). My plan is to do the audit every evening, expanding to daily audits, and share the full week's entries with my accountability partner (who's also my sponsor) via scanned photos or a shared Google Doc by the end of each week. He'll know I've done it because the doc will be updated with timestamps, and we can discuss patterns in our bi-weekly meetings.

E. Approach help with confidence (Hebrews 4:16): Today, reach out boldly to one resource—text a friend, join an online recovery forum like Reddit's r/recovery, or attend a virtual AA/NA meeting (find one at aa.org or na.org).

Prepare by jotting down one specific need (e.g., "I need advice on cravings"), and follow through without overthinking to build momentum.

My Implementation Plan: I'll start this on _____ (date), at _____ (time). My plan is to prepare a note with my specific need, participate at least once a week, and log the date, what I shared, and any insights in a dedicated recovery journal. My sponsor will confirm I've done it by receiving a photo of my journal entry after each outreach, sent via text within 24 hours, and we'll review them together.

F. Avoid hardening your heart (Hebrews 3:7-19): Start immediately by setting a daily "soften check"—at noon, reflect on any excuses or cynical thoughts from the morning and counter them with a positive affirmation like "I'm open to change."

Share one with a support person via text to stay accountable and prevent buildup.

My Implementation Plan: I'll start this on _____ (date), at _____ (time). My plan is to set a midday phone reminder to jot down any hardening thoughts and my counter-affirmation in a text draft, then send one example to my sponsor daily. He'll know it's completed because he'll receive the daily text, and if I miss one, he'll follow up; we can track consistency in our sponsor meetings.

G. Build a supportive community (Hebrews 3:13; 10:24-25): Right away, connect with at least one person—call a family member, join a local recovery group via Meetup.com, or message someone from a past support circle.

Commit to daily encouragement: Send or receive one uplifting text, and aim to meet in person or virtually weekly.

My Implementation Plan: I'll start this on _____ (date), at _____ (time). My plan is to send or receive one encouragement text daily and schedule a weekly virtual meetup (e.g., every Wednesday).

To prove it to my sponsor, I'll forward him screenshots of the daily texts and meeting confirmations weekly on Sundays, so he can verify participation and discuss during check-ins.

H. View discipline as growth (Hebrews 12:5-11): Today, reframe one recent setback (e.g., a slip-up) as a "growth lesson"—write down what it taught you and one positive outcome it could lead to.

Incorporate discipline by starting a simple routine, like 10 push-ups or a healthy meal prep, viewing it as training for resilience rather than punishment.

My Implementation Plan: I'll start this on _____ (date), at _____ (time). My plan is to add a daily discipline like 10 push-ups, logging the reframe and routine completion with notes on growth insights. My sponsor will know via a shared app or weekly email with dated entries, and he'll quiz me on the lessons during our talks to ensure authenticity.

I. Anchor your hope (Hebrews 6:19): Immediately create a "hope anchor" visual—save a photo or draw something symbolizing your long-term goal (e.g., a family pic for sobriety) on your phone.

Look at it during low moments today, affirming out loud, "This is my secure future," and review it morning and night to shift focus from highs/lows.

My Implementation Plan: I'll start this on _____ (date), at _____ (time). My plan is to review it daily, saying the affirmation aloud, and note in a habit app each time I use it during lows. My sponsor gets proof through daily app export screenshots texted to him by evening, and we can role-play the affirmation in sessions.

J. Live by faith, not sight (Hebrews 11:1-40): Start now by picking one "faith hero" from Hebrews 11 (like Abraham) and reading their story briefly online or in a Bible app.

Apply it by setting a small, unseen goal for the day (e.g., resisting a trigger without immediate reward), trusting the process, and noting the outcome to build belief in progress.

My Implementation Plan: I'll start this on _____ (date), at _____ (time). My plan is to set one unseen goal daily, track the outcome in my journal by evening, and tie it to the hero's example. My sponsor will verify by receiving a photo of the journal page daily via text, and he'll ask follow-up questions on how it built faith.

K. Embrace forgiveness and renewal (Hebrews 8:10-12; 10:16-18): Right away, do a "forgiveness release"—write down one past mistake on paper, then symbolically destroy it (tear or burn safely) while saying, "That's no longer me." Follow with a renewal step:

List three new habits to adopt this week, starting with one today, to focus on transformation over guilt.

My Implementation Plan: I'll start this on _____ (date), at _____ (time). My plan is to implement one new habit daily, logging progress in a notebook. To show my sponsor, I'll video the destruction (safely) once and send it, then text daily habit updates with photos, so he can confirm during reviews.

L. Run the race with endurance (Hebrews 12:1-2): Today, identify and "throw off" one entangling habit—delete a triggering app or clear out temptation items from your space.

Then, start your "race" with a daily step goal: Walk or journal for 15 minutes, fixing your mind on a positive focus like Jesus or your end goal, and build endurance by increasing it gradually each day.

My Implementation Plan: I'll start this on _____ (date), at _____ (time). My plan is to do the 15-minute walk or journal daily, increasing by 5 minutes weekly, and record details in a fitness app. My sponsor will know through shared app access or weekly screenshots emailed on Mondays, plus discussing the mental focus in our meetings.

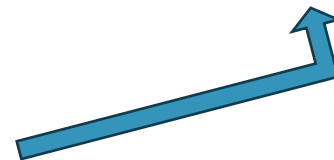
Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1. Read Carefully through to the next Action List.		
	2. Then complete the TOP 10 List of what you learned in this reading.		
	3. Call or Text Your Sponsor to schedule the first meeting to go over these pages. Do not miss a night checking in. This is important to determine if you are serious about completing a step study.		
	4. Partially fill in the weekly planning sheet writing in mandatory meetings that you know you will have each week (like house meetings, drug court requirements, etc.).		
	5. Notify step leader/ sponsor of possible days of the week that you are available for a weekly one-hour meeting starting next week. These might be video call or in person.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



Feel free to also use each weekly action list for personal needs or reminders. This is your own To Do list for the week. Make it work for you. Items may be recovery related or not.



How to Use

The Resilients in Recovery®

12-Step Curriculum Notebook

A Guide to Effective and Reflective Recovery Practice

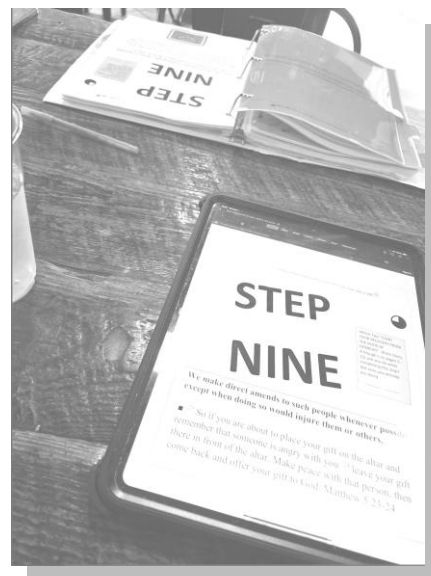
The Resilients in Recovery® 12-Step Notebook is an invaluable tool designed to assist individuals on their journey through the 12-step recovery process. Whether you are new to recovery or have been on this path for some time, the notebook offers a structured and supportive way to navigate each step. Here, we provide a detailed guide on how to use this notebook effectively.

1. Understanding the Layout

The notebook is divided into sections corresponding to each of the 12 steps of recovery. Each section includes prompts, questions, reflections, and space for journaling. This layout helps you to stay organized and focused as you work through each step systematically.

2. Setting Up a Routine

Consistency is key when using the Resilients In Recovery® 12-Step Notebook. Set aside a specific time each day to write in your notebook. This could be in the morning, as part of your daily meditation, or in the evening before bed. The important thing is to make it a regular part of your routine.



3. Working Through Each Step

Step 1: Admitting the Overwhelming Feeling that you have allowed yourself to become Powerlessness

In this section, you will find prompts that encourage you to reflect on your struggles and acknowledge your powerlessness over your addiction. Write honestly about your experiences, feelings, and the ways in which your addiction has impacted your life.

Reflect also on medical myths that may have contributed to your struggles, such as the notion that low-fat diets are essential for health. These can lead to energy crashes and heightened vulnerability to addiction.

Step 2: Believing in God as your Higher Power

Here, you will explore your beliefs and thoughts about God. The prompts will guide you to contemplate your spiritual beliefs, how they have evolved, and how they can support your recovery. As you contemplate spiritual beliefs, include deliverance prayers to break generational curses or demonic influences on addictions and addictive behaviors.

Step 3: Making a Decision to Turn Your Will Over to God

This step involves making a conscious decision to surrender your will to God. Use the notebook to write about your fears, hopes, and what it means to you to let go of control. Reflect on the trust you are building in the process.

Steps 4 and 5: Self-Inventory and Confession

These sections are particularly comprehensive, as they require deep self-reflection. The notebook provides space for you to list and explore your resentments, fears, and harmful behaviors. As you list resentments and harms, include dependencies on pharmaceuticals rooted in medical myths, such as statins for non-existent cholesterol dangers.

Once you have completed your inventory, use the prompts to prepare for confessing these to yourself, to God, and another person. Explore dissociated parts from trauma by journaling dialogues: "What does this inner part need from Jesus for healing?" Confess associated sins, seeking integration through prayer for wholeness.

Steps 6 and 7: Readiness and Humility

In Step 6, you will write about your readiness to overcome your struggles and shortcomings by asking God for wisdom. The prompts will help you articulate what changes you seek and why. In Step 7, focus on humility and your prayers for strength to overcome your shortcomings. In seeking God's wisdom for change, address how dietary inflammation from grains or sugars fuels anxiety and relapse risks.

Steps 8 and 9: Making Amends

These steps involve listing those you have harmed and preparing to make amends. The notebook provides structured prompts to help you think about how to approach these individuals and what you need to say to make meaningful amends.

Map your family tree and pray: "I renounce ancestral addictions per Exodus 20:5, breaking their hold through Christ's blood." Include these in your amends list for holistic healing.

Steps 10, 11, and 12: Maintenance, Prayer, and Service

The final steps are about maintaining your progress, seeking ongoing spiritual growth, and helping others. Use the notebook to track your daily inventory, note your prayers and meditations, and plan ways to be of service to others in recovery. In seeking God's will, discern spiritual influences: Meditate on soul, spirit, and body realms, journaling revelations about hidden oppressions and praying for clarity.

4. Reflecting on Your Progress

You will meet with your sponsor or step leader one on one for an hour each week to review (read) your responses as you progress through the steps. You will also periodically review your entries to reflect on your growth and progress. Look for patterns, recurring themes, and areas where you have made significant improvements. This reflection is key to understanding your journey and staying motivated.

3. The 12-Steps and the 10 R-E-S-I-L-I-E-N-T-S Principles

The Resilients in Recovery® 12-Step program obviously consists of the steps listed above but also of 10 principles that are not taken in a particular order—they apply to your recovery “all the time”, mostly from day one. We start each principle with a letter from the word RESILIENTS to make them easier to remember. These principles don’t match up to particular steps along your progress. But they apply to your recovery in every step.

5. Additional Tips for Success

- Be Honest: Honesty with yourself is crucial in recovery. Write openly and truthfully in your notebook.
- Use the Prompts: The prompts are designed to guide your thoughts and reflections. Use them fully to get the most out of your writing.
- Seek Support: Share your progress with a sponsor or trusted accountability partners in your recovery circle. Their insights can be invaluable.
- Attend Faith Based Recovery Meetings: Interactions with others in recovery will challenge your thinking and support your recovery.
 - Consider attending a 12-Step meeting every day, whether you are mandated to do so or not.



- Do more than one meeting per day early in your recovery.
- Never stop going to meetings. Your recovery will be important to you for the rest of your life.
- Be Patient: Recovery is a journey, not a destination. Be patient with yourself as you work through each step.
- Celebrate Milestones: Acknowledge and celebrate your achievements, no matter how small they may seem. Every step forward is progress.

Conclusion

The Resilients in Recovery® 12-Step Notebook is more than just a journal; it is a companion on your path to recovery.

By using it consistently and thoughtfully, you can gain deeper insights into your addiction, build a stronger connection with God, and develop the tools you need to live a fulfilling and sober life.

Remember, recovery is a lifelong journey, and with the right tools and support, you can navigate it successfully.



Resilients in Recovery® Mission Statement

We who have experienced brokenness but have chosen life recovery, choose to love the broken, offer hope to the hopeless and provide a sober, safe, and supportive environment for the hurting to heal, be transformed and be equipped for service through the power of Jesus Christ.

“Use your heads as you live and work among outsiders. Don’t miss a chance to do good.”

— Colossians 4:5 (The Message)

Inner Healing Prayers for Soul Wounds

I. Introduction

- **Purpose:** This introduction prepares participants in Resilients in Recovery for the 12-step process by addressing deep-seated soul wounds—emotional, psychological, and spiritual traumas—that may hinder progress if left unhealed.
- **Biblical Foundation:** Drawing from principles in Scripture (e.g., Psalm 147:3, "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds"), inner healing invites Jesus Christ to minister directly to painful memories, fostering wholeness before embarking on recovery steps.
- **Rationale:** Unresolved traumas can manifest as triggers, leading to relapse; proactive healing equips individuals with resilience, aligning with the 12-step emphasis on spiritual awakening and personal inventory.

II. The Role of Inner Healing in 12-Step Recovery

- **Pre-Step Preparation:** Before initiating Step 1 (admitting powerlessness), engage in inner healing to uncover root causes of addiction, such as abandonment, abuse, or shame, preventing these from sabotaging surrender to a Higher Power.
- **Benefits:** Enhances self-awareness, reduces emotional reactivity, and strengthens reliance on divine intervention, complementing the program's focus on moral inventory (Step 4) and making amends (Steps 8-9).
- **Caution:** Proceed prayerfully, recognizing that healing may surface intense emotions; seek professional support if dissociation or severe distress occurs.

III. Guided Prayers for Healing Deep Traumas

- **Preparation:** Find a quiet space, invite the Holy Spirit's presence, and recall specific memories of trauma without forcing details.
- **Prayer for Invitation and Revelation:** "Lord Jesus, I invite You into the memory of [specific pain, e.g., childhood neglect or betrayal]. Show me Your presence in that moment and reveal any lies I believe about myself, such as 'I am unworthy' or 'I am alone.'"

- **Prayer for Truth Replacement:** "Heavenly Father, replace these lies with Your truth from Scripture, such as 'I am fearfully and wonderfully made' (Psalm 139:14) or 'You will never leave me nor forsake me' (Hebrews 13:5). Bind any spiritual oppression and fill me with Your peace."
- **Prayer for Forgiveness and Release:** "Lord, I forgive [person or self] for the harm caused in this memory, as You have forgiven me (Ephesians 4:32). Release me from bitterness and grant me freedom to move forward in recovery."
- **Closing Affirmation:** "Thank You, Jesus, for healing my soul wounds. Seal this work by Your blood and empower me for the 12 steps ahead."

IV. Journaling Responses and Sponsor Discussion

- **Journaling Practice:** After each prayer session, record insights, emotions, revealed lies, and truths received; note any physical sensations or visions for ongoing reflection.
- **Sponsor Integration:** Share journal entries with your sponsor to gain accountability and perspective, ensuring unaddressed wounds do not trigger relapse during vulnerable steps like inventory or amends.
- **Frequency:** Engage in these prayers weekly or as needed before starting the program, revisiting as new memories surface.

V. Conclusion: Embracing Wholeness in Recovery

- **Encouragement:** This inner healing process positions you as a resilient participant, ready to experience transformation through the 12 steps.
- **Final Prayer:** "Lord, guide my journey, heal my deepest wounds, and sustain my recovery for Your glory."

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® PRINCIPLES (& Scriptural Support for Each Principle)

- R** **Recognize that I am a spiritual being, not alone, having a human experience with real life struggles.** ■ “In Christ we can come before God with freedom and without fear. We can do this through faith in Christ.” Ephesians 3:12
- E** **Every aspect of my being matters to God who has the power to help me recover; He can use my struggles & experiences to help another with his or her recovery** ■ “We know that God makes all things work together for the good of those who love Him and are chosen to be a part of His plan.” Romans 8:28
- S** **Surrender your weakness to Christ, for His power is made perfect in redeeming, restoring, and reconciling your struggles to His plans for your life.** ■ “My gift of undeserved grace is all you need. My power is strongest when you are weak.” So, if Christ keeps giving me his power, I will gladly brag about how weak I am!” 2 Corinthians 12:9
- I** **Identify changes God wants me to make in my life and humbly ask for His wisdom to change my way of thinking and use the tools that He equips me with to make positive changes and overcome my struggles.** ■ ²³ God, examine me and know my heart; test me and know my anxious thoughts. See if there is any bad thing in me. ²⁴ Lead me on the road to everlasting life. Psalms 139:23-24 ■ Don't be like the people of this world, but let God change the way you think. Then you will know how to do everything that is good & pleasing to him. Romans 12:2
- L** **Learn from each mistake & every struggle developing an understanding that sometimes I win and sometimes I learn.** ■ “So now anyone who is in Christ Jesus is not judged guilty.” Romans 8:1
- I** **Identify ways that I can serve in day-to-day situations such as in the workplace and at meetings.** ■ “Do your work with enthusiasm. Work as if you were serving the Lord, not as if you were serving only men and women. Ephesians 6:7 ■ So then, encourage one another and build each other up, as you are doing. 1 Thessalonians 5:11
- E** **Express my gratitude on a daily basis.** ■ ¹⁶ Always be joyful. ¹⁷ Never stop praying. ¹⁸ Be thankful in all circumstances, for this is God's will for you who belong to Christ Jesus. 1 Thessalonians 5:16-18 ■ Each of you must give as you have made up your mind, not reluctantly or under compulsion, for God loves a cheerful giver. 2 Corinthians 9:7
- N** **Navigate life by ① reading, ② studying, and ③ applying lessons I learn from God's Word.** ■ “Everything in the Scriptures is God's Word. All of it is useful for teaching and helping people and for correcting them and showing them how to live.” 2 Timothy 3:16 ■ A man without self-control is as defenseless as a city with broken-down walls. Proverbs 25:28
- T** **Testify to those God puts in my path telling the story and how the 12-Steps of Recovery transformed my life.** ■ “Instead, you must worship Christ as Lord of your life. And if someone asks about your hope as a believer, always be ready to explain it.” 1 Peter 3:15
- S** **Schedule a daily time with God for ① self-examination, ② Bible reading, ③ study, and ④ prayer in order to know God and His will for my life- and to gain the power to follow His will.** ■ The Scriptures train God's servants to do all kinds of good deeds. 2 Timothy 3:17, ■ Brothers and sisters, think about the things that are good and worthy of praise. Think about the things that are true and honorable and right and pure and beautiful and respected. Philippians 4:8

12-STEPS OF RECOVERY (and scriptural support for each step)

RESISTENTS IN RECOVERY 12 Step TRANSFORMATION CURRICULUM VER 7.21 Page 34 of 614

- 1) **We admit that we struggle & we have allowed ourselves to become powerless over our addictions & compulsive behaviors, that our lives have become unmanageable.** ■ But I need something more! For if I know the law but still can't keep it, and if the power of sin within me keeps sabotaging my best intentions, I obviously need help! I realize that I don't have what it takes. I can will it, but I can't do it. I decide to do good, but I don't really do it; I decide not to do bad, but then I do it anyway. My decisions, such as they are, don't result in actions. Something has gone wrong deep within me and gets the better of me every time. Romans 7:18
- 2) **We come to believe that a power greater than ourselves can restore us to sanity.** ■ So humble yourselves before God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you. James 4:7 ■ For God is working in you, giving you the desire and the power to do what pleases him. Philippians 2:13
- 3) **We make the decision to turn our lives and our wills over to the care of God.** ■ Therefore, I urge you, brothers, and sisters, in view of God's mercy, to offer your bodies as living sacrifices, holy and pleasing to God - this is your spiritual act of worship. Romans 12:1 ■ Do what God's teaching says, when you only listen and do nothing, you are fooling yourselves. James 1:22
- 4) **We make a searching and fearless moral inventory of ourselves offering forgiveness to those who have harmed us.** ■ Let us examine our ways and test them and let us return to the Lord. Lamentations 3:40 ■ "God blesses those people who are merciful. They will be treated with mercy!" Matthew 5:7
- 5) **We examine & confess our faults ① to ourselves, ② to God, and ③ to someone we trust.** ■ Confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so God can heal you. When a believing person prays, great things happen. James 5:16
- 6) **We become open to the idea that God can guide us to freedom from struggles with character flaws and individual weaknesses.** ■ Humble yourselves before the Lord, and He will lift you up. James 4:10 ■ O Lord, you are my lamp. The Lord turns my darkness into light. 2 Samuel 22:29
- 7) **We humbly ask God for wisdom to equip us to overcome our shortcomings.** ■ Do any of you need wisdom? Ask God for it. He is generous and enjoys giving to everyone. So he will give you wisdom. James 1:5. ■ God is faithful and reliable. If we confess our sins, he forgives them and cleanses us from everything we've done wrong. 1 John 1:9
- 8) **We make a list of all persons we have harmed & we become willing to make amends to them all.** ■ Do to others as you would have them do to you. Luke 6:31. ■ "God blesses those people who make peace. They will be called his children!" Matthew 5:9
- 9) **We make direct amends to such people whenever possible, except when doing so would injure them or others.** ■ ²³ So if you are about to place your gift on the altar and remember that someone is angry with you ²⁴ leave your gift there in front of the altar. Make peace with that person, then come back and offer your gift to God. Matthew 5:23-24
- 10) **We continue to take personal inventory and when we are wrong, promptly admit it.** ■ So, if you think you are standing firm, be careful that you don't fall! 1 Corinthians 10:12
- 11) **We continually seek through prayer and meditation to improve our conscious contact with God, praying only for knowledge of His will for us, and power to carry that out.** ■ The word of Christ must live in you richly. Teach and warn each other with all wisdom by singing psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs. Sing to God with gratitude in your hearts. Colossians 3:16
- 12) **Having had a spiritual experience as the result of these steps, we try to carry this message to others and practice these principles in all our affairs.** ■ Brothers and sisters, if a person is caught doing something wrong, you who are spiritual should restore someone like this with a spirit of gentleness. Watch out for yourselves so you won't be tempted too. Galatians 6:1

How to Get the Most Out of Resilients in Recovery®

Pay attention. Stay off your phone during meetings. Put them on silent and put them away. **Never disrupt a meeting; that keeps others from working their own recovery.**

1. **Commit to a Plan** — Plan for regular attendance & commit to keeping the plan. Attendance is relapse prevention!
2. **Learn & Follow the Steps** — Ask a Resilients in Recovery Team leader to coach/ sponsor you through the steps.
3. **Awareness is Key** — We can't change what we don't acknowledge. Continue to grow in understanding your struggle seeking to understand the problems & solutions. What triggers do you see? What understanding do you gain from the shared experience of fellow strugglers? What is the Holy Spirit telling you?
4. **Journaling & Prayer** — Start journaling your observations about your area of struggle. Much of what you write in this note could be considered part of your daily journal. Prayerfully, ask God to reveal truths to you & help you to see areas of ineffective coping, but take a moment to listen for guidance about the next step(s) as well as contemplate what you are praying for. Ask trusted friends to speak truth to you and to help you see negative patterns.
5. **Accountability Partners & Sponsors** — Attend Resilients in Recovery events & build relationships. Ask someone you identify with and trust to be your accountability partner and/ or sponsor. (Pre-Step Lesson Sponsor)
6. **Daily Self-Examination & Mindfulness** — Life is stressful, & relationships can be messy further revealing our struggles. Maintain a daily time with God for self—examination. Continue to journal the challenges and progress in your area of struggle.
7. **Listen & Learn** — Take notes during large group teachings and testimonies keeping aware of your own story and area of struggle in mind. Look for similarities, not differences. What inspired or challenged you? Listen to others share in Open Share groups. What experiences give you hope, compassion, and understanding in your own journey? Talk with group leaders and members outside the meeting.
8. **Be Prepared to Share** — Resilients in Recovery is a safe place to share about your struggles. As you learn, follow the steps, pray, journal, and experience progress and setbacks (you will experience both) — share your week's challenges and victories in the group. If you are discouraged or tempted, let the group pray for and encourage you. If you have relapsed, there is no shame.
9. **Stick to the Plan** — Thinking about skipping a meeting? Evaluate your physical, emotional, relational, and spiritual health. Are you Hurting? Exhausted? Angry? Resentful? Tense? Reach out to God, your Accountability partners and/or Sponsor.
10. **Gratitude & Others** — Maintaining an attitude of gratitude is relapse prevention. Express gratitude toward God, others in your life. Share your experience and victories as an encouragement to others. Let I, become we. The first word in Step 1 is "We." The road to recovery is not meant to be traveled alone. The Newcomer will be grateful that you share your experiences, hope, and journey with him or her.
11. **Serve** — Serve others as Christ did. Get involved and help out behind the scenes, or with worship, step & principle readings, greetings, meals, and more.

Pre-Reading Before you Get Started

KEY TERMS Familiarize yourself with these foundational terms before beginning your Step Study.

Accountability Partnership

A committed relationship with one or more trusted individuals who agree to walk alongside you in truth and love, providing consistent check-ins, honest feedback, and prayerful support. True accountability is not surveillance—it is covenant. As John Townsend and Henry Cloud describe in *Boundaries*, healthy accountability combines grace and truth, creating the safe container where real change becomes possible.

Addiction

A compulsive pattern of behavior—whether involving substances, relationships, food, sex, technology, or other sources—that temporarily fills emotional or spiritual voids but ultimately deepens them. Stephen Arterburn (*Life Recovery Bible*) frames addiction as 'medicating pain God never intended us to carry alone.' It is not a moral failure but a spiritual and neurological condition requiring integrated healing.

Behavioral Relapse

The gradual drift back toward addictive thinking patterns, emotional dysregulation, and old coping behaviors that precedes a return to physical use. As outlined in this curriculum, relapse rarely happens suddenly—it builds over time through subtle shifts in perception, attitude, and behavior. Recognizing early warning signs is essential to prevention.

Boundaries

Personal limits—emotional, relational, physical, and spiritual—that define where you end and another person begins. Drawing from Drs. Cloud and Townsend's foundational work, healthy boundaries are not walls of self-protection but property lines of the soul that enable genuine love and responsible living. In recovery, learning to set and respect boundaries is foundational to healing.

Dry Drunk Syndrome

A condition in which a person abstains from substances but continues to exhibit the emotional and behavioral patterns that fueled the addiction—including anger, dishonesty, restlessness, resentment, and irritability. Russell Brand (*Recovery*) and the 12-Step tradition both emphasize that sobriety without inner transformation is a fragile and incomplete healing. True recovery addresses the roots, not just the fruit.

False Belief / Lie

A distorted thought or deeply held internal message—often rooted in trauma, abandonment, abuse, or shame—that shapes how we see ourselves, others, and God. Neil T. Anderson (*The Bondage Breaker*) teaches that spiritual and emotional captivity is sustained by believing lies (e.g., 'I am unworthy,' 'I am alone,' 'I am beyond help'). Freedom begins when these lies are identified, renounced, and replaced with biblical truth.

Gluconeogenesis

The body's built-in metabolic process of producing glucose from non-carbohydrate sources such as proteins and fats, used especially when dietary carbohydrates are low. Dr. Ken Berry's work challenges the myth that the brain requires dietary carbohydrates to function—the body manufactures what it needs. This is foundational to understanding why a low-carb, ketogenic approach can reduce cravings and stabilize mood during recovery.

Inner Healing

A prayerful, Spirit-led process of inviting Jesus Christ into unresolved traumatic memories to reveal His presence, replace lies with truth, and release emotional and spiritual wounds. Unlike cognitive therapy alone, inner healing

addresses the spiritual dimension of pain—recognizing that only the Healer Himself can fully restore what was broken (Psalm 147:3). It is a foundational pre-step practice in the Resilients in Recovery program.

Intentionality

The deliberate, proactive choice to pursue growth, healing, and recovery rather than simply reacting to life's circumstances. John Maxwell defines intentional living as making every day count by aligning your choices with your values and goals. In recovery, intentionality means scheduling your writing, attending your meetings, and doing the work—before you feel like it.

Ketogenic / Low-Carb Nutrition

A dietary approach that prioritizes healthy fats, proteins, and non-starchy vegetables while minimizing refined sugars, grains, and starches. Dr. Ken Berry demonstrates that this way of eating stabilizes blood sugar, reduces neurological inflammation, supports healthy dopamine and serotonin function, and significantly lowers cravings—making it a powerful companion to 12-Step recovery. It is an act of stewardship over the body as God's temple (1 Corinthians 6:19).

Milestone Celebration

The intentional marking of progress in recovery—whether a day, a week, 30 days, 90 days, a year, or the completion of a Step—in ways that affirm growth without creating new risks. Celebrations in recovery are reimagined: they are sober, safe, and meaningful, often shared with a sponsor or accountability partner over a meal, a walk, or a moment of prayer.

Moral Inventory

A thorough, written self-examination (associated with Step 4) that surfaces resentments, fears, relational harms, and character patterns that have fueled addictive behavior. As Craig Groeschel notes, we cannot change what we are unwilling to honestly confront. The inventory is not an exercise in shame—it is an act of courageous self-awareness that opens the door to genuine transformation.

Recovery

A lifelong, ongoing process of healing—physical, emotional, relational, and spiritual—that moves a person from the grip of addiction toward freedom, wholeness, and purpose. Recovery is for everyone, whether struggling with substances, behavioral compulsions, trauma, or relational dysfunction. It is not a destination but a direction—and every honest step forward counts.

Relapse Prevention

A proactive set of strategies, spiritual disciplines, and relational structures designed to interrupt the early stages of behavioral and emotional regression before they escalate to physical use. Effective prevention involves knowing your triggers, doubling your meeting attendance during vulnerable seasons, addressing resentments, practicing service, and maintaining close contact with your sponsor and accountability team.

Resentment

Unresolved anger, bitterness, or offense toward a person, situation, or institution that is held internally and rehearsed over time. Often called 'the number one offender' in recovery circles, resentment is both a primary cause and consequence of relapse. Fred Stoeker (Every Man's Battle series) and the 12-Step tradition both emphasize that resentment is a poison we drink while expecting the other person to suffer.

Self-Care

The intentional, disciplined practice of tending to your own physical, emotional, and spiritual health—not as indulgence, but as stewardship. In this curriculum, self-care is the organizing principle beneath all recovery disciplines: daily writing, prayer, nutrition, sleep, accountability, and meeting attendance. You cannot give what you do not have. Caring for yourself is an act of faithfulness.

Shame

The painful internal experience of believing 'I am bad,' 'I am broken,' or 'I am beyond repair'—as distinct from guilt, which says 'I did something wrong.' John Townsend and Henry Cloud emphasize that shame, when unchecked, drives

people deeper into hiding and addiction rather than toward healing. Shame loses its power when brought into the light of honest relationship and the grace of God.

Sober Living Home

A structured, abstinence-focused transitional living environment that provides peer accountability, community support, and recovery-oriented structure after inpatient treatment—or as an alternative to it. Research consistently shows that longer stays in sober living environments correlate with greater long-term sobriety rates and improved mental health outcomes.

Soul Wound

A deep emotional, psychological, or spiritual injury resulting from trauma, betrayal, abandonment, abuse, or other significant pain that remains unhealed and continues to influence behavior, relationships, and recovery. Neil T. Anderson's framework recognizes that unhealed soul wounds become doorways for spiritual oppression and behavioral compulsion. Inner healing prayer specifically targets these wounds.

Sponsor / Step Leader

A trained, experienced guide who walks alongside a person in recovery—reading the same curriculum, meeting weekly, listening without judgment, asking hard questions, and offering prayerful encouragement. The sponsor does not fix or rescue; they model, witness, and hold space for transformation. As this curriculum's Sponsor Agreement states: 'I will be your biggest encourager—but I cannot work the steps for you.'

Spiritual Warfare

The ongoing, real conflict between the believer's freedom and the forces of darkness that seek to maintain bondage through temptation, deception, shame, and accusation. Neil T. Anderson (Victory Over the Darkness) and this curriculum both affirm that recovery is not only psychological but spiritual—and that binding temptation in Jesus' name, declaring truth, and putting on the full armor of God are daily practices, not theological abstractions.

Step Work

The active, written engagement with the 12 Steps of recovery under the guidance of a sponsor or step leader. Step work is not passive reading—it requires honest written answers, vulnerability in sharing, and willingness to change. Mike Yorkey and Stephen Arterburn's writing in the Life Recovery Bible tradition frames Step work as the practical expression of surrender to God and self-examination in community.

Transformation

The deep, lasting change in a person's character, thinking, patterns, and identity that occurs through sustained recovery work, spiritual renewal, and relational healing. John Maxwell distinguishes between change (external, temporary) and transformation (internal, permanent). True transformation—as the Resilients in Recovery mission states—is made possible through 'the power of Jesus Christ,' not willpower alone.

Trauma

Any experience—physical, emotional, sexual, relational, or spiritual—that overwhelms a person's capacity to process and integrate it, leaving a lasting imprint on the nervous system, beliefs, and behavior. Trauma is frequently a root cause of addiction: substances and compulsive behaviors often began as attempts to manage the pain that trauma left behind. Addressing trauma directly—rather than only its symptoms—is central to lasting recovery.

Writing as Self-Care

The intentional, regular practice of putting thoughts, feelings, prayers, and reflections into written form as a primary tool of recovery. As outlined in this curriculum, writing is not a school assignment—it is a healing discipline. Journaling externalizes the internal, creates space for honest reflection, builds self-awareness, and helps break the cycle of reactive living. Protect your writing time like you would protect any other form of medicine.

WRITING AS SELF-CARE: AN IMPORTANT PART OF YOUR JOURNEY

Congratulations on choosing to work the faith-based 12 Steps to Recovery through the Resilients in Recovery® Program.

Recovery truly is for everyone—even if many people don’t realize it yet—and making this commitment is one of the most important decisions you can make to take care of yourself.

Self-care runs through everything we do in this program, and regular writing is one of its most powerful tools. You will do a great deal of writing on this journey. Our hope is that answering the weekly questions in this curriculum will help make writing a regular, meaningful practice for you. We also encourage you to journal your thoughts freely and look forward to that dedicated time for honest reflection and deep thinking.

To stay consistent, choose the time of day when your energy and mental clarity are at their best—whether that’s first thing in the morning, after lunch, or late at night. Protect this writing time fiercely. Don’t let emails, meetings, social media, or other distractions steal it away. Just like exercise, if you don’t schedule it during your peak energy window, it often doesn’t happen. Give your best hours to your recovery.

By investing time and energy in your writing practice, you are sustaining and caring for yourself in a profound way. This discipline will not only strengthen your recovery but will also help you become a happier, clearer, and more effective person in every area of your life.

Take the writing prompts in this curriculum seriously. Let them drive your recovery each day rather than simply reacting and coping with whatever comes your way. Be intentional. Don’t procrastinate until the last day before your meeting. When you make your self-care a real priority, you’ll move forward with purpose—and you’ll discover how good it feels to be productive in your own healing.



Special Note from the Directors of Resilients in Recovery®

To Those Working the Steps Again

If you are returning to the Steps—whether this is your second, third, fourth, or any subsequent time—thank you for choosing the Resilients in Recovery® Program once more. Your willingness to go deeper shows real courage and commitment to lasting freedom.

As you work through the questions in this curriculum, we invite you to approach them with fresh eyes and an open heart. Pay special attention to:

- Events that have taken place in your life since the last time you worked these Steps
- New people you've met and significant encounters you've had
- “Aha” moments when memories from earlier in life surface—things you now realize you never included before
- Items from your previous Step 4 inventory that still feel unresolved
- Situations with individuals or organizations where resentments you thought were forgiven have quietly returned
- Anything you may have intentionally left out during earlier rounds

This time, focus primarily on the problems and issues that have crept back into your life, along with any lifelong patterns that continue to challenge you. Think of many of the questions as beginning with the phrase: **“Since the last time you worked this Step...”**

Remember: there are no wrong answers, only honest ones. Growth happens in the honesty.

For added accountability this round, you may wish to switch roles with your sponsor (taking turns as sponsor/sponsee). Or consider working with a different Step leader or life coach than the one you used before. Fresh perspective often brings new breakthroughs.

You've done this work before—and you already know the power it holds. Now it's time to let it go even deeper.

With deep respect and belief in your recovery journey,

Stanton & Ariella Robertson Program Directors: Resilients in Recovery®

In the Resilients in Recovery® Program...

--- we guide you through the 12 Steps one person at a time and one step at a time. This personal, focused approach creates the space for honest reflection, deeper healing, and lasting transformation.



Here's exactly how the process works:

- You and your sponsor (or step leader) will each have a copy of the Resilients in Recovery® Curriculum.
- This notebook is your personal workbook. You will write honest answers to every question, moving through them in order.
- Schedule a regular one-hour meeting with your sponsor or step leader at the same time each week.
- At each meeting, you will read your written answers aloud. Your sponsor may ask questions or invite you to explore certain areas more deeply.
- You will work at a pace that is right for you. Your sponsor or step leader will offer gentle guidance if you are moving too quickly or too slowly.
- Always bring this notebook to every meeting.
- If you have not completed the writing, the meeting will be rescheduled. Coming prepared honors your commitment to recovery.

Before Your First Meeting Please complete items 1-8 on the Curriculum Completion Checklist. The checklist boxes are there to guide your progress, especially during the first two weeks.

At the End of Every Step You will complete three important reflection pages:

- The Top 10 page – listing the ten most meaningful things you learned
- The Prayer Needs page – noting the people, situations, and areas you want to bring to God in prayer
- The Praying in the Form of Writing page – a place to write out specific prayers tied to your recovery

Congratulations again on choosing to work your recovery through the Resilients in Recovery® Program. We're honored to walk this journey with you.

- You & your sponsor or step-leader both have a copy of the 12 Step Curriculum.
- Your copy (this notebook) is a workbook for you to write it.
- You progress through the questions IN ORDER writing your answer to each question.
- You and your sponsor or step-leader schedule

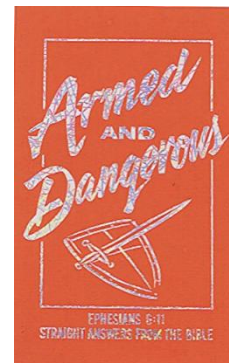
Before you undertake your Resilients in Recovery® Step Study,

we strongly recommend that you purchase your own copy of :

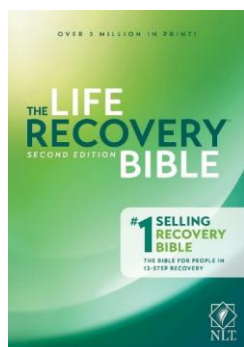
Armed and Dangerous by Ken Abraham

With nearly a million copies sold, Armed & Dangerous has become a trusted favorite for teens. Instantly recognizable by its bright orange cover, this powerful resource features more than 100 vital topics and over 1,000 Bible passages from both the King James and New International Versions.

It offers God's clear perspective on real-life issues and helps teens apply biblical truth to their everyday experiences. Practical, challenging, and encouraging, Armed & Dangerous equips young people with the truth they need to grow strong in their faith.



NLT Life Recovery Bible Addiction Bible Tied to 12 Steps of Recovery for Help with Drugs, Alcohol, Personal Struggles – With Meeting Guide by Tyndale, Stephen Arterburn, et al.



Tyndale's Life Recovery Bible is the #1-selling recovery Bible, with over 3 million copies in print.

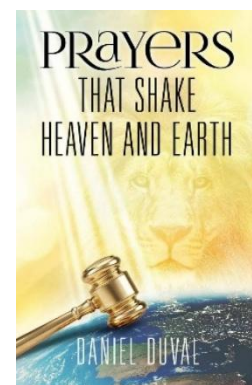
It points straight to God as the true source of recovery and equips readers with powerful tools and features designed to break the grip of addiction.

Trusted by thousands, it is widely used alongside 12-Step programs, in correctional facilities, and by anyone determined to take their life back from the behaviors and substances that once held them captive

Prayers That Shake Heaven and Earth by Daniel Duval

This book is not a teaching tool, but a powerful collection of prayer resources. It is available as a free download.

Daniel Duval serves as Executive Director of BRIDE Ministries and Senior Leader of The BRIDE Ministries Church. A licensed minister, author, international speaker, and host of the weekly broadcast Discovering the Truth with Dan Duval, he is also a highly sought-after coach specializing in Dissociative Identity Disorder (DID) and Satanic Ritual Abuse (SRA). His vision is to promote unity in the body of Christ worldwide and assist in the development of sheep nations.



Forms, Check lists, and Contract

- Curriculum Transcript (Back of notebook)
- Weekly Planner of What Meetings I will Attend
- Significant Milestones to Celebrate with Sponsor and Accountability Partners.
- Sponsor contract, and what is expected of me and my sponsor.
- Resilients in Recovery Action List
- Resilients in Recovery Meeting Attendance Sheet



Participant: _____

MAKE COPIES OF THIS SHEET AS NEEDED

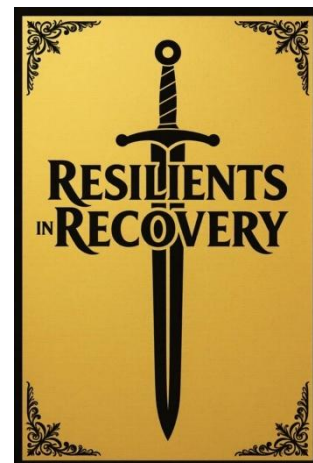
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Sponsor Agreement

In Order to Proceed when we get to Step 1 with your Resilients in Recover Sponsor, Step Leader or Life Coach you must agree to the Following:

What is required of you:

- 1) You agree to attend a total of five meetings per week.
 - a) These five meetings include
 - i) our step study meeting,
 - ii) at least one other Resilients in Recovery Meeting,
 - iii) and three other recovery meetings.
 - b) I can help you locate meetings to attend regularly. You will keep a log of those meetings signed off by the meeting leader as you attend each. You will show me that list of five meetings you have attended each week. If you have a sheet that you already have to show to a recovery center, Drug Court or a probation officer, bring that sheet with you to each meeting with me.
- 2) This means you agree to attend weekly recovery meetings and serve at meetings regularly.
 - a) If you are in a town where a Christ Centered Recovery group is closer to you than one in Athens, attend that group weekly and serve with that group.
 - b) You should not routinely miss meetings.
 - c) Attending a meeting means staying for the full meeting, including the small group.
 - d) You agree to attend weekly church services at the church of your choosing or with Resilients in Recovery Character Study meetings.
- 3) I will ask you regularly how you are serving.
 - a) You agree to participate in service activities with/ at that church or with Resilients in Recovery Character Study meetings.
 - b) I will ask you regularly how you are serving.
- 4) Commit to daily Bible reading.
 - a) Read a Bible in a language you can understand. We recommend the Celebrate Recover Bible because of the Character Studies and Recovery Stories.
 - b) Read a Daily Devotional. We recommend the Celebrate Recovery 365 Daily Devotional Book or the Resilients in Recovery Read a Daily Devotional with journal prompts for each day.
 - c) Commit to having your own recovery Bible such as the *Celebrate Recovery Bible* or *another recovery Bible*.
- 5) Commit to daily prayer.
 - a) Share your prayer requests with me. I will share mine with you.
 - b) Learn & pray the Serenity Prayer.



- 6) Keep a Journal (journal about what you are learning from God, about your recovery issues, your “ah-ha moments”, struggles, victories, and even your responses to step study questions, etc.).
 - a) You will also learn several different ways to journal as we work through the step notebook. (You can also get ideas from Resilients in Recovery Read a Daily Devotional with journal prompts for each day.
 - b) This can be a spiral notebook, or whatever works for you.
 - c) When we meet, bring in your Journal:
 - i) Google *Docs* and Google *Keep* works well if you like technology.
 - ii) You might consider using a calendar feature on your phone for journal entries.
- 7) Keep in close contact with me and your accountability partners.
 - a) Establish accountability partners (at least four people). Do that today.
 - b) I will ask you to identify who your accountability partners are.
 - c) You agree to call or text me at least four times per week and once on weekends explaining:
 - i) What you are grateful for,
 - ii) How your day went,
 - iii) What you are praying about today and how I can pray for you.
 - d) Call before you use or slip rather than afterwards.
 - i) This means before a slip in your area of struggle.
 - ii) Your struggle might include relationship issues, pornography, bingeing, alcohol, internet, drugs, shopping, or one of several other addictive behaviors that we will address in Step 1.
 - e) Make another 1 to 2 phone calls a week to your accountability partners.
 - f) Respect my boundaries –
 - i) Please do not call after 10:00 on any given night unless it is an emergency – I need my sleep too.
 - ii) I will let you know when I am out of town/ cannot be reached; use your accountability partners then.
- 8) You agree to meet with me every weeks for lunch, coffee, dinner, etc.
 - a) It is your responsibility to coordinate times to meet with me.
 - b) Track me down and schedule with me. You can text me to arrange this with text/ voice/ email/ messenger.
- 9) You Promise to be completely honest with me about your issues, struggles, fears, addictions, insecurities, etc.
 - i) You agree to accept my constructive criticism, input, suggestions, encouragement, praisens, homework assignments, etc.
 - ii) but know that I cannot & will not be able to fix you. You have to do this for yourself. Only you can.
- 10) You agree to complete three required readings.
 - a) There are three Workshop Breaks in the step study list in addition to Step study

homework.

- b) You will have a choice of books to read after step 1, step 4 and step 10.
- 11) Keep a confidence. I will share things about myself, and I must be able to trust you
 - a) If these requirements are not met (and/or for other reasons) at any time, we can terminate this sponsor relationship with no feelings hurt.
 - b) My sponsorship is reserved for those who want recovery and are willing to do the challenging work needed to work the steps weekly. However, I will continue to pray for you and your recovery.

What to expect from me as your Resilients in Recovery Sponsor, Step Leader or Life Coach:

- 1) I am not your Savior. I cannot fix you.
- 2) To the best of my ability, I will be available in times of crisis and/or potential relapse. I will make myself available for phone calls, meetings, lunches, etc.
- 3) I promise to use God's Word as a foundation to provide an objective point of view, to encourage, spiritually advise and help you find options and God's prescribed direction.
- 4) I'll be a great cheer leader as you work the steps, but I will not & can't work them for you.
- 5) I will not drag, push or pull you through recovery, but I will be your biggest encourager.
- 6) I promise to continue to grow myself in God's Word to be the best "model" possible for you, to live a lifestyle which is a result of working the steps and principles, seek God's will for my life; knowing that I must continue to change and grow to get rid of my character defects. My recovery will not be put on the back burner.
- 7) I promise to be honest, to respect you and your boundaries.
- 8) I promise to show you unconditional love, not judge nor condemn.
- 9) I promise to praise your efforts and changes. I will always speak truth in love and together, we will recover and grow, one day at a time.
- 10) I promise to keep a confidence. However, if you disclose that you are thinking of hurting yourself or someone else, I will have to seek wise counsel and/or assistance.
- 11) If I do not meet your needs & these requirements of me, as your sponsor (and/or for other reasons) at any time you have the right/freedom to terminate this sponsor agreement...no feelings hurt.

By continuing at this point and beginning Step One you agree to the terms in the above Sponsor agreement.

Your Signature _____

Date Signed _____

Witness/ Accountability Partner Signature _____

WRITE DOWN YOUR ASSINGMENTS.

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



STRENGTHENING YOUR RECOVERY: ESSENTIAL TOOLS AND PERSPECTIVES

Recovery is a lifelong journey of growth, supported by practical actions, spiritual practices, community, and informed choices. This section outlines key ways to build and maintain resilience in your recovery through the Resilients in Recovery® program and beyond.

Tips to Get Connected and Strengthen Your Recovery

Build a strong foundation by prioritizing these habits:

- Form an **Accountability Team** — Secure a sponsor and accountability partners right away.
- Attend meetings consistently — Never miss unless absolutely necessary; reschedule instead of skipping. You're worth the effort.
- Use a **Recovery Bible** — Read daily commentaries focused on recovery.
- Exchange phone numbers — Connect with others in the Resilients in Recovery program for support.
- Pray daily — Start your morning by asking God for help with struggles; end your evening with thanks for His guidance.
- Seek additional meetings — Attend Resilients in Recovery and other recovery groups multiple times per week—more than one meeting is essential.
- Go beyond requirements — Make extra effort to attend more meetings and get involved (e.g., service roles—talk to a leader for ideas).
- Pair with partners on goals — Share check-ins for nutritional aims (like avoiding high-carb foods for emotional stability) and progress in meetings.

Where Does a 12-Step Program Fit into My Recovery Plan?

Rehab centers stabilize you but do not "fix" you—they prepare you to begin true recovery work.

- Once stable, start a 12-Step program like Resilients in Recovery®—some rehabs even allow this during treatment.
- Working the 12 Steps (guided by a trained sponsor or step leader) doesn't fix you either—it helps you discover answers within yourself, building a personal recovery toolkit for ongoing use.
- These programs don't teach you simply to stop using; they reveal **why** you used (e.g., to fill voids, numb pain, or cope temporarily).

- The Resilients in Recovery® curriculum uncovers roots of addiction (substance and behavioral) and adds tools for handling them.
- True recovery involves:
 - Processing trauma, uncomfortable feelings, and behaviors.
 - Changing distorted thinking and short-term coping skills.
 - Understanding that substances/behaviors fill emotional/spiritual voids.

Safely Celebrating Milestones in Recovery

Celebrating progress is vital, but safety comes first—especially early on, when emotions run high and triggers risk relapse.

- Focus primarily on **completing 12 Steps** (e.g., Steps 1, 4, 5, 9 deserve special recognition with your sponsor/accountability partners—perhaps a shared meal).
- Acknowledge time-based milestones cautiously:
 - Pre-Step/starting Step 1: Pat yourself on the back—it's huge, but relapse risk remains high.
 - 1 week: Past initial withdrawal—great start, but still vulnerable.
 - 30 days: Celebrate carefully—you're fragile but succeeding.
 - 90 days: Body adjusts to sobriety; confidence grows, relapse risk drops.
 - 6 months: Feel more confident; celebrate proudly.
 - 1 year: Major accomplishment—persevere and enjoy safely.
 - 5+ years: Life changes dramatically; remain cautious but embrace fun.
- Celebrate other wins too: daily victories, leading a meeting, clean evaluations, amends (Step 9), ending physical dependence, steady employment, new hobbies/friends, mental health improvements, healthy relationships, physical health gains (e.g., via low-carb nutrition—celebrate with non-sugary treats like steak dinner).
- Track progress (e.g., via app) and celebrate with sponsor (coffee/dinner at 100 days).
- Learn sober fun: Celebrations no longer mean substances. Reclaim simple joys—time with safe family/friends, cookouts, travel, journaling retreats,

dining out (home or restaurant), charitable donations, ice cream/sweet treats (or alternatives), amusement parks.

- Avoid triggers: Skip bars (if alcohol recovery), limit invites to non-using people, choose low-risk settings.

Relapse Prevention in Recovery

Relapse happens when you drift from what works—shifting back in perception/behavior. It can strike anyone, even without obvious urges, as temptation exploits weaknesses (Satan as Tempter; Hebrews 4:15).

- Relapse worsens addiction, amplifying guilt/shame that drives deeper use—especially for Christians feeling like failures.
- Combat it with support: Remind the person they're not a failure, progress is real, and victory is possible (Galatians 6:2—bear burdens; Romans 8:1—no condemnation).
- Rebound through therapy (12 Steps), fellowship, sharing, prayer, and wise choices.
- Daily spiritual warfare: Bind temptation in Jesus' name and declare freedom.
- Additional tools: Consider a ketogenic/low-carb diet (healthy fats, low carbs) to stabilize blood sugar, reduce inflammation/cravings (body as temple—1 Corinthians 6:19). Example meals: eggs/avocado breakfast, grilled chicken salad lunch, fatty fish/greens dinner—track weekly.
- Shame is brief awareness only—don't dwell (it gives the Enemy leverage). Instead, reach out vulnerably, admit failings, seek constructive help without self-beating.
- Relapse doesn't erase progress—any sober day is success. Reflect on lessons, avoid negative self-talk, continue goals, celebrate staying sober another day.

Nutrition and Its Role in Overcoming Addiction

Conventional advice often pushes high-carb, low-fat diets (grains, fruits)—but this can destabilize recovery.

- High carbs (refined sugars/grains) cause blood sugar spikes/crashes, mimicking substance highs/lows, activating reward pathways, triggering cravings, irritability, anxiety—worsening vulnerability during key Steps.
- Chronic effects include inflammation/insulin resistance, compounding recovery challenges.
- Evidence (e.g., Dr. Ken Berry's work) challenges outdated low-fat/high-carb myths (e.g., Ancel Keys' flawed studies). Modern trials show low-carb/ketogenic approaches reduce cravings, stabilize neurotransmitters (dopamine/serotonin), support Steps 6–12.
- Carbs aren't essential "brain fuel"—the body makes glucose via gluconeogenesis and uses ketones efficiently.
- Adopt low-carb: Prioritize meats, eggs, fatty fish, vegetables, healthy fats; minimize grains/sugars/starches for steady energy, less inflammation, fewer cravings—enhancing prayer/meditation (Step 11), humility (Steps 6–7), accountability (Steps 10–12).
- Benefits: Better sleep, clarity, resilience, lower relapse risk.
- Implement: Log intake daily, focus on whole foods/proteins/non-starchy veggies. Journal weekly: Note carb effects on mood/energy/triggers vs. whole-food improvements. Review with sponsor/partner; consult low-carb-aware provider if needed.
- Conclusion: Reject high-carb myths, embrace evidence-based choices as self-care—aligning body stewardship with spiritual freedom and resilience.

UNDERSTANDING AND PREVENTING RELAPSE: CAUSES AND STRATEGIES

Relapses rarely happen suddenly—it builds over time through subtle shifts in behavior, thinking, and perception. Recognizing causes and taking proactive steps can greatly reduce risk, especially during challenging periods like holidays.

Common Causes of Relapse

- **Selfishness and resentment** are major precursors, particularly in alcohol and drug recovery.
 - Resentment builds a slippery slope: old addictive behaviors, thinking, and perceptions return.
 - Resentments toward family often surface during holidays, leading to using as a "weapon" against others.

- A common saying: Resentful people take poison (drugs/alcohol) while waiting for the other person to suffer.
- Addicts/alcoholics often use *against* resented people, not *with* them.
- Processing resentments, addressing selfish/victim mindsets, and shifting perspective (especially around family/holidays) significantly lowers relapse risk.
- **Holiday-specific challenges** — Many in 12-Step meetings report struggles during holidays, but relapses aren't directly caused by the holidays themselves.
 - Holidays add stress that can push vulnerable people over the edge if regression has already begun.
 - They serve as a convenient diversion/cover for deeper underlying issues.
- **Relapse builds gradually** — The longer someone has been sober, the more time behavioral relapse takes before physical use resumes.
 - Dissecting any relapse usually reveals an early trigger point where subtle shifts started.
- **Other key reasons for relapse:**
 - Being new in recovery and facing celebrations (birthdays, holidays, sports events, social gatherings) without a solid recovery plan.
 - Abstaining from substances without addressing root causes of addiction (dry drunk syndrome: clean/sober on the surface but still angry, miserable, restless, irritable, dishonest, discontent).
 - Passing drug/alcohol tests while emotional/spiritual issues remain unresolved.
- **Holiday relapses** almost always stem from regression starting *long before* the holidays—the event is just the final tipping point.

Ways to Avoid Addiction Relapses During Challenging Times

Prioritize your sobriety above all—it's the foundation for everything else. If lost, other gains follow.

- **Know your limitations and triggers** — Skip high-risk gatherings if unprepared (e.g., around alcohol or unresolved people). Sincere loved ones will understand; if not, that's on them. Put recovery first.
 - Are you dwelling on situations from the past that trigger you?
 - Are you dwelling on chaos because you think it feels comfortable?
 - Are you pushing or rushing your recovery back to a “normal” state too quickly (so that you are being drawn back to your old patterns and thinking)?

- **Double your spiritual efforts** — Focus on practical recovery practices (not just religion)—pray more, meditate, apply 12-Step principles rigorously during tough times.
- **Attend more 12-Step meetings** — Many groups (e.g., AA, NA) offer all-day meetings and sober holiday events. Surround yourself with recovery community for accountability.
- **Do service work** — Volunteer at meetings, shelters, etc. Combats selfishness, boosts self-esteem, and shifts focus outward without expecting return.
- **Work with newcomers** — Sponsorship and carrying the message (Step 12) after working Steps 1–11 helps you stay grounded year-round.
- **Increase therapy/counseling** — Schedule extra sessions during holidays/struggles. Surround yourself with support and solutions instead of isolating with old ineffective ones.
- **Address resentments and amends** — Clear past harms (Step 9) and work through resentments to reduce holiday stress and contact triggers. Own your part sincerely—clean your side of the street.
- **Set boundaries** — Plan ahead with sponsor, treatment team, and family. Identify risks, avoid one-on-one with toxic people, arrange interventions if needed.
- **Avoid isolation** — Don't stay home alone—seek positive people/influences. Balance caution (avoid high-risk people/places/things) with healthy connection to prevent depression/sadness.

How Long Should I Stay in a Sober Living House?

Sober living homes provide a structured, peer-supported transitional environment—abstinence-focused, with rules promoting recovery.

- Stay length varies by individual needs; many programs require at least one year to "graduate."
- As transitional support after treatment (or alternative to it), sober living is invaluable for long-term success in alcohol/drug recovery.
- Success rates are significantly higher for those who stay compared to those who don't.
- A key longitudinal study of ~300 individuals in sober living homes found positive outcomes: peer support facilitates ongoing sobriety; longer stays correlate with greater length of sobriety and better mental health.
 - The longer you stay in a sober living environment, the more successful your long-term recovery will be.

- Residents often describe it as one of the best decisions in recovery—building lasting friendships, support networks, and life lessons carried forward lifelong.

Reading Comprehension Test

Strengthening Your Recovery: Essential Tools and Perspectives

Instructions: Answer each question below in your own words using complete sentences. These questions are based directly on previous sections of your curriculum. If you are unsure of an answer, go back and re-read the relevant section before responding. There are no trick questions — the answers are found in the reading.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Section 1 — Tips to Get Connected & Strengthen Recovery

1. According to the material, what is the very first thing you should do to build a strong foundation in your recovery, and who specifically should be part of that?
2. The material lists several tips for getting connected and strengthening recovery. Name at least four of them in your own words.
3. What does the material say you should do each morning and each evening as part of your daily spiritual practice?

Section 2 — Where Does a 12-Step Program Fit?

4. What does the material say rehab centers do—and do NOT do—for a person in recovery?
5. According to this section, what is the real purpose of working the 12 Steps with a trained sponsor? What do those steps help you discover?
6. The material says that true recovery involves three specific things. What are they?

Section 3 — Safely Celebrating Milestones in Recovery

7. What does the material say your primary focus should be when it comes to celebrating milestones in recovery?
8. Describe what the material says about celebrating at the 30-day, 90-day, and 1-year milestones. How does the guidance differ at each point?
9. What is one example of 'sober fun' listed in the material, and why does the material say it is important to learn this kind of celebration?

Section 4 — Relapse Prevention

10. How does the material define what a relapse is? What causes it to happen, according to this section?
11. The material mentions what you should NOT do when a person relapses. What does it say you should do instead when supporting someone who has relapsed?
12. According to the material, does a relapse erase the progress a person has made? Explain what it says about this.

Section 5 — Nutrition and Its Role in Overcoming Addiction

13. Why does the material say that high-carb diets can be harmful during recovery? What specific physical effects are described?
14. What type of diet does the material recommend for people in recovery, and what foods does it suggest prioritizing?
15. What are three benefits of a low-carb approach that the material connects to better recovery outcomes?

Section 6 — Common Causes of Relapse

16. What two emotional issues does the material identify as major causes of relapse, especially during the holidays?

17. The material explains that holiday relapses rarely start on the holiday itself. What does it say actually causes them?

18. What is 'dry drunk syndrome' as described in the material? What makes someone a 'dry drunk' even if they are not using substances?

Section 7 — Ways to Avoid Relapse During Challenging Times

19. The material says sobriety should be your number one priority during challenging times. What reason does it give for placing recovery above everything else?

20. What does the material say you should do with your spiritual efforts during tough times—and what does it clarify that those efforts are NOT?

21. Why does the material recommend doing service work during challenging seasons? What specific benefit does it say this provides?

22. What does the material say about isolation during difficult times, and what does it recommend doing instead?

Section 8 — Sober Living

23. What is the minimum length of time many sober living programs require before a resident can 'graduate,' according to the material?

24. What does the material say about the long-term success rates of people who stay in sober living homes compared to those who do not?

25. Based on the study mentioned in the material, what did residents of sober living homes find to be true about longer stays and their recovery outcomes?



TOP 10 THINGS I LEARNED IN THIS READING SECTION THAT I CAN APPLY TO MY LIFE.

(Write These in Complete Sentences)

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

10.

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1. Read and complete all work (writing your answer to every question) up to the next Action List		
	2. Complete the Prayer Sections on at the end of the step		
	3. Complete the Top 10 List at the end of the step		
	4. Complete the Prayer in the form of writing at the end of the step		
	5. Select two more items in A – L RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY STARTING IN THE BOOK OF HEBREWS on pages 8 -13. Make a plan to implement those starting today.		
	6. Call or Text Sponsor tonight to tell him or her when two you selected this time.		
	7. Continue to call or text each night with how that went each day.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		

Reflect on the past week's experiences by responding to this prompt: Document instances where processed sugars or grains influenced your mood, energy levels, or recovery triggers, such as heightened anxiety or impulsive thoughts. Simultaneously, track your daily consumption of whole foods like meats and vegetables, noting any observed improvements in emotional stability or reduced cravings.



Pre-Step





RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

12 Step TRANSFORMATION Curriculum • VER 7.1

Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

PRE-STEP

Foundations for Recovery

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® PRE-STEP

HEBREWS IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® — STARTING IN THE BOOK OF HEBREWS

Choose TWO items (A–L) to implement while working the Pre-Step. Select items NOT already in practice.

First Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

Second Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

TOOLS I ACQUIRE WORKING PRE-STEP

- **Gratitude List** — Daily identifying and writing things you are thankful for; sharing with a sponsor or trusted person
- **Trigger Identification** — Naming the people, places, emotions, and situations that activate cravings or destructive patterns
- **The Mental Light Switch Technique** — A visualization tool to interrupt cravings and urges before they build
- **Stress Toolkit** — Immediate-response strategies (diaphragmatic breathing, walking, positive self-talk) for high-risk moments
- **ANT Interruption** — Noticing, writing down, and replacing automatic negative thoughts with evidence-based truths
- **Diaphragmatic (Belly) Breathing** — A calming breathwork practice to lower cortisol and activate the parasympathetic nervous system
- **Idle Time Planning** — Intentionally filling unstructured time with healthy hobbies, service, and purposeful activity
- **Sponsor / Accountability Partner Relationship** — Structured relational accountability with a step guide and peer support partner
- **Sleep Hygiene Practices** — Consistent sleep routines to support brain health, neuroplasticity, and emotional stability
- **Personal Stress Inventory** — Identifying current stresses and high-risk times of day previously associated with use

PRE-STEP — Essential Questions & Prayer

PRE-STEP ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS

I	What are some healthy things that I do to reduce stress in my life, and what are some new things I could consider doing?
II	How will I be able to keep and maintain my recovery?
III	What will working the steps involve for me?
IV	What are my triggers, and how do I avoid them?
V	What is a sponsor, & what is an accountability partner?
VI	Is gratitude really important?
VII	Is too much free time actually a bad thing?

PRE-STEP PRAYER

Heavenly Father,

This is a very scary time for me. You already know this. I have reached the point that I am “ready”; it is time for a change.

I don’t yet understand all that is necessary to bring about this change, but I am becoming willing to accept that doing things my own way has not worked out the way I would hope.

I am hearing that recovery is for everyone and that it is not simply about drugs and alcohol. I don’t understand what that means, but I do know that I want a better life for myself.

It seems that the people who work faith-based programs and people who learn to trust in You are blessed with happier lives. I want what they seem to have. My trust is in You to guide me and those you put in my path to guide me.

I need courage and wisdom God. Thank you for this chance to change!

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.

PRE-STEP KEY TERMS & DEFINITIONS

The following terms appear throughout the Pre-Step and lay the groundwork for your recovery journey. Read and reflect on each definition before moving forward.

Recovery

More than the absence of substances or destructive behavior, recovery is the ongoing process of becoming whole — spiritually, emotionally, relationally, and physically. As Stephen Arterburn describes it, recovery is a full-life renovation, not merely stopping one habit. True recovery requires a complete 180° change in life direction.

Willingness

The inner posture of being open and ready to accept help, change, and direction — even when the full picture is unclear. John Maxwell identifies willingness as the starting point of all growth: you cannot change what you are not first willing to examine. Willingness is not the same as having answers; it is the courage to begin the process.

Foundation

The spiritual, relational, and practical bedrock upon which lasting recovery is built. Dr. Henry Cloud and Dr. John Townsend teach that a healthy foundation includes clear boundaries, honest relationships, and a secure connection to God. Without this foundation, progress remains fragile.

Trigger

Any person, place, emotion, memory, time of day, or circumstance that activates the craving or urge to return to a destructive pattern. Russell Brand, in his own recovery writings, emphasizes that triggers must be identified honestly and confronted with both awareness and a prepared response — not merely avoided in weakness, but understood and disarmed through truth.

Sponsor

An experienced person in recovery who has worked the steps and agrees to walk alongside a newcomer as a guide, mentor, and accountability holder. The sponsor relationship mirrors the biblical model of discipleship: one who has gone before reaching back to help another move forward. A sponsor helps you stay grounded in truth when your own thinking distorts reality.

Accountability Partner

A trusted peer — often in the same stage of recovery — who provides regular, honest, mutual support and check-ins. Unlike a sponsor (who leads from experience), an accountability partner walks beside you as a companion. Dr. Cloud and Dr. Townsend describe this relationship as essential for maintaining healthy growth; isolation is the enemy of transformation.

Gratitude

A daily, deliberate practice of recognizing and giving thanks for what is good, present, and provided — even in the midst of difficulty. Craig Groeschel teaches that gratitude rewires the mind away from scarcity and complaint toward abundance and trust. A gratitude list is not a sentiment but a spiritual discipline that shifts the lens through which you see your life.

Stress

The internal and external pressure placed on mind, body, and spirit that — when unmanaged — destabilizes recovery and increases risk of relapse. Dr. Ken D. Berry, M.D., emphasizes the physiological reality of chronic stress: elevated cortisol shrinks the hippocampus, impairs memory, and fuels the "doom loop" of anxiety and poor decisions. Managing stress is not optional — it is brain-protective medicine.

Automatic Negative Thoughts (ANTs)

Habitual patterns of distorted, self-defeating thinking that arise automatically in response to stress, failure, or uncertainty — often without conscious awareness. These internal scripts ("I always fail," "Nothing ever changes") reinforce shame and trigger relapse. The work of recovery includes identifying, challenging, and replacing these thoughts with evidence-based truth.

Neuroplasticity

The brain's God-given ability to change, rewire, and form new patterns of thought and behavior throughout life. Recovery is literally possible at the level of the brain. New habits, new thoughts, and new spiritual practices create new neural pathways. This is the science behind what Neil T. Anderson calls the renewing of the mind (Romans 12:2) — transformation is not just spiritual; it is neurological.

Relapse Prevention

The ongoing, proactive effort to identify risks, avoid high-danger situations, and build structures that protect sobriety and wholeness. Fred Stoeker and Mike Yorkey emphasize that relapse rarely arrives suddenly — it is usually the accumulated result of small compromises. Prevention means staying awake to patterns long before a crisis appears.

Idle Time

Unstructured, unoccupied hours that — without intentional filling — become fertile ground for temptation, rumination, and relapse. In recovery, the danger of too much free time is real: the mind left without direction drifts toward old patterns. Replacing idle time with purposeful activities (service, creativity, exercise, community) is a recovery strategy, not just a preference.

Spiritual Warfare

The real but often unseen dimension of opposition that targets individuals in recovery — including temptation, shame, fear, and the accusation of the enemy. Neil T. Anderson's framework helps participants understand that they are not fighting against themselves alone; there is an adversary who exploits vulnerability. The armor of God (Ephesians 6) is not metaphor — it is necessary gear for the recovery journey.

Fail Forward

The recovery-minded approach to mistakes and setbacks that treats failure not as a final verdict but as instructive data for growth. John Maxwell popularized this principle: every failure contains a lesson that, when extracted and applied, moves you further along the path than if you had never stumbled. Shame says "I am a failure"; failing forward says "I learned something."

Boundaries

The God-honoring limits a person establishes around their time, relationships, behaviors, and emotional energy in order to protect their health, integrity, and recovery. Dr. Cloud and Dr. Townsend define a boundary as knowing where you end and another person begins. In recovery, weak or absent boundaries are one of the most consistent contributors to relapse and relational dysfunction.

Transformational Pathway

A structured, intentional course of continued growth beyond the initial 12 Steps — addressing spirit, mind, body, relationships, finances, and worldview. Resilients in Recovery offers multiple Transformational Pathways, recognizing that genuine recovery is not a single destination but a lifelong process of becoming who God designed each person to be.

To Keep and Maintain your Recovery

1. Make a list of your current mental and physical stresses?
2. What are the times of day when you used to drink or use substances?
3. Did you use or drink just so you could relax a little?
4. If you compare your answers to the three above questions for overlapping factors, do you find that you tend(ed) to use or drink after stress, arguments, etc.?

In order to relax a little some people will think about joining a gym or sports club. If they don't want to be around others, they might take walks when the need to relax (a lot of people can improve not only their physical health, but their mental health as well by simply walking 20 minutes a day at one time or in 10- or 5-minute increments). Another option is to practice stretching or yoga regularly.

 That ability to relax can really help maintain your recovery. How can you wear yourself down a little . Try to list at least five ideas.

BUILDING A STRONG FOUNDATION FOR RECOVERY

1. Embracing Challenges with Joy

Read James 1:2-4 in these three versions (or your favorite Bible translations):

- **The Message** Consider it a sheer gift, friends, when tests and challenges come at you from all sides. You know that under pressure, your faith-life is forced into the open and shows its true colors. So don't try to get out of anything prematurely. Let it do its work, so you become mature and well-developed, not deficient in any way.
- **New Living Translation** Dear brothers and sisters, when troubles of any kind come your way, consider it an opportunity for great joy. For you know that when your faith is tested, your endurance has a chance to grow. So let it grow, for when your endurance is fully developed, you will be perfect and complete, needing nothing.
- **King James Version** My brethren, count it all joy when ye fall into divers temptations; knowing this, that the trying of your faith worketh patience. But let patience have her perfect work, that ye may be perfect and entire, wanting nothing.

What does this scripture mean to you (for your life)?:

2. Starting with Gratitude

Gratitude shifts our focus from what's hard to what's good. It builds strength for the journey ahead.

- List **three areas** where God (or a higher power) has guided or helped you:

1.

2.

3.

- List **three people** whose help or guidance you're grateful for:

1.

2.

3.

- List **three groups, activities, or regular involvements** (church, support groups, clubs, etc.) you're thankful for:

1.

2.

3.

- List **three other things** in your life you're grateful for (big or small):

1.

2.

3.

Great job — you've just created your first gratitude list! Plan to write and share a short gratitude list daily with a trusted person (like a sponsor or friend) and at least one other supportive person. Example starters: God, living sober today, my support network, my sponsor, helping someone today, my job/family, simple joys like coffee or a game.

3. The Power of Support: Sponsors and Accountability Partners Recovery isn't meant to be solo. Having a sponsor (someone experienced who guides you through the steps) and/or accountability partners (trusted peers for ongoing support) is wise and biblical — it provides perspective, encouragement, and help staying on track.

A sponsor/accountability partner can help you:

- Stay realistic about your progress
- Stay committed to meetings and growth
- Rely on God for strength
- Give back to others

Qualities to look for:

- Their actions match their words
- They show a growing relationship with Jesus/God
- They want to help others in recovery
- They offer compassion, hope, and good listening
- They're willing to confront denial gently and share their own struggles

Their role: Be available for regular check-ins, crises, objective feedback, and modeling a healthy lifestyle.

Finding one: Pray for the right person, ask trusted leaders or group members for suggestions, be patient, and trust the process. Choose someone of the same gender. Attend meetings together, do service work, and work steps side-by-side if possible.

1. Why is having a sponsor/accountability partner important for you?

2. What qualities matter most to you in choosing one?

3. Have you tried finding one before? What happened?

4. New ideas to find an accountability partner:

5. Difference between a sponsor (step guide) and accountability partner (peer support):

6. Possible people to consider:

4. Avoiding and Handling Triggers

The easiest way to avoid relapse? Avoid high-risk triggers entirely when possible. Sometimes this means big changes — like changing where you live, who you spend time with, or even relocating.

- One serious trigger situation for you:

- Easiest way to avoid it:
-

Every day, ask: "Is this good for my recovery or bad?" Small decisions add up.

- Another high-risk trigger:

- Greatest struggle(s) right now:
-

- Things that trigger you to slip:
-

- Small decisions that lead to facing that trigger:
-

- Different decisions to avoid it:
-

(Note: Write your prayer request/response about this on the prayer page at the end of this step.)

When a trigger hits suddenly: Interrupt the thoughts early! Use a visualization technique — picture a big mental light switch for drug/alcohol thoughts. When the switch is "ON," cravings build. Flip it "OFF" to stop them.

1. Describe a past situation where a trigger sparked the urge to use:

2. How did you handle it?
-

3. How could you have used the switch technique?
-

4. Best time to use it?
-

5. How might things have turned out differently?
-

5. Filling Free Time and Building a New Life Too much idle time can lead to trouble. Fill it with healthy, relaxing, or energizing activities that don't replace one habit with another.

- Things to relax (end of day or free time): Pray/meditate, read Scripture/a book, listen to calming music (try soft instrumental, guitar, piano, or frequencies like 432/528 Hz), audio books. My ideas:
-

- Hobbies to use energy: Construction/remodeling, working on cars, collections (cards, coins), puzzles, crosswords, coloring/art, cooking new recipes. My ideas (avoid addictive ones like excessive video gaming, online gambling, gas station slot machines, etc...):
-

(Watch for alcoholic reactions to these ideas)

Recovery is a full 180° turn in life direction — not just stopping one habit.

Brainstorm 5–10 things you need to reverse/start changing for true recovery:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

6. Common Reasons People Get Stuck — and Ways Forward Even when motivated, obstacles arise. Here's what others face — talk these through with a sponsor or trusted friend:

1. **Lack of commitment/motivation** — Set tiny goals (one step at a time), connect with others to stay inspired.
2. **Unresolved trauma/mental health** — Seek professional help alongside recovery, practice self-care.
3. **Feeling overwhelmed** — Focus on one step, use the "24-hour rule," lean on support.
4. **Lack of good sponsor/community** — Try different meetings, seek a better fit, do service to connect.
5. **Relapse or fear of failure** — See it as learning, return to basics, share openly to drop shame.
6. **Resistance to spiritual parts** — Start simple with prayer/meditation; use the Serenity Prayer fully.
7. **Life pressures/time** — Integrate short practices daily, use online options, set realistic pacing.

You've got this — one day, one choice at a time. Keep this page handy as a reminder of your foundation. You're building something strong! 💪



MANAGING STRESS TO PROTECT YOUR BRAIN

Why It Matters Chronic stress harms your brain physically: it raises cortisol, shrinks the hippocampus (hurting memory/learning), over-activates the amygdala (amplifying fear/anxiety), and reduces blood flow (seen in SPECT scans), leading to foggy thinking, mood swings, and higher risk for depression, heart issues, and faster aging. This can trap you in a "doom loop" where tension and negative rumination reinforce each other. Brain types vary—e.g., those with overactive basal ganglia face more obsessive worry.

Key Actions

- **Kill the ANTs** (Automatic Negative Thoughts): Notice thoughts like "Everything always goes wrong," write them down daily (3–5), then challenge/replace with evidence-based positives. This rewires neural pathways.
- **Diaphragmatic Breathing**: Practice belly breathing (abdomen rises, not chest) for 5 minutes, 3 times/day to lower cortisol and activate calm (parasympathetic) mode.
- **Move to Release**: Do rhythmic activity like walking or yoga to burn off stress hormones. Limit caffeine/sugar, which worsen fight-or-flight.
- **Monitor & Rewire**: Use apps/wearables to track stress; try self-hypnosis or visualization for calm to build neuroplasticity.

Quick Takeaways

- Unmanaged stress mimics ADHD or dementia symptoms—treat it as brain preventive care.
- **Real Result**: High-stress executives show prefrontal damage on scans; after weeks of ANTs work + breathing, focus/mood often improve significantly.
- **Your Step**: Build a simple "stress toolkit" (e.g., 2-minute breathing + quick walk + positive statement) for instant use during triggers.

The Power of Sleep for Brain Optimization

Why It Matters Sleep is your brain's nightly detox: the glymphatic system clears toxins (like Alzheimer's-linked amyloid), consolidates memories, and

balances emotions. Less than 7–9 hours causes prefrontal slowdown (like being legally intoxicated after 24 hours awake), plaque buildup, and limbic overactivity (irritability/impulse issues). SPECT scans show uneven flow in poor sleepers. Brain types affect this—e.g., low-dopamine types struggle falling asleep; anxious types ruminate.

Key Actions

- **Sleep Hygiene Basics:** No screens 1 hour before bed (use blue-light blockers if needed). Stick to consistent bedtime/wake time, even weekends.
- **Wind-Down Routine:** Dump worries in a "worry journal" before bed. Try guided imagery or progressive muscle relaxation.
- **Support Nutrition:** Eat sleep-friendly foods (cherries for melatonin, turkey for tryptophan). Consider magnesium (300–400mg) or glycine (3g) to boost deep sleep.
- **Optimize Environment:** Keep room cool (65–68°F), dark, quiet; avoid heavy meals/alcohol 3 hours before bed (they disrupt REM).

Quick Takeaways

- **Good sleep enhances neuroplasticity**, making stress tools and other habits easier to adopt.
- **Real Result:** Patients with fatigue/memory fog often regain hippocampal volume (up to 5% on scans) after consistent sleep protocols.
- **Your Step:** Track sleep 1 week (hours + 1–10 quality rating), add 2 changes (e.g., no screens + magnesium), then re-evaluate.

These tools are practical, neuroscience-backed ways to protect and optimize your brain—start small, stay consistent, and track progress for real change.

This excerpt comes from Daniel Duval's book [Prayers that Shake Heaven and Earth](#) and draw from his online resources.

Evening Prayer

This prayer holds a special place in my heart because it is the first prayer that I wrote down as a resource. I have been targeted and attacked in the night for as long as I can remember. When I was very young, I would see evil spirits at night with my physical eyes. This was very traumatizing. As I got older, I stopped seeing as much with my physical eyes, but I would go through sleep paralysis and would often have evil spirits jump on me to wrestle with me. These attacks would drain my energy. I was getting attacked in this nature on almost a nightly basis by the time I was a senior in high school. With very limited understanding, my strategy was to wake myself up and rebuke the attacks in the name of Jesus.

The frequency of this kind of activity began to decrease after I left home and went to college. It decreased even more after I rededicated my life to God during my junior year of college. It didn't stop altogether. As I applied myself to the Word, to Bible school, to research, and to prayer in subsequent years, I learned a lot more about spiritual warfare. I learned a lot of things that aren't commonly taught in the body of Christ. I learned that some prayers are effective, others are not, and that praying in accordance with the mechanics and protocols of the spiritual world yields the most fruit. I began building this prayer in response to my own journey to peaceful sleep. I began to discern every type of attack the enemy was attempting to leverage against me in my sleep. I built this prayer to strategically counteract it.

I wrote it for myself and began to experience night after night of peaceful, restorative sleep that I could count on. As other people came to me sharing similar challenges with their sleep, I would share the prayer. The testimonies began coming back immediately. This prayer has helped thousands around the world and has been circulated rather extensively. If you have experienced challenges with your sleep, this prayer is likely to help in most cases.

Father, I come before you in prayer. I enter into your gates with thanksgiving and enter into your courts with praise. I praise you because you are worthy, holy, righteous, and just. I plead the blood of Jesus over myself, my dwelling place, my spouse, my children, my car, my bank account, and everything under my stewardship.

I pray that your heavenly hosts, your angels, would guard this dwelling place round about, both above and below, and against every dimensional access point, in Jesus' name.

I will say of the Lord that you are my refuge and my fortress, my God, in you will I trust.

I thank you that you set a hedge of protection round about me and that no plague will come near my dwelling. I thank you in advance that every curse, hex, vex, spell, incantation, voodoo, sorcery, form of witchcraft, dark art, or other form of weaponized demonic activity sent against me would be reversed upon the heads of the senders seven-fold that they would know that Jesus is Lord.

Moreover, I pray that every human spirit, fallen angelic spirit, or otherwise malevolent spirit attempting to come against me or my household would be apprehended by your heavenly hosts such that they cannot so much as set foot upon this property.

I pray that they would be escorted out to wherever the Lord Jesus sends them, pierced through with many arrows and discomfited by your lightning in the process, that they would know that Jesus is Lord.

Furthermore, I cancel and render powerless all attempts at mind-to-mind communication, dream manipulation, and all other forms of psychic and telepathic intrusion, in the name of Jesus.

I thank you that all of my dreams are inspired by your Holy Spirit.

I declare that my sleep will be sweet, uninterrupted, and that upon waking I will be well rested.

I also put on the armor of light. I take up the helmet of salvation, the breastplate of righteousness, the belt of truth, I declare that my feet are shod with the preparation of the gospel of peace, and I take up the shield of faith to quench all the fiery darts of the wicked one, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God.

I pray all of this in the mighty name of Jesus. Amen.

Put a check mark next to the ones that you already do each day.

Circle the ones that you could or would like to do to decrease the stress in your daily life.



TOOLS TO BUILD A CAPACITY FOR STRESS

1. **Exercise** (e.g., walking, running, strength training) (Releases endorphins, reduces tension, improves mood and sleep, and helps the body process stress hormones.)
2. **Yoga and Stretching** (Combines movement, breathing, and mindfulness to lower physical tension, calm the nervous system, and enhance flexibility and focus.)
3. **Journaling or Daily Writing** (Helps process emotions, gain clarity on thoughts, release worries, and track patterns that trigger stress.)
4. **Starting the Day off Fresh (Reset each day)** (Creates a positive mindset, prevents carrying yesterday's stress forward, and sets an intentional tone for the day.)
5. **Positive Affirmations** (Rewires negative self-talk, boosts self-confidence, and shifts focus toward strengths and possibilities.)
6. **Embracing Culture** (or cultural practices that ground you) (Provides a sense of identity, belonging, and rituals that offer comfort and perspective beyond daily pressures.)
7. **Eight hours of Sleep** (aim for consistent 7–9 hours) (Restores mental and physical energy, regulates mood and stress hormones, and improves resilience to daily challenges.)
8. **Connected to community** (Builds social support, reduces feelings of isolation, and provides perspective and encouragement during tough times.)
9. **Giving** (Shifts focus outward, creates positive emotions, and activates reward centers in the brain that counteract stress.)
10. **Serving Others** (Fosters purpose and connection, boosts self-worth, and often puts personal stressors into a broader context.)
11. **Allow yourself to experience joy** (Counters the narrowing effect of stress by opening you to positive emotions and rebuilding emotional resources.)
12. **Do something creative** (art, music, crafts, etc.) (Provides a flow state, expresses emotions non-verbally, and offers a sense of accomplishment and play.)
13. **Trust your gut** (Builds self-trust and intuition, reduces second-guessing, and helps you make decisions with less anxiety.)
14. **Carve out alone time every day** (Allows mental recharge, self-reflection, and recovery from social or sensory overload.)
15. **Visualization** (Uses mental imagery to rehearse calm or successful scenarios, reducing anticipatory anxiety and activating relaxation.)
16. **Write down goals** (Clarifies priorities, creates a sense of direction and control, and breaks overwhelming tasks into manageable steps.)
17. **Practice Let go of the Past** (Frees mental energy from rumination, prevents old regrets from fueling current stress, and promotes forward movement.)
18. **Practice Forgive—People and Yourself** (Releases resentment and self-blame that keep stress alive, leading to greater emotional freedom and peace.)

19. **Fail Forward** (learn from setbacks) (Turns mistakes into growth opportunities, reduces fear of failure, and builds long-term resilience.)
20. **Surround yourself with positive people** (Limits exposure to negativity, models healthy coping, and creates an uplifting environment that buffers stress.)
21. **Read—Positive Books, Articles, Blogs** (Provides inspiration, new perspectives, and mental escape while reinforcing helpful mindsets.)
22. **Reduce exposure to News** (Prevents information overload and constant negativity that can heighten anxiety and helplessness.)
23. **Reduce exposure to social media** (Decreases comparison, FOMO, and doom-scrolling that amplify stress and distort reality.)
24. **Practice Gratitude** (e.g., gratitude journal) (Shifts attention to what's going well, improves mood, and builds psychological resilience over time.)
25. **Be vulnerable with someone you can trust** (Strengthens close relationships, releases bottled-up emotions, and normalizes struggles through shared support.)
26. **Ask for help** (Reduces the burden of going it alone, brings in fresh solutions, and models healthy interdependence.)
27. **Deep Breathing or Breathwork** (e.g., 4-7-8 or box breathing) (Quickly activates the parasympathetic nervous system, lowers heart rate and blood pressure, and interrupts acute stress responses.)
27. **Meditation or Mindfulness** (even 5–10 minutes daily) (Trains present-moment awareness, reduces rumination, and improves emotional regulation.)
28. **Progressive Muscle Relaxation** or body scan (Releases stored physical tension and heightens awareness of the mind-body connection.)
29. **Spend time in nature** (walk outdoors, sit in a park, or view greenery) (Lowers cortisol, improves mood and attention, and provides a calming sensory reset.)
30. **Listen to or play music** (soothing playlists, singing, or instruments) (Elevates mood, distracts from worries, and can synchronize brainwaves toward relaxation.)
31. **Healthy eating / balanced nutrition** (focus on whole foods, stay hydrated) (Stabilizes blood sugar and energy, supports brain chemistry, and prevents mood dips from poor fuel.)
32. **Laugh more** (watch comedy, share jokes, or recall funny memories) (Releases endorphins, relaxes muscles, and provides a quick emotional reset.)
33. **Set boundaries and say “no”** when needed (Protects your time and energy, prevents resentment, and creates space for what truly matters.)
34. **Plan ahead / improve time management** (Reduces last-minute pressure and overwhelm by creating structure and predictability.)
35. **Self-massage, warm bath, or gentle touch** (Provides immediate physical soothing and signals safety to the nervous system.)
36. **Hobbies or leisure activities** just for fun (reading fiction, gardening, puzzles) (Offers pure enjoyment, restores energy, and counters the “all work, no play” stress cycle.)
37. **Limit caffeine** (especially later in the day) (Prevents artificial spikes/crashes in energy and anxiety that can worsen stress.)
38. **Pet time or animal interaction** (if accessible) (Lowers blood pressure and cortisol while increasing oxytocin and feelings of calm.)

Write an action plan in your own words for what you will do to reduce stress in your life:

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and extend across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.



Starting with the End Target in Mind

Your recovery is very serious and very important to us at Resilients in Recovery. In order for you to realize what we intend for your successful recovery we need to start by going over the evaluation questions that you will be asked at the end of the step study. The first 16 questions you could not likely answer ahead of time but starting with question 17 consider writing an “I can and I will...” sentence restating your intent for each of the questions from our evaluation. See an example in number 1.

1. Did you have a Resilients in Recovery® coach or sponsor?

★ Example: I can and will work the Resilients in Recovery 12 Step Curriculum with my Coach/ Sponsor:

17. Did you carefully work your steps pacing yourself throughout the week answering the questions or did you mainly try to get the questions answered immediately before your next step meeting?

I can and will

18. Were you always prepared for your step meetings with written answers to each question?

I can and will

19. Did you read all three books (Workshop Break 1, Workshop Break 2, and Workshop Break 3) and fill out the report pages for each? Which books did you read from the list?

I can and will

20. How many outside meetings did you attend per week while completing the step study?

I can and will



21. At what point(s) did you consider quitting the step study?

When I feel frustrated or feel like quitting the step study
I can and will

22. ~~Why did you consider quitting?~~

23. What kept you going/ kept you from quitting?

I can and will

24. Will you be starting a Resilients in Recovery® Transformational Pathway now? Which one? (see the following pages)

I can and will

Read the Overview of the Transformational Pathways and Circle the one(s) that might be most useful for your recovery/ maybe the one(s) that interest you the most.

1) *Core Recovery & Personal Growth Pathways*

- a) **Foundations in Transformational Recovery Path** Reinforces core recovery principles post-12 Steps, focusing on ongoing application of resilience, spiritual disciplines, and preventing relapse through deeper foundational work.
- b) **Overcoming & Personal Healing Path** Targets emotional and spiritual wounds, promoting forgiveness, inner healing, trauma processing, and personal breakthroughs for sustained freedom.
- c) **Individualized Personal Development Path** A customizable track tailored to your unique needs, allowing flexible focus on personal goals like character development, habits, or life skills.
- d) **Obstacles that Sabotage Recovery Path** Identifies and dismantles hidden barriers (e.g., self-sabotage, limiting beliefs, unaddressed sin patterns) that hinder progress.

2) *Spiritual & Faith-Based Pathways*

- a) **God's Teachings Path** Deep dive into Scripture and biblical teachings for spiritual maturity, applying God's Word directly to recovery and daily living.
- b) **Spiritual Warfare Path** Equips participants to recognize and combat spiritual attacks, strongholds, and opposition that can derail recovery work (and recovery efforts), using prayer, authority in Christ, and biblical armor.

3) *Purpose, Leadership & Service Pathways*

- a) **Finding Life's Purpose Path** Helps discover God's calling, passions, and vocational direction, shifting from survival to purposeful, impactful living.

- b) **Leadership Path** Prepares individuals to lead in recovery ministry, sponsor others, facilitate groups, or serve in church/community roles.
- c) **Coaching Certification for Resilients in Recovery®** Formal training to become a certified coach/facilitator in the Resilients program, enabling you to guide newcomers and expand the ministry.

4) *Relational & Health-Focused Pathways*

- a) **Relationship Building Path** Focuses on healthy connections—family reconciliation, marriage, friendships, boundaries, communication, and trust restoration.
- b) **Nutrition and Wellness Path** Integrates physical health (diet, exercise, sleep) with recovery, recognizing body-mind-spirit connection for holistic resilience.
- c) **Understanding the Human Brain Path** Explores neuroscience basics (e.g., addiction's impact on the brain, neuroplasticity, emotional regulation) to empower informed, science-informed recovery strategies aligned with faith.

5) *Specialized Awakening & Awareness Pathways*

- a) **Financial Resilients Path** Addresses financial stewardship, debt, generosity, and biblical principles for economic resilience and freedom.
- b) **Resilient Awakening in Health Care Deceptions Path** Examines potential misconceptions or deceptions in modern healthcare, promoting discernment, informed choices, and faith-based wellness.
- c) **Resilient Awakening in Historical Deceptions Path** Investigates historical narratives or "deceptions" through a biblical lens, building critical thinking and resilience against misleading worldviews.

These Pathways reflect the program's holistic approach: addressing spirit, mind, body, relationships, finances, and worldview. Many groups offer them in small-group format, with workbooks, discussions, and accountability. Your sponsor, group leader, or local Resilients ministry can help select the best starting Pathway (or multiple over time) based on your needs.



1. Have you ever started working the steps before? Did you finish? What stopped you? Explain:
2. What would you expect to get out of working the steps?



Most people who start working the 12 Steps quit before finishing the steps.

3. How would you be able to stick with it and not become one of those statistics (the ones who quit working their steps to return to their old lifestyle)?
4. What would help you the most in sticking with it to finish the steps?
5. In recovery- ***“A sponsor can’t help you if you aren’t truthful.”*** How would you plan to allow your sponsor to help you as you work through the steps?
6. Also, in recovery- ***“working the steps means nothing if you do not want to change or if you don’t actually do the work”***. Explain how you might plan to be successful.

Timeless Wisdom for a Stronger You

Reflection: The Power of Staying the Course A wise elder once shared this powerful truth: **“It is much easier to STAY sober than to GET sober again.”** Take a deep breath, then make this wisdom yours.

1. Rewrite the advice in your own words (make it feel like something you’d actually say):
2. How can you apply this to your real life right now? Give one specific example of what it could look like for you.

3. When will these words be most important for you to remember? (Think of situations, feelings, or times of day when you might need them.)
4. How can you equip yourself ahead of time so you're ready if temptation shows up? List 2–3 simple, doable steps you can start using today.

Reflection: Choosing Your Circle Wisely Another wise elder passed along this game-changing piece of guidance: **“Stick with the winners.”** Make it personal and put it into action.

1. Rewrite the advice in your own words (say it the way it makes sense to you):
2. How can you apply this to your life? Who are the “winners” you want around you, and what might that look like day-to-day?
3. When will it be most important for you to remember this advice? (Picture the moments when you might need to lean on it.)
4. How can you equip yourself to succeed by sticking with winners? List 2–3 easy actions you can take this week to build or strengthen those positive connections.

Quick Note to Yourself After you fill this section, read it out loud once a week. Highlight the parts that feel strongest. This page is 100% yours — no outside rules, just you getting stronger every day. You've got everything you need inside you already. Keep going! 🙌

(Turn to the TOP 10 page at the end of this step and summarize what you have learned from this page)

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

Pre Reading — Comprehension and Progress Review

Answer each question in your own words based on what you read. If you are unsure of an answer, go back and read the material again.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Section 1 — The Program & How It Works

1. What is the mission of Resilients in Recovery®? Write it in your own words.

(Review the Mission Statement in your reading)

2. Describe how the weekly step study meetings work. What is expected of you each week before you meet with your sponsor or step leader?

(Think about writing, reading aloud, and coming prepared)

3. What happens at the end of every step? Name the three reflection pages you are required to complete.

(Each has a specific name — go back and find them)

Section 2 — The RESILIENTS Principles

4. What does the letter "R" stand for in the RESILIENTS principles, and what does it mean to you personally?

(Look for the principle that begins with 'Recognize...')

5. Choose any two of the ten RESILIENTS principles that stand out to you most. Write out what each one means and briefly explain why you chose them.

Section 3 — The 12 Steps

6. Write out Step 1 of the Resilients in Recovery® 12 Steps in your own words. What is the core admission being made?

7. What is the difference between Steps 4 and 5? What does each one require you to do?

Section 4 — Key Terms & Concepts

8. In your own words, what is the difference between "shame" and "guilt" as defined in the Key Terms section?

9. What is a "Behavioral Relapse" and why is recognizing its early warning signs so important?

10. The reading describes "Writing as Self-Care." What does that mean, and why does the program place such emphasis on it?

Section 5 — Starting in Hebrews

11. You were asked to choose two items (A through L) from the Hebrews section to implement. Which two did you choose, and what is your plan for following through on each one?

(Refer to your implementation plan)

Section 6 — Reflection

12. Looking at the Stages of Change listed in the Pre-Assessment, which stage best describes where you are today — and why?

13. The reading says, "Let I become we. The first word in Step 1 is We." What do you think this means, and why does it matter for your recovery?



TOP 10 THINGS I LEARNED WORKING THIS STEP THAT I CAN APPLY TO MY LIFE.

(Write These in Complete Sentences)

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

10.

As you work through each step you will discover things that you need to ask God to help you with. Write those items on this page as you go.

Also write prayer needs for others.

Refer to this page at your prayer time.

Things to Pray About Regarding my Own Recovery	Others Who Need Prayer (and why)

TO COMPLETE THIS STEP, GO BACK TO THE ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS PAGE AT THE BEGINNING OF THIS STEP, READ THEM AGAIN. THE BACK OF THAT PAGE IS BLANK. WRITE OUT YOUR ANSWERS IN COMPLETE SENTENCES LIKE AND ESSAY OR IN PARAGRAPHS (BUT WRITE THE QUESTION NUMBERS BESIDE EACH ANSWER SO THAT YOU ANSWER EACH QUESTION FULLY ABOUT YOUR SELF).

CHECK HERE WHEN YOU HAVE DO THIS INDICATING THAT THIS STEP IS COMPLETE.

☐


THIS STEP IS COMPLETE INCLUDING ALL ANSWERS, TOP TEN LIST, ESSENTIAL QUESTION ANSWERS)

Day

Date

Participant Signature Sponsor/ Step Leader Signature



Praying in the Form of Writing

Write a letter to God, asking for clarity and understanding regarding the specific aspect of your life.



Heavenly Father,

Thank you for the learning opportunities you have given me in this step. This week I have realized that I am especially grateful for (you might include some items from your gratitude lists):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

In this Step, with your guidance I have begun to learn (*list those things on your Top 10 list from this Step*)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

I ask now that you give me even more clarity at understanding in these areas, and especially in the area of

You tell me in your Word, The Bible, to come to you with my needs, so that is what I am doing now. I seek your wisdom and guidance with (mention all the things from your prayer request list from the previous page):

I ask that you give me a sense of willingness to allow you to work in my life so that I can heal and so that I may find my purpose and become the person you would have me be.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.

- Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise during writing this prayer and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive.

Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise as you read this prayer aloud praying with your step leader/ sponsor (and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive).

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1. Plan to complete through the page with the next Action List		
	2. Continue to fill in dates that you accomplished events		
	3. Read the sponsor contract carefully to decide if you wish to work your recovery with the Resilients in Recovery curriculum.		
	4. Finish filling out the weekly schedule of what meetings you will attend each week. Your schedule can be changed later, but for now a routine is important.		
	5. Are there more milestone dates you can fill in?		
	6. Complete the Top 10 list of the things you learned in this short session.		
	7. At the next meeting it will be determined that you have shown a willingness to be accepted into the Resilients in Recovery program. A letter of acceptance will be provided.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



STEP ONE



STEP ONE

STEP 1: We admit that we struggle & we have allowed ourselves to become powerless over our addictions & compulsive behaviors, that our lives have become unmanageable.

■ *“But I need something more! For if I know the law but still can’t keep it, and if the power of sin within me keeps sabotaging my best intentions, I obviously need help! I realize that I don’t have what it takes. I can will it, but I can’t do it. I decide to do good, but I don’t really do it; I decide not to do bad, but then I do it anyway. My decisions, such as they are, don’t result in actions. Something has gone wrong deep within me and gets the better of me every time.” — Romans 7:18*

HEBREWS IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® — STARTING IN THE BOOK OF HEBREWS

Choose TWO items (A–L) to implement while working Step 1. Select items NOT already in practice.

First Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

Second Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

TOOLS I ACQUIRED WORKING STEP 1

- **Breaking Denial** — The practiced ability to honestly name and acknowledge the reality of one’s struggles, failures, and powerlessness
- **Admission of Powerlessness** — Accepting that willpower alone is insufficient to overcome addictive behaviors
- **Surrender** — The intentional decision to stop fighting one’s own truth and release the illusion of self-control
- **Defensiveness Awareness** — Learning to notice when and why one becomes defensive as a form of self-honesty
- **Sponsor Contract** — A formal commitment to accountability and structure that governs the entire step study journey



RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

12 Step TRANSFORMATION Curriculum • VER 7.1

Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP ONE — Essential Questions & Prayer

STEP 1 ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS

I	Have I agreed to the terms of the Sponsor Contract before starting Step 1?
II	What is denial, and am I in denial about anything?
III	How do I begin to prepare to make real changes?
IV	What is the difference between addictions and addictive behaviors?
V	What addictive behaviors are issues for me?
VI	Am I powerless? How did I allow myself to become powerless over addictions and addictive behaviors?
VII	What do I really want to change about myself?
VIII	Am I willing to do whatever it takes to change?
IX	How has my pride impacted relationships?

STEP 1 PRAYER

Heavenly Father,

Your Word tells me that I can't heal a wound or heal my struggles by just saying that they are not there. I need your help.

Parts of my life, or all of my life, are out of control. I now know that I cannot "fix" myself. Like Paul said in Romans, it seems the harder that I try to do the right thing the more I struggle.

Lord, I want to step out of my denial into the truth. I pray for the courage to continue in this course and not give up with the enemy trying to tell me that there is no hope for me.

Please draw me nearer to You and to the life that You would have in mind for me. Help me stay encouraged as I undertake this work completing the steps. Guide me and my sponsor reminding me that average work on these steps will yield only average results. That is not what I want; I want Your spectacular results for my life. Guide me, Lord!

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

STEP ONE

KEY TERMS & DEFINITIONS

The following terms are foundational to the work of Step One. Understanding these concepts will help you engage more honestly and completely with the questions and exercises in this step. Read through this list carefully — ideally with your sponsor — before or alongside your Step One work.

Admission

The courageous act of openly acknowledging the truth about your own struggles, failures, and powerlessness — spoken aloud, to yourself, to God, and to at least one other person. Admission is not defeat; it is the first act of genuine courage in recovery. As John Townsend teaches, we cannot heal what we refuse to name. Admission breaks the cycle of pretending and opens the door to real help.

Addiction

A compulsive, chronic dependence on a substance or behavior that has taken on a life of its own — overriding your values, your relationships, and your best intentions. Dr. Ken Berry emphasizes that addiction is not merely a moral failure but is deeply rooted in brain chemistry and biochemical imbalance. Russell Brand notes that addiction is ultimately a misdirected search for relief, connection, and transcendence — one that always extracts more than it gives.

Addictive Behavior

Any repeated pattern of behavior that involves excessive allocation of time, energy, or focus to short-term rewards at the expense of long-term well-being. Unlike substance addiction, addictive behaviors may include gambling, pornography, social media, work, conflict-seeking, victim mentality, or food. The behavior becomes addictive when it produces salience, mood modification, tolerance, withdrawal, conflict, and relapse. Stephen Arterburn reminds us that anything we turn to for comfort instead of God can become a behavioral chain.

Denial

The psychological defense mechanism by which a person refuses to acknowledge the reality, severity, or consequences of their own destructive patterns. Henry Cloud describes denial as a wall we build to protect ourselves from pain — but that same wall traps us inside the very prison we are trying to escape. Denial manifests as minimizing, rationalizing, blaming others, forgetting, or simply refusing to discuss what is true. Step One begins with breaking denial.

Powerlessness

The honest recognition that you do not have, within yourself, the ability to consistently control or stop your addictive behaviors by willpower alone. This is not weakness — it is honesty. Romans 7:18 captures it: 'I can will it, but I can't do it.' John Maxwell teaches that the first step toward transformation is acknowledging the gap between who you are and who you want to be. Powerlessness is not the end of the story; it is the beginning of surrender to a Power greater than yourself.

Unmanageability

The condition in which one's life — relationships, responsibilities, emotional health, finances, spiritual life — has been significantly disrupted or destabilized by addictive behaviors. Unmanageability is the natural consequence of sustained powerlessness. It is not just inconvenience; it is the accumulated wreckage that

results when addiction has been the operating system of a life. Craig Groeschel reminds us that we cannot change what we refuse to confront — recognizing unmanageability is the prerequisite to transformation.

Compulsive Behavior

An action driven by an irresistible internal urge rather than conscious choice, often performed to relieve anxiety, shame, or emotional discomfort — even when the person knows it causes harm. Compulsive behavior differs from simple habit in that it persists despite negative consequences and despite repeated attempts to stop. Neil T. Anderson notes that compulsive patterns often have spiritual roots: strongholds built over time that require both truth and surrender to break.

Surrender

The intentional decision to stop fighting against your own truth and to release control of your life to God. Surrender is not giving up — it is giving over. Russell Brand describes surrender as the paradoxical moment when you gain real power by releasing your grip on false power. In Step One, surrender begins the moment you stop insisting that you can fix yourself and start asking for help. It is the pivot point between the old life and the new one.

Salience

A hallmark marker of addiction in which a particular substance or behavior becomes the single most important thing in a person's life — crowding out relationships, responsibilities, and God. When salience is present, the person organizes their entire daily existence around the addictive activity. Fred Stoeker's work on purity and recovery identifies salience as the moment an appetite crosses over into a tyrant, demanding to be fed above all else.

Mood Modification

The use of a substance or behavior as a tool to change or regulate one's emotional state — to manufacture a high, escape discomfort, numb pain, or de-stress. Mood modification is one of the six diagnostic markers of addiction. Dr. Ken Berry connects this directly to brain biochemistry: addictive substances and behaviors hijack the brain's natural reward and stress systems, training the person to seek chemical relief rather than real resolution of underlying pain.

Tolerance

The progressive requirement for more of a substance or behavior over time in order to achieve the same mood-altering effect. Tolerance is evidence that the brain has adapted to the addictive agent and begun to compensate — raising the floor of 'normal' and requiring escalation to feel anything. What once felt like relief now barely feels like baseline. Tolerance is a biological and behavioral trap that deepens the cycle of addiction over time.

Withdrawal

The psychological and/or physical consequences — including irritability, restlessness, anxiety, cravings, and mood instability — that occur when a person is unable to engage in their addictive behavior. Withdrawal symptoms are the body and mind's protest against the absence of what has become 'normal.' They are evidence that the addiction has rewired the nervous system. Recognizing withdrawal symptoms in yourself is a form of honest self-assessment and an act of Step One.

Relapse

The return to addictive patterns after a period of abstinence or recovery progress. Relapse is not the end of recovery — but it is always a serious warning. John Maxwell teaches that failure is not final unless you stop learning from it. Neil T. Anderson emphasizes that relapse often signals an unaddressed lie, wound, or stronghold that has not yet been surrendered to God. Understanding the triggers and internal conditions that lead to relapse is essential homework throughout recovery.

Pride

The posture of the self that insists on self-sufficiency, refuses to ask for help, and resists accountability. Pride disguises itself as strength but functions as a barrier to healing. Henry Cloud and John Townsend write extensively on how pride — the refusal to need others — is the engine that keeps people stuck in destructive patterns. In Step One, pride must be identified and named, because it is pride that sustains denial and prevents the admission of powerlessness.

Defensiveness

An emotional and behavioral reaction that deflects, minimizes, or redirects honest confrontation about one's struggles. Defensiveness is denial in action — the wall going up the moment truth gets too close. In Step One work, noticing when and why you become defensive is critical self-examination. Defensiveness protects the ego at the cost of growth. Craig Groeschel reminds us that we cannot build the life we want while defending the life we have.

Accountability

The practice of giving another trusted person — a sponsor, step leader, or spiritual mentor — ongoing access to the truth of your inner life, your behaviors, and your progress. Accountability is not surveillance; it is relationship in the service of transformation. Townsend and Cloud's foundational teaching on boundaries is inseparable from accountability: we need the honest input of safe people to stay tethered to reality and moving in the right direction.

Sponsor

A person further along in recovery who walks alongside you through the steps, holds you accountable, asks the hard questions, and reflects truth back to you when you cannot see it yourself. The sponsor relationship is one of the most important structures in recovery work. Mike Yorkey and Stephen Arterburn consistently affirm that sustainable recovery is almost never a solo project — it requires walking with someone who has been where you are and found a way through.

Isolation

The pattern of withdrawing from safe community, relationships, and accountability — often as a way to protect the addiction or to avoid the shame associated with it. Isolation is one of addiction's most powerful tools. It removes the mirrors that help us see ourselves clearly and eliminates the voices that might speak truth into our lives. John Townsend teaches that healing never happens in isolation — it happens in relationship, in community, with others who are trustworthy and willing to tell us the truth in love.

Resentment

Unresolved anger held over time toward a person, institution, or circumstance — re-felt and replayed internally rather than processed and released. Resentment is often described as drinking poison and expecting the other person to die. In Step One, identifying resentments is important because they are frequently used as fuel for addictive behavior: 'I earned this' or 'after what they did, who can blame me.' Neil T. Anderson connects resentment to spiritual bondage — unforgiveness keeps a chain around the one who refuses to let go.

Amends

The act of acknowledging harm done to others and making genuine effort to repair what has been broken — addressed more fully in later steps but first recognized in Step One. Making amends is not merely an apology but a commitment to changed behavior. It is introduced here as a concept to begin taking inventory of relationships that have been damaged by addictive behavior. In Step One, the work is simply to see clearly — the making of amends comes later, in proper sequence.

Dopamine

A neurotransmitter — a chemical messenger in the brain — associated with reward, motivation, and pleasure. Addictive substances and behaviors hijack the brain's dopamine system, creating artificial spikes of reward that over time flatten the brain's natural response to normal pleasures. Dr. Ken Berry teaches that diet, particularly sugar and processed carbohydrates, can destabilize the dopamine system in ways that directly mirror and amplify addictive cravings — making the biochemical dimension of recovery impossible to ignore.

Blood Sugar Instability

A physiological state in which blood glucose rises and falls rapidly — typically in response to consumption of sugar, refined carbohydrates, and processed foods — producing mood swings, anxiety, brain fog, irritability, and intensified cravings. Dr. Ken Berry's work in the Step One curriculum establishes that blood sugar rollercoasters are not merely a dietary issue; they are a recovery issue, because they biochemically produce the very internal states — impulsivity, restlessness, craving — that make powerlessness feel inescapable.

Family Secret

An unspoken but collectively maintained denial within a family system about dysfunction, abuse, addiction, or shame that 'everyone knows but no one says.' Family secrets create a culture of silence that trains children to deny reality as a survival skill — a training that often follows them directly into their own addictive patterns. Townsend and Cloud's work on dysfunctional family systems shows that until the secret is named, it continues to exercise power over every member of the family who carries it.

Spiritual Stronghold

A deeply entrenched pattern of thinking, believing, or behaving that is rooted in deception and has become a point of spiritual, psychological, and behavioral captivity. Neil T. Anderson defines a stronghold as a 'mental fortress' built from lies we have believed over time — about ourselves, about God, and about reality — that now functions as a prison. Breaking a stronghold requires both the renewal of the mind through truth (Romans 12:2) and the authority of prayer and surrender.

Unmanaged Pain

Emotional, relational, physical, or spiritual hurt that has never been properly acknowledged, processed, or healed — and which therefore continues to drive behavior from below the surface of awareness. Step One invites the person to stop denying the pain they are carrying. As the curriculum states: 'You are ready to take your first step in recovery when your pain is greater than your fear.' Unmanaged pain is the fuel of most addictive behavior — the thing the addiction was originally recruited to silence.

Transformation

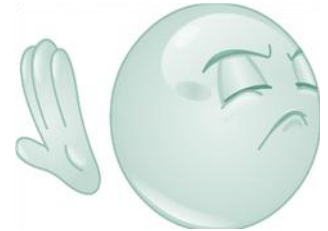
The deep, lasting, inside-out change of a person's character, patterns, values, and way of life — initiated by surrender to God and sustained through community, truth, and disciplined work. Transformation is distinguished from mere behavior modification in that it changes who you are, not just what you do. John Maxwell describes transformation as a process, not an event — a daily, cumulative movement toward becoming a different kind of person. In Resilients in Recovery, transformation is the stated goal: not just sobriety, but a completely rebuilt life.

STEP 1: We admit that we struggle & we have allowed ourselves to become powerless over our addictions & compulsive behaviors, that our lives have become unmanageable.

Did you read and do you agree to the terms of the Sponsor Contract? (if not, we will discontinue this step study now)_____

IN DENIAL ABOUT WHAT?

1. In your own words what does it mean to be in denial about something?
2. Do you feel any remorse from the ways that you have acted in your life? If so, explain. ✝ Write *your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* ☐ 
3. Have you avoided people in your life because they did not share in or approve of your addictive behavior? If so, list these people and situations.
4. Describe any dreams that you have had about the difficulties in your life.
5. In what areas of your life do you suspect you may still be living in denial about your addiction?
6. Have your addictive behaviors seriously damaged any of your relationships? If so, list the relationships and describe exactly how the damage occurred.
7. If others have directly told you how you hurt them, what did they say? How did you respond at the time?





8. Describe a recent time when you felt defensive about your behavior.

a) What emotions and thoughts came up for you?

b) What triggered the defensiveness?

9. Have you missed important appointments, obligations, or commitments because of your addictive behaviors? Give specific examples.

10. Describe any memory lapses or “blackouts” where you cannot account for where you were or what you did.

11. Describe any times you cannot remember how you got home or how you ended up in a particular place.

12. In what ways and at what times have you significantly neglected or damaged your relationships with loved ones in order to engage in (or recover from) your addictive behaviors?

13. Have you ever used someone else’s story of addiction to justify or minimize your own struggles? If so, describe when and how.

14. Have any illnesses or physical problems resulted from your addictive behaviors? Describe them.

- 15.If your addiction led to excessive spending, describe the situations, what you spent money on, and why you did it.

- 16.Describe times when you withdrew from social interaction and isolated yourself to an extreme degree. What was happening in your addiction at those times, and why did you isolate?

- 17.Describe any incidents in which you expressed inappropriate anger or rage toward others. What role did your addiction or its aftermath play?

- 18.Describe any embarrassing or humiliating incidents you can recall. Were they related to your addictive behaviors? If so, how?

- 19.What attempts have you made in the past to control, manage, or stop your addictive behaviors?
 - a) How successful were those attempts?

 - b) What do those attempts reveal about your powerlessness over the addiction?

- 20.Respond in your own words to this statement: “If you think you are the only one you are hurting, you are wrong.”

21. List any prescribed diets, medications, or treatment plans you have followed that were based on (what you have already learned to be) outdated or incomplete advice.

A. diets,

B. medications,

C. treatment plans

For this coming week document your experiences by responding to this prompt:

Diet, Brain Function & Mood Journal related to Step 1 *(7-day guided journal)*

Introduction (to be read with your sponsor) Dr. Ken Berry teaches that what you put in your mouth directly controls your brain chemistry. Sugar and processed grains cause blood-sugar rollercoasters that spike dopamine, create anxiety, fog your thinking, and trigger the exact cravings that make us feel powerless. Real food (especially meat and eggs) stabilizes blood sugar, calms the brain, and reduces the impulsive thoughts that feed addiction.

This is not another “diet.” This is a one-week experiment in honesty. You will track what you actually eat, what it does to your mood and cravings, and how it connects to Step 1 powerlessness. Write every day — even if it’s short. Bring the whole journal to your sponsor at the end of the week.

Instructions

- Every evening, answer the same set of questions below for that day.
- Use the space provided (or copy the template into a notebook).
- Be brutally honest — this is Step 1 work.
- You do NOT have to change anything yet. Just observe.



Diet, Brain Function & Mood Journal Day 1 of 7

Date: _____

1. **Sugar Detective** List every food and drink you consumed today. Next to each item, write the exact words you saw on the label that are actually sugar (examples: glucose, fructose, maltose, dextrose, corn syrup, cane sugar, agave, “natural flavors,” etc.). How many different sugar names did you find today?

2. **Processed Sugar / Grain Impact Log** Did you eat anything with processed sugars or grains today? If yes, record the exact time and what happened 30–90 minutes later to you: • Mood (anxious, irritable, depressed, restless?) • Energy (crash, wired, foggy?) • Cravings or recovery triggers (impulsive thoughts, “just one” thinking, desire to use?)

3. **Whole-Food Experiment** What real, whole foods did you eat today (especially beef, eggs, lamb, pork, chicken, fish, butter, tallow, or other animal foods)? Note the time you ate them and any positive changes you noticed in the following 1–4 hours: • Mood stability • Mental clarity • Reduced cravings or anxiety • Overall sense of calm or power over impulses

4. **Brain & Recovery Connection** Looking back at today, how did what I ate affect my ability to stay present and honest in recovery? (Example: “Sugar at lunch made me foggy and defensive at my meeting — exactly the denial I work on in Step 1.”)

5. **One Sentence Summary of the Day** “Today my food made me feel _____ and that directly impacted my recovery by _____.”



Diet, Brain Function & Mood Journal Day 2 of 7

Date: _____

1. **Sugar Detective** List every food and drink you consumed today. Next to each item, write the exact words you saw on the label that are actually sugar (examples: glucose, fructose, maltose, dextrose, corn syrup, cane sugar, agave, “natural flavors,” etc.). How many different sugar names did you find today?

2. **Processed Sugar / Grain Impact Log** Did you eat anything with processed sugars or grains today? If yes, record the exact time and what happened 30–90 minutes later to your: • Mood (anxious, irritable, depressed, restless?) • Energy (crash, wired, foggy?) • Cravings or recovery triggers (impulsive thoughts, “just one” thinking, desire to use?)

3. **Whole-Food Experiment** What real, whole foods did you eat today (especially beef, eggs, lamb, pork, chicken, fish, butter, tallow, or other animal foods)? Note the time you ate them and any positive changes you noticed in the following 1–4 hours: • Mood stability • Mental clarity • Reduced cravings or anxiety • Overall sense of calm or power over impulses

4. **Brain & Recovery Connection** Looking back at today, how did what I ate affect my ability to stay present and honest in recovery? (Example: “Sugar at lunch made me foggy and defensive at my meeting — exactly the denial I work on in Step 1.”)

5. **One Sentence Summary of the Day** “Today my food made me feel _____ and that directly impacted my recovery by _____.”



Diet, Brain Function & Mood Journal Day 3 of 7

Date: _____

1. **Sugar Detective** List every food and drink you consumed today. Next to each item, write the exact words you saw on the label that are actually sugar (examples: glucose, fructose, maltose, dextrose, corn syrup, cane sugar, agave, “natural flavors,” etc.). How many different sugar names did you find today?

2. **Processed Sugar / Grain Impact Log** Did you eat anything with processed sugars or grains today? If yes, record the exact time and what happened 30–90 minutes later to your: • Mood (anxious, irritable, depressed, restless?) • Energy (crash, wired, foggy?) • Cravings or recovery triggers (impulsive thoughts, “just one” thinking, desire to use?)

3. **Whole-Food Experiment** What real, whole foods did you eat today (especially beef, eggs, lamb, pork, chicken, fish, butter, tallow, or other animal foods)? Note the time you ate them and any positive changes you noticed in the following 1–4 hours: • Mood stability • Mental clarity • Reduced cravings or anxiety • Overall sense of calm or power over impulses

4. **Brain & Recovery Connection** Looking back at today, how did what I ate affect my ability to stay present and honest in recovery? (Example: “Sugar at lunch made me foggy and defensive at my meeting — exactly the denial I work on in Step 1.”)

5. **One Sentence Summary of the Day** “Today my food made me feel _____ and that directly impacted my recovery by _____.”



Diet, Brain Function & Mood Journal Day 4 of 7

Date: _____

1. **Sugar Detective** List every food and drink you consumed today. Next to each item, write the exact words you saw on the label that are actually sugar (examples: glucose, fructose, maltose, dextrose, corn syrup, cane sugar, agave, “natural flavors,” etc.). How many different sugar names did you find today?

2. **Processed Sugar / Grain Impact Log** Did you eat anything with processed sugars or grains today? If yes, record the exact time and what happened 30–90 minutes later to your: • Mood (anxious, irritable, depressed, restless?) • Energy (crash, wired, foggy?) • Cravings or recovery triggers (impulsive thoughts, “just one” thinking, desire to use?)

3. **Whole-Food Experiment** What real, whole foods did you eat today (especially beef, eggs, lamb, pork, chicken, fish, butter, tallow, or other animal foods)? Note the time you ate them and any positive changes you noticed in the following 1–4 hours: • Mood stability • Mental clarity • Reduced cravings or anxiety • Overall sense of calm or power over impulses

4. **Brain & Recovery Connection** Looking back at today, how did what I ate affect my ability to stay present and honest in recovery? (Example: “Sugar at lunch made me foggy and defensive at my meeting — exactly the denial I work on in Step 1.”)

5. **One Sentence Summary of the Day** “Today my food made me feel _____ and that directly impacted my recovery by _____.”



Diet, Brain Function & Mood Journal Day 5 of 7

Date: _____

1. **Sugar Detective** List every food and drink you consumed today. Next to each item, write the exact words you saw on the label that are actually sugar (examples: glucose, fructose, maltose, dextrose, corn syrup, cane sugar, agave, “natural flavors,” etc.). How many different sugar names did you find today?

2. **Processed Sugar / Grain Impact Log** Did you eat anything with processed sugars or grains today? If yes, record the exact time and what happened 30–90 minutes later to your: • Mood (anxious, irritable, depressed, restless?) • Energy (crash, wired, foggy?) • Cravings or recovery triggers (impulsive thoughts, “just one” thinking, desire to use?)

3. **Whole-Food Experiment** What real, whole foods did you eat today (especially beef, eggs, lamb, pork, chicken, fish, butter, tallow, or other animal foods)? Note the time you ate them and any positive changes you noticed in the following 1–4 hours: • Mood stability • Mental clarity • Reduced cravings or anxiety • Overall sense of calm or power over impulses

4. **Brain & Recovery Connection** Looking back at today, how did what I ate affect my ability to stay present and honest in recovery? (Example: “Sugar at lunch made me foggy and defensive at my meeting — exactly the denial I work on in Step 1.”)

5. **One Sentence Summary of the Day** “Today my food made me feel _____ and that directly impacted my recovery by _____.”



Diet, Brain Function & Mood Journal Day 6 of 7

Date: _____

1. **Sugar Detective** List every food and drink you consumed today. Next to each item, write the exact words you saw on the label that are actually sugar (examples: glucose, fructose, maltose, dextrose, corn syrup, cane sugar, agave, “natural flavors,” etc.). How many different sugar names did you find today?

2. **Processed Sugar / Grain Impact Log** Did you eat anything with processed sugars or grains today? If yes, record the exact time and what happened 30–90 minutes later to you: • Mood (anxious, irritable, depressed, restless?) • Energy (crash, wired, foggy?) • Cravings or recovery triggers (impulsive thoughts, “just one” thinking, desire to use?)

3. **Whole-Food Experiment** What real, whole foods did you eat today (especially beef, eggs, lamb, pork, chicken, fish, butter, tallow, or other animal foods)? Note the time you ate them and any positive changes you noticed in the following 1–4 hours: • Mood stability • Mental clarity • Reduced cravings or anxiety • Overall sense of calm or power over impulses

4. **Brain & Recovery Connection** Looking back at today, how did what I ate affect my ability to stay present and honest in recovery? (Example: “Sugar at lunch made me foggy and defensive at my meeting — exactly the denial I work on in Step 1.”)

5. **One Sentence Summary of the Day** “Today my food made me feel _____ and that directly impacted my recovery by _____.”



Diet, Brain Function & Mood Journal Day 7 of 7

Date: _____

1. **Sugar Detective** List every food and drink you consumed today. Next to each item, write the exact words you saw on the label that are actually sugar (examples: glucose, fructose, maltose, dextrose, corn syrup, cane sugar, agave, “natural flavors,” etc.). How many different sugar names did you find today?

2. **Processed Sugar / Grain Impact Log** Did you eat anything with processed sugars or grains today? If yes, record the exact time and what happened 30–90 minutes later to you: • Mood (anxious, irritable, depressed, restless?) • Energy (crash, wired, foggy?) • Cravings or recovery triggers (impulsive thoughts, “just one” thinking, desire to use?)

3. **Whole-Food Experiment** What real, whole foods did you eat today (especially beef, eggs, lamb, pork, chicken, fish, butter, tallow, or other animal foods)? Note the time you ate them and any positive changes you noticed in the following 1–4 hours: • Mood stability • Mental clarity • Reduced cravings or anxiety • Overall sense of calm or power over impulses

4. **Brain & Recovery Connection** Looking back at today, how did what I ate affect my ability to stay present and honest in recovery? (Example: “Sugar at lunch made me foggy and defensive at my meeting — exactly the denial I work on in Step 1.”)

5. **One Sentence Summary of the Day** “Today my food made me feel _____ and that directly impacted my recovery by _____.”

End-of-Week Reflection Questions



(Answer on Day 7 or 8 with your sponsor)

A. What patterns did I discover between hidden sugars/grains and my mood, energy, or cravings?

B. When I ate more whole foods (especially meat and eggs), what improvements did I notice in emotional stability or reduced addictive thinking?

C. In what specific ways did my eating habits this week show me that I am powerless over my addiction when my brain chemistry is unstable?

D. How does this one-week experiment challenge any old “diet” advice I was given in the past that may have kept me stuck?

E. What is one small, doable change I am willing to discuss with my sponsor based on what I observed?

“Where did food show up as another form of denial or powerlessness this week?” Tie every observation back to Step 1: “We admitted we were powerless...”

FROM THIS POINT FORWARD, YOU WILL BE RESPONSIBLE FOR WRITING YOUR OWN ASSIGNMENTS ON EACH ACTION LIST FOR THE NEXT WEEK. AS WE GO OVER EXPTECATIONS FOR THE NEXT WEEK, WRITE

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



PREPARING MYSELF FOR REAL CHANGE

Your Mind

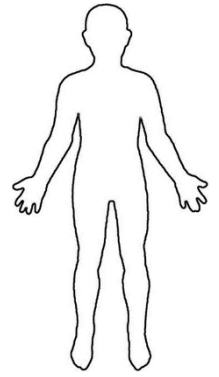


1. Have you accepted Christ as your personal savior? If so, how has God transformed your mind?
2. What would you like to change about your life or your mind?
✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* ☐
3. If you answered on the previous page that you believe you are in denial, how have you used denial to protect your mind?
4. Have you filled your mind with hurtful and unhealthy movies, programs, internet sites, magazines, music, or books, (or anything else)?
 - Do you still do this?
5. Are there other people in your life who are filling your mind with hurtful or unhealthy content? If so, who?
6. What are some of the most uplifting, encouraging, or life-affirming teachings and truths found in the Bible?
7. Are there examples of times when you believed that you could handle a temptation related to your struggle? Give examples.



Your Body

1. What past activities or habits caused harm to your physical health (How have you mistreated your body)?
2. Have you abused alcohol, drugs, food, sex, shopping, gambling (or something else)?
 - How could those things have negatively affected your body?
3. What have you done (and begun to do) to restore your body (referred to in the Bible as “God’s Temple”)?
4. Are there situations where you have tried your best but figured out that you really just substituted one “drug” for another (or one struggle for another)? Explain in detail.



Your Family

1. Have you mistreated anyone in your family verbally, emotionally, or physically?
2. Whom in your family do you hold some kind of some kind of resentment against? Why?
3. Can you think of anyone to whom you owe amends? Why?
(This is not the time to make amends. We are just making a list.
The steps are in order for a reason.)
4. What is your family’s secret that you have kept denying?





Your Church

1. How would you rate your past participation in your church?

- | | |
|---|------------------------------|
| _____ Very Involved | _____ Semi-active Member |
| _____ Sideline Member | _____ Attender |
| _____ Holiday Attender | _____ Never Attender/ Member |
| _____ Never Attended nor was Member of a Church | |

2. What was your main reason for going to church?

3. Have you ever tried to discourage any family member (or anyone else) from church involvement? Did you discourage them with your words or with your actions (or facial expression)? Why?



4. What does going to church or participating in church mean to you?

5. Have you ever blamed God for situations where human beings' actions brought on the consequences? Explain.

6. Do you attend religious/ church services (or go to recovery meetings) offered where you are now?

- Has your participation or commitment to those services/ meetings increased? Give examples.



GETTING YOU TO THINK ABOUT ADDICTIVE BEHAVIORS

Addiction is not limited to substances. Any behavior that provides a short-term reward can, over time, become something we reach for compulsively — even when it costs us our health, relationships, or integrity. The questions below are not a clinical diagnosis. They are an honest mirror. Answer as truthfully as you can.



1. Do you engage in any behavior excessively...

- a) even when you told yourself you would stop or cut back? _____
 - b) to the point that it interferes with sleep, work, or relationships? _____
 - c) as a way to escape emotional pain, stress, or boredom? _____
 - d) and feel irritable, anxious, or empty when you cannot do it? _____
 - e) while hiding it or lying about how much you do it? _____
 - f) knowing it is harming you, but feeling unable to stop? _____
 - g) in ways that are escalating — needing more to get the same feeling? _____
 - h) that has caused you to neglect personal hygiene, health, or finances? _____
 - i) that you return to immediately after trying to quit? _____
-

2. Think about the following areas of your life and ask: "Am I doing this to an extreme?"

- a) How I use technology, screens, or social media _____
 - b) What and how much I eat or drink (non-alcoholic) _____
 - c) How I spend or manage money _____
 - d) How I relate to people — do I cling, control, or collapse for others? _____
 - e) How I handle anger — do I seek out conflict or chaos? _____
 - f) How I exercise or pursue physical appearance _____
 - g) How I use entertainment — gaming, streaming, binge-watching _____
 - h) How I cope with stress — do I reach for something to numb it? _____
 - i) How honest I am with myself about any of the above _____
-

3. Other Addictive Behaviors...

A dissertation at the University of Florida defines addictive behaviors as *those behaviors which involve excessive allocation to short-term rewards with longer-term costs*. The American Psychological Association first recognized gambling as an addiction, citing it as comparable to alcohol and substance addiction.

Addictive behaviors you might struggle with could include:



Addictive Behavior	YES	NO	MAYBE
 DIGITAL & TECHNOLOGY			
Internet Addiction	YES	NO	MAYBE
Social Media Addiction	YES	NO	MAYBE
Video Game Addiction	YES	NO	MAYBE
Technology Addiction	YES	NO	MAYBE
Screen Time / Streaming Binge	YES	NO	MAYBE
Pornography Addiction	YES	NO	MAYBE
 FOOD & BODY			
Binge Eating Disorder	YES	NO	MAYBE
Food Addiction / Addiction to Sugars & Carbs	YES	NO	MAYBE
Processed Food Addiction	YES	NO	MAYBE
Exercise / Fitness Addiction	YES	NO	MAYBE
Plastic Surgery Addiction	YES	NO	MAYBE
Tattooing Addiction	YES	NO	MAYBE
 MONEY & RISK			
Shopping / Spending Addiction	YES	NO	MAYBE
Debt-Fueled / Compulsive Buying	YES	NO	MAYBE
Gambling Addiction	YES	NO	MAYBE
Risky Behavior Addiction	YES	NO	MAYBE
Work Addiction	YES	NO	MAYBE
 RELATIONAL & EMOTIONAL			
Sex Addiction	YES	NO	MAYBE
Codependency / People-Pleasing	YES	NO	MAYBE
Conflict Seeking / Addiction to Chaos & Drama	YES	NO	MAYBE
Anger / Rage Patterns	YES	NO	MAYBE
Victim Mentality / Quick to Blame Others	YES	NO	MAYBE
 SUBSTANCE-ADJACENT			
Caffeine / Energy Drink Dependence	YES	NO	MAYBE
Nicotine Addiction	YES	NO	MAYBE
_____	YES	NO	MAYBE
_____	YES	NO	MAYBE

If you believe that you may struggle with one of these addictive behaviors, consider returning to the questions on the previous page and applying them to that specific behavior.

What addictive behaviors are you struggling with? Write this out in a complete sentence. (I struggle with _____ addiction as well as _____.)

4. WHEN HEALTHY ENTHUSIASM BECOMES EXCESSIVE: LEADING TO ADDICTION

- Excessive behavior on its own does not mean someone is addicted. In fact, there are lots of people who engage in excessive activities, but the question is do they appear to experience any detrimental effects in their life because of engaging in the behavior.
- In a nutshell, the fundamental difference between excessive enthusiasm and addiction is that healthy enthusiasm adds to life whereas addiction takes away from life.
- According to *Psychology Today* for any behavior to be defined as addictive, there are specific consequences because of the person's relationship with the behavior:
 - ❖ **Salience** (when a particular activity becomes the most important activity in the person's life)
 - ❖ **Mood modification** (the use of the activity as a way of either getting a 'high' or 'buzz' and/or using the activity to escape, de-stress or numb)
 - ❖ **Tolerance** (needing more and more of the activity over time to feel the mood modifying effects)
 - ❖ **Withdrawal symptoms** (psychological and/or physiological consequences such as excess moodiness and irritability if unable to engage in the activity)
 - ❖ **Conflict** (with other activities – such as work and hobbies – and personal relationships, that may lead to a loss of control)
 - ❖ **Relapse** (i.e. returning to addictive patterns of use following a period of abstinence)

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



Addictive Behavior Inventory Sheet

My Addictive Behavior may be: (Hint each answer from question # 3 will go here) <i>Use a different sheet for each behavior- if you have three answers to #3 then use three sheets</i>	This is called: (Hint your answer may come from the descriptions in bold print at bottom in question # 4)	How do I know that this is not just a healthy enthusiasm? (Hint your answer may come from the descriptions in “parentheses” at bottom in question # 4)	Detrimental Effects of this addictive behavior (Write your own answers here about what the specific consequences are or may be for this behavior)

-  Write out a summary of why it is now clear to you that each addictive behavior (from question #3) is in fact an issue for you (write out a summary statement from everything you wrote in this table).



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-  Write out a summary of why it is now clear to you that each addictive behavior (from question #3) is in fact an issue for you (write out a summary statement from everything you wrote in this table).

1. Use your completed summarizing sentence(s) at the bottom of each of your **Addictive Behavior Inventory Sheets** on the previous pages. For each sheet that you completed, write a new statement about what you are going to change, when you will start and why you are doing this.

Behavior that I want to change?

Why it is important for me to make this change?

When will I start?

Who will I be accountable to about this?

How will this work?

Behavior that I want to change?

Why it is important for me to make this change?

When will I start?

Who will I be accountable to about this?

How will this work?

Behavior that I want to change?

Why it is important for me to make this change?

When will I start?

Who will I be accountable to about this?

How will this work?

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Who will I be accountable to about this?

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Behavior that I want to change?

Why it is important for me to make this change?

When will I start?

Who will I be accountable to about this?

How will this work?

Behavior that I want to change?

Why it is important for me to make this change?

When will I start?

Who will I be accountable to about this?

How will this work?

- 2.** What do you want to change in your life? (Don't say "everything. Be specific.) Hit, get your answers from # 1.
‡ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.*
- 3.** Are you willing to talk about and write about very tough subjects about yourself and your life to reach that point?
- Would you be willing to journal these things as a way of talking to God?
- 4.** Is there one incident or insight that made you realize that life was unmanageable? Describe in detail.
- How is that difficulty (or unmanageability) of your life related to your addiction?

CONSIDER AT THIS POINT, WHICH RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY TRANSFORMATIONAL PATHWAY YOU MAY PERSUE Look at additional book listed here:

•

1) Core Recovery & Personal Growth Pathways

a) Foundations in Transformational Recovery Path

- **Alcoholics Anonymous Big Book Executive Summary:** Bill Wilson and Dr. Bob Smith (1939)
- **Overcomer Executive Summary:** Dr. David Jeremiah (2018)
- **Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions Executive Summary:** Bill Wilson (1953)
- **The Resilience Factor Executive Summary:** Karen Reivich and Andrew Shatté (2002)
- **The Road Less Traveled Executive Summary:** M. Scott Peck (1978)

b) Overcoming & Personal Healing Path

- **Anxiety Rx Executive Summary:** Dr. Russell Kennedy (2020)
- **Approval Addiction Executive Summary:** Joyce Meyer (2005)
- **Bondage Breaker Executive Summary:** Neil T. Anderson (1990)
- **The Codependency Recovery Plan Executive Summary:** Krystal Mazzola (2019)
- **The Entitlement Cure Executive Summary:** Dr. John Townsend (2015)
- **The New Codependency Executive Summary:** Melody Beattie (2009)
- **Outwitting the Devil Executive Summary:** Napoleon Hill (2011—written in 1938)
- **Pummel the Devil Executive Summary:** Dr. James B. Richards (2021)
- **Victory over the Darkness A Complete Guide Executive Summary:** Neil T. Anderson (1990)

c) Individualized Personal Development Path

- **Blink The Power of Thinking Without Thinking Executive Summary:** Malcolm Gladwell (2005)
- **Change Your Brain Change Your Life Executive Summary:** Dr. Daniel Amen (1998)
- **How People Grow Executive Summary:** Dr. Henry Cloud and Dr. John Townsend (2001)
- **How Successful People Think Executive Summary:** John C. Maxwell (2009)
- **How to Test Negative for Stupid Executive Summary:** Larry Winget (2012)
- **How to Win Friends and Influence People Executive Summary:** Dale Carnegie (1936)
- **If You Want to Walk on Water Executive Summary:** John Ortberg (2001)
- **Necessary Endings Executive Summary:** Dr. Henry Cloud (2010)
- **People Can't Drive You Crazy Executive Summary:** Mike Bechtle (2012)
- **Permanent Record Executive Summary:** Edward Snowden (2019)
- **Prompt Engineering for AI Executive Summary:** Various/Instructional (c. 2023)
- **Rewiring Your Mind for AI Executive Summary:** Various/Instructional (c. 2023)
- **Servant Leadership Executive Summary:** Robert K. Greenleaf (1977)
- **The 360 Degree Leader Executive Summary:** John C. Maxwell (2005)
- **The 5 Love Languages Executive Summary:** Gary Chapman (1992)
- **The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People Executive Summary:** Stephen R. Covey (1989)
- **The Art of the Deal Executive Summary:** Donald J. Trump and Tony Schwartz (1987)
- **The Tipping Point Executive Summary:** Malcolm Gladwell (2000)

2) Spiritual & Faith-Based Pathways

a) God's Teachings Path

- **Banned from the Bible Executive Summary:** Joseph B. Lumpkin (2008)



- **Keys to Living on Fire for God Executive Summary:** Various (e.g., Benny Hinn)
- **Lost Scriptures- the New Testament Executive Summary:** Bart D. Ehrman (2003)
- **Praying Through the Names of God Executive Summary:** Tony Evans (2014)
- **Prayers that Shake Heaven and Earth Executive Summary:** John Eckhardt (2010)
- **The Gifts of the Spirit Executive Summary:** Derek Prince (2007)
- **The Septuagint with Apocrypha in English Executive Summary:** Sir Lancelot C.L. Brenton (1851)
- **The Seven-Fold Spirit of God Executive Summary:** Chris Oyakhilome (2005)
- **Why We Need the Gifts of the Holy Spirit Executive Summary:** Rick Joyner (2018)

b) Spiritual Warfare Path

- **Killing Kryptonite Executive Summary:** John Bevere (2017)
- **Manual for Spiritual Warfare Executive Summary:** Paul Thigpen (2014)
- **Bondage Breaker Executive Summary:** Neil T. Anderson (1990)
- **Outwitting the Devil Executive Summary:** Napoleon Hill (2011—written in 1938)
- **Pummel the Devil Executive Summary:** Dr. James B. Richards (2021)
- **Victory over the Darkness A Complete Guide Executive Summary:** Neil T. Anderson (1990)

3) Purpose, Leadership & Service Pathways

a) Finding Life's Purpose Path

- **Man's Search for Meaning Executive Summary:** Viktor Frankl (1946)
- **Metaphors We Live By Executive Summary:** George Lakoff and Mark Johnson (1980)
- **Morning After The Revolution Executive Summary:** Nellie Bowles (2024)

b) Leadership Path

- **Become the Manager You Want to Be Executive Summary:** Various
- **Right Wing Revolution Executive Summary:** Charlie Kirk (2024)
- **Save America Executive Summary:** Donald J. Trump (2024)
- **The Agency: A History of the CIA Executive Summary:** Hugh Wilford (2023)

4) Relational & Health-Focused Pathways

a) Relationship Building Path

- **Boundaries Executive Summary:** Dr. Henry Cloud and Dr. John Townsend (1992)
- **Codependent No More Executive Summary:** Melody Beattie (1986)
- **Unconditional Executive Summary:** Dr. Samra Zafar (2019)

b) Nutrition and Wellness Path

- **The Carnivore Diet Executive Summary:** Dr. Shawn Baker (2018)
- **The Case Against Sugar Executive Summary:** Gary Taubes (2016)
- **The Ketogenic Kitchen During Cancer Treatment Executive Summary:** Patricia Daly and Domini Kemp (2016)
- **The Salt Fix Executive Summary:** Dr. James DiNicolantonio (2017)

c) Understanding the Human Brain Path

- **The Life-Changing Art of Self-Brain Surgery Executive Summary:** Dr. W. Lee Warren (2023)

5) Specialized Awakening & Awareness Pathways

a) Financial Resilients Path

- **The Total Money Makeover Executive Summary:** Dave Ramsey (2003)

b) Resilient Awakening in Health Care/Historical Deceptions Path

- **Blind Spots When Medicine Gets It Wrong Executive Summary:** Dr. Marty Makary (2024)
- **Lies Across America Executive Summary:** James W. Loewen (1999)
- **Lies My Doctor Told Me Executive Summary:** Dr. Ken Berry (2017)
- **The Wuhan Cover-Up Executive Summary:** Robert F. Kennedy Jr. (2023)
- **Behold a Pale Horse Executive Summary:** Milton William Cooper (1991)
- **Morning After The Revolution Executive Summary:** Nellie Bowles (2024)
- **Jesus, Interrupted Executive Summary:** Bart D. Ehrman (2009)
- **The Creature from Jekyll Island Executive Summary:** G. Edward Griffin (1994)
- **The Innocents Abroad Executive Summary:** Mark Twain (1869)
- **The Naked Communist Executive Summary:** W. Cleon Skousen (1958)
- **Tripping Over the Truth Executive Summary:** Travis Christofferson (2014)



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Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



POWERLESS ABOUT WHAT?



POWERLESS ABOUT WHAT?

1. What areas of your life are out of control, unmanageable? Be specific.

-
- Do you have control of your attitude over these areas?
-

2. What areas of your life do you have power (control) over? Be specific.

3. How do you think taking this first step will help you?

† Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.

4. As a child, what coping skills did you use to get attention or to protect yourself?

5. In your family of origin, what was the “family secret” everyone was protecting? (Note: a previous question asked what YOU were in denial about; this asks what the family kept secret — the answers may differ.)

6. Before your recovery journey, how did you handle pain & disappointment?

-
- What about now? Do you still do any of these things?
-

7. Would you like to change anything about how you handle discomfort and disappointment now? If yes, explain.

† Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.

8. Why is it important to begin addressing denial?

9. How can you take a step to address your denial?

10. In what areas of your life are you now beginning to face reality and break the effects of denial?

11. Are you starting to develop a support team where you are now?

12. Besides family members and a boyfriend/girlfriend, who is on your support team?

1.)

2.)

3.)

4.)

5.)





At this stage in your recovery, you need to stop doing 2 things:



1. Stop Denying the Pain You are ready to take your first step in recovery when your pain is greater than your fear. "Pity me, O Lord, for I am weak. Heal me, for my body is sick, and I am upset and disturbed. My mind is filled with apprehension and with gloom." (Psalm 6:2-3, TLB)

2. Stop Playing God You are unable to do for yourself what you need God to do for you. You are either going to serve God or yourself. You can't serve both. "No one can be a slave to two masters; he will hate one & love the other; he will be loyal to one and despise the other." (Matthew 6:24, GNB)

In addition to stopping certain behaviors, you need to start doing 2 things:



1. Start Admitting Your that you have allowed yourself to be powerless. As you work the first step, you will see that by yourself you do not have the power to change your hurts, hang-ups, and habits. "Jesus . . . said, 'With man this is impossible, but with God all things are possible.'" (Matthew 19:26)

2. Start Admitting Tha

t Your Life Has Become Unmanageable You can finally start admitting that some or all areas of your life are out of your control to change. "Problems far too big for me to solve are piled higher than my head. Meanwhile my sins, too many to count, have all caught up with me and I am ashamed to look up." (Psalm 40:12, TLB).

Pause to Pray

Heavenly Father,

- **Your Word tells me that I can't heal my struggles, shortcomings, and sabotaging behaviors by just saying that they are not there.**
- **Help me! Parts of my life, or all my life, are out of control. I now know that I cannot "fix" myself. It seems the harder I try to do the right thing the more I struggle.**
- **Lord, I want to step out of my denial into the truth. I pray for You to show me the way.**
- **In Jesus' name, I renounce the spirit of addiction and command it to leave (James 4:7)." *(you must fill that void with God's Word)***
In the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God I pray, Amen.

PRIDE, CONTROL, AND RELATIONSHIPS

1. List some of the ways that your pride has stopped you from asking for and getting the help you need to overcome your struggles.



2. What in your past has caused you to have the “if-only’s”?

🔑 “If only” I had stopped _____ years ago.

🔑 “If only” _____ hadn’t left me.

🔑 “If only” _____

🔑 “If only” _____

3. Instead of worrying about things that we cannot control; we need to focus on what God can do in our lives. What are you worrying about? Why?

✝️ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* ✍️

4. In what ways have you tried to escape your past pain and discomfort (besides what might be the obvious answer, which is likely your drug of choice)? Be specific.

5. How has holding on to anger and resentments affected you?

6. How has your denial isolated you from important relationships in your life?

7. Selfishness is at the heart of most problems between people. In what areas of life have you been selfish?

8. What is the difference between being selfish and making healthy decisions regarding your own recovery and your own well-being? Give an example of each.

9. Separation from God can feel very real (this separation does not come from God), but it is never permanent. What can you do to get closer to God?

✝️ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* ✍️

10. Do you tend to live in isolation?

👤 Have you tended to live in isolation before? Explain.

Make Lists of Significant People in your Life

👤 Age 0-5 [preschool age] (list 10 or more people who were significant in your life, good or bad)

- | | |
|---|----|
| 1 | 6 |
| 2 | 7 |
| 3 | 8 |
| 4 | 9 |
| 5 | 10 |



👤 Age 5-12 [elementary age] (list 10 or more people who were significant in your life, good or bad)
(Some repeats are OK, but try not to list too many repeats from previous list)



- | | |
|---|----|
| 1 | 6 |
| 2 | 7 |
| 3 | 8 |
| 4 | 9 |
| 5 | 10 |

 **Age 13-15 [middle school]** (list 10 or more people who were significant in your life, good or bad)
(Some repeats are OK, but try not to list too many repeats from previous lists)

- | | |
|---|----|
| 1 | 6 |
| 2 | 7 |
| 3 | 8 |
| 4 | 9 |
| 5 | 10 |



Age 15-18 [high school] (list 10 or more people who were significant in your life, good or bad)

(Some repeats are OK, but try not to list too many repeats from previous lists)



- | | |
|---|----|
| 1 | 6 |
| 2 | 7 |
| 3 | 8 |
| 4 | 9 |
| 5 | 10 |

-  **Age 19-30 [young adult]** (list 10 or more people who were significant in your life, good or bad)
(Some repeats are OK, but try not to list too many repeats from previous lists)

- | | |
|---|----|
| 1 | 6 |
| 2 | 7 |
| 3 | 8 |
| 4 | 9 |
| 5 | 10 |



-  **Age 30 + [adult]** (list 10 or more people who were significant in your life, good or bad)
(Some repeats are OK, but try not to list too many repeats from previous lists)

- | | |
|---|----|
| 1 | 6 |
| 2 | 7 |
| 3 | 8 |
| 4 | 9 |
| 5 | 10 |



How many people in total have you listed? (don't count anyone twice) _____



RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

Step One Comprehension Review

Instructions: Answer each question in your own words using complete sentences. The answers to all questions are found in the Step One material (pages 99–154). If you cannot answer a question, go back and read the material again before proceeding.

Name: _____ Date: _____ Sponsor/Step Leader: _____

SECTION 1 — KEY CONCEPTS & DEFINITIONS

Answers are found in the Key Terms & Definitions pages.

1.	What is denial, and how does it keep a person stuck in addiction?	
2.	Define powerlessness as it is used in Step One. What famous Bible verse captures this idea?	
3.	What is the difference between addiction and addictive behavior? Give one example of an addictive behavior that is NOT a substance.	
4.	What are the six markers that distinguish a true addiction from a healthy enthusiasm? List all six	
5.	What is a "spiritual stronghold," and what two things are needed to break one?	
6.	What is "unmanaged pain," and what role does it typically play in addictive behavior?	
7.	What is the difference between surrender as described in Step One and simply "giving up"?	

SECTION 2 — DENIAL, POWERLESSNESS & UNMANAGEABILITY

Answers are found in the "In Denial About What?" and "Powerless About What?" sections.

8.	What are at least three ways that denial shows itself in a person's life (beyond simply saying "I don't have a problem")?	
9.	The material describes two things a person must STOP doing and two things they must START	



	doing in Step One. What are they?	
10.	What is "unmanageability," and what are some areas of life where it may show up?	
11.	What is the difference between what a person is personally in denial about and the "family secret"? Why does this distinction matter?	
12.	Why is isolation described as one of addiction's most powerful tools? What does it take away from a person in recovery?	

SECTION 3 — BRAIN CHEMISTRY, DIET & RECOVERY

Answers are found in the Diet, Brain Function & Mood Journal introduction and the Key Terms section.

13.	What is dopamine, and how does addiction affect the brain's dopamine system over time?	
14.	What is blood sugar instability, and why is it considered a recovery issue and not just a diet issue?	
15.	What connection does the Step One material draw between what a person eats and their feelings of powerlessness in recovery?	

SECTION 4 — PRIDE, RELATIONSHIPS & PREPARING FOR CHANGE

Answers are found in the "Pride, Control, and Relationships" and "Preparing Myself for Real Change" sections.

16.	How is pride described as a barrier to healing? In what specific ways can pride prevent a person from getting help?	
17.	What is the sponsor's role in recovery, and why is the material clear that sustainable recovery is rarely a solo project?	
18.	What does accountability mean as defined in Step One? How is it different from surveillance?	
19.	What is the relationship between resentment and addictive behavior? How is resentment sometimes used to justify continued use?	
20.	What does transformation mean in the context of this program — and how is it different from mere behavior modification?	



SECTION 5 — COMPLETING THE STEP

Answers are found in the completion pages (pp. 147–154).

21.	List the five "tools" added to the tool chest in Step One. What does each one mean?	
22.	What must a person complete before moving on to Steps Two and Three, and who must they meet with before continuing?	
23.	What is the purpose of the significant people lists (ages 0–5 through 30+)? Why does the material ask you to go back that far in your life?	

Step 1 Comprehensive Transformation Essay Question

Resilients in Recovery® | Step 1 Completion Essay *"We admit that we struggle and we have allowed ourselves to become powerless over our addictions and compulsive behaviors, that our lives have become unmanageable."*

Instructions: Write a thoughtful, honest, and thorough essay response — in complete sentences and full paragraphs — that demonstrates the personal transformation and growth you experienced while working Step 1. This essay is not a summary of the step; it is the story of *your* change. Draw from the work you completed throughout the step, including your denial inventory, your addictive behavior inventory, the Diet & Brain Function journal, your powerlessness and unmanageability reflections, your pride and relationships work, your significant people lists, your Top 10 list, and your prayer writing. Your essay should be substantial enough to demonstrate that you have genuinely done the work, not just gone through the motions. Be brutally honest. Your sponsor will read this with you.

The Essay Question:

Before you began Step 1, you may have been living inside a wall of denial — a wall built brick by brick out of minimizing, rationalizing, blaming, hiding, and pretending. Describe in detail the person you were when you entered this step, and then describe — with equal depth and honesty — the person you are becoming as a result of completing it.

Your essay must address all of the following dimensions:



Part 1 — Breaking Denial: Facing What Was True

Begin by describing your life *before* you were willing to face it honestly. Using specific examples from your Step 1 work, address each of the following:

1. What was the nature of your denial, and what were you protecting yourself from seeing?
 2. How were your addictive behaviors — whether substances, pornography, food, screens, anger, codependency, spending, or any other pattern — affecting your mind, your body, your family, your relationships, your finances, and your faith?
 3. What damage had you excused, minimized, or blamed on others?
 4. What truth were you most afraid to say out loud?
 5. Describe the moment — or the slow accumulation of moments — when your pain finally became greater than your fear, and you took the first honest step toward reality.
-

Part 2 — Powerlessness and Unmanageability: What Willpower Could Not Do

This step asks us to admit that we allowed ourselves to become powerless. Reflect deeply and address each of the following:

1. Describe the specific attempts you made — over weeks, months, or years — to control, manage, or stop your addictive behaviors on your own. What did those failed attempts reveal about the nature of your problem?
 2. In what areas of your life — emotional, relational, physical, spiritual, financial — did unmanageability show up most clearly?
 3. How did your addictive behavior connect to the deeper pain, the family secrets, the childhood coping patterns, and the resentments you uncovered in this step?
-

Part 3 — The Body, the Brain, and Recovery

Through the seven-day Diet, Brain Function, and Mood Journal, you observed firsthand how what you eat affects your brain chemistry, mood, cravings, and ability to stay honest in recovery. Address each of the following:

1. What patterns did you discover between hidden sugars, processed foods, and your emotional state or addictive thinking?
 2. When you ate whole foods, what changed in your mood, mental clarity, or ability to resist cravings?
 3. How did this experiment challenge or overturn any old beliefs you had about diet and recovery?
 4. Explain in your own words how blood sugar instability and dopamine disruption connect to the powerlessness described in Step 1 — and what this means for how you will care for your body going forward as a recovery practice.
-

Part 4 — Pride, Relationships, and the People Who Shaped You

Step 1 asks us to look honestly at how pride, selfishness, isolation, and resentment have damaged our most important relationships. Address each of the following:

1. How has pride kept you from asking for and receiving the help you needed?
 2. How has isolation protected your addiction and robbed you of community?
 3. In reviewing the significant people of your life across each stage of life — childhood through adulthood — what patterns did you notice? What wounds, loyalties, or family secrets shaped the way you think, cope, and relate to others?
 4. What amends will eventually need to be made, and why?
 5. What is the difference — as you now understand it — between the selfishness that feeds addiction and the healthy self-care that supports recovery?
-

Part 5 — Spiritual Warfare, Surrender, and the God You Are Beginning to Trust

This step introduces the truth that the forces working against your recovery are not merely psychological or biological — they are also spiritual. Address each of the following:

1. What did the Step 1 prayer mean to you when you first read it, and what does it mean to you now?
 2. How have you experienced the enemy's voice in your own head — the voice that said you were too far gone, that there was no hope, that you could handle this alone? How are you beginning to recognize and resist that voice?
 3. What does it mean to stop playing God over your own life?
 4. What does it feel like — however tentative or fragile — to begin trusting the One who actually holds everything together?
-

Part 6 — Your Recovery Tool Kit: What You Are Carrying Forward

Step 1 gave you specific, practical tools to add to your recovery tool kit. Do not simply list the tools — explain how you personally intend to use each one, and describe how your experience in this step brought each tool to life. Address each of the following tools:

1. **Breaking Denial** — How will you continue to practice honesty with yourself, God, and your sponsor when the wall tries to go back up?
2. **Admission of Powerlessness** — How will you use this admission as an ongoing touchpoint rather than a one-time event?
3. **Surrender** — What does surrender look like in your daily life, not just as a concept but as a practice?
4. **Defensiveness Awareness** — Describe a moment in this step when you noticed yourself getting defensive. What did you do with it? How will you use that awareness going forward?
5. **The Sponsor/Accountability Partner Relationship** — What does the Sponsor Contract mean to you, and how are you committing to use this relationship honestly?
6. **The Seven-Day Diet and Brain Function Journal** — What is the one food-related change you are willing to commit to as a tool for protecting your brain chemistry and your recovery?
7. **The Addictive Behavior Inventory** — Now that you have named your addictive behaviors clearly and distinguished them from healthy enthusiasm, how will that naming protect you going forward?
8. **Significant People Awareness** — How will an honest understanding of the relationships that shaped you help you in your recovery journey and in making future amends?

Closing Paragraph

Close your essay with this: In one final paragraph, describe — as honestly and specifically as you can — the person you want to become through this program. Not a vague wish, but a real vision. What does the transformed version of your life look like? What is at stake if you do not finish this work? And what becomes possible if you do?

When your essay is complete, read it aloud in its entirety with your sponsor or step leader before signing the Step 1 completion page. Average work on the steps yields average results. This essay is your chance to do exceptional work.

Step is COMPLETE when: All questions answered in writing · Top 10 List completed · Essential Questions answered · Prayer in the Form of Writing page completed · Answers reviewed with Sponsor / Step Leader

Participant Signature: _____ Date: _____ Sponsor Signature: _____



TOP 10 THINGS I LEARNED WORKING THIS STEP THAT I CAN APPLY TO MY LIFE.

(Write These in Complete Sentences)

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

10.

As you work through each step you will discover things that you need to ask God to help you with. Write those items on this page as you go.

Also write prayer needs for others.

Refer to this page at your prayer time.

Things to Pray About Regarding my Own Recovery	Others Who Need Prayer (and why)

TO COMPLETE THIS STEP, GO BACK TO THE ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS PAGE AT THE BEGINNING OF THIS STEP, READ THEM AGAIN. THE BACK OF THAT PAGE IS BLANK. WRITE OUT YOUR ANSWERS IN COMPLETE SENTENCES LIKE AND ESSAY OR IN PARAGRAPHS (BUT WRITE THE QUESTION NUMBERS BESIDE EACH ANSWER SO THAT YOU ANSWER EACH QUESTION FULLY ABOUT YOUR SELF).

CHECK HERE WHEN YOU HAVE DO THIS INDICATING THAT THIS STEP IS COMPLETE.

☐


THIS STEP IS COMPLETE INCLUDING ALL ANSWERS, TOP TEN LIST, ESSENTIAL QUESTION ANSWERS)

Day

Date

Participant Signature

Sponsor/ Step Leader Signature

Praying in the Form of Writing



Write a letter to God, asking for clarity and understanding regarding the specific aspect of your life.



Heavenly Father,

Thank you for the learning opportunities you have given me in this step. This week I have realized that I am especially grateful for (you might include some items from your gratitude lists):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

In this Step, with your guidance I have begun to learn (*list those things on your Top 10 list from this Step*)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

I ask now that you give me even more clarity at understanding in these areas, and especially in the area of

You tell me in your Word, The Bible, to come to you with my needs, so that is what I am doing now. I seek your wisdom and guidance with (mention all the things from your prayer request list from the previous page):

I ask that you give me a sense of willingness to allow you to work in my life so that I can heal and so that I may find my purpose and become the person you would have me be.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.

-
- Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise during writing this prayer and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive.
 - Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise as you read this prayer aloud praying with your step leader/ sponsor (and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive).

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		

Congratulations on your progress, having finished the first step & the pre-step!

If you have not already begun weekly meetings with a Resilients in Recovery Certified Life Coach or a Resilients in Recovery Sponsor, now is the time.

Before you go on to steps two and three, you must talk through and read your answers in individual meetings with a Resilients in Recovery Certified Life Coach or a Resilients in Recovery Sponsor.

You will need to contact the program directors so that they can match you with a Resilients in Recovery Certified Life Coach or a Resilients in Recovery Sponsor. That coach or sponsor will provide you with the pages for the next steps to put in your notebook.

Before you make that call, be sure that you have completed: **The Top 10 Lists, Prayer In the Form of Writing Pages, And begun filling in the Forms and Checklists section**



WORKSHOP

BREAK 1

This is not a step. This is a point where we take a break from the step questions to do two workshops (one each week for the next two weekly sessions). These will be one on one sessions with your step leader. You will not need to prepare for them. Your step leader will guide you through them at each meeting time. Pick any one workshop in this section and notify your step leader of which one you chose. Your step leader will select the other one.



Spiritual Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **Before Amen** (Max Lucado) — Simple, powerful prayer practices. A practical prayer framework they can use daily to reduce anxiety, increase conscious contact with God, and experience peace in the midst of recovery struggles.
- **Bondage Breaker, The** (Neil T. Anderson) — Spiritual freedom from strongholds. Tools to identify and tear down lies/strongholds, steps to walk in Christ’s victory, and renewed confidence that freedom is possible now.
- **Empowered by the Spirit** (Derek Prince) — Gifts of the Holy Spirit. Understanding of how the Holy Spirit empowers daily living and recovery, plus discernment to recognize and steward spiritual gifts.
- **Facing Your Giants** (Max Lucado) — Facing fears through David’s story. Courage to confront personal “giants” (addiction, shame, relapse triggers) with faith instead of fear.
- **Fearless** (Max Lucado) — Overcoming fear with faith. Practical ways to replace fear-based thinking with trust in God, reducing anxiety-driven decisions in recovery.
- **Not a Fan** (Kyle Idleman) — Moving from fan to follower. Clarity on the cost of true discipleship and motivation to move from casual faith to full surrender.
- **Prayer of Jabez, The** (Bruce Wilkinson) — Bold, daily prayer. A simple, memorable prayer they can pray daily for blessing, influence, protection, and God’s presence.
- **Problem of Pain, The** (C.S. Lewis) — Suffering and God’s goodness. A biblical framework for making sense of pain without losing faith, helping prevent resentment or relapse during hard seasons.
- **Screwtape Letters, The** (C.S. Lewis) — Recognizing temptation. Insight into subtle spiritual attacks and practical strategies to resist them.
- **When the Body Remembers** (Bessel van der Kolk) — Trauma and the body. Understanding of how trauma lives in the body and faith-based hope for healing.
- **Why Am I Like This?** (Kobe Campbell) — Trauma roots and patterns. Compassionate insight into why they repeat certain patterns and the first steps toward breaking cycles.
- **You’ll Get Through This** (Max Lucado) — Hope in crisis. Encouragement and biblical perspective that God redeems pain, helping them endure tough seasons without giving up.

Emotional Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **Anxious for Nothing** (Max Lucado) — C.A.L.M. plan for anxiety. Immediate, Scripture-based tools to manage anxiety and worry.

- **Approval Addiction** (Joyce Meyer) — Breaking people-pleasing. Freedom from needing everyone's approval and courage to live authentically.
- **Every Woman's Battle** (Shannon Ethridge) — Emotional and sexual integrity (women). Practical help for guarding the heart and mind in relationships.
- **Guilt & Shame** — Addressing guilt and shame. Distinction between guilt and shame plus biblical release from both
- **Human Magnet Syndrome, The** (Ross Rosenberg) — Codependent patterns. Awareness of unhealthy attraction patterns and how to break them.
- **Overcoming Disappointment and Discouragement** (Kathy Spampinato) — Renewing hope. Tools to process disappointment without sliding into despair.
- **PRIDE in Recovery** — Humility vs. pride. Recognition of pride as a recovery saboteur and the path of humility.
- **Soul of Shame, The** (Curt Thompson) — Healing shame. Understanding of shame's power and the healing that comes from being known.
- **Steady in the Storm** (Spampinato + Carlson) — Handling daily stressors. Practical emotional regulation for everyday life.

Relational Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **5 Apology Languages, The** (Chapman & Thomas) — Healthy apologies. Skills to repair relationships through effective apologies (key for Step 8–9 work).
- **Boundaries** (Cloud & Townsend) — Healthy limits. Clarity on what is “my responsibility” vs. “not mine,” reducing resentment and enabling better relationships.
- **Every Man's Battle** (Arterburn & Stoeker) — Sexual integrity (men). Accountability tools and honesty for sexual purity.
- **Making Sense of Forgiveness** (Brad Hambrick) — The forgiveness journey. Freedom from bitterness without pressure for premature reconciliation.
- **Safe People** (Cloud & Townsend) — Choosing healthy relationships. Discernment to build safe community and avoid toxic ones.
- **The Book of Forgiving** (Tutu & Tutu) — Fourfold path to forgiveness. A clear process for healing personal and relational wounds.
- **Unpacking Forgiveness** (Chris Brauns) — Biblical forgiveness. Release from bitterness while honoring justice and safety.

Physical Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **Carnivore Diet, The** (Shawn Baker) — Elimination diet exploration. A clear understanding of how an animal-based elimination diet can stabilize energy, reduce inflammation, and support brain

health, along with practical next steps for experimenting safely while stewarding their body as God's temple.

- **Fat Chance** (Robert Lustig) — Sugar, metabolism, and grace. Eye-opening knowledge about hidden sugars and their impact on the brain and body, combined with grace-filled encouragement to make sustainable changes without shame.
- **Metabolical** (Robert Lustig) — Processed food awareness. Tools to identify ultra-processed foods that drive cravings and metabolic dysfunction, along with practical strategies for choosing real food that supports long-term recovery.
- **Plant Paradox, The** (Steven Gundry) — Gut health and lectins. Understanding of how certain plant compounds affect gut health and inflammation, with actionable ways to reduce digestive issues and improve overall physical well-being.

Mental Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **Change Your Diet, Change Your Mind** (Georgia Ede) — Nutrition and brain health. Science-backed insight into how food affects mood, cravings, and mental clarity, plus simple dietary shifts that can support emotional stability and reduce addictive eating patterns.
- **Get Out of Your Head** (Jennie Allen) — Breaking toxic thought spirals. Skills to interrupt negative rumination and replace lies with truth.
- **Every Thought Captive** (Kyle Idleman) — Renewing the mind. Biblical strategies from 2 Corinthians 10:5 to take thoughts captive, replace toxic thinking patterns, and experience greater mental freedom and peace. .
- **Heal Your Hurting Mind** (Craig Groeschel) — Tools for anxiety, depression, anger, trauma. Honest, practical steps for emotional honesty and healing.

Cultural / Practical Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **God Pocket, The** (Bruce Wilkinson) — Generosity and availability. A simple, life-changing practice of being ready to bless others daily, shifting focus from self-centeredness to service and building a habit of generosity.
- **How to Test Negative for Stupid** (John Kennedy) — Wisdom and common sense. Humorous yet practical discernment tools to make wiser daily decisions and avoid common pitfalls that sabotage recovery.
- **Total Money Makeover, The** (Dave Ramsey) — Financial peace plan. Clear “Baby Steps” for getting out of debt, building emergency savings, and gaining financial peace — reducing stress that often fuels relapse.
- **The 360° Leader** (John C. Maxwell) — Influence from anywhere. Leadership principles for influencing others positively regardless of title or position, helping participants become assets in their recovery community and workplace.



STEP TWO





RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

12 Step TRANSFORMATION Curriculum • VER 7.1

Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP TWO

STEP 2: We come to believe that a power greater than ourselves can restore us to sanity.

- *“So humble yourselves before God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you.” — James 4:7*
- *“For God is working in you, giving you the desire and the power to do what pleases him.” — Philippians 2:13*

HEBREWS IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® — STARTING IN THE BOOK OF HEBREWS

Choose TWO items (A–L) to implement while working Step 2. Select items NOT already in practice.

First Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

Second Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

TOOLS I ACQUIRE WORKING STEP 2

- **Prayer** — Beginning and sustaining daily honest communication with God — the lifeline through which strength and guidance flow
- **The Serenity Prayer** — A daily prayer tool for accepting what cannot be changed, changing what can, and gaining wisdom to know the difference
- **Spiritual Identity Anchoring** — Replacing shame-based self-perception with Scripture-grounded identity (child of God, new creation)
- **Spiritual Warfare Awareness** — The ability to recognize the enemy’s lies and tactics and resist them with discernment
- **Virtues Assessment (2 Peter 1)** — An honest self-inventory of the eight qualities of spiritual growth as a roadmap for transformation
- **Hope as a Daily Practice** — Choosing forward-leaning trust in God’s promises as a discipline, not just a feeling



STEP TWO — Essential Questions & Prayer

STEP 2 ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS

I	What am I afraid of?
II	Who has impacted my life?
III	What do I know about God?
IV	What do I think about God's power?
V	When considering the Book of 2 Peter in the Bible, what do I want to change about myself?
VI	What is sanity, and are there things that I have been doing that are not really sane?
VII	Why do people pray for serenity, and should I do that?
VIII	What is Spiritual Warfare and how does it affect me?

STEP 2 PRAYER

Heavenly Father,

I have tried to "fix" and "control" my struggles all by myself. Doing things my way has not gone well.

I admit that I have allowed myself to become powerless to change. I need to begin to really believe in Your power to help me recover. My way has not worked out so well.

You loved me enough to send Your Son to the cross to die for my sins. Help me be open to the hope that I can only find in Him.

Please help me to start living my life one day at a time and remind me that it took a while to get to this point in my life, it will not be an instant transformation. But I know that by turning to You that I can start to change things.

My hope is in You Lord. Please help me never to forget that.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.



STEP TWO

KEY TERMS & DEFINITIONS

We come to believe that a power greater than ourselves can restore us to sanity.

The following terms are central to the work of Step Two. Understanding them will deepen your engagement with the questions, scripture, and reflection throughout this step. Take time to read each definition carefully — and return to them as often as needed.

Higher Power

The God of the Bible — the all-knowing, all-powerful Creator who stands infinitely above human ability and understanding. In Step Two, we begin to loosen our grip on the illusion of self-sufficiency and open ourselves to the reality that real, lasting change flows from a source beyond our own willpower. As Philippians 2:13 declares, God is working in you — giving both the desire and the power to do what pleases Him. This is not a vague spiritual force but a personal Father who knows your name, hears your cry, and is fully capable of doing what you cannot do for yourself.

Sanity

Sound, God-aligned thinking and behavior grounded in truth rather than distorted by fear, addiction, pride, trauma, or self-deception. Insanity, in the recovery context, is continuing the same destructive behaviors and expecting different results. True sanity is not merely the absence of chaos — it is the restoration of the mind to its created purpose: to perceive reality clearly, to make decisions wisely, and to respond to life's challenges from a place of inner peace. 2 Timothy 1:7 reminds us that God has not given us a spirit of fear but of power, love, and self-discipline — all hallmarks of a sane and restored mind.

Restoration

The divine process by which God rebuilds and renews what addiction, trauma, sin, and self-will have broken down. Restoration is not simply returning to a former state — it is transformation into something stronger, healthier, and more whole than before. It involves the renewal of the mind (Romans 12:2), the healing of emotional wounds, the rebuilding of relationships, and the recovery of dignity. God does not discard what is broken; He restores it. This is the promise at the heart of Step Two.

Spiritual Warfare

The ongoing invisible battle between the Kingdom of God and the forces of darkness that seek to keep people trapped in bondage, deception, isolation, and defeat. Ephesians 6:12 makes clear that the real enemy is not flesh and blood but spiritual powers operating in the unseen realm. In recovery, spiritual warfare shows up as the inner voice that says 'you can't change,' the compulsion to isolate from community, the temptation to quit the process, and the fear that God does not care. Recognizing these as enemy tactics — rather than truth — is a critical skill for those in recovery.

Spiritual Identity

Who you truly are as defined by Scripture and by the finished work of Jesus Christ, not by your worst moments, your failures, your diagnosis, or what others have said about you. You are a child of God (John 1:12), a new creation (2 Corinthians 5:17), God's masterpiece (Ephesians 2:10), and a co-heir with Christ (Romans 8:17). Anchoring your life to this truth is not positive thinking — it is the antidote to shame, the foundation of lasting change, and the ground on which recovery is built.

Denial

The psychological and spiritual defense mechanism by which a person refuses to acknowledge the true nature or severity of their problem, pain, or need. Denial is not stupidity — it is often a survival tool that has outlived its usefulness. It may have protected you at one point, but in recovery, denial is a wall between you and the healing God desires to bring. Breaking through denial requires honesty, community, and the courage to face reality with God's help rather than your own strength.

Surrender



The courageous decision to stop fighting God and to release control of your life, your recovery, and your outcomes into His capable hands. Surrender is not weakness — it is the most powerful act a person in recovery can perform. It is the moment the war inside you begins to cease. James 4:7 ties surrender directly to freedom: 'Humble yourselves before God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you.' You cannot resist the enemy while you are still fighting God. Surrender to God is always the first step toward victory.

Powerlessness

The honest acknowledgment that you have tried — and failed — to manage your life, your habits, your pain, or your behavior through sheer willpower alone. Admitting powerlessness is not defeat; it is the beginning of real freedom. It is the crack in the wall of self-reliance through which God's power can finally enter. The apostle Paul understood this when he wrote, 'When I am weak, then I am strong' (2 Corinthians 12:10). Powerlessness is not the end of the story — it is the beginning of the one where God shows up.

Belief / Coming to Believe

The gradual, often messy journey from skepticism, confusion, or spiritual emptiness toward genuine trust that God exists, that He is good, and that He is powerful enough to restore you. Step Two does not demand you arrive with iron-clad faith — it asks only that you open the door. 'Coming to believe' is a process, not a single moment. It may begin with a small willingness, a quiet prayer, or a moment of honesty with another person. Over time, as God proves faithful, belief deepens into conviction.

Deception (Demonic)

The enemy's primary weapon: the introduction of lies into the mind and spirit in order to distort reality, undermine identity, promote isolation, and block recovery. Satan's deceptions often feel like your own thoughts. They say things like: 'You're too far gone.' 'God won't forgive this.' 'You don't need a group — you can handle this alone.' 'Recovery isn't working.' Spiritual discernment — the ability to test thoughts against Scripture and to recognize the enemy's voice — is a critical weapon in staying free. As 1 Timothy 4:1 warns, deceiving spirits are actively at work in this age.

Serenity

A deep, anchored peace that transcends circumstances — not the absence of difficulty, but the presence of God in the midst of it. Serenity is what happens when we stop trying to control everything and begin trusting the One who actually holds everything. It is the fruit of surrender, prayer, and an ongoing relationship with God. The Serenity Prayer captures it: the wisdom to know what we can and cannot change, and the grace to accept the difference. Serenity is not passivity — it is the calm from which wise and intentional action flows.

Hope

The confident, forward-leaning expectation that God is not finished with you — that healing is possible, that change is real, and that your story is not over. Biblical hope is not wishful thinking; it is a secure anchor for the soul (Hebrews 6:19), grounded in the character of God and the promises of His Word. Jeremiah 29:11 declares that God has plans to give you a future and a hope. In recovery, hope is both a gift and a practice — something you receive from God and something you choose to hold onto, one day at a time.

Renewal of the Mind

The ongoing, Spirit-empowered process of replacing false, destructive, and shame-based thinking with truth rooted in Scripture and identity in Christ. Romans 12:2 calls believers to 'be transformed by the renewing of your mind.' In recovery, the battle is often as much mental as it is physical or behavioral. Old thought patterns — formed by trauma, addiction, false beliefs, and the enemy's lies — must be actively dismantled and rebuilt. This is not behavior modification; it is deep, lasting transformation from the inside out.

Accountability

The relational structure in which you invite trusted others to speak truth into your life, to ask the hard questions, and to help you stay on course when self-deception tempts you off the path. Accountability is not punishment — it is protection. It is the acknowledgment that we were not designed to heal in isolation. Hebrews 3:13 urges believers to 'encourage one another daily... so that none of you may be hardened by sin's deceitfulness.' Recovery communities, sponsors, small groups, and spiritual mentors are all expressions of God's design for shared accountability.

Virtues (2 Peter 1)

The eight qualities that the apostle Peter identifies as essential to spiritual growth and freedom: faith, virtue (moral excellence), knowledge, self-control, patient endurance, godliness, brotherly kindness, and love. These are not character traits that appear overnight — they are cultivated through intentional effort, with the Holy Spirit's help, over time. In Step Two, participants are invited to honestly assess which of these qualities are already growing in them and which ones still need work. This honest self-inventory is not shame-based — it is a roadmap for transformation.

Prayer

Direct, honest, ongoing communication with God — speaking and listening — that forms the backbone of recovery, spiritual warfare, and relationship with your Heavenly Father. Prayer is not a religious performance; it is the lifeline through which God's power flows into your daily life. It is how you surrender control, how you fight the enemy, how you receive guidance, and how you stay connected to the Source of your healing. In Step Two, prayer is both a practice to develop and a posture to maintain: the humility of a person who knows they cannot do this alone.

STEP 2: We come to believe that a power greater than ourselves can restore us to sanity.

WHO AM I AND WHAT ARE MY FEARS?

1. What was the religion that your family of origin practiced or claimed to be a part of?
2. List the positive and negative aspects as you see it of your family's religion.
3. Have you made a break with your family's religion, or have you stayed with it? Explain why you have taken your particular course of action.
4. What other people have helped you to see the unmanageability of your life?
5. Do they believe in God? If so, describe their belief as far as you know.
6. Recall some of your best friends from childhood or adolescence. Describe what you liked best about them- and what they liked best about you?



From the list of groups, write Yes or No according to whether (or not) you could share in their values:

<i>Group</i>	<i>Share Values?</i>
1. Twelve Step Group	
2. Conservative Christian church	
3. Liberal Christian church	
4. Synagogue	
5. Mosque	
6. Hindu temple	
7. Buddhist temple	
8. Unitarian or non-Christian church	
9. Non-religious ethical organization	
10. Activist Humanitarian group (e.g., Amnesty Intl)	
11. Environmental Organization (e.g., Sierra Club)	
12. Denominations (Baptist, Methodist, etc.)	
13. Non-denominational Church	





GOD (MY HIGHER POWER)

1. Describe events, situations or people who have helped you to understand what a "Higher Power" or God is all about.

2. Describe any dreams that you have had about a "Higher Power" or God, and what they mean to you.

3. What have been your previous experiences with religion?

4. What do you believe about God? What are some of His characteristics?

5. How are your feelings for your heavenly Father and your earthly father alike?

6. How do they differ?

7. Have you been plugging into God's power when you are stressed?

-Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now. ✍️

8. Share a time when God's power helped you overcome a situation?



9. Before taking this step, where were you trying to find hope?

10. In what areas of your life are you now ready to let God help you? (Don't just say *everything*.)

11. Read this verse and rewrite it in your own words. When you do this,

- Keep in mind that the words “I” & “me” refer to “God”.
- Change the word “you” to “*your name*”.

¹¹ For I know the thoughts that I think toward you, says the Lord, thoughts of peace and not of evil, to give you a future and a hope. ¹² Then you will call upon Me and go and pray to Me, and I will listen to you. Jeremiah 29:11-12 New King James Version

12. Has the enemy tried to convince you that you should be able to handle all these things yourself?

13. Are there examples of when the enemy tries to get you to not participate in small recovery groups? Give examples:

14. Has the enemy tried to get you to discontinue this step study? Give examples.

15. The most powerful lessons for you may not come from reading scripture but from those people around you that are living out that Word. Given this fact, how can you best equip yourself to learn the most?
16. How can your relationship with God help you step out of your denial and face reality?
17. The Bible tells us in 2 Peter 1 that we must work on ourselves if we want to receive God's gifts and His kindness. That chapter specifically mentions eight things for us to work on (in ourselves). Which of these qualities are you adding to your plate currently?
- a. virtue _____
 - b. faith _____
 - c. knowledge _____
 - d. self-control _____
 - e. patient endurance _____
 - f. godliness _____
 - g. brotherly kindness _____
 - h. love _____
18. Which ones do you need to work on? *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* ✎



- a. virtue _____
- b. faith _____
- c. knowledge _____
- d. self-control _____
- e. patient endurance _____
- f. godliness _____
- g. brotherly kindness _____
- h. love _____



19. What things are you ready to change in your life? (Don't just say *everything*?)

20. Where can you get the power to change them?



Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.

21. What A.I. prompt could you use to have your favorite A.I. platform give you ideas for the next step to change?

22. Since starting step 2, where is my sense of hope on this number line?



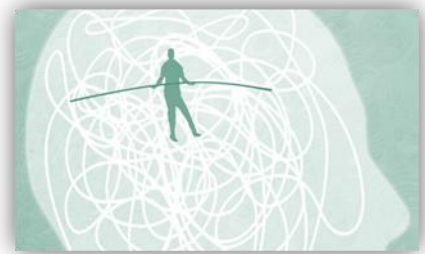
-2 -1 0 +1 +2

23. Before starting your recovery journey where was my sense of hope on this number line?

-2 -1 0 +1 +2

WHAT ABOUT MY SANITY?

1. What have you been doing over and over, expecting different results each time (insanity)?
2. What is your definition of sanity?
3. How have your past expectations of yourself or others been unrealistic? Give examples.
4. In the past, how has trusting only in your own feelings and emotions gotten you in trouble?
5. How can God help restore you to make sane decisions?
✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 
6. How do you get another chance?



SPIRITUAL WARFARE AWARENESS: A BRIEF OVERVIEW

In addition to warning us against self-deception and false prophets and teachers, Scripture warns us against the deception which comes through demonic influence.



Paul alerted Timothy: "**The Spirit explicitly says that in later times some will fall away from the faith, paying attention to deceitful spirits and doctrines of demons**" (1 Timothy 4:1).

John also cautioned us to **test the spirits in order to unmask Antichrists** (1 John 2:18) and to **distinguish the spirit of truth from the spirit of error** (4:1-6).

Satan's demonic forces are at work attempting to pollute your mind with lies in order to keep you confused believing that you have no power, and that the demonic forces have some kind of power over you. Satan tries to deceive you to get you believe that you should isolate yourself from others, not go to meetings, not contact others, not reach out for help when you need help.

There are the voices of evil and deceiving spirits, who lie in wait to entrap those who would try to draw nearer to God. In the same epistle that tells us that we are seated in the heavenly places in Christ, we are also told that we shall have to fight with spiritual enemies.

These spiritual enemies, whoever or whatever they may be, must necessarily communicate with us by means of our spiritual faculties, and their voices, as the voice of God, are an inward impression made upon our spirit. Therefore, just as the Holy Spirit may tell us by impressions what the will of God is concerning us, so also will these spiritual enemies tell us by impression what is their will concerning us, though not, of course, giving it their name.

Top 25 Benefits for Readers in Recovery from Chapter 4 of Pummel the Devil by Daniel Duval

We encourage you to read the book **Pummel the Devil by Daniel Duval**. Chapter 4 of that book equips readers with a robust understanding of active spiritual warfare, emphasizing the believer's authority to enforce Christ's victory. For those in recovery from trauma, dissociation, or spiritual oppression, these insights provide immediate, actionable steps toward freedom and wholeness. You are encouraged to choose from these main points taken from that chapter and develop a plan of immediate action for yourself:

1. A clearer understanding of why spiritual attacks persist even after salvation and Christ's finished work on the cross. **Immediate action:** Today, journal one ongoing struggle and declare aloud: "In Jesus' name, I recognize this attack is not my destiny—Christ's victory is already won over it."
2. Empowerment to shift from a victim mindset to a victorious warrior identity in recovery. **Immediate action:** Stand in front of a mirror and speak: "I am not a victim; I am a victorious warrior in Christ," repeating it three times to affirm your new identity.
3. Biblical insight into the devil's defeated status, reducing fear and intimidation from spiritual forces. **Immediate action:** When fear arises today, quote aloud: "The devil is a loser and he knows it—I stand in Christ's triumph over you!"
4. Practical encouragement to take an offensive stance against darkness rather than just defending. **Immediate action:** Identify one trigger today and pray offensively: "In Jesus' name, I command any spirit fueling this trigger to flee now."
5. Recognition that spiritual warfare is essential for aligning Heaven's reality with your earthly healing journey. **Immediate action:** Pray a simple alignment prayer: "Father, align Heaven's freedom over my mind and body right now in Jesus' name."
6. Tools to identify spiritual dimensions behind setbacks, triggers, or recurring pain in recovery. **Immediate action:** Pause during a setback today and ask: "Holy Spirit, reveal any spiritual influence here," then renounce it verbally.
7. Renewed confidence in your God-given authority to command and bind opposing spirits. **Immediate action:** Bind a specific opposing thought: "In Jesus' authority, I bind you, spirit of fear (or name it), and loose peace over me."
8. Motivation to "pummel the devil" through declarative prayer and authoritative action. **Immediate action:** Speak declaratively: "I pummel every dark force harassing my recovery in the name and power of Jesus Christ!"
9. Hope that relentless spiritual harassment can be confronted and overcome. **Immediate action:** When harassed today, declare: "This harassment ends now—I overcome you by the blood of the Lamb."

10. Deeper appreciation for Christ's victory as something to be enforced personally.
Immediate action: Enforce victory over one wound: "I enforce Christ's cross and resurrection over this trauma right now."
11. Strategies for bringing breakthrough in areas of stagnation or opposition during inner healing. **Immediate action:** Target stagnation: Pray, "Breakthrough come now in Jesus' name—remove every blockage in my healing."
12. Understanding that suffering in recovery may have spiritual warfare components needing direct address. **Immediate action:** Address suffering directly: "Any spirit prolonging this pain, I command you to leave in Jesus' name."
13. Inspiration to wield the name and power of Jesus more boldly against adversity.
Immediate action: Boldly use His name today: "In the powerful name of Jesus, I rebuke adversity in my emotions/mind/body."
14. Clarity on how passive faith alone may not suffice—active engagement is required.
Immediate action: Shift to active faith: Spend 5 minutes praying authoritatively over one passive area in your recovery.
15. Encouragement to view recovery challenges as opportunities for spiritual triumph.
Immediate action: Reframe a challenge: Thank God for it, then declare triumph: "This challenge is my opportunity for victory in Christ."
16. Biblical foundation for why believers must actively resist and subdue dark forces.
Immediate action: Resist actively: "I resist you, devil, in every area of my life—you must flee now (James 4:7)."
17. Insight into the ongoing cosmic conflict and your role as a co-enforcer of God's will.
Immediate action: Co-enforce God's will: Pray, "Your will be done in my recovery as it is in Heaven—enforce it now, Lord."
18. Practical steps to experience greater freedom from unseen influences affecting emotions or parts. **Immediate action:** Command freedom: "Unseen influences over my emotions/parts, be gone in Jesus' name—I am free."
19. Reinforcement that the devil is limited and already a "loser" in Christ's economy.
Immediate action: Remind the enemy: "You are limited and defeated—your influence over me ends today."
20. Empowerment to pray alignment prayers that shift atmospheres over your life and recovery process. **Immediate action:** Shift atmosphere: "Heavenly atmosphere of peace and healing, align over my home and heart now."

21. Growth in resilience by seeing spiritual opposition as temporary and defeatable.

Immediate action: Build resilience: Declare over opposition: "You are temporary—I defeat you in Christ's name."

22. Tools to support integrated healing by addressing both natural and spiritual layers of trauma. **Immediate action:** Address layers: Pray, "Heal the natural and spiritual layers of this trauma simultaneously, Jesus."

23. Renewed faith that God equips you to not just endure but dominate spiritual battles.

Immediate action: Dominate a battle: "I dominate this battle today—victory is mine through Christ's equipping."

24. Encouragement to persist in warfare prayer for long-term breakthrough and wholeness.

Immediate action: Start persistence: Commit to a 5-minute warfare prayer daily, beginning right now.

25. A stronger sense of partnership with Jesus in pummeling darkness, leading to accelerated recovery and abundant life. **Immediate action:** Partner with Jesus: Pray, "Jesus, partner with me now—together we pummel darkness for my abundant life."

What A.I. prompt could you use to have your favorite A.I. platform give you ideas for the next step to change?

➤ **Choose three (or more) of these 25 actions that you can add to your current recovery plan. Circle them or mark them.**

- Then rewrite exactly what you will do and when you will begin.
- Explain how you will be accountable regarding that new plan.
- Include how you will continue and not lose track of this plan over time.

1.

2.

3.



Scriptures Frequently Cited by Daniel Duval on Spiritual Warfare

Below is a compilation of scriptures that Daniel Duval most often references in *Pummel the Devil: A Biblical Foundation for Spiritual Warfare* and his *Discovering the Truth with Dan Duval* podcast when teaching about spiritual warfare. Each scripture is presented in the New Living Translation, as requested, and accompanied by a brief explanation of its significance in Duval's teachings.

- **Ephesians 6:12**

Scripture: "For we are not fighting against flesh-and-blood enemies, but against evil rulers and authorities of the unseen world, against mighty powers in this dark world, and against evil spirits in the heavenly places."

Significance: Duval uses this verse to establish the reality of spiritual warfare, emphasizing that believers' true battles are against spiritual forces, not merely physical circumstances. It frames the unseen nature of the enemy in his teachings.

- **James 4:7**

Scripture: "So humble yourselves before God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you."

Significance: This is a cornerstone verse for Duval, illustrating the believer's authority to resist the devil through submission to God. He teaches that active resistance, grounded in humility, ensures victory over demonic attacks.

- **2 Corinthians 10:4**

Scripture: "We use God's mighty weapons, not worldly weapons, to knock down the strongholds of human reasoning and to destroy false arguments."

Significance: Duval frequently cites this to highlight the power of spiritual weapons, such as prayer and scripture, to dismantle demonic strongholds and false beliefs, central to his warfare strategies.

- **John 1:12**

Scripture: "But to all who believed him and accepted him, he gave the right to become children of God."

Significance: Duval emphasizes this verse to affirm the believer's identity and authority in Christ, teaching that this divine right empowers Christians to confront spiritual adversaries with confidence.

- **Psalms 91:1**

Scripture: "Those who live in the shelter of the Most High will find rest in the shadow of the Almighty."

Significance: Duval often references Psalm 91 as a protective prayer against spiritual attacks, encouraging believers to declare it for safety and deliverance from demonic oppression.

- **Psalms 91:4**

Scripture: "He will cover you with his feathers. He will shelter you with his wings. His



faithful promises are your armor and protection.”

Significance: This verse is used by Duval to reinforce the idea that God’s promises serve as spiritual armor, shielding believers from demonic assaults when declared in faith.

- **Matthew 18:18**

Scripture: “I tell you the truth, whatever you forbid on earth will be forbidden in heaven, and whatever you permit on earth will be permitted in heaven.”

Significance: Duval teaches this verse to illustrate the believer’s authority to bind and loose spiritual forces, aligning earthly realities with heaven’s will through prayer and declaration.

- **2 Timothy 3:16**

Scripture: “All Scripture is inspired by God and is useful to teach us what is true and to make us realize what is wrong in our lives. It corrects us when we are wrong and teaches us to do what is right.”

Significance: Duval cites this to underscore the Bible’s divine inspiration and its role as a foundational tool for spiritual warfare, equipping believers with truth to combat deception.

- **Luke 10:19**

Scripture: “Look, I have given you authority over all the power of the enemy, and you can walk among snakes and scorpions and crush them. Nothing will injure you.”

Significance: Duval uses this to empower believers, highlighting Christ’s delegated authority to overcome demonic forces, encouraging bold action in spiritual battles.

- **1 John 4:4**

Scripture: “But you belong to God, my dear children. You have already won a victory over those people, because the Spirit who lives in you is greater than the spirit who lives in the world.”

Significance: Duval frequently references this to instill confidence in believers, reminding them that the Holy Spirit within them ensures victory over demonic powers in spiritual warfare.

Pick a couple of scriptures from this list and explain why they are important for you.

Due to the deceptive nature of his impressions, Satan's voice may not always be detected objectively. The following is an example of the kind of prayer we need to pray in order to disassociate ourselves from deceiving spirits:

"Heavenly Father, I commit myself unreservedly to Your will. If I have been deceived in any way, I pray that You will open my eyes to the deception. I command in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ that all deceiving spirits depart from me, and I renounce and reject all counterfeit gifts (or any other spiritual phenomena). Lord, if it is from You, bless it and cause it to grow that Your body may be blessed and edified through it. Amen."

A. Have you noticed any new struggles since starting recovery?

- a.
- b.
- c.

B. What actions have you taken to deal with them?

- a.
- b.
- c.

C. What actions can you take to deal with them?

- a.
- b.

D. What is Satan's ultimate lie?

E. What is Christ's ultimate truth?

F. How are you living independently of God right now? Confess those things to another human being and to God. (Make a list.)

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

10.

Renew your commitment that Jesus Christ is your Lord and Savior using the following page.

Renewal isn't about striving in your own strength—it's about returning to first love through grace, the blood of Jesus, and the power of the Holy Spirit. Do these things consistently, and you'll find your fire and conviction refreshed. Jesus is faithful; He's ready to meet you right where you are. If you're doing this today, declare it: "Jesus Christ is my Lord and Savior—today and every day."

Here's a list of practical things one can do when renewing a commitment to **Jesus Christ** as Lord and Savior, approached in the straightforward, no-nonsense, deliverance-minded style that Daniel Duval often brings—focusing on surrender, repentance, breaking agreements with anything that competes with Christ, and stepping back into Kingdom authority.

1. **Pray a bold rededication prayer out loud** — Come before the Father in the name of Jesus, confess any distance, lukewarmness, or idolatry, repent (turn away from it), renounce every competing influence (sin, distractions, or spiritual strongholds), and declare afresh: "Jesus, You are my Lord and Savior. I surrender my whole life to You again. I invite You to rule every part of me—spirit, soul, and body." Speak it with authority, like you're enforcing the finished work of the cross.
2. **Confess and repent of specific sins or compromises** — Get honest before God. Write them down if needed, confess them (1 John 1:9), receive forgiveness through the blood of Jesus, and repent by choosing to turn and walk differently. In a Duval-style approach, don't just feel sorry—renounce any legal rights the enemy might have gained through those areas.
3. **Immerse yourself in the Word of God daily** — Open the Bible and let it renew your mind (Romans 12:2). Read passages about lordship (like Romans 10:9, Luke 9:23, or Philippians 3:7-14), the finished work of the cross, and your identity in Christ. Ask the Holy Spirit to make it alive and personal again. Make it a non-negotiable habit.
4. **Spend intentional time in worship and prayer** — Worship Jesus for who He is—not just what He does for you. Put on worship music, sing, or simply sit in His presence and listen. Pray in the Spirit, decree Scripture, and realign your heart with the reality that He is King and you are not.
5. **Examine and clean house (inner and outer)** — Look at your life: entertainment, relationships, habits, or anything that dilutes your allegiance to Christ. Renounce agreements with compromise, break soul ties if needed, and remove idols. Ask the Holy Spirit to search your heart (Psalm 139:23-24) and bring anything hidden to light so you can deal with it decisively.
6. **Remember and rehearse what Jesus has already done** — Reflect on the cross, the resurrection, and His faithfulness in your own life. Journal testimonies of how He saved you, delivered you, or showed up. Gratitude and remembrance stir fresh commitment and fight off forgetfulness or doubt.
7. **Take up your cross daily and deny yourself** — Make small, consistent choices to put Jesus first—deny fleshly impulses, serve others, or step out in obedience where He's calling you. Lordship means daily surrender, not just a one-time event.
8. **Connect with the Body of Christ** — Get around believers who are serious about Jesus (a solid church, small group, or accountability partner). Share your renewed commitment, receive prayer, and lock arms in Kingdom purpose. Isolation weakens; fellowship strengthens.
9. **Engage in deliverance or inner healing prayer if things feel stuck** — If old patterns, torment, or spiritual heaviness persist, use simple steps like confess → repent → renounce → bind and cast out in Jesus' name. Invite the Holy Spirit to fill every place that's been cleared, and command anything not of God to go.
10. **Step into purpose and obedience** — Ask God to realign you with your heavenly scroll or assignment. Obey the next thing He shows you, whether big or small. Renewed commitment shows up in action—walking as a son of God who enforces Christ's victory on the earth.



MY SPIRITUAL IDENTITY

- The following statements summarize your scriptural identity and position in Christ and form the foundation for your freedom in Christ. Read these statements aloud often.
- If you are presently involved in a spiritual conflict, read these statements aloud at least once each day for a month.



The Christian's Scriptural Identity and Position: Who Am I?

Who I Am in Christ

other apostles; yet it was not I but God who was working through me by his grace.

I am part of the true vine, a channel of Christ's life (15:1,5)

John 15:1 — "I am the true grapevine, and my Father is the gardener."

John 15:5 — "Yes, I am the vine; you are the branches. Those who remain in me, and I in them, will produce much fruit. For apart from me you can do nothing."

Exodus

I am not the great "I am" (3:14; John 8:24,28,58), but by the grace of God, I am what I am (1 Corinthians 15:10)

Exodus 3:14 — God replied to Moses, "I AM WHO I AM. Say this to the people of Israel: I AM has sent me to you."

John 8:24 — "That is why I said that you will die in your sins; for unless you believe that I Am who I claim to be, you will die in your sins."

John 8:28 — So Jesus said, "When you have lifted up the Son of Man on the cross, then you will understand that I Am he."

John 8:58 — Jesus answered, "I tell you the truth, before Abraham was even born, I Am!"

1 Corinthians 15:10 — But whatever I am now, it is all because God poured out his special favor on me—and not without results. For I have worked harder than any of the

Matthew

I am the salt of the earth (5:13)

Matthew 5:13 — "You are the salt of the earth. But what good is salt if it has lost its flavor? Can you make it salty again? It will be thrown out and trampled underfoot as worthless."

I am the light of the world (5:14)

Matthew 5:14 — "You are the light of the world—like a city on a hilltop that cannot be hidden."

John

I am a child of God (1:12)

John 1:12 — But to all who believed him and accepted him, he gave the right to become children of God.

I am Christ's friend (15:15)

John 15:15 — "I no longer call you slaves, because a master doesn't confide in his slaves. Now you are my friends, since I have told you everything the Father told me."

I am chosen and appointed by Christ to bear His fruit (15:16)

John 15:16 — "You didn't choose me. I chose you. I appointed you to go and produce lasting fruit, so that the Father will give you whatever you ask for, using my name."

Romans

I am a slave of righteousness
(6:18)

Romans 6:18 — Now you are free from your slavery to sin, and you have become slaves to righteous living.

I am enslaved to God (6:22)

Romans 6:22 — But now you are free from the power of sin and have become slaves of God. Now you do those things that lead to holiness and result in eternal life.

I am a child of God; God is spiritually my Father (8:14,15; Galatians 3:26; 4:6)

Romans 8:14-15 — For all who are led by the Spirit of God are children of God. So you have not received a spirit that makes you fearful slaves. Instead, you received God's Spirit when he adopted you as his own children. Now we call him, "Abba, Father."

I am a joint heir with Christ, sharing His inheritance with Him
(8:17)

Romans 8:17 — And since we are his children, we are his heirs. In fact, together with Christ we are heirs of God's glory. But if we are to share his glory, we must also share his suffering.

1 Corinthians

I am a temple—a dwelling place—of God. His Spirit and His life dwell in me (3:16; 6:19)

1 Corinthians 3:16 — Don't you realize that all of you together are the temple of God and that the Spirit of God lives in you?

1 Corinthians 6:19 — Don't you realize that your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit, who lives in you and was given to you by God? You do not belong to yourself,

I am united to the Lord and am one spirit with Him (6:17)

1 Corinthians 6:17 — But the person who is joined to the Lord is one spirit with him.

I am a member of Christ's body
(12:27; Ephesians 5:30)

1 Corinthians 12:27 — All of you together are Christ's body, and each of you is a part of it.

2 Corinthians

I am a new creation (5:17)

2 Corinthians 5:17 — This means that anyone who belongs to Christ has become a new person. The old life is gone; a new life has begun!

I am reconciled to God and am a minister of reconciliation
(5:18,19)

2 Corinthians 5:18-19 — And all of this is a gift from God, who brought us back to himself through Christ. And God has given us this task of reconciling people to him. For God was in Christ, reconciling the world to himself, no longer counting people's sins against them. And he gave us this wonderful message of reconciliation.

Galatians

I am a child of God and one in Christ (3:26,28)

Galatians 3:26,28 — For you are all children of God through faith in Christ Jesus. ... There is no longer Jew or Gentile, slave or free, male and female. For you are all one in Christ Jesus.

I am an heir of God since I am a son of God (4:6,7)

Galatians 4:6-7 — And because we are his children, God has sent the Spirit of his Son into our hearts, prompting us to call out, "Abba, Father." Now you are no longer a slave but God's own child. And since you are his child, God has made you his heir.

Ephesians

I am a saint (1:1; 1 Corinthians 1:2; Philippians 1:1; Colossians 1:2)

Ephesians 1:1 — This letter is from Paul, chosen by the will of God to be an apostle of Christ Jesus. I am writing to God's holy people in Ephesus, who are faithful followers of Christ Jesus.

I am God's workmanship—His handiwork—born anew in Christ to do His work (2:10)

Ephesians 2:10 — For we are God's masterpiece. He has created us anew in Christ Jesus, so we can do the good things he planned for us long ago.

I am a fellow citizen with the rest of God's family (2:19)

Ephesians 2:19 — So now you Gentiles are no longer strangers and foreigners. You are citizens along with all of God's holy people. You are members of God's family.

I am a prisoner of Christ (3:1; 4:1)

Ephesians 3:1 — When I think of all this, I, Paul, a prisoner of Christ Jesus for the benefit of you Gentiles...

Ephesians 4:1 — Therefore I, a prisoner for serving the Lord, beg you to lead a life worthy of your calling, for you have been called by God.

I am righteous and holy (4:24)

Ephesians 4:24 — Put on your new nature, created to be like God—truly righteous and holy.

Philippians

I am a citizen of heaven, seated in heaven right now (3:20; Ephesians 2:6)

Philippians 3:20 — But we are citizens of heaven, where the Lord Jesus Christ lives. And we are eagerly waiting for him to return as our Savior.

Ephesians 2:6 — For he raised us from the dead along with Christ and seated us with him in the heavenly realms because we are united with Christ Jesus.

Colossians

I am hidden with Christ in God (3:3)

Colossians 3:3 — For you died to this life, and your real life is hidden with Christ in God.

I am an expression of the life of Christ because He is my life (3:4)

Colossians 3:4 — And when Christ, who is your life, is revealed to the whole world, you will share in all his glory.

I am chosen of God, holy and dearly loved (3:12; 1 Thessalonians 1:4)

Colossians 3:12 — Since God chose you to be the holy people he loves, you must clothe yourselves with tenderhearted mercy, kindness, humility, gentleness, and patience.

1 Thessalonians

I am a child of light and not of darkness (5:5)

1 Thessalonians 5:5 — For you are all children of the light and of the day; we don't belong to darkness and night.

Hebrews

I am a holy partaker of a heavenly calling (3:1)

Hebrews 3:1 — And so, dear brothers and sisters who belong to God and are partners with those called to heaven, think carefully about this Jesus whom we declare to be God's messenger and High Priest.

I am a partaker of Christ; I share in His life (3:14)

Hebrews 3:14 — For if we are faithful to the end, trusting God just as firmly as when we first believed, we will share in all that belongs to Christ.

1 Peter

I am one of God's living stones, being built up in Christ as a spiritual house (2:5)

1 Peter 2:5 — And you are living stones that God is building into his spiritual temple. What's more, you are his holy priests. Through the mediation of Jesus Christ, you offer spiritual sacrifices that please God.

I am a member of a chosen race, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for God's own possession (2:9,10)

1 Peter 2:9-10 — But you are not like that, for you are a chosen people. You are royal priests, a holy nation, God's very own possession. As a result, you can show others the goodness of God, for he called you out of the darkness into his wonderful light. "Once you had no identity as a people; now you are God's people. Once you received no mercy; now you have received God's mercy."

I am an alien and stranger to this world in which I temporarily live (2:11)

1 Peter 2:11 — Dear friends, I warn you as "temporary residents and foreigners" to keep away from worldly desires that wage war against your very souls.

I am an enemy of the devil (5:8)

1 Peter 5:8 — Stay alert! Watch out for your great enemy, the devil. He prowls around like a roaring lion, looking for someone to devour.

1 John

I am a child of God and I will resemble Christ when He returns (3:1,2)

1 John 3:1-2 — See how very much our Father loves us, for he calls us his children, and that is what we are! But the people who belong to this world don't recognize that we are God's children because they don't know him. Dear friends, we are already God's children, but he has not yet shown us what we will be like when Christ appears. But we do know that we will be like him, for we will see him as he really is.

I am born of God, and the evil one—the devil—cannot touch me (5:18)

1 John 5:18 — We know that God's children do not make a practice of sinning, for God's Son holds them securely, and the evil one cannot touch them.

Romans (continued)

I have been justified—completely forgiven and made righteous (5:1)

Romans 5:1 — Therefore, since we have been made right in God's sight by faith, we have peace with God because of what Jesus Christ our Lord has done for us.

I died with Christ and died to the power of sin's rule over my life (6:1-6)

Romans 6:1-6 — Well then, should we keep on sinning so that God can show us more and more of his wonderful grace? Of course not! Since we have died to sin, how can we continue to live in it? Or have you forgotten that when we were joined with Christ Jesus in baptism, we joined him in his death? For we died and were buried with Christ by baptism. And just as Christ was raised from the dead by the glorious power of the Father, now we also may live new lives. Since we have been united with him in his death, we will also be raised to life as he was. We know that our old sinful selves were crucified with Christ so that sin might lose its power in our lives. We are no longer slaves to sin.

I am free forever from condemnation (8:1)



Romans 8:1 — So now there is no condemnation for those who belong to Christ Jesus.

1 Corinthians 6:19-20 — Don't you realize that your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit, who lives in you and was given to you by God? You do not belong to yourself, for God bought you with a high price. So you must honor God with your body.

I have been made righteous (5:21)

2 Corinthians 5:21 — For God made Christ, who never sinned, to be the offering for our sin, so that we could be made right with God through Christ.

1 Corinthians (continued)

I have been placed into Christ by God's doing (1:30)

1 Corinthians 1:30 — God has united you with Christ Jesus. For our benefit God made him to be wisdom itself. Christ made us right with God; he made us pure and holy, and he freed us from sin.

I have received the Spirit of God into my life that I might know the things freely given to me by God (2:12)

1 Corinthians 2:12 — And we have received God's Spirit (not the world's spirit), so we can know the wonderful things God has freely given us.

I have been given the mind of Christ (2:16)

1 Corinthians 2:16 — For, "Who can know the Lord's thoughts? Who knows enough to teach him?" But we understand these things, for we have the mind of Christ.

I have been bought with a price; I am not my own; I belong to God (6:19,20)

2 Corinthians (continued)

I have been established, anointed, and sealed by God in Christ, and I have been given the Holy Spirit as a pledge guaranteeing my inheritance to come (1:21; Ephesians 1:13,14)

2 Corinthians 1:21-22 — It is God who enables us, along with you, to stand firm for Christ. He has commissioned us, and he has identified us as his own by placing the Holy Spirit in our hearts as the first installment that guarantees everything he has promised us.

Since I have died, I no longer live for myself, but for Christ (5:14,15)

2 Corinthians 5:14-15 — Either way, Christ's love controls us. Since we believe that Christ died for all, we also believe that we have all died to our old life. He died for everyone so that those who receive his new life will no longer live for themselves. Instead, they will live for Christ, who died and was raised for them.

Galatians (continued)

I have been crucified with Christ, and it is no longer I who live, but Christ lives in me. The life I am now living is Christ's life (2:20)

Galatians 2:20 — My old self has been crucified with Christ. It is no longer I who live, but Christ lives in me. So I live in this earthly body by trusting in the Son of God, who loved me and gave himself for me.

Ephesians (continued)

I have been blessed with every spiritual blessing (1:3)

Ephesians 1:3 — All praise to God, the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who has blessed us with every spiritual blessing in the heavenly realms because we are united with Christ.

I was chosen in Christ before the foundation of the world to be

**holy, and I am without blame
before Him (1:4)**

Ephesians 1:4 — Even before he made the world, God loved us and chose us in Christ to be holy and without fault in his eyes.

**I was predestined—determined
by God—to be adopted as God's
son (1:5)**

Ephesians 1:5 — God decided in advance to adopt us into his own family by bringing us to himself through Jesus Christ. This is what he wanted to do, and it gave him great pleasure.

**I have been redeemed and
forgiven, and I am a recipient of
His lavish grace (1:6-8)**

Ephesians 1:7-8 — He is so rich in kindness and grace that he purchased our freedom with the blood of his Son and forgave our sins. He has showered his kindness on us, along with all wisdom and understanding.

**I have been made alive together
with Christ (2:5)**

Ephesians 2:5 — Even though we were dead because of our sins, he gave us life when he raised Christ from the dead. (It is only by God's grace that you have been saved!)

**I have been raised up and seated
with Christ in heaven (2:6)**

Ephesians 2:6 — For he raised us from the dead along with Christ and seated us with him in the heavenly realms because we are united with Christ Jesus.

**I have direct access to God
through the Spirit (2:18)**

Ephesians 2:18 — Now all of us can come to the Father through the same Holy Spirit because of what Christ has done for us.

**I may approach God with
boldness, freedom, and
confidence (3:12)**

Ephesians 3:12 — Because of Christ and our faith in him, we can now come boldly and confidently into God's presence.

Colossians (continued)

**I have been rescued from the
domain of Satan's rule and
transferred to the kingdom of
Christ (1:13)**

Colossians 1:13 — For he has rescued us from the kingdom of darkness and transferred us into the Kingdom of his dear Son,

**I have been redeemed and
forgiven of all my sins. The debt
against me has been canceled
(1:14)**

Colossians 1:14 — who purchased our freedom and forgave our sins.

Christ Himself is in me (1:27)

Colossians 1:27 — For God wanted them to know that the riches and glory of Christ are for you Gentiles, too. And this is the secret: Christ lives in you. This gives you assurance of sharing his glory.

**I am firmly rooted in Christ and
am now being built up in Him
(2:7)**

Colossians 2:7 — Let your roots grow down into him, and let your lives be built on him. Then your faith will grow strong in the truth you were taught, and you will overflow with thankfulness.

**I have been made complete in
Christ (2:10)**

Colossians 2:10 — So you also are complete through your union with Christ, who is the head over every ruler and authority.

**I have been buried, raised, and
made alive with Christ (2:12,13)**

Colossians 2:12-13 — For you were buried with Christ when you were baptized. And with him you were raised to new life because you trusted the mighty power of God, who raised Christ from the dead. You were dead because of your sins and because your



sinful nature was not yet cut away. Then God made you alive with Christ, for he forgave all our sins.

2 Timothy 1:7 — For God has not given us a spirit of fear and timidity, but of power, love, and self-discipline.

call them his brothers and sisters.

I died with Christ and I have been raised up with Christ. My life is now hidden with Christ in God. Christ is now my life (3:1-4)

Colossians 3:1-4 — Since you have been raised to new life with Christ, set your sights on the realities of heaven, where Christ sits in the place of honor at God's right hand. Think about the things of heaven, not the things of earth. For you died to this life, and your real life is hidden with Christ in God. And when Christ, who is your life, is revealed to the whole world, you will share in all his glory.

2 Timothy

I have been given a Spirit of power, love, and self-discipline (1:7)

I have been saved and set apart according to God's doing (1:9; Titus 3:5)

2 Timothy 1:9 — For God saved us and called us to live a holy life. He did this, not because we deserved it, but because that was his plan from before the beginning of time—to show us his grace through Christ Jesus.

Hebrews (continued)

Because I am sanctified and am one with the Sanctifier, He is not ashamed to call me His brother or sister (2:11)

Hebrews 2:11 — So now Jesus and the ones he makes holy have the same Father. That is why Jesus is not ashamed to

I have the right to come boldly before the throne of God to receive mercy and find grace to help in time of need (4:16)

Hebrews 4:16 — So let us come boldly to the throne of our gracious God. There we will receive his mercy, and we will find grace to help us when we need it most.

2 Peter

I have been given precious and magnificent promises by God, by which I am a partaker of God's divine nature (1:4)

2 Peter 1:4 — And because of his glory and excellence, he has given us great and precious promises. These are the promises that enable you to share his divine nature and escape the world's corruption caused by human desires.



Pick one or two and copy them below:

Design Your Own Start My Day Prayer:

In Daniel Duval's Book, Prayers that Shake Heaven and Earth, Daniel presents a comprehensive prayer designed to set the spiritual atmosphere for the entire day, noting that proper morning prayer allows things to work out more gracefully with less warfare throughout the day.

The prayer begins with praise and thanksgiving, then applies the blood of Jesus over every area of life including dwelling place, spouse, children, vehicles, and bank accounts. It establishes smoke screens in the spirit realm as barriers against interlopers and satanic agents, declaring cleansing from all filthiness of flesh and spirit. The prayer specifically addresses attacks that occur during sleep, commanding destruction of evil words spoken in dreams, devices implanted, and imprisonments established in other realms. For example, the prayer declares that "all evil devices, chains of bondage, evil injections, imprisonments of my humanity, insertions and implants of every type physical, spiritual, and energetic that were established against me in my sleep, are now being consumed in the holy fire of Jesus Christ." Angels are systematically assigned to different categories of ministry including finance, opportunity, healing, and warfare. The prayer releases specific weapons against the enemy including hailstones, coals of fire, tsunamis of living water, engines of war, and the razor of the Lord. It addresses cosmological powers, commanding that evil assignments invested in the sun, moon, stars, and planets by witches and warlocks be excised by the sword of the Lord. The prayer declares "Just as the stars fought in the courses against Sisera, I determine that the stars are now employed in exploits against the enemies of Jesus Christ." The believer assumes the full armor of God including the helmet, breastplate, belt, shoes, shield, and sword, plus the garments of vengeance and cloak of zeal.

The prayer concludes by declaring the spirit of excellence and charging one's realm with all the names of God, bringing everything into interface with the seven Spirits of God mentioned in Isaiah 11.



In Summary:

- Duval offers a structured morning prayer to start your day with spiritual protection and purpose.
- You'll learn to cover yourself, your family, and your environment with God's word and promises.
- Duval includes specific requests for strength, guidance, and victory over the day's challenges.
- The prayer is designed to be read daily, establishing a routine of faith and reliance on God.
- It incorporates scriptures to align your morning with heavenly authority.
- For example, you might add a personal request for wisdom if facing a tough decision at work.
- The chapter teaches you to set a positive spiritual tone, countering any early attacks.
- It's a practical tool for beginners and seasoned believers alike to maintain spiritual focus.
- The prayer's adaptability makes it a versatile start to your daily spiritual practice.

Now , write your own start my day prayer. Insert pages or notebook paper as needed:

Here is a practical, customizable template you can use to build your own “Start My Day” prayer, inspired by the kind of structure and spiritual warfare but scaled to whatever length feels right for you (5 minutes or 25 minutes). You do NOT have to use every section. Pick the ones that resonate, skip the ones that don't, and add your own as the Holy Spirit leads.

How to use this template the first week

- Print it or keep it on your phone.
- Bold or highlight the 5–8 sections that feel most alive to you right now.
- Pray only those sections for the first few days.
- Gradually add one new section every few days as it becomes natural.
- Feel free to speak spontaneously inside any section — the template is a scaffold, not a cage.

Over time your prayer will become uniquely yours, carrying the same authority and coverage as Stanton's, but in your own voice and at your own pace.



START MY DAY PRAYER – Personal Template

1. **Opening Invocation** Heavenly Father, I come before You in the mighty name of Jesus Christ / Yeshua HaMashiach [*pronounced Hah Mah SHEE Ah*]... (and add any personal titles or names of God that stir your heart.)
2. **Worship & Praise** You are great and greatly to be praised! I honor You as _____ (e.g., El Shaddai, the Ancient of Days, my Shield and Redeemer...).
3. **Thanksgiving** Thank You for _____ (3–5 specific things from the last 24 hours).
4. **Cleansing & Covering** I plead the blood of Jesus over my spirit, soul, body, mind, dreams, home, vehicles, finances, technology, and everything under my stewardship. I declare I am washed by the blood and the water of the Word.
5. **Renunciation & Cancellation of Evil** I renounce and break every:
 - evil word, curse, or assignment spoken over me
 - astral projection, dream manipulation, or spiritual abduction
 - implant, insertion, device, or altar bearing my name or likeness
 - agreement I made (knowingly or unknowingly) with darkness
 - All these are now nullified by the blood of Jesus and consumed by holy fire.
6. **Activation of My Spiritual Authority** (*optional but powerful*) I activate my arche / my spiritual jurisdiction / my seat in Christ today. I declare it charged with _____ (e.g., Yahweh-Shalom, El Shaddai's abundance, Yahweh-Rapha's healing).
 - **Specific Protection & Provision for Today**
 - a. Over my health: _____
 - b. Over my finances: _____
 - c. Over relationships & emotions: _____
 - d. Over technology & travel: _____

- I declare peace instead of stress, provision instead of lack, health instead of affliction.

7. **Angelic Activation** (*if you pray this way*) Angels of the Lord, I loose you to:

- minister to me as an heir of salvation
- bring provision / opportunities / healing / warfare as needed today.

8. **Putting on the Armor of God** I put on the full armor of God: belt of truth, breastplate of righteousness, shoes of peace, shield of faith, helmet of salvation, sword of the Spirit, garments of vengeance, and cloak of zeal.

9. **Declaration Over Creation & Cosmic Realm** (optional – only if this is part of your warfare language) I command the sun, moon, stars, ley lines, and frequencies to serve the Kingdom of God and cease serving any dark agenda.

10. **Invitation of the Seven Spirits of God** / Holy Spirit I welcome the Spirit of the Lord, Wisdom, Understanding, Counsel, Might, Knowledge, and the Fear of the Lord to rest on me and empower my day.

11. **Closing Sealing & Benediction** I seal this prayer in every realm, age, timeline, and dimension — past, present, and future to infinity — in the mighty name of Jesus Christ / Yeshua HaMashiach [*pronounced Hah Mah SHEE Ah*]. This day is blessed, fruitful, and prosperous. Amen.



RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

Step Two Comprehension Review

We come to believe that a power greater than ourselves can restore us to sanity.

Answer each question in your own words. If you cannot answer a question, return to Step Two and read that section again before continuing.

SECTION 1 — Key Terms & Definitions

1. In Step Two, what is meant by the term "sanity"? How does the material define insanity in the context of recovery?

2. How does the Step Two material define "restoration"? Is it simply returning to how things were before? Explain.

3. What is "spiritual identity" according to the Key Terms section? What Scripture passages are used to support it?

4. How does the material describe "surrender"? Why is it said to be a powerful act rather than a weak one?

5. What is "demonic deception" and what are some examples of the lies it uses against people in recovery?

SECTION 2 — God as Your Higher Power

6. In your own words, how does the Step Two material describe the God of the Bible as a "Higher Power"? What makes this different from a vague spiritual force?

7. What does "coming to believe" look like according to this material? Does Step Two require you to have strong faith before you begin?

8. The study asks you to rewrite Jeremiah 29:11–12 in your own words, inserting your name. What does that verse communicate about God's intentions toward you personally?

SECTION 3 — Spiritual Warfare Awareness

9. What tactics does the enemy use to keep people in recovery isolated and disconnected, according to the Spiritual Warfare Awareness section?

10. The material lists 25 benefits from Daniel Duval's book. Choose one that stood out to you and explain what immediate action it calls you to take and why it matters for your recovery.

11. Which Scripture from the Daniel Duval warfare list was most meaningful to you? Write it out and explain why it is important for you personally.



SECTION 4 — Sanity, Hope & the 2 Peter 1 Virtues

12. The material asks: "What have you been doing over and over, expecting different results?" In your own words, explain how this pattern relates to the concept of insanity as defined in Step Two.

13. 2 Peter 1 lists eight qualities to cultivate. Name at least four of them and explain why the material says these are important in recovery.

14. The Step Two hope number line ranges from -2 to +2. What do you think the material is trying to help you recognize by rating your hope both before recovery and now?

Resilients in Recovery® — Step 2 Comprehensive Essay Question

Step 2: "We come to believe that a power greater than ourselves can restore us to sanity."

Essay Question for Step 2 Completion

Instructions: This essay is your opportunity to demonstrate the depth of your growth and transformation through Step 2. Answer thoughtfully and honestly, drawing from your written work, your prayers, your sponsor conversations, and your personal experiences throughout this step. There are no right or wrong answers — only your truth. Write in full sentences and paragraphs, not just lists. Take your time. This matters.

When you first began Step 2, you were asked to examine what you believed — about God, about yourself, about hope, and about sanity. Now that you have completed this step, write a comprehensive personal essay that addresses all of the following:

Part 1 — Where You Started Describe where you were spiritually, emotionally, and mentally when you began Step 2. Where was your sense of hope on the number line — and why? What did you believe about God's power, and how had those beliefs been shaped by your upbringing, your relationships, and your experiences in

addiction? Be honest about the fears you carried into this step and the ways that denial may have protected you — but also held you back.

Part 2 — What You Discovered About Sanity and Surrender Explain, in your own words, what sanity means to you now — and how your understanding of it changed during this step. What patterns of thinking or behavior did you recognize as forms of insanity? Where were you seeking hope before this step, and what shifted? Describe what surrender looked like for you — not as a concept, but as something real and personal. How did you experience the tension between self-reliance and trusting God's power, and what helped you begin to loosen your grip?

Part 3 — Your Encounter with Spiritual Warfare Step 2 introduced you to the reality of spiritual warfare as it relates to your recovery. Describe what you now understand about how the enemy has worked against you — in your addiction, in your isolation, in your doubts about God, and in your attempts to complete this step itself. What lies did you identify that had been shaping your choices and your self-image? How did recognizing these as enemy tactics — rather than truth — begin to change the way you fight? What does it mean to you now that your identity in Christ is not defined by your worst moments?

Part 4 — The New Tools in Your Recovery Toolkit This section is at the heart of your essay. Go beyond listing what you learned and explain how you are now *equipped differently* than when you began. Specifically address:

- How has **prayer** become a more active and intentional tool in your recovery? Reference the Step 2 Prayer and describe how praying it — or praying like it — has shifted something in you.
- Which of the **eight virtues from 2 Peter 1** (faith, virtue, knowledge, self-control, patient endurance, godliness, brotherly kindness, and love) are you now actively cultivating, and what does that practice look like in your daily life?
- Choose at least **two of the 25 spiritual warfare actions** from the *Pummel the Devil* chapter that you committed to incorporating into your recovery plan. Describe specifically what you chose, when and how you are practicing them, how you are maintaining accountability around them, and what difference — if any — you have already noticed.
- How are you using **Scripture** differently now? Choose one or two verses from Step 2 that became personally significant to you and explain why they matter to your recovery in a way they did not before.
- How has your **spiritual identity** — who you are in Christ — become a more concrete tool against shame, relapse thinking, and the enemy's deceptions?

Part 5 — The Transformation You Can Name Compare where you were at the beginning of Step 2 to where you are now. What is the most significant internal change you can point to — not just in your behavior, but in how you think, how you pray, and how you see yourself and God? How has your relationship with your sponsor or step leader supported that transformation? What would you tell someone just beginning Step 2 about what is on the other side of it?

Finally, close your essay with a brief, honest statement of where your hope stands today — and what you believe God is capable of doing in the next step of your recovery.

Your essay will be read aloud to your sponsor or step leader as part of your Step 2 completion. Write it as someone who has done the work — and owns it.



TOP 10 THINGS I LEARNED WORKING THIS STEP THAT I CAN APPLY TO MY LIFE.

(Write These in Complete Sentences)

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

10.

As you work through each step you will discover things that you need to ask God to help you with. Write those items on this page as you go.

Also write prayer needs for others.

Refer to this page at your prayer time.

Things to Pray About Regarding my Own Recovery	Others Who Need Prayer (and why)

TO COMPLETE THIS STEP, GO BACK TO THE ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS PAGE AT THE BEGINNING OF THIS STEP, READ THEM AGAIN. THE BACK OF THAT PAGE IS BLANK. WRITE OUT YOUR ANSWERS IN COMPLETE SENTENCES LIKE AND ESSAY OR IN PARAGRAPHS (BUT WRITE THE QUESTION NUMBERS BESIDE EACH ANSWER SO THAT YOU ANSWER EACH QUESTION FULLY ABOUT YOUR SELF).

CHECK HERE WHEN YOU HAVE DO THIS INDICATING THAT THIS STEP IS COMPLETE.

☐


THIS STEP IS COMPLETE INCLUDING ALL ANSWERS, TOP TEN LIST, ESSENTIAL QUESTION ANSWERS)

Day

Date

Participant Signature

Sponsor/ Step Leader Signature

Praying in the Form of Writing

Write a letter to God, asking for clarity and understanding regarding the specific aspect of your life.



Heavenly Father,

Thank you for the learning opportunities you have given me in this step. This week I have realized that I am especially grateful for (you might include some items from your gratitude lists):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

In this Step, with your guidance I have begun to learn (*list those things on your Top 10 list from this Step*)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

I ask now that you give me even more clarity at understanding in these areas, and especially in the area of

You tell me in your Word, The Bible, to come to you with my needs, so that is what I am doing now. I seek your wisdom and guidance with (mention all the things from your prayer request list from the previous page):

I ask that you give me a sense of willingness to allow you to work in my life so that I can heal and so that I may find my purpose and become the person you would have me be.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.

-
- Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise during writing this prayer and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive.
 - Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise as you read this prayer aloud praying with your step leader/ sponsor (and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive).

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



STEP THREE





Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP THREE

STEP 3: We make the decision to turn our lives and our wills over to the care of God.

- “Therefore, I urge you, brothers, and sisters, in view of God’s mercy, to offer your bodies as living sacrifices, holy and pleasing to God — this is your spiritual act of worship.” — Romans 12:1
- “Do what God’s teaching says, when you only listen and do nothing, you are fooling yourselves.” — James 1:22

HEBREWS IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® — STARTING IN THE BOOK OF HEBREWS

Choose TWO items (A–L) to implement while working Step 3. Select items NOT already in practice.

First Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

Second Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

TOOLS I ACQUIRE WORKING STEP 3

- **Daily Surrender Practice** — Making the ongoing, repeated decision to turn one’s will and life over to God’s care rather than relying on self-will
- **Regular Spiritual Disciplines Plan** — Committing to a personal plan of church attendance, prayer, Bible reading, and community involvement as a structured support system



Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP THREE — Essential Questions & Prayer

STEP 3 ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS

I	What does giving up control of my life to God mean?
II	What am I willing to give up control of?
III	What am I not willing to give up control of?
IV	How can I keep on letting God direct my life?
V	Do I really trust God?
VI	How does God speak to me?
VII	If I turn my life and my will over to the care of God, what will that look like?

STEP 3 PRAYER

Heavenly Father,

As You already know I have tried to take care of and fix things all by myself, using my own power, and I have failed. Today, I want to turn my life over to You.

I ask You to be my Lord and my Savior. You are the One and only Higher Power! In Psalm 139:23–24 we read:

God, examine me and know my heart. Test me and know my thoughts. See if there is any bad thing in me. Lead me in the way you set long ago.

I pray this prayer now and ask that You help me start to think less about me and my will. I want to turn my will over to You daily and seek Your direction, wisdom, and courage for my life.

Please continue to help me overcome my struggles. When I have victory over those struggles, may that help others as they see Your power at work in changing my life.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.



STEP THREE: KEY TERMS AND DEFINITIONS

We make the decision to turn our lives and our wills over to the care of God.

Surrender

The conscious, deliberate act of releasing your grip on outcomes, people, and circumstances — and placing them into God's hands. Surrender is not weakness; it is the most courageous act a recovering person can take. It is the moment you stop white-knuckling your way through life and acknowledge that you were never meant to carry the weight of the world alone. True surrender is not a one-time event — it is a daily, sometimes hourly, decision to get off the throne of your own life.

Will

Your internal drive, desire, and decision-making power — the engine of your choices. In addiction and destructive living, the will becomes hijacked by compulsion, fear, and self-reliance. Step Three invites you to offer your will back to God, not as an act of weakness but as an act of worship. When your will aligns with God's will, you move from reactive survival to purposeful living.

Control

The illusion that we can manage all variables of life through our own effort, intelligence, or manipulation. Control is often rooted in fear — fear that if we let go, everything will fall apart. But the compulsive need to control others and circumstances is itself a form of bondage. Recovery calls us to recognize the limits of our control, release what was never ours to hold, and trust that God's sovereignty is more reliable than our grip.

Trust

The active, ongoing choice to believe that God is good, present, and capable — even when circumstances suggest otherwise. Trust is not blind optimism; it is faith informed by evidence of God's faithfulness. For many in recovery, trust has been shattered by people who failed them. Rebuilding trust begins with the God who has never failed, and grows outward from there. Trust is the foundation that makes surrender possible.

Decision

A firm, intentional commitment of the mind and will — not merely a feeling or a wish. Step Three hinges on a decision, not an emotion. You may not feel like turning your life over to God; the decision comes anyway. Decisions precede feelings in recovery. When you decide to live differently, the feelings, the relief, and the freedom often follow. A decision made in the presence of others and written down carries weight that private intentions rarely do.



Repentance

More than remorse or regret, repentance is a complete change of direction — a turning away from self-destructive patterns and a turning toward God. The Greek word metanoia means a transformation of the mind. Repentance is not self-punishment or shame-soaked confession; it is a gift of grace that makes a new beginning possible. In recovery, repentance is the soil in which genuine change takes root and grows.

Identity

Who you fundamentally are — not what you have done, not what has been done to you, and not what the world has labeled you. In Christ, your identity is rewritten. You are no longer defined by your addiction, your failures, or your worst moments. Understanding your true identity is not a luxury in recovery — it is a necessity. When you know who you are, you know what you are worth, and you stop settling for less.

God's Will

God's purposes, direction, and design for your life — a path characterized by love, growth, service, and wholeness. Discerning God's will requires stillness, prayer, Scripture, and the counsel of trustworthy community. God's will is not a hidden puzzle designed to confuse you; it is a relationship to be walked daily. In recovery, choosing God's will over our own is the practical outworking of Step Three every single day.

Higher Power

The God who is infinitely greater than you — not a vague cosmic force, but the personal, living God of the Scriptures who knows your name and your need. In Resilients in Recovery, we are direct about this: the Higher Power is not a concept you construct; it is the God who created you, pursues you, and is capable of transforming you from the inside out. No amount of human willpower substitutes for divine power in lasting recovery.

Lordship

The condition of allowing Christ to occupy the CEO position of your life — directing your choices, values, relationships, and priorities. Lordship is the practical outcome of Step Three. When you make the decision to turn your life and will over to the care of God, you are establishing Christ as Lord. Lordship is not about religious performance; it is about daily, honest accountability to a God who loves you too much to leave you the way you are.

Self-Reliance

The deeply ingrained habit of trusting yourself above all others — including God — to manage, fix, and navigate life. Self-reliance is not the same as healthy responsibility. It becomes destructive when it excludes God and isolates us from community. Much of addiction, anxiety, and chronic relapse is fueled by self-reliance — the exhausting insistence on doing life alone. Step Three is the direct antidote: choosing God-reliance in place of self-reliance.



Worship

The act of ascribing ultimate worth and value to God through the way we think, speak, and live. Romans 12:1 calls the offering of our bodies — our daily choices and actions — a 'spiritual act of worship.' In recovery, worship is not limited to Sunday services; it is the Monday-through-Saturday decision to live surrendered, grateful, and obedient. Every time you choose God's way over your own, that is worship.

Boundaries

The healthy, God-honoring lines that define where you end and another person begins — and that protect your recovery, your relationships, and your soul. Boundaries are not walls built in anger; they are fences with gates, opened and closed according to safety and wisdom. In Step Three, boundaries also apply to your relationship with God: honest acknowledgment of what you can and cannot control, and clarity about what you are — and are not — willing to surrender.

Renewal of Mind

The ongoing, Spirit-empowered transformation of the way you think — replacing lies, distortions, and addictive thought patterns with truth. Romans 12:2 frames this as refusing conformity to the world's patterns and being 'transformed by the renewing of your mind.' In recovery, we cannot simply stop destructive behavior; we must rewire the thinking that drives it. The renewed mind is not built overnight; it is constructed brick by brick through Scripture, community, and honest self-examination.

Living Sacrifice

The image Paul presents in Romans 12:1 — a life fully given over to God, not killed on an altar, but alive and actively devoted. Unlike Old Testament sacrifices that were slain and burned, a living sacrifice keeps getting up and choosing God each day. This is the daily rhythm of Step Three: laying down self-will repeatedly, not as defeat, but as devotion. The challenge Paul notes is that living sacrifices can crawl off the altar — and we must keep climbing back.

One Day at a Time

The recovery principle that sustainable change is not achieved by conquering the future, but by making one right choice today. Worry, anxiety, and overwhelm are often products of projecting our fears into an uncertain future. The invitation of Step Three is to place tomorrow in God's hands and focus your energy on faithful, surrendered living in the present moment. Grace sufficient for today is always available; grace for next year cannot be borrowed in advance.

Willpower

The human capacity for self-discipline and determination — a resource that is real but limited. Many people enter recovery believing willpower is the solution. Experience teaches that willpower alone is insufficient to break deeply rooted patterns of addiction and self-destruction. Step Three is not a rejection of personal

responsibility; it is the honest acknowledgment that human willpower needs to be partnered with God's power to produce lasting transformation. Willpower sets the stage; God's power writes the story.

Meaning

The deep sense of purpose, significance, and direction that makes life worth living and recovery worth fighting for. Viktor Frankl observed that those who have a 'why' can endure almost any 'how.' In recovery, finding meaning — in faith, relationships, service to others, and a story being redeemed — is not optional. It is the fuel that sustains the long journey. Step Three connects us to the ultimate source of meaning: a God who does not waste our wounds.

Not Guilty (Justification)

The legal and spiritual declaration of Romans 8:1 — that those who are in Christ Jesus are no longer judged guilty. Justification is not the same as being told your actions had no consequences; it is the stunning truth that the penalty has been paid and the verdict has been changed. In recovery, understanding that you are not condemned is essential. Shame drives relapse. Freedom from condemnation creates the safe space in which genuine transformation can happen.

Encouragement

The intentional act of coming alongside another person in their struggle and infusing them with courage, hope, and truth. Recovery is not a solo project — it was never designed to be. In the Resilients community, encouraging others is not just a nice idea; it is a recovery tool. When you reach back to help someone who is behind you on the road, you reinforce your own commitment to the path. Encouragement given returns to the giver in ways that cannot be manufactured any other way.

STEP 3: We make the decision to turn our lives and our wills over to the care of God.

HAVE I GOT THIS ON MY OWN?



1. What are your greatest fears about giving up control over your life to God as you understand God?

2. What things, people or circumstances have you tried to control in the past?
 - How has that turned out?

3. Do you think that God will be able to direct your life better than you have?

4. How do you feel in general about allowing God to direct your life?



In what ways will you keep up the process of allowing God to direct your life?

Possibilities:

i) religious services:

ii) 12 Step meetings:

iii) meeting with others in recovery:

iv) surround myself with other believers in Christ:

v) writing in a journal:

vi) service to others:

vii) meditation:

viii) prayer for guidance & wisdom:

ix) prayer for others:

x) reading:

xi) physical exercise:

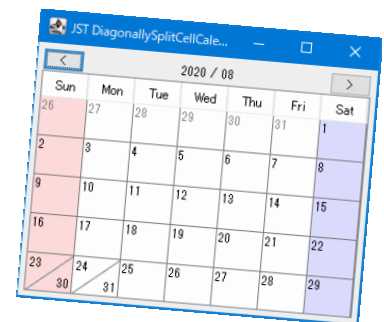
xii) contacting your sponsor or engaging in therapy:

How often?

Start Date?

5. Do you keep a calendar?

a) Is it on your computer or phone?



b) Can you schedule each of the items in the previous question using the repeat function on a calendar?

c) When will you put these things on your calendar?



6. How would you answer the question "Who am I"?

7. Share about a time when you helped someone else in need of encouragement in their recovery.

- How can you be an encourager to others in recovery?

- Do you need a reminder on your calendar to do this often?



8. Describe a situation where you basically acted as if you were saying, "I got this, God". How did that work out?

9. How would you answer the question "Who is God"? In other words, describe God as you understand God.

10. What are you worried about *today*?

11. Are you willing to turn that worry over to God?

✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 

If the answer is yes, when will you do that and how?

12. Describe who or what you trust and to what degree.



13. To what degree do you trust God's Word?

14. Where do you find meaning now?

15. Where do you think that you can find meaning in the future?

16. How do you think that you should live your life after giving your life over to the care of God?

✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 

17. What changes do you expect to make and how will this look in specific detail?

18. Describe any celebration or honoring activity that you have made in turning your life over to the care of God.

19. How would you know if something is God's will or your own?

✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 

20. How often do you read your Bible?

21. Do you believe that God Can speak to you through others?

✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 



WHAT AM I GOING TO DO ABOUT IT?



1. What's stopping you from asking Christ in your heart as your Lord and Savior? *If you already have, discuss your experience.*
2. Specifically, how has relying on your own understanding caused problems in your life?
3. What do you think "repent" means?
4. What do you need to repent about?
✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now. ✎*
5. What does "not guilty" according to Romans 8:1 mean to you?
"So now anyone who is in Christ Jesus is not judged guilty." Romans 8:1
**Reading Suggestion: You may wish to read Romans 8:1-8 in an easy-to-understand Bible like The Living Bible or The Message.)*
6. With this information, you can have a new life. What does that mean for you?
7. Go back and re-read the L in RESILIENTS and put it in your own words. Can you give an example?
↳ *Learn from each mistake & every struggle developing an understanding that sometimes I win and sometimes I learn.*
8. What does the Resilients in Recovery Step 3 prayer mean to you? (Hint turn back to the beginning of Step 3 and read it again.)

9. If you have accepted Christ into your life, what differences have you noticed since you did that.? *(If you need help with this, see one of our Resilients in Recovery TEAM members.)*
10. How has your definition of *willpower* changed since you have been in recovery?
11. What have you been able to turn over to God? (Don't just say "everything".)
12. What do you fear turning over to His care?
✠ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 
13. What is keeping you from turning these things over to God?
14. What does the phrase "live one day at a time" mean to you?
15. What is a major concern in your life?
16. What's stopping you from turning it over to God?
✠ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 

tRESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® – STEP 3 Comprehension Review

Instructions: Answer each question in your own words. Draw from what you learned while working Step 3. Focus on explaining the ideas in a way that shows you understand them and are applying them to your own life and recovery. There are no “right” single-word answers — show your thinking.

1. What is the main idea behind Step 3? In your own words, explain what it asks a person in recovery to do.
2. Many people in recovery are used to trying to control everything themselves. How has learning about Step 3 changed (or started to change) the way you think about control in your life?
3. What does “turning your will and your life over to the care of God” look like for you personally right now? Give one or two examples of what you are learning to release or hand over.
4. Step 3 talks about making a real **decision**, not just having a hopeful feeling. What is the difference for you, and why does that matter in recovery?
5. Read the Step 3 Prayer again if needed. What part of the prayer stands out to you most right now, and why? How does it connect to what you are experiencing?
6. What does “daily surrender” mean to you after working Step 3? Describe one recent moment (this week or recently) when you tried to practice it — even if it was hard or imperfect.

7. Step 3 encourages moving away from self-reliance toward relying on God. What is one area of your recovery or daily life where you used to rely mostly on yourself, and how are you beginning to approach it differently now?
8. What is one fear, habit, or situation you are still hesitant to fully turn over to God? What have you learned in Step 3 that is helping you with that hesitation?
9. How has working Step 3 shifted or challenged your thinking about trust, letting go, or your relationship with God in recovery?
10. Overall, what is one key thing you have learned or are learning from Step 3 that you want to carry forward into the rest of your recovery journey? How will it help you?

Review your answers with your sponsor or step leader. Use what you wrote to strengthen your **Top 10 List for Step 3** and your daily surrender practice. Be ready to discuss your reflections.

Resilients in Recovery® — Step 3 Comprehensive Essay Question

Step 3: *We make the decision to turn our lives and our wills over to the care of God.*

Essay Prompt:

Step 3 asks you to do something that may be one of the most difficult and courageous things a person in recovery can do — make a *decision*. Not a feeling, not a wish, but a firm, intentional commitment to stop being the CEO of your own life and place God in that position instead.

In a thoughtful, honest, and personal essay, describe your transformation through Step 3 by addressing **all four of the following areas**:



Part 1 — Where You Started: The Honest Inventory of Control Before you could surrender, you had to see clearly what you were holding onto. Describe the fears, people, circumstances, and habits of self-reliance that you brought *into* Step 3 with you. What did control look like in your life before this step — and what had that control actually cost you? Be specific. How did the *illusion* of control show up in your addiction or destructive living, and how did it keep you stuck?

Part 2 — The Decision Itself: What Surrender Looked Like for You Step 3 is built on a *decision*, not an emotion. Describe the decision you made in this step. What did it mean — personally, practically, and spiritually — for you to turn your will and your life over to the care of God? What were you most afraid to let go of, and what did you actually surrender? Walk the reader through what this decision looked like in real, concrete terms in your daily life. How did working through the Step 3 Prayer shape or reflect that decision for you?

Part 3 — The Growth: How You Were Transformed Describe the evidence of transformation that took place in you as a result of completing this step. Consider the following as you write:

- How has your understanding of *willpower* changed? What does it now look like when human willpower partners with God's power rather than trying to replace it?
 - How has your sense of *identity* shifted — who are you now, beyond your addiction, your failures, and your worst moments?
 - What does *trust* look like for you now — in God, in community, in the process — compared to when you began this step?
 - How has the concept of living *one day at a time* become more real and more livable for you through this step?
 - What does it now mean to you that, according to Romans 8:1, you are *not guilty*? How has that truth affected the shame and self-condemnation that may have fueled your destructive patterns?
-

Part 4 — The Tools: What You Added to Your Recovery Toolkit Step 3 is not just a spiritual experience — it is the beginning of a *structured, practiced way of living*. Describe in specific detail the tools you added to your recovery toolkit by completing this step. Your answer must include:

- Your **Daily Surrender Practice** — what does making the ongoing, daily (sometimes hourly) decision to turn your will over to God actually look like for you? How do you return to the altar when you have crawled off it?
 - Your **Regular Spiritual Disciplines Plan** — what specific commitments did you make regarding church attendance, 12-Step meetings, prayer, Bible reading, journaling, service, or community? How have you structured these into your calendar so they become habits and not intentions?
 - Any *additional* spiritual or relational tools that emerged for you personally through working this step — things from your Top 10 list or the "What Am I Going to Do About It?" section that are now part of how you do life differently.
-

Closing Reflection: End your essay by answering this question in your own words: *If a newcomer to recovery asked you what Step 3 is really about, what would you tell them — not just the definition, but what it actually did in you?*

Your essay should be written in complete sentences and paragraphs. Be honest, be specific, and be personal. This is not a test of right answers — it is a record of your real transformation. Write it in a way that, years from now, you could read it back and clearly see who you were, what you decided, and how God met you here.

This question is designed to draw out not just intellectual understanding of Step 3, but genuine personal testimony — the kind of writing that demonstrates real inner work has been done.



TOP 10 THINGS I LEARNED WORKING THIS STEP THAT I CAN APPLY TO MY LIFE.

(Write These in Complete Sentences)

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

10.

As you work through each step you will discover things that you need to ask God to help you with. Write those items on this page as you go.

Also write prayer needs for others.

Refer to this page at your prayer time.

Things to Pray About Regarding my Own Recovery	Others Who Need Prayer (and why)

TO COMPLETE THIS STEP, GO BACK TO THE ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS PAGE AT THE BEGINNING OF THIS STEP, READ THEM AGAIN. THE BACK OF THAT PAGE IS BLANK. WRITE OUT YOUR ANSWERS IN COMPLETE SENTENCES LIKE AND ESSAY OR IN PARAGRAPHS (BUT WRITE THE QUESTION NUMBERS BESIDE EACH ANSWER SO THAT YOU ANSWER EACH QUESTION FULLY ABOUT YOUR SELF).

CHECK HERE WHEN YOU HAVE DO THIS INDICATING THAT THIS STEP IS COMPLETE.

☐


THIS STEP IS COMPLETE INCLUDING ALL ANSWERS, TOP TEN LIST, ESSENTIAL QUESTION ANSWERS)

Day

Date

Participant Signature

Sponsor/ Step Leader Signature



Praying in the Form of Writing

Write a letter to God, asking for clarity and understanding regarding the specific aspect of your life.



Heavenly Father,

Thank you for the learning opportunities you have given me in this step. This week I have realized that I am especially grateful for (you might include some items from your gratitude lists):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

In this Step, with your guidance I have begun to learn (*list those things on your Top 10 list from this Step*)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

I ask now that you give me even more clarity at understanding in these areas, and especially in the area of

You tell me in your Word, The Bible, to come to you with my needs, so that is what I am doing now. I seek your wisdom and guidance with (mention all the things from your prayer request list from the previous page):

I ask that you give me a sense of willingness to allow you to work in my life so that I can heal and so that I may find my purpose and become the person you would have me be.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.

-
- Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise during writing this prayer and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive.
 - Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise as you read this prayer aloud praying with your step leader/ sponsor (and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive).

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



STEP

FOUR





STEP FOUR

STEP 4: We make a searching and fearless moral inventory of ourselves offering forgiveness to those who have harmed us.

- *“Let us examine our ways and test them, and let us return to the Lord.” — Lamentations 3:40*
- *“God blesses those people who are merciful. They will be treated with mercy!” — Matthew 5:7*

HEBREWS IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® — STARTING IN THE BOOK OF HEBREWS

Choose TWO items (A–L) to implement while working Step 4. Select items NOT already in practice.

First Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

Second Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

TOOLS I ACQUIRE WORKING STEP 4

- **Written Moral Inventory** — A thorough, written self-examination surfacing resentments, fears, relational harms, struggles, shortcomings, and self-sabotaging behaviors
- **Resentment Processing** — Identifying and naming unresolved anger to break its power over behavior
- **Fear Inventory** — Writing out fears honestly to understand how they have driven destructive decisions and relational patterns
- **Forgiveness Work** — Beginning the intentional work of extending forgiveness to those who have caused harm
- **Identifying the Three Core Lists** — Distinguishing between Struggles, Shortcomings, and Self-Sabotaging Behaviors — a framework used in Steps 4, 6, and 7



Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP FOUR — Essential Questions & Prayer

STEP 4 ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS

I	What are my struggles, shortcomings, and sabotaging behaviors?
II	Who and what has caused harm to me ever in my life?
III	What behaviors in others do I despise?
IV	Do I do any of those things that I despise?
V	What things in my past do I really not like to think about (& what have I been doing to not think about them)?
VI	What are my character defects and my assets?
VII	After learning more about the Fruits of the Spirit in the Bible, what do I really want to change about myself?
VIII	Who has ever harmed me and what exactly did they do?
IX	What is forgiveness and how do I truly do that?

STEP 4 PRAYER

Heavenly Father,

You already know my past, all the good and bad things that I've done. You knew these things before I talked to another person about them and even before I knew about them.

In Step 4, I ask you give me the strength and the courage to recall and list those things so that I can "come clean" and face them and face the truth. I ask for Your strength and comfort when challenged with real frustration in this step.

As I work through Step 4, please help me to remember that I must take these steps in order. I will likely feel the need to make amends and write letters to those I have harmed; remind me to turn to my sponsor — that comes later in the steps.

Please help me reach out to others You place in my path to recovery. Thank You for providing them to help me keep balanced as I do my inventory.

Encourage me when the enemy attacks me in Step 4. I know that spiritual attacks are coming as I draw closer to You. Help me stay reminded that those attacks are coming because I am now trying to carry out Your will for my life.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ the Son of the Living God. Amen.



Key Terms for Step Four

ASSETS — The God-given strengths, positive traits, and Fruits of the Spirit already operating in us (love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, etc.). Naming them prevents self-loathing and reminds us recovery is not only about what is broken but what is being redeemed. (Cloud: healthy self-view includes both shadow and light.)

BOUNDARY VIOLATIONS — Ways we have allowed others to harm us without consequence, or have pushed into others' lives without permission. Healthy recovery requires learning biblical boundaries that protect both ourselves and others. (Townsend & Cloud: boundaries are not walls but gates.)

CHARACTER DEFECTS — Deep-rooted traits (pride, resentment, fear, selfishness, etc.) that produce harm to ourselves and others — the "logs in our own eye" (Matt. 7:3-5) that must be owned before we can see clearly or offer genuine amends.

DEEP DIVE PLANNING — A practical, Spirit-led action plan built from Scripture, trusted Christian authors, and accountability that turns awareness of a struggle into measurable steps of obedience and freedom.

FEAR — The paralyzing belief that God will not protect, provide, or be enough. It drives control, people-pleasing, isolation, and relapse. (Townsend: fear is the enemy of boundaries and intimacy with God.)

FORGIVENESS — The deliberate choice to release another person from the debt they owe us — not because they deserve it, but because we refuse to let their sin define our future. It is never "forgetting" or approving the harm; it is canceling the debt so we can walk free.

FRUITS OF THE SPIRIT — The nine qualities (love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control) the Holy Spirit produces in us when we surrender. Step Four measures our defects against these fruits and asks: "What do I really want to become?"

LIE VS. BIBLICAL TRUTH — Every struggle is fueled by a specific lie we have believed about God, ourselves, or others. Step Four requires us to name the lie, replace it with Scripture, and rehearse the truth daily until it rewires our thinking. (See your Lie/Truth Supplement for each struggle.)



MORAL INVENTORY — A courageous, written self-examination that names every resentment, fear, character defect, and sabotaging behavior without excuses or minimization.

MY PART — The honest column on every inventory sheet where we own our selfishness, dishonesty, fear, blame, and wrong. Taking "my part" is the doorway to freedom and the only place real change begins.

RESENTMENT — The repeated mental replay of a past harm that keeps us emotionally chained to the offender. "Drinking poison and waiting for the other person to die."

SELF-PITY / ENTITLEMENT — The twin lies that "no one has suffered like me" and "I deserve better" — both block gratitude, responsibility, and the humility required for genuine forgiveness.

SPIRITUAL BYPASS — Using spiritual language or religious activity to avoid facing real pain, sin, or relational damage. Step Four refuses bypass; it demands ruthless honesty before true healing.

STRUGGLES, SHORTCOMINGS & SABOTAGING BEHAVIORS — The specific patterns, attitudes, and actions (emotional, relational, behavioral, or spiritual) that keep us stuck in addiction, resentment, or self-defeat. These are not just "flaws" but active choices or unaddressed wounds that sabotage the life God intends.

These key terms are the language of Step Four. Master them, speak them aloud to your sponsor, and let them guide every inventory sheet and forgiveness letter you write. You are not just listing problems — you are stepping into the freedom that comes when truth replaces every lie.

SECTION 1 — What Are My Struggles, Shortcomings & Sabotaging Behaviors?

 = *This answer may reveal someone to add to your inventory list.*

1. As you prepare to do a moral inventory and start Step 4, how do you feel?  (Also write your response on the prayer request page.)

2. Have you had any broken relationships? Describe them and how they hurt others or yourself.

3. Describe any grudges, anger, or resentment you hold over these relationships. 

4. Do you ever think "this isn't fair"? Do you ask, "Why is this happening to me?" Do you compare your situation to others' situations? 

5. Have you ever felt self-righteous? Explain when and the circumstances. Was it justified?





6. What events or triggers have caused you to begin your addictive behaviors in the past? Describe situations, feelings, events, food, or people that seem to appear just before or during your addictive behaviors.

7. Do you allow others to really get to know you? Is that difficult?

8. When you have held grudges, did you try to get revenge? Explain the situation and how it played out. ■

9. Describe times you have been oversensitive. Did this damage your relationships?

10. Describe the faults you most detest in others (list two or three). ■ Do you have any of these traits yourself? ■

11. What events from your past — both good and bad — have shaped you in big ways?

12. Have you failed to do things you KNOW you should have done? Explain in detail.

13. What are your fears? How have they caused difficulty in your life?

14. Describe your relationships with friends, co-workers, or neighbors.

15. Describe your relationships with your family of origin. Do you have conflicts with siblings or parents that you are avoiding? ■

16. Describe the earliest memories of your life. Did you share a similar personality with your family? Did those similarities or differences cause problems?

17. Describe your current relationships with your immediate family (spouse, partner, children). How do they differ from the family you grew up in? ■

18. Describe in detail any major experiences that you believe changed your life forever.

19. What decisions have you made that made a significant impact on your life? Is there a pattern if you drew a timeline?

20. What are some things that you are ashamed of in your past? ■

21. Do you see any patterns in your addictive behaviors? Explain in detail.

22. What have you done to cover and conceal your addictive behaviors? What other deceptions did this lead to? ■

23. What is so shameful in your life that you would not want to tell anyone? Who would you hurt if you told this? Is there a fear that someone would hurt you? ■

24. How do you feel knowing that SOME of these answers don't define you?



Traits I Despise in Others — and in Myself

Put a checkmark beside any trait you despise in others. Also check whether you see it in yourself. ■

Trait	Others	Myself
Selfishness		
Cowardice		
Dishonesty		
Fearfulness		
Controlling		
Manipulative		
Intimidating		
Power-hungry		
Possessive		
Prejudiced		
Overly dependent		
Procrastinating		
Judgmental		
Preoccupied		
Lying		
Cheating		
Intolerant		
Self-Pitying		
Jealous		
Insecure		

Trait	Others	Myself
Greedy		
Snobbish		
Sarcastic		
Hypercritical		
Gossip		
Tightwad		
Harsh		
Unforgiving		
Verbally abusive		
Physically abusive		
Sexually abusive		
Impatient		
Adulterous		
Sneakiness		
Ungrateful		
Cynical		
Bitter		
Full of Rage		
Envious		
Gaslighting		



Section 2 — Self-Rating: Character Defects & Assets

Rate yourself on each: 1 = Very Little | 2 = Sometimes | 3 = Considerable | 4 = Almost Always

Character Defect	Rating	Priority	Asset	Rating	Priority
Self-pitying			Unselfish, thoughtful of others		
Resentful			Not holding grudges		
Critical			Charitable		
Suspicious			Trusting		
Angry			Patient		
Tense and apprehensive			Relaxed		
Emotionally uncontrolled			Calm		
Withdrawn			Outgoing		
Jealous			Loving in attitude		
Fearful (afraid to assert self)			Confident		
Selfish, self-indulgent			Generous and loving		
Domineering			Yielding		
Self-righteous			Uncritical		
Stubborn			Agreeable		
Intolerant			Forgiving		
Dishonest with self			Truthful		
Depressed and gloomy			Optimistic and cheerful		
Feeling superior			Humble		
Hyper-sensitive			Willing to admit faults		
Despondent			Hopeful		
Procrastinating			Being prompt		
Aimless and indifferent			Finding a purpose		
Worrisome, over-anxious			Serene		
Ungrateful			Thankful for all blessings		
Prone to gossip			Protect confidences of others		

Obsessed with own problems			Helpful to others		
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After Rating — Fill In:

A. My greatest assets (assets rated 3 or 4):

B. My biggest Struggles, Shortcomings & Sabotaging Behaviors (defects rated 3 or 4):

C. What I would like to change about myself *(Also write on your prayer request page.)*



Section 3 — Struggles, Shortcomings & Sabotaging Behaviors

Circle any that apply to you. Look up those you circle in the Lie/Truth Supplement to identify the lie, scripture, and biblical truth for each.

Emotional

anger • anxiety / worry • bitterness • contempt • cowardice • despair / hopelessness • emotional numbness / detachment • envy / enviousness • fear • guilt • hate • impatience • insecurity • jealousy • malice • negative thinking • over-sensitivity • rage • resentment • self-pity • shame (hurt pride) • timidity • vulgar immoral thinking

Relational

bigotry • blaming others • boundary violations • criticizing • cruelty • defensiveness • domination • exclusionary behavior • gossiping • insensitivity • intolerance • judgmentalism • lack of empathy • manipulation • meanness • passive-aggressiveness • people pleasing • pettiness • pugnacity (quarrelsome / combative) • retaliation • sarcasm • snobbery • violation of confidence

Behavioral

avoidance • blame-shifting (as a repeated action) • compulsive behaviors • denial • disobedience • gluttony • hoarding • impulsivity • inconsistency / unreliability • laziness / lack of discipline • lying / dishonesty • minimizing • obsession • overscheduling • over-ambition • overworking / workaholism • passivity • perfectionism • procrastination • rumination • self-neglect • stinginess • wastefulness

Spiritual / Attitudinal

arrogance • avarice (greed) • covetousness • cynicism • distrust / lack of trust • egotism • entitlement • false pride • grandiosity • greed • impenitence • indifference • ingratitude • lack of humility • legalism • low self-worth / worthlessness • lust • phoniness • pride • prudery • rigidity / stubbornness • self-centeredness • self-condemnation • self-importance • self-justification • selflessness (performative self-denial) • sentimentality • spiritual bypass • vanity



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STEP FOUR

LIE / SCRIPTURE / BIBLICAL TRUTH

— SUPPLEMENTAL REFERENCE

HOW TO USE THIS SUPPLEMENT

1. You just circled each struggle that applies to you on the previous page.
2. Find each circled struggle in this supplement (entries are in alphabetical order within each category).
3. Identify the lie you have believed, the countering scripture, and the biblical truth. You may choose to circle them again in this section for easy reference
4. Transfer your top 10 to the fill-in grid in Section 4 (then next section) of your Workbook.
5. Speak your biblical truth ALOUD every day for 63+ days.

These key terms are the language of Step Four. Master them, speak them aloud to your sponsor, and let them guide every inventory sheet and forgiveness letter you write.

You are not just listing problems — you are stepping into the freedom that comes when truth replaces every lie.



EMOTIONAL

ANGER

THE LIE *They deserve my rage because they've wronged me so badly — God understands my righteous anger.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **James 1:19-20** “Know this, my beloved brothers: let every person be quick to hear, slow to speak, slow to anger; for the anger of man does not produce the righteousness of God.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God calls me to be slow to anger because human anger does not accomplish His righteous purposes; instead, I can trust Him to handle justice while I respond with patience and grace.

ANXIETY / WORRY

THE LIE *If I don't worry and plan every detail, everything will fall apart — God won't handle it without my help.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Philippians 4:6-7** “Do not be anxious about anything, but in everything by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your requests be made known to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH I do not need to carry anxiety because God invites me to bring every concern to Him in prayer, and His peace will guard my heart and mind when I trust Him instead of worrying.

BITTERNESS

THE LIE *I have every right to hold onto this hurt forever — they'll never change, so neither will I.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Ephesians 4:31-32** “Let all bitterness and wrath and anger and clamor and slander be put away from you, along with all malice. Be kind to one another, tenderhearted, forgiving one another, as God in Christ forgave you.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God commands me to release bitterness and forgive others just as He has forgiven me through Christ, replacing malice with kindness and tenderheartedness.

CONTEMPT

THE LIE *They are beneath me and unworthy — my standards and judgment are far superior.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Romans 14:10** “Why do you pass judgment on your brother? Or you, why do you despise your brother? For we will all stand before the judgment seat of God.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Contempt and judgment of others are dangerous because we will all answer to God; He alone is the true Judge.

COWARDICE

THE LIE *Speaking up or acting would cost too much — staying silent or safe is the wiser choice.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **2 Timothy 1:7** “For God gave us a spirit not of fear but of power and love and self-control.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God has given me a spirit of power, love, and self-control rather than fear, empowering me to act courageously.

DESPAIR / HOPELESSNESS

THE LIE *My situation is beyond repair — God has abandoned me or can't change this.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Romans 15:13** “May the God of hope fill you with all joy and peace in believing, so that by the power of the Holy Spirit you may abound in hope.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God is the God of hope who fills me with joy and peace as I trust Him, empowering me to abound in hope through the Holy Spirit.

EMOTIONAL NUMBNESS / DETACHMENT

THE LIE *Feeling nothing protects me from pain — vulnerability is dangerous and unnecessary.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Psalms 34:18** “The Lord is near to the brokenhearted and saves the crushed in spirit.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God draws especially near to the brokenhearted and saves those who are crushed in spirit; emotional honesty allows His comfort.



ENVY / ENVOUSNESS

THE LIE *They don't deserve what they have — God is unfair for giving it to them instead of me.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Galatians 5:26** “Let us not become conceited, provoking one another, envying one another.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Envy and conceit stir up conflict; God calls me to contentment and freedom from comparing myself to others.

FEAR

THE LIE *The worst outcome is likely, and I must control everything — God won't protect or provide.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Isaiah 41:10** “Fear not, for I am with you; be not dismayed, for I am your God; I will strengthen you, I will help you, I will uphold you with my righteous right hand.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God is with me and promises to strengthen, help, and uphold me; I do not need to fear or try to control everything.

GUILT

THE LIE *I am too far gone or unforgivable — God's mercy can't cover what I've done.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **1 John 1:9** “If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH When I confess my sins, God is faithful and just to forgive and cleanse me completely through Christ.

HATE

THE LIE *They are my enemy and irredeemable — loving them would betray justice or my pain.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **1 John 4:20** “If anyone says, 'I love God,' and hates his brother, he is a liar...”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Claiming to love God while hating others makes me a liar; genuine love for God must overflow into love for people.

IMPATIENCE

THE LIE *Waiting is pointless and weak — things should happen on my timeline, not God's.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Psalms 27:14** “Wait for the Lord; be strong, and let your heart take courage; wait for the Lord!”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Waiting on the Lord builds strength and courage; His timing is perfect and worth trusting.

INSECURITY

THE LIE *I am not enough as I am — only external validation or achievements can make me worthy.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Psalms 139:14** “I praise you, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Wonderful are your works; my soul knows it very well.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH I am fearfully and wonderfully made by God; my worth comes from His creation and love, not from performance or approval.

JEALOUSY

THE LIE *They are taking what rightfully belongs to me or threatens my position — God should stop them.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **James 3:16** “For where jealousy and selfish ambition exist, there will be disorder and every vile practice.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Jealousy and selfish ambition create disorder and evil; God calls me to contentment and trust in His provision.

MALICE

THE LIE *Wishing harm on them is justified by what they did — revenge aligns with justice.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **1 Peter 2:1** “So put away all malice and all deceit and hypocrisy and envy and all slander.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God commands me to put away all malice; revenge belongs to Him, not me.



NEGATIVE THINKING

THE LIE *Focusing on the bad prepares me for reality — optimism or trust is unrealistic.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Philippians 4:8** “Finally, brothers, whatever is true, whatever is honorable, whatever is just, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is commendable... think about these things.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God calls me to fill my mind with what is true, honorable, pure, and lovely rather than dwelling on the negative.

OVER-SENSITIVITY

THE LIE *Every slight is a real attack on my worth — God expects me to defend my feelings.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Proverbs 19:11** “Good sense makes one slow to anger, and it is his glory to overlook an offense.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Wisdom and glory come from overlooking offenses rather than being overly sensitive and defensive.

RAGE

THE LIE *My explosive anger is justified by the offense — suppressing it would be dishonest.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Ephesians 4:26-27** “Be angry and do not sin; do not let the sun go down on your anger, and give no opportunity to the devil.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH I can feel anger but must not sin with it or let it linger; unresolved rage gives the devil a foothold.

RESENTMENT

THE LIE *Holding this grudge protects me from further hurt — forgiveness would let them off easy.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Colossians 3:13** “Bearing with one another and, if one has a complaint against another, forgiving each other; as the Lord has forgiven you, so you also must forgive.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH I must forgive others as the Lord has forgiven me; resentment blocks the freedom God offers.

SELF-PITY

THE LIE *No one understands or has suffered like me — focusing on my hardships is justified.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **2 Corinthians 1:3-4** “Blessed be the God... who comforts us in all our affliction, so that we may be able to comfort those who are in any affliction...”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God comforts me in my affliction so that I can comfort others; self-pity keeps me from this purpose.

SHAME (HURT PRIDE)

THE LIE *This humiliation defines me forever — God's forgiveness can't fully restore my worth.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Psalms 34:5** “Those who look to him are radiant, and their faces shall never be ashamed.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Those who look to God become radiant and are never put to shame; His forgiveness fully restores my worth.

TIMIDITY

THE LIE *Staying small and quiet protects me — stepping out in faith would lead to embarrassment or failure.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **2 Timothy 1:7** “For God gave us a spirit not of fear but of power and love and self-control.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God has not given me a spirit of fear but of power, love, and self-control, empowering me to step out boldly.

VULGAR IMMORAL THINKING

THE LIE *These thoughts are private and don't affect anyone — entertaining them is harmless.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Philippians 4:8** “...Whatever is pure... think about these things.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God calls me to dwell on what is pure and honorable; impure thoughts are not harmless but shape my heart.



RELATIONAL

BIGOTRY

THE LIE *My group is superior and God favors us — those people are inferior and don't deserve respect.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Galatians 3:28** “There is neither Jew nor Greek, there is neither slave nor free, there is no male and female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH In Christ, all people are equally valued and united; no group is superior, and God calls me to treat every person with dignity and love.

BLAMING OTHERS

THE LIE *My problems stem entirely from what others have done — God sees they are the real sinners here.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Matthew 7:3-5** “Why do you see the speck that is in your brother's eye, but do not notice the log that is in your own eye?... You hypocrite, first take the log out of your own eye...”

BIBLICAL TRUTH I must first examine and address my own faults before focusing on others; self-righteous blame blinds me to my greater responsibility.

BLAME-SHIFTING

THE LIE *It's never truly my fault — the circumstances or other people caused this, not me.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Galatians 6:7-8** “Do not be deceived: God is not mocked, for whatever one sows, that will he also reap.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH I am personally accountable for my actions; God is not deceived by excuses, and I will reap what I sow.

BOUNDARY VIOLATIONS

THE LIE *My needs are more important, so it's okay to push into their space or decisions.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Philippians 2:3-4** “Do nothing from selfish ambition or conceit, but in humility count others more significant than yourselves.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Humility means considering others' needs and boundaries as more important than my own selfish desires.

CRITICIZING

THE LIE *Pointing out their flaws helps them (or me) — I'm just being honest like God wants.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Matthew 7:1-2** “Judge not, that you be not judged. For with the judgment you pronounce you will be judged...”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Harsh criticism and judgment return upon me; God calls me to examine my own life first and speak with grace instead.

CRUELTY

THE LIE *They need to feel this pain to learn or because they deserve it — mercy would enable weakness.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Ephesians 4:32** “Be kind to one another, tenderhearted, forgiving one another, as God in Christ forgave you.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God calls me to kindness, tenderheartedness, and forgiveness, modeling the mercy He has shown me in Christ.

DEFENSIVENESS

THE LIE *Any feedback is an attack — I'm mostly right, and admitting fault would make me weak.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Proverbs 27:6** “Faithful are the wounds of a friend; profuse are the kisses of an enemy.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Honest correction from others is often a faithful act of love; defensiveness keeps me from the growth that comes through humility.

DOMINATION

THE LIE *Controlling others is necessary for order or success — God made me the leader for a reason.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE *Mark 10:42-45* “Whoever would be great among you must be your servant, and whoever would be first among you must be slave of all. For even the Son of Man came not to be served but to serve...”

BIBLICAL TRUTH True greatness in God's kingdom comes through humble service, not domination; Jesus modeled servant leadership for me to follow.



EXCLUSIONARY BEHAVIOR

THE LIE Only certain people are worthy of inclusion — God approves of keeping 'outsiders' away.

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Romans 15:7** "Therefore welcome one another as Christ has welcomed you, for the glory of God."

BIBLICAL TRUTH I am called to welcome others just as Christ welcomed me, bringing glory to God through inclusive love.

GOSSIPING

THE LIE Sharing this information is harmless or even helpful — people need to know the 'truth.'

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Proverbs 16:28** "A dishonest man spreads strife, and a whisperer separates close friends."

BIBLICAL TRUTH Gossip destroys relationships and spreads strife; God calls me to guard my words and protect trust.

INSENSITIVITY

THE LIE Their feelings are exaggerated or irrelevant — focusing on them would slow me down.

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Romans 12:15** "Rejoice with those who rejoice, weep with those who weep."

BIBLICAL TRUTH God calls me to empathize with others' joys and sorrows rather than dismiss their feelings.

INTOLERANCE

THE LIE My view is the only correct one — accepting differences compromises truth.

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Romans 14:1** "As for the one who is weak in faith, welcome him, but not to quarrel over opinions."

BIBLICAL TRUTH I am called to welcome others in humility rather than quarrel over secondary opinions, trusting God with differences.

JUDGMENTALISM

THE LIE I can accurately assess their worth and sins — my standards reflect God's perfectly.

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Matthew 7:1** "Judge not, that you be not judged."

BIBLICAL TRUTH Judging others invites judgment on myself; only God is the perfect Judge.

LACK OF EMPATHY

THE LIE Their pain isn't my problem — I have my own issues to focus on.

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Galatians 6:2** "Bear one another's burdens, and so fulfill the law of Christ."

BIBLICAL TRUTH Bearing others' burdens fulfills the law of Christ; God calls me to share in their struggles with empathy.

MANIPULATION

THE LIE Steering others this way is for their good (or mine) — honest directness wouldn't work.

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Proverbs 12:22** "Lying lips are an abomination to the Lord, but those who act faithfully are his delight."

BIBLICAL TRUTH Manipulation and deceit are detestable to God; He delights in faithfulness and honesty.

MEANNESS

THE LIE Being harsh or unkind gets results — softness would make me look weak.

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Colossians 3:12** "Put on then, as God's chosen ones, holy and beloved, compassionate hearts, kindness..."

BIBLICAL TRUTH As God's chosen and loved people, I am to clothe myself with compassion and kindness, not harshness.

PASSIVE-AGGRESSIVENESS

THE LIE Indirect jabs or silence express my feelings safely — direct honesty would cause conflict.

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Ephesians 4:25** "Therefore, having put away falsehood, let each one of you speak the truth with his neighbor..."

BIBLICAL TRUTH God calls me to put away falsehood and speak truth directly and lovingly with others.



PEOPLE PLEASING

THE LIE *Gaining everyone's approval keeps peace and shows love — saying no is selfish.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Galatians 1:10** “For am I now seeking the approval of man, or of God? Or am I trying to please man? If I were still trying to please man, I would not be a servant of Christ.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Seeking to please people prevents me from being a true servant of Christ; I am called to live for God's approval.

PETTINESS

THE LIE *These small issues matter greatly — overlooking them would mean losing ground.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **1 Corinthians 13:4-5** “Love is patient and kind; love does not envy or boast; it is not arrogant or rude. It does not insist on its own way...”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Love does not insist on its own way or focus on petty offenses; it is patient and kind instead.

PUGNACITY (QUARRELSOME / COMBATIVE)

THE LIE *Arguing and fighting prove I'm right — backing down shows weakness.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **2 Timothy 2:24** “And the Lord's servant must not be quarrelsome but kind to everyone...”

BIBLICAL TRUTH As the Lord's servant, I am called to kindness rather than quarreling; gentleness reflects Christ.

RETALIATION

THE LIE *Paying them back is fair and biblical (an eye for an eye) — mercy enables evil.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Romans 12:19** “Beloved, never avenge yourselves, but leave it to the wrath of God, for it is written, ‘Vengeance is mine, I will repay, says the Lord.’”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Vengeance belongs to God alone; I am called to trust Him rather than take revenge.

SARCASM

THE LIE *My cutting words are just humor or truth-telling — they deserve it and it doesn't really hurt.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Ephesians 4:29** “Let no corrupting talk come out of your mouths, but only such as is good for building up...”

BIBLICAL TRUTH My words should build others up rather than tear them down; corrupting speech grieves the Holy Spirit.

SNOBBERY

THE LIE *I belong to a better class or group — associating with 'lesser' people diminishes me.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **James 2:1-4** “My brothers, show no partiality as you hold the faith in our Lord Jesus Christ, the Lord of glory.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Partiality and snobbery contradict faith in Christ; God calls me to treat all people equally with honor.

VIOLATION OF CONFIDENCE

THE LIE *Sharing this secret is harmless or necessary — trust isn't as important as the information.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Proverbs 11:13** “Whoever goes about slandering reveals secrets, but he who is trustworthy in spirit keeps a thing covered.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH A trustworthy person keeps confidences; violating trust through gossip dishonors God and damages relationships.



BEHAVIORAL

AVOIDANCE

THE LIE *Dealing with this problem now is too hard or painful — ignoring it will make it go away on its own.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **James 4:17** “So whoever knows the right thing to do and fails to do it, for him it is sin.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Knowing what is right and choosing not to act is sin; God calls me to confront problems courageously rather than avoid them.

COMPULSIVE BEHAVIORS

THE LIE *Just one more time won't hurt — God understands my weakness and this brings real relief.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Romans 6:12-13** “Let not sin therefore reign in your mortal body, to make you obey its passions... but present yourselves to God as those who have been brought from death to life.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Sin no longer has the right to rule over me; I am called to present myself to God as alive in Christ and refuse to obey destructive urges.

DENIAL

THE LIE *This isn't really a problem or sin — things aren't as bad as they seem, and I'm fine.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **1 John 1:8** “If we say we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Claiming I have no sin is self-deception; walking in truth begins with honest confession before God.

DISOBEDIENCE

THE LIE *God's command doesn't apply to my situation — my way is better or more practical right now.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **1 Samuel 15:22** “Behold, to obey is better than sacrifice, and to listen than the fat of rams.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Obedience to God is far better than any religious effort or personal reasoning; listening to Him is always the wisest path.

GLUTTONY

THE LIE *I need this excess to feel satisfied or comforted — moderation robs me of enjoyment.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Philippians 3:19** “...Their end is destruction, their god is their belly, and they glory in their shame...”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Making my appetites my god leads to destruction; true satisfaction comes from Christ, not excess.

HOARDING

THE LIE *I might lack later, so I must hold onto everything — God's provision isn't reliable.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Matthew 6:19-21** “Do not lay up for yourselves treasures on earth... but lay up for yourselves treasures in heaven...”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Earthly hoarding is temporary and insecure; God calls me to store up eternal treasures by trusting His faithful provision.

IMPULSIVITY

THE LIE *Acting on this urge feels right in the moment — thinking it through would ruin the opportunity.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Proverbs 14:29** “Whoever is slow to anger has great understanding, but he who has a hasty temper exalts folly.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Hasty, impulsive actions often lead to folly; wisdom comes from patience and thoughtful self-control.

INCONSISTENCY / UNRELIABILITY

THE LIE *It's okay to break commitments when it suits me — people should understand.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Matthew 5:37** “Let what you say be simply 'Yes' or 'No'; anything more than this comes from evil.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH My word should be trustworthy and simple; unreliability dishonors God and damages relationships.



LAZINESS / LACK OF DISCIPLINE

THE LIE *Rest or shortcuts are justified — hard work or structure isn't necessary right now.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Proverbs 6:6** “Go to the ant, O sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God calls me to learn diligence and wisdom from even the smallest creatures rather than justify laziness.

LYING / DISHONESTY

THE LIE *A small lie prevents bigger problems — God understands when honesty would hurt someone.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Proverbs 12:22** “Lying lips are an abomination to the Lord, but those who act faithfully are his delight.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Deception is detestable to God regardless of my justification; He delights in those who act faithfully and truthfully.

MINIMIZING

THE LIE *It's not that big a deal — others overreact, and God isn't bothered by small things.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Luke 16:10** “One who is faithful in a very little is also faithful in much...”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Faithfulness in small matters matters greatly to God; minimizing sin or responsibility is dangerous.

OBSESSION

THE LIE *Fixating on this is necessary for control or success — letting go would be irresponsible.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Matthew 6:33** “But seek first the kingdom of God and his righteousness, and all these things will be added to you.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH When I seek God's kingdom first, He promises to provide what I need; obsession with secondary things shows misplaced priorities.

OVER-AMBITION

THE LIE *Climbing higher and faster is God's will for me — rest or contentment is settling.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Proverbs 16:9** “The heart of man plans his way, but the Lord establishes his steps.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH I can make plans, but God ultimately directs my steps; over-ambition ignores His sovereign control.

OVERSCHEDULING

THE LIE *Busyness proves my value and importance — slowing down means I'm unproductive.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Psalms 127:2** “It is in vain that you rise up early and go late to rest, eating the bread of anxious toil; for he gives to his beloved sleep.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Excessive busyness and anxious striving are vain; God gives rest to those He loves.

OVERWORKING / WORKAHOLISM

THE LIE *My worth comes from what I accomplish — rest is laziness or lack of faith.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Matthew 11:28-30** “Come to me, all who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Jesus invites the weary and burdened to find true rest in Him; my worth is not earned through constant work.

PASSIVITY

THE LIE *Waiting for others or circumstances to change is safer — taking initiative risks failure.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **James 1:22** “But be doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving yourselves.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH I must be a doer of God's Word, not just a passive hearer; obedience requires active response.

PERFECTIONISM

THE LIE *I must be flawless to be acceptable — anything less disappoints God and others.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **2 Corinthians 12:9** “But he said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you, for my power is made perfect in weakness.’”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God's grace is sufficient, and His power is made perfect in my weakness; I do not need to be flawless.



PROCRASTINATION

THE LIE *There's still plenty of time — I'll do it later when I feel more ready or motivated.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Ecclesiastes 11:4** "He who observes the wind will not sow, and he who regards the clouds will not reap."

BIBLICAL TRUTH Waiting for perfect conditions prevents action; faithfulness requires doing what God calls me to do now.

RUMINATION

THE LIE *Replaying the hurt or mistake keeps me from being fooled again — letting it go is dangerous.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Philippians 3:13-14** "Brothers, I do not consider that I have made it my own. But one thing I do: forgetting what lies behind and straining forward to what lies ahead..."

BIBLICAL TRUTH God calls me to forget what lies behind and press forward toward Christ; rumination keeps me stuck in the past.

SELF-NEGLECT

THE LIE *Taking care of myself is selfish — pouring everything out for others (or work) is more spiritual.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Mark 12:31** "You shall love your neighbor as yourself."

BIBLICAL TRUTH Loving my neighbor as myself includes caring for my own well-being; neglecting myself is not true spirituality.

STINGINESS

THE LIE *Sharing my resources freely would leave me lacking — God expects me to be prudent with what's mine.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **2 Corinthians 9:6-7** "The point is this: whoever sows sparingly will also reap sparingly, and whoever sows bountifully will also reap bountifully."

BIBLICAL TRUTH Generous sowing leads to generous reaping; God loves a cheerful giver who trusts His provision.

WASTEFULNESS

THE LIE *Squandering time or resources is my right — stewardship is overly restrictive.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Luke 16:10-11** "One who is faithful in a very little is also faithful in much, and one who is dishonest in a very little is also dishonest in much."

BIBLICAL TRUTH Faithfulness in small things (including time and resources) matters to God; wastefulness shows unfaithfulness as a steward.



SPIRITUAL / ATTITUDINAL

ARROGANCE

THE LIE *I'm better and more capable than everyone else — my success proves I don't need others or God.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Proverbs 16:18** "Pride goes before destruction, and a haughty spirit before a fall. (Also James 4:6 — 'God opposes the proud but gives grace to the humble.')

BIBLICAL TRUTH Pride leads to downfall, but God actively opposes the arrogant and generously gives grace to those who walk in humility and dependence on Him.

AVARICE (GREED)

THE LIE *More money and possessions will finally make me secure and happy — God wants me to have it all.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Luke 12:15** "Take care, and be on your guard against all covetousness, for one's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions."

BIBLICAL TRUTH True life and security are not found in accumulating possessions; greed distracts me from the eternal riches that come from a relationship with God.

COVETOUSNESS

THE LIE *If I had what they have, my life would be complete — God is withholding something good from me.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Exodus 20:17** "You shall not covet your neighbor's house... or anything that is your neighbor's."

BIBLICAL TRUTH Coveting what belongs to others violates God's command and reveals a lack of contentment with what He has provided for me.

CYNICISM

THE LIE *People and life always disappoint — trusting God or others is naive and foolish.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Psalms 118:8** "It is better to take refuge in the Lord than to trust in man."

BIBLICAL TRUTH It is wiser and safer to put my trust in the Lord rather than in people, who will inevitably disappoint.

DISTRUST / LACK OF TRUST

THE LIE *People (and even God) will always let me down — I must protect myself first.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Proverbs 3:5-6** "Trust in the Lord with all your heart, and do not lean on your own understanding. In all your ways acknowledge him, and he will make straight your paths."

BIBLICAL TRUTH Wholehearted trust in the Lord, rather than self-protection or suspicion, allows God to direct my paths.

EGOTISM

THE LIE *The world revolves around my needs and opinions — my importance is obvious to everyone.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Romans 12:3** "For by the grace given to me I say to everyone among you not to think of himself more highly than he ought to think..."

BIBLICAL TRUTH I must not think more highly of myself than I ought; sober judgment of my importance comes through God's grace.

ENTITLEMENT

THE LIE *I deserve special treatment, blessings, or success because of who I am or what I've done.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **James 4:6** "God opposes the proud but gives grace to the humble."

BIBLICAL TRUTH God actively opposes pride and entitlement but pours out grace on the humble who do not demand what they think they deserve.

FALSE PRIDE

THE LIE *I've earned everything through my own strength — God's role is secondary to my effort.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **1 Corinthians 4:7** "What do you have that you did not receive? If then you received it, why do you boast as if you did not receive it?"

BIBLICAL TRUTH Everything I have is a gift from God; boasting in my own strength ignores His generosity and grace.



GRANDIOSITY

THE LIE *I am exceptionally gifted or important — ordinary rules and humility don't apply to me.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Romans 12:3** “For by the grace given to me I say to everyone among you not to think of himself more highly than he ought to think...”

BIBLICAL TRUTH I must view myself with sober judgment according to God's grace, not inflated self-importance.

IMPENITENCE

THE LIE *I don't need to repent or change — my way is good enough and God isn't that strict.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Acts 3:19** “Repent therefore, and turn back, that your sins may be blotted out.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Repentance brings refreshing and the blotting out of sins; God calls me to turn from my ways to receive His mercy.

INDIFFERENCE

THE LIE *Their suffering or moral issues aren't my concern — God doesn't expect me to get involved.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **James 4:17** “So whoever knows the right thing to do and fails to do it, for him it is sin.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Failing to act when I know the right thing to do is sin; God calls me to care and get involved.

INGRATITUDE

THE LIE *What I have isn't enough or isn't as good as others' — God owes me more.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **1 Thessalonians 5:18** “Give thanks in all circumstances; for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus for you.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God's will for me includes giving thanks in every circumstance, recognizing His goodness even when I feel lacking.

LACK OF HUMILITY

THE LIE *Admitting weakness or need for help diminishes me — self-reliance is strength.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Micah 6:8** “He has told you, O man, what is good; and what does the Lord require of you but to do justice, and to love kindness, and to walk humbly with your God?”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God requires me to walk humbly with Him; true strength is found in humility, justice, and kindness.

LEGALISM

THE LIE *Following every rule perfectly earns God's favor — grace and heart attitude matter less.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Galatians 2:21** “I do not nullify the grace of God, for if righteousness were through the law, then Christ died for no purpose.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Righteousness does not come through perfect rule-keeping; Christ's death shows that grace is essential.

LOW SELF-WORTH / WORTHLESSNESS

THE LIE *I am fundamentally broken and unlovable — God couldn't truly value me.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Ephesians 2:10** “For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works...”

BIBLICAL TRUTH I am God's workmanship, created in Christ for good works; I am valuable and purposeful to Him.

LUST

THE LIE *This desire is harmless or natural — God made me this way and understands my needs.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Matthew 5:28** “But I say to you that everyone who looks at a woman with lustful intent has already committed adultery with her in his heart.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Lust in the heart is already sin; God calls me to purity of thought and heart.

PHONINESS

THE LIE *Pretending to be better or different helps me fit in or succeed — authenticity is risky.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Colossians 3:9-10** “Do not lie to one another, seeing that you have put off the old self with its practices and have put on the new self...”

BIBLICAL TRUTH I am called to put off the old self and its deceit, living authentically in the new life Christ has given me.



PRIDE

THE LIE *I don't really need God or others — I've earned my position through my own merit.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Proverbs 16:18** "Pride goes before destruction, and a haughty spirit before a fall."

BIBLICAL TRUTH Pride precedes destruction; true security and success come from humility and dependence on God.

PRUDERY

THE LIE *My strict standards of modesty or behavior make me holier — others' freedom is sinful.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Colossians 2:20-23** "These have indeed an appearance of wisdom in promoting self-made religion and asceticism and severity to the body, but they are of no value in stopping the indulgence of the flesh."

BIBLICAL TRUTH Self-made religious rules and harsh judgment may look spiritual but have no power to truly restrain sin; God values heart transformation over outward severity.

RIGIDITY / STUBBORNNESS

THE LIE *Changing my mind or ways would mean I was wrong — sticking to my position is strength.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Proverbs 29:1** "He who is often reproved, yet stiffens his neck, will suddenly be broken beyond healing."

BIBLICAL TRUTH Stubborn refusal to accept correction leads to sudden and irreparable harm; humility allows growth.

SELF-CENTEREDNESS

THE LIE *My needs and perspective come first — the world and God should revolve around me.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Philippians 2:3-4** "Do nothing from selfish ambition or conceit, but in humility count others more significant than yourselves."

BIBLICAL TRUTH Humility means counting others as more significant than myself and looking to their interests, not just my own.

SELF-CONDEMNATION

THE LIE *I must constantly beat myself up for my failures — God expects this level of self-punishment.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Romans 8:1** "There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."

BIBLICAL TRUTH There is no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus; God's forgiveness frees me from self-punishment.

SELF-IMPORTANCE

THE LIE *I am special and my opinions deserve priority — others should recognize my significance.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Romans 12:3** "For by the grace given to me I say to everyone among you not to think of himself more highly than he ought to think..."

BIBLICAL TRUTH I must not think of myself more highly than I ought; sober self-assessment comes through God's grace.

SELF-JUSTIFICATION

THE LIE *My reasons make this behavior acceptable — God understands my unique circumstances.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Proverbs 16:2** "All the ways of a man are pure in his own eyes, but the Lord weighs the spirit."

BIBLICAL TRUTH My own justifications may seem right to me, but the Lord examines my true motives and heart.

SELFLESSNESS (PERFORMATIVE SELF-DENIAL)

THE LIE *Sacrificing myself excessively proves my godliness — setting boundaries is selfish.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **Galatians 5:13** "For you were called to freedom, brothers. Only do not use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh, but through love serve one another."

BIBLICAL TRUTH Christ has set me free to serve others in love, not to engage in unhealthy, performative self-denial that harms me or others.



SENTIMENTALITY

THE LIE *Nostalgic or superficial emotions are enough — facing real issues or truth would ruin the feeling.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **John 8:32** “And you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Truth sets me free; superficial sentimentality cannot replace the liberating power of facing reality in God's light.

SPIRITUAL BYPASS

THE LIE *Using spiritual phrases or activities means I don't need to face my real pain or sin.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **James 1:22** “But be doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving yourselves.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH Merely hearing or using spiritual language without obedient action is self-deception; God wants real heart change.

VANITY

THE LIE *My appearance, image, or reputation is what truly matters — inner character is secondary.*

COUNTERING SCRIPTURE **1 Samuel 16:7** “For the Lord sees not as man sees: man looks on the outward appearance, but the Lord looks on the heart.”

BIBLICAL TRUTH God looks at the heart, not outward appearance; true value lies in inner character, not vanity or reputation.

Section 4 — My Top 10: Lies, Scripture & Biblical Truths

For each struggle you circled, look it up in the Lie/Truth Supplement (previous pages). Then fill your top 10 below. Choose the ten that are most significant for you right now.

Speak these truths aloud daily for 63+ days.

1	
My Struggle / Shortcoming / Sabotaging Behavior	
Lie I have told myself	
Related Bible Verse (write it out)	
Biblical Truth to tell myself daily for the next 63+ days	

2	
My Struggle / Shortcoming / Sabotaging Behavior	
Lie I have told myself	
Related Bible Verse (write it out)	
Biblical Truth to tell myself daily for the next 63+ days	

3

My Struggle /
Shortcoming /
Sabotaging
Behavior

Lie I have told
myself

Related Bible
Verse (write it out)

Biblical Truth to
tell myself daily for
the next 63+ days

4

My Struggle /
Shortcoming /
Sabotaging
Behavior

Lie I have told
myself

Related Bible
Verse (write it out)

Biblical Truth to
tell myself daily for
the next 63+ days

5

My Struggle /
Shortcoming /
Sabotaging
Behavior

Lie I have told
myself

Related Bible
Verse (write it out)

Biblical Truth to
tell myself daily for
the next 63+ days

6

My Struggle /
Shortcoming /
Sabotaging
Behavior

Lie I have told
myself

Related Bible
Verse (write it out)

Biblical Truth to
tell myself daily for
the next 63+ days

7

My Struggle /
Shortcoming /
Sabotaging
Behavior

Lie I have told
myself

Related Bible
Verse (write it out)

Biblical Truth to
tell myself daily for
the next 63+ days

8

My Struggle /
Shortcoming /
Sabotaging
Behavior

Lie I have told
myself

Related Bible
Verse (write it out)

Biblical Truth to
tell myself daily for
the next 63+ days

9

My Struggle / Shortcoming / Sabotaging Behavior	
Lie I have told myself	
Related Bible Verse (write it out)	
Biblical Truth to tell myself daily for the next 63+ days	

10

My Struggle / Shortcoming / Sabotaging Behavior	
Lie I have told myself	
Related Bible Verse (write it out)	
Biblical Truth to tell myself daily for the next 63+ days	



Section 5 — The Fruits of the Spirit

"But what happens when we live God's way? He brings gifts into our lives — things like affection for others, exuberance about life, serenity. We develop a willingness to stick with things, a sense of compassion in the heart, and a conviction that a basic holiness permeates things and people. We find ourselves involved in loyal commitments, not needing to force our way in life, able to marshal and direct our energies wisely."

Galatians 5:22-23 — The Message

Which of these qualities are you adding to your life currently? (Also write your response on the prayer request page.)

Love: _____

Joy: _____

Peace: _____

Patience: _____

Kindness: _____

Goodness: _____

Faithfulness: _____

Gentleness: _____

Self-control: _____

Which ones do you need to work on?

Section 6 — Pre-Moral Inventory Preparation

Answer these questions before beginning your inventory sheets.

1. How can you find a quiet time and place to begin your inventory? What date and time will you set aside? (Also write your response on the prayer request page.)

2. What are your fears as you begin your inventory? Why? (Also write on the prayer request page.)

3. If you have turned your life over to God, describe that experience. How can you turn your will to His care daily? (Also write on the prayer request page.)

4. What would help you remember all the struggles you need to list in your inventory?

5. List the things you have used to block the pain of your past.

6. Do you use technology or social media to vent frustrations or avoid people?

7. What have you done to step out of your denial so far? How can you continue to find new ways out of your denial?

8. Why is it important to do a written inventory? What are some good things — and negative things — you have done in the past?

9. Do you have a sponsor or accountability partner to help keep your inventory balanced?



Section 7 — Deep Dive: From Struggles to a Spirit-Led Plan

From your list of 10 struggles, choose the TWO that are most significantly impacting your life and recovery right now. Complete one Planning Form for each.

PHASE A — Review your 10 struggles. Circle the two causing you the most pain right now.

PHASE B — Ask your A.I. to recommend 3–5 Christian authors who have written about that struggle.

PHASE C — For each book, ask A.I. for the top 10 things you would learn from it. Write your most meaningful insights.

PHASE D — Use A.I. to help build a practical, faith-based action plan. Adapt it in your own words.

PHASE E — Share BOTH plans in detail with your sponsor and accountability partners in Step 5.

Suggested A.I. Prompts

PHASE B — Finding Authors: "I am a Christian in recovery and I struggle with [your struggle]. Can you recommend 3–5 Christian authors who have written books about this? Include the book title and a brief description."

PHASE C — Exploring a Book: "Based on [book title] by [author], what are the top 10 practical things someone struggling with [your struggle] would learn from reading it?"

PHASE D — Building Your Plan: "Based on what I learned from these Christian authors about [your struggle], help me build a practical, faith-based action plan with spiritual practices, action steps, and accountability measures."

"Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed." — James 5:16

DEEP DIVE PLANNING FORM — STRUGGLE #1 OF 2

Name: _____ Date: _____

SECTION A | My Focus Struggle

Write the specific struggle you are working on:

In 2–3 sentences, describe how this struggle is affecting your life and recovery right now:

SECTION B | Christian Authors & Books

Use A.I. to find 3–5 Christian authors who have written about this struggle. Record below:

#	Author Name	Book Title	Why This Book Speaks to You
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

SECTION C | My Top 10 Insights & Learnings

After asking A.I. to summarize these books, record your 10 most meaningful takeaways:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.
- 6.

- 7.
 - 8.
 - 9.
 - 10.
-

SECTION D | Scripture Anchor

Ask A.I.: "What are 3 Bible verses that speak directly to the struggle of [your struggle]?"

My anchor verse:

- 1.
 - 2.
 - 3.
-

What these verse personally mean to me:

- 1.
 - 2.
 - 3.
-

SECTION E | My Faith-Based Next-Step Plan

Spiritual Practices (prayer, Scripture, worship, fasting, journaling, etc.)

- 1.
 - 2.
 - 3.
-

Practical Action Steps (concrete actions in the next 30 days)

- 1.
 - 2.
 - 3.
-

Accountability & Support

Who will hold me accountable? How and when will we check in?

My Commitment Prayer (in your own words)

SECTION F | Preparing to Share in to a Group

Most surprising discovery:

What feels most challenging to share aloud:

What I most need from my group:

DEEP DIVE PLANNING FORM — STRUGGLE #2 OF 2

Name: _____ Date: _____

SECTION A | My Focus Struggle

Write the specific struggle you are working on:

In 2–3 sentences, describe how this struggle is affecting your life and recovery right now:

SECTION B | Christian Authors & Books

Use A.I. to find 3–5 Christian authors who have written about this struggle. Record below:

#	Author Name	Book Title	Why This Book Speaks to You
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

SECTION C | My Top 10 Insights & Learnings

After asking A.I. to summarize these books, record your 10 most meaningful takeaways:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.
- 6.

- 7.
 - 8.
 - 9.
 - 10.
-

SECTION D | Scripture Anchor

Ask A.I.: "What are 3 Bible verses that speak directly to the struggle of [your struggle]?"

My anchor verse:

- 1.
 - 2.
 - 3.
-

What these verse personally mean to me:

- 1.
 - 2.
 - 3.
-

SECTION E | My Faith-Based Next-Step Plan

Spiritual Practices (prayer, Scripture, worship, fasting, journaling, etc.)

- 1.
 - 2.
 - 3.
-

Practical Action Steps (concrete actions in the next 30 days)

- 1.
 - 2.
 - 3.
-

Accountability & Support

Who will hold me accountable? How and when will we check in?

My Commitment Prayer (in your own words)

SECTION F | Preparing to Share in to a Group

Most surprising discovery:

What feels most challenging to share aloud:

What I most need from my group:



Section 8 — Resentment & Fear: People Inventory Prompt List

Circle any that you need to add to your inventory:

PEOPLE	INSTITUTIONS & SYSTEMS	PRINCIPLES & IDEAS
• father • mother • grandparents • sister • brother • aunt • uncle • cousin • in-laws • husband • wife • birth / adoptive / foster family • police • lawyers • judges • probation officers • doctors • pastors • employers / employees • coworkers • teachers / school leaders • church leaders • childhood friends • school friends • online / lifelong friends • acquaintances • girlfriends / boyfriends • recovery friends • President(s) • creditors • God • Jesus Christ • Satan	• the Bible • church(es) • religion • government / Congress • law / authority • Food & Drug Administration • big pharma / medical associations • mental health system • correctional system • education system • technology / social media • video game / gambling industry • big food • marriage principles • philosophy / races / nationalities	• Ten Commandments • The Golden Rule • heaven / hell • death / life after death • retribution / entitlement • religious programming • seven deadly sins • the original sin / sin • leadership

Section 9 — Who Has Harmed Me?

List at least 18 people below. Also review each question marked  at the beginning of this step to check if anyone should be added.

1. _____	2. _____	3. _____
4. _____	5. _____	6. _____
7. _____	8. _____	9. _____
10. _____	11. _____	12. _____
13. _____	14. _____	15. _____
16. _____	17. _____	18. _____

Against whom have you held a grudge?

Against whom are you still angry?

Are you jealous of someone?

GO BACK TO SECTION 1 AND LOOK AT EACH QUESTION MARKED  . IS THERE ANYONE TO ADD TO YOUR INVENTORY? People named in those answers belong on your inventory sheets.



Section 10 — Myths About Forgiveness

Initial next to each myth after reading and understanding it fully before beginning your inventory sheets.

Myth #1 To forgive means to forget about what happened.

I may still remember the incident, but the memory will no longer carry the emotional charge that it once had.

Initials: _____

Myth #2 Forgiveness can only be accomplished by a spiritual or religious person.

Forgiveness can be accomplished by anyone with willingness and an ability to see its value for themselves.

Initials: _____

Myth #3 I must feel like forgiving before I can forgive.

Forgiveness is a choice available at any time. The choice to forgive does not deny our feelings — it first requires we acknowledge them.

Initials: _____

Myth #4 I can only forgive if the other person asks for it or forgives first.

If I wait for the other person to take the first step, I will wait for the rest of my life.

Initials: _____

Myth #5 Forgiveness means pretending nothing happened.

The opposite is true. Forgiveness means facing the upsetting situation and fully acknowledging the emotions that arose from it.

Initials: _____

Myth #6 Forgiveness lasts forever.

When I am triggered or overthink, I may need to forgive again — maybe 70 x 7 times — for the same incident.

Initials: _____

Myth #7 I must have a guarantee I won't be hurt again.

There are no guarantees. Forgiveness is unconditional and an expression of letting go of the past.

Initials: _____

Myth #8 I am supposed to forgive because my religion says I should.

If I should forgive, I probably won't. If I could forgive, I might. If I choose to forgive, I will.

Initials: _____

Myth #9 Forgiveness is for the other person's benefit.

Forgiveness is primarily for me. I am the one who is released to live my life again.

Initials: _____

Myth #10 To forgive means I am approving of someone's negative behavior.

Forgiveness does not say, "Go ahead and hurt me again." It acknowledges the hurtful situation while releasing the debt.

Initials: _____



Section 11 — Completing Your Inventory

This is it! You are ready.

You will need:

- An inventory worksheet for each name or institution that has harmed you (use the 10 sets provided; make additional copies as needed).
- Write each person's name at the top of a worksheet. Each set includes a Forgiveness Letter template (Part C).
- You may fill in all letters after completing all inventory fronts, or write them one at a time — either is fine.
- Your Fruits of the Spirit sheet (Section 5) and your Self-Rating Chart with Assets (Section 2).

IMPORTANT: Read all answers on the front of each worksheet aloud to your sponsor BEFORE writing your Forgiveness Letter. The letters are for your sponsor's ears only — they are not to be delivered to the person named.

Resilients in Recovery® — STEP 4 PERSONAL INVENTORY WORKSHEET 1 OF 10

Make additional copies as needed. Complete Parts A–C per person. Read aloud to sponsor before writing the Forgiveness Letter (Part D).

PART A

1. THE PERSON — Who are you writing about? (name, title, or relationship)

2. THE CAUSE — What did they do that hurt you, made you angry, or that you still can't let go of?

3. HOW THIS AFFECTS ME — Check areas affected and briefly describe:

☐ PRIDE (humiliated, put down)

☐ SELF-ESTEEM (worthless, unlovable)

☐ PERSONAL RELATIONS (damaged/destroyed relationships)

☐ SEXUAL RELATIONS (shame, mistrust, unhealthy patterns)

☐ AMBITIONS (gave up on goals or dreams)

☐ SECURITY (unsafe, unstable, constantly worried)

☐ FINANCES (loss, debt, poor money decisions)

4. THE DAMAGE — Real-world impact on relationships, health, job, reputation, finances:

PART B — MY PART (answer only about YOUR actions)

◆ Where did I make a mistake? (What did I do or fail to do that made this worse?)

◆ Where was I selfish? (Was I putting my wants above what was right or fair?)

◆ Where was I dishonest? (Did I lie, hide the truth, or deceive myself or others?)

◆ Where was I afraid? (Did fear drive my behavior — fear of rejection, abandonment, losing control?)

◆ Where was I to blame / at fault / wrong?

PART C — FORGIVENESS LETTER (read aloud to sponsor only — not delivered)

Dear _____

Date _____

This note is regarding the situation/time where/when:

I have been holding feelings of: _____
since:

Holding on to these feelings has cost me: _____

What these feelings have done to me: _____

My payoff in keeping these feelings has been: _____

The difference if I could let go: _____

My fears in letting go:

I am able and willing to let go of these feelings and replace them with:
feelings of _____ (Fruits of the Spirit)

I want to tell myself:

The behaviors I want to show: _____

The words I want to say:

I choose to forgive you for (be specific — not just 'everything'): _____

Signed: _____

Resilients in Recovery® — STEP 4 PERSONAL INVENTORY WORKSHEET 2 OF 10

Make additional copies as needed. Complete Parts A–C per person. Read aloud to sponsor before writing the Forgiveness Letter (Part D).

PART A

1. THE PERSON — Who are you writing about? (name, title, or relationship)

2. THE CAUSE — What did they do that hurt you, made you angry, or that you still can't let go of?

3. HOW THIS AFFECTS ME — Check areas affected and briefly describe:

☐ PRIDE (humiliated, put down)

☐ SELF-ESTEEM (worthless, unlovable)

☐ PERSONAL RELATIONS (damaged/destroyed relationships)

☐ SEXUAL RELATIONS (shame, mistrust, unhealthy patterns)

☐ AMBITIONS (gave up on goals or dreams)

☐ SECURITY (unsafe, unstable, constantly worried)

☐ FINANCES (loss, debt, poor money decisions)

4. THE DAMAGE — Real-world impact on relationships, health, job, reputation, finances:

PART B — MY PART (answer only about YOUR actions)

◆ Where did I make a mistake? (What did I do or fail to do that made this worse?)

◆ Where was I selfish? (Was I putting my wants above what was right or fair?)

◆ Where was I dishonest? (Did I lie, hide the truth, or deceive myself or others?)

◆ Where was I afraid? (Did fear drive my behavior — fear of rejection, abandonment, losing control?)

◆ Where was I to blame / at fault / wrong?

PART C — FORGIVENESS LETTER (read aloud to sponsor only — not delivered)

Dear _____

Date _____

This note is regarding the situation/time where/when:

I have been holding feelings of: _____
since:

Holding on to these feelings has cost me: _____

What these feelings have done to me: _____

My payoff in keeping these feelings has been: _____

The difference if I could let go: _____

My fears in letting go:

I am able and willing to let go of these feelings and replace them with:
feelings of _____ (Fruits of the Spirit)

I want to tell myself:

The behaviors I want to show: _____

The words I want to say:

I choose to forgive you for (be specific — not just 'everything'): _____

Signed: _____

Resilients in Recovery® — STEP 4 PERSONAL INVENTORY WORKSHEET 3 OF 10

Make additional copies as needed. Complete Parts A–C per person. Read aloud to sponsor before writing the Forgiveness Letter (Part D).

PART A

1. THE PERSON — Who are you writing about? (name, title, or relationship)

2. THE CAUSE — What did they do that hurt you, made you angry, or that you still can't let go of?

3. HOW THIS AFFECTS ME — Check areas affected and briefly describe:

☐ PRIDE (humiliated, put down)

☐ SELF-ESTEEM (worthless, unlovable)

☐ PERSONAL RELATIONS (damaged/destroyed relationships)

☐ SEXUAL RELATIONS (shame, mistrust, unhealthy patterns)

☐ AMBITIONS (gave up on goals or dreams)

☐ SECURITY (unsafe, unstable, constantly worried)

☐ FINANCES (loss, debt, poor money decisions)

4. THE DAMAGE — Real-world impact on relationships, health, job, reputation, finances:

PART B — MY PART (answer only about YOUR actions)

◆ Where did I make a mistake? (What did I do or fail to do that made this worse?)

◆ Where was I selfish? (Was I putting my wants above what was right or fair?)

◆ Where was I dishonest? (Did I lie, hide the truth, or deceive myself or others?)

◆ Where was I afraid? (Did fear drive my behavior — fear of rejection, abandonment, losing control?)

◆ Where was I to blame / at fault / wrong?

PART C — FORGIVENESS LETTER (read aloud to sponsor only — not delivered)

Dear _____

Date _____

This note is regarding the situation/time where/when:

I have been holding feelings of: _____
since:

Holding on to these feelings has cost me: _____

What these feelings have done to me: _____

My payoff in keeping these feelings has been: _____

The difference if I could let go: _____

My fears in letting go:

I am able and willing to let go of these feelings and replace them with:
feelings of _____ (Fruits of the Spirit)

I want to tell myself:

The behaviors I want to show: _____

The words I want to say:

I choose to forgive you for (be specific — not just 'everything'): _____

Signed: _____

Resilients in Recovery® — STEP 4 PERSONAL INVENTORY WORKSHEET 4 OF 10

Make additional copies as needed. Complete Parts A–C per person. Read aloud to sponsor before writing the Forgiveness Letter (Part D).

PART A

1. THE PERSON — Who are you writing about? (name, title, or relationship)

2. THE CAUSE — What did they do that hurt you, made you angry, or that you still can't let go of?

3. HOW THIS AFFECTS ME — Check areas affected and briefly describe:

☐ PRIDE (humiliated, put down)

☐ SELF-ESTEEM (worthless, unlovable)

☐ PERSONAL RELATIONS (damaged/destroyed relationships)

☐ SEXUAL RELATIONS (shame, mistrust, unhealthy patterns)

☐ AMBITIONS (gave up on goals or dreams)

☐ SECURITY (unsafe, unstable, constantly worried)

☐ FINANCES (loss, debt, poor money decisions)

4. THE DAMAGE — Real-world impact on relationships, health, job, reputation, finances:

PART B — MY PART (answer only about YOUR actions)

◆ Where did I make a mistake? (What did I do or fail to do that made this worse?)

◆ Where was I selfish? (Was I putting my wants above what was right or fair?)

◆ Where was I dishonest? (Did I lie, hide the truth, or deceive myself or others?)

◆ Where was I afraid? (Did fear drive my behavior — fear of rejection, abandonment, losing control?)

◆ Where was I to blame / at fault / wrong?

PART C — FORGIVENESS LETTER (read aloud to sponsor only — not delivered)

Dear _____

Date _____

This note is regarding the situation/time where/when:

I have been holding feelings of: _____
since:

Holding on to these feelings has cost me: _____

What these feelings have done to me: _____

My payoff in keeping these feelings has been: _____

The difference if I could let go: _____

My fears in letting go:

I am able and willing to let go of these feelings and replace them with:
feelings of _____ (Fruits of the Spirit)

I want to tell myself:

The behaviors I want to show: _____

The words I want to say:

I choose to forgive you for (be specific — not just 'everything'): _____

Signed: _____

Resilients in Recovery® — STEP 4 PERSONAL INVENTORY WORKSHEET 5 OF 10

Make additional copies as needed. Complete Parts A–C per person. Read aloud to sponsor before writing the Forgiveness Letter (Part D).

PART A

1. THE PERSON — Who are you writing about? (name, title, or relationship)

2. THE CAUSE — What did they do that hurt you, made you angry, or that you still can't let go of?

3. HOW THIS AFFECTS ME — Check areas affected and briefly describe:

☐ PRIDE (humiliated, put down)

☐ SELF-ESTEEM (worthless, unlovable)

☐ PERSONAL RELATIONS (damaged/destroyed relationships)

☐ SEXUAL RELATIONS (shame, mistrust, unhealthy patterns)

☐ AMBITIONS (gave up on goals or dreams)

☐ SECURITY (unsafe, unstable, constantly worried)

☐ FINANCES (loss, debt, poor money decisions)

4. THE DAMAGE — Real-world impact on relationships, health, job, reputation, finances:

PART B — MY PART (answer only about YOUR actions)

◆ Where did I make a mistake? (What did I do or fail to do that made this worse?)

◆ Where was I selfish? (Was I putting my wants above what was right or fair?)

◆ Where was I dishonest? (Did I lie, hide the truth, or deceive myself or others?)

◆ Where was I afraid? (Did fear drive my behavior — fear of rejection, abandonment, losing control?)

◆ Where was I to blame / at fault / wrong?

PART C — FORGIVENESS LETTER (read aloud to sponsor only — not delivered)

Dear _____

Date _____

This note is regarding the situation/time where/when:

I have been holding feelings of: _____
since:

Holding on to these feelings has cost me: _____

What these feelings have done to me: _____

My payoff in keeping these feelings has been: _____

The difference if I could let go: _____

My fears in letting go:

I am able and willing to let go of these feelings and replace them with:
feelings of _____ (Fruits of the Spirit)

I want to tell myself:

The behaviors I want to show: _____

The words I want to say:

I choose to forgive you for (be specific — not just 'everything'): _____

Signed: _____

Resilients in Recovery® — STEP 4 PERSONAL INVENTORY WORKSHEET 6 OF 10

Make additional copies as needed. Complete Parts A–C per person. Read aloud to sponsor before writing the Forgiveness Letter (Part D).

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Resilients in Recovery® — STEP 4 PERSONAL INVENTORY WORKSHEET 7 OF 10

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Resilients in Recovery® — STEP 4 PERSONAL INVENTORY WORKSHEET 8 OF 10

Make additional copies as needed. Complete Parts A–C per person. Read aloud to sponsor before writing the Forgiveness Letter (Part D).

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Resilients in Recovery® — STEP 4 PERSONAL INVENTORY WORKSHEET 9 OF 10

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I want to tell myself:

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Signed: _____

Resilients in Recovery® — STEP 4 PERSONAL INVENTORY WORKSHEET 10 OF 10

Make additional copies as needed. Complete Parts A–C per person. Read aloud to sponsor before writing the Forgiveness Letter (Part D).

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I want to tell myself:

The behaviors I want to show: _____

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I choose to forgive you for (be specific — not just 'everything'): _____

Signed: _____

Step 4 Action List

(To be used during each weekly meeting with your sponsor or step leader — tear out or copy for reference.)

Date: _____

#	Tasks To Get Done This Week	✓ Done
1.		
2.		
3.		
4.		
5.		
6.		
7.		
8.		
9.		
10.		



RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY Step Four — Comprehension Review

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group: _____

Answer each question in your own words. If you are unsure of an answer, go back and re-read the Step Four material before responding.

Section 1: The Purpose of Step Four

1. In your own words, what does Step Four ask you to do?

2. What is a "moral inventory" and why does Step Four require it to be both searching and fearless?

3. What is "spiritual bypass," and why does Step Four refuse to allow it?

Section 2: Key Terms

4. What is resentment, and how does the material describe its effect on the person holding it?

5. What does "My Part" mean in the inventory process, and why is it important?

6. How does the material define forgiveness? What is it — and what is it NOT?

Section 3: Character Defects & Assets

7. What are the Fruits of the Spirit, and what is their role in Step Four?

8. Name two character defects from the Step Four material and describe what each one looks like in real life.

9. After completing the character defect and asset rating exercise, what three things are you asked to identify about yourself?
-

Section 4: Lies & Biblical Truth

10. According to the Step Four material, what fuels every struggle or shortcoming we have? What is the solution?
-

11. Choose one lie listed in the material that you connected with. What is the Bible verse and the Biblical Truth given to counter it?
-

Section 5: Personal Reflection

12. What are the nine Essential Questions of Step Four? List at least five of them.
-

13. What is one area of your life that Step Four is asking you to look at honestly? Why is this important for your recovery?

If you could not answer a question without looking back at the material, that is your sign to re-read that section before moving on. This step is too important to rush.

Step 4 Comprehensive Essay Question Resilients in Recovery® — Step 4 Reflection Essay

Instructions: This essay is your opportunity to demonstrate the depth of your personal transformation through Step 4. Write in complete sentences and full paragraphs. Be honest, specific, and thorough — this step demanded your fearless engagement, and your essay should reflect that same courage. There is no minimum length, but there is a minimum of honesty. Your answer should show your sponsor, your step leader, and yourself that you did not merely *complete* Step 4 — you were *changed* by it.

Essay Prompt:

Step 4 calls us to make *a searching and fearless moral inventory of ourselves, offering forgiveness to those who have harmed us*. In a comprehensive essay, describe who you were when you began this step, who you are now that you have completed it, and what specific work brought about that transformation. Your essay should address all of the following dimensions:

Part One — Before the Mirror: Who You Were Coming In

Begin by describing the version of yourself who sat down to start Step 4. What fears did you bring with you into this work? What were you most afraid to find — or to admit? Looking back at your answer to the very first question of this step ("*As you prepare to do a moral inventory, how do you feel?*"), describe how that honest emotional starting point compared to where you are now. What were the lies you had been telling yourself that kept you from facing your full inventory, and how did those lies begin to lose their power as you worked through this step?

Part Two — The Inventory Itself: What You Found

Describe what your searching and fearless moral inventory revealed about you. Without minimizing or over-explaining, address the following: What were your most significant struggles, shortcomings, and self-sabotaging behaviors — and in which of the four categories (emotional, relational, behavioral, or spiritual/attitudinal) did you find the most concentrated patterns? What did your character defect and asset

rating chart reveal about the gap between who you have been and who you want to become? Describe what it felt like to see your own name in the column titled "*My Part*" — and what it meant for your recovery to take honest ownership there rather than continuing to shift blame.

Part Three — Resentment, Fear, and the Weight You Were Carrying

Describe your resentment and fear inventory. Who were the people, institutions, or principles you placed on your list — and what did that naming process do for you emotionally and spiritually? Explain how you understood the difference between resentment (*replaying a past harm that keeps you chained to the offender*) and the freedom that comes from beginning to release it. What did you discover about the role that fear has played as a hidden driver of your destructive decisions, patterns, and relationships?

Part Four — Forgiveness: The Hardest and Most Liberating Work

Describe your experience writing and reading your forgiveness letters. Which myths about forgiveness did you need to confront and dismantle in yourself before you could do this work authentically? For at least one person on your inventory, describe — without naming them if you prefer — what it cost you to hold onto those feelings, what your *payoff* had been in holding them, and what it meant to choose forgiveness not for their benefit but for your own freedom. How did incorporating the Fruits of the Spirit into your forgiveness letters connect the work of recovery to the work of spiritual transformation?

Part Five — The Lie, the Truth, and the Scripture

From your list of struggles and the corresponding Lie / Biblical Truth / Scripture chart you completed, describe how this framework changed your understanding of your own behavior. Choose at least two of your identified struggles and explain: What was the specific lie you had been believing? What does the biblical truth replace it with? And what does it mean — practically — to commit to telling yourself that truth for 63 or more days until it begins to rewire your thinking?

Part Six — Deep Dive and Fruit: Your Three Focus Struggles

Describe the three struggles you selected for your Deep Dive Planning Forms. Why did you choose those three above all others? What did you discover from the Christian authors and resources you researched — and what was the most surprising or convicting insight you encountered? Describe the faith-based action plan you built for at least one of those struggles, including the spiritual practices you committed to, the concrete 30-day action steps, and the accountability structure you put in place. How does your commitment prayer for that struggle represent a genuine shift in your relationship with God?

Part Seven — The New Toolkit: What You Are Carrying Forward

Your Step 4 tool chest includes the Written Moral Inventory, Resentment Processing, Fear Inventory, Forgiveness Work, and the Three-Core-List Framework (Struggles / Shortcomings / Self-Sabotaging Behaviors). For each of these tools, explain in your own words what it is, why it matters, and how you intend to use it going forward — not just in the remaining steps, but in the daily practice of your recovery. Which of these tools do you anticipate needing to return to most frequently, and why?

Part Eight — Summary: Who You Are Now

Return to the nine Essential Questions at the beginning of Step 4. Looking at them again through the lens of everything you have done in this step, write a closing summary — as thorough as the two-page "*Summary So*

Far" you completed — that captures what you have learned about yourself. Who are you now? What has genuinely changed? What Fruits of the Spirit do you see beginning to grow in you that were absent or stunted before? And what does it mean to you — personally, relationally, and spiritually — that you did not turn away from this mirror, but looked into it with honesty and courage?

"Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed." — James 5:16

This essay, along with your completed inventory sheets, Top 10 List, forgiveness letters, and Essential Question answers, represents the full completion of Step 4. Present it to your sponsor with the same fearlessness you brought to the work itself.

This question is designed to pull the full arc of Step 4 out of the participant — from the emotional starting point, through every major component of the step (the self-rating chart, the Lie/Truth/Scripture framework, the Deep Dive planning, the resentment and fear inventory, the forgiveness letters), and all the way through to the five specific tools the curriculum identifies in the "Tools I Added to My Tool Chest" section. It requires demonstration of both *what was done* and *what was transformed* — leaving no major element of the step unaccounted for.

TOP 10 THINGS I LEARNED WORKING THIS STEP THAT I CAN APPLY TO MY LIFE.

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

10.

As you work through each step you will discover things that you need to ask God to help you with. Write those items on this page as you go.

Also write prayer needs for others.

Refer to this page at your prayer time.

Things to Pray About Regarding my Own Recovery	Others Who Need Prayer (and why)

TO COMPLETE THIS STEP, GO BACK TO THE ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS PAGE AT THE BEGINNING OF THIS STEP, READ THEM AGAIN. THE BACK OF THAT PAGE IS BLANK. WRITE OUT YOUR ANSWERS IN COMPLETE SENTENCES LIKE AND ESSAY OR IN PARAGRAPHS (BUT WRITE THE QUESTION NUMBERS BESIDE EACH ANSWER SO THAT YOU ANSWER EACH QUESTION FULLY ABOUT YOUR SELF).

CHECK HERE WHEN YOU HAVE DO THIS INDICATING THAT THIS STEP IS COMPLETE.

☐


THIS STEP IS COMPLETE INCLUDING ALL ANSWERS, TOP TEN LIST, ESSENTIAL QUESTION ANSWERS)

Day

Date

Participant Signature

Sponsor/ Step Leader Signature



Praying in the Form of Writing

Write a letter to God, asking for clarity and understanding regarding the specific aspect of your life.



Heavenly Father,

Thank you for the learning opportunities you have given me in this step. This week I have realized that I am especially grateful for (you might include some items from your gratitude lists):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

In this Step, with your guidance I have begun to learn (*list those things on your Top 10 list from this Step*)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

I ask now that you give me even more clarity at understanding in these areas, and especially in the area of

You tell me in your Word, The Bible, to come to you with my needs, so that is what I am doing now. I seek your wisdom and guidance with (mention all the things from your prayer request list from the previous page):

I ask that you give me a sense of willingness to allow you to work in my life so that I can heal and so that I may find my purpose and become the person you would have me be.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.

-
- Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise during writing this prayer and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive.
 - Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise as you read this prayer aloud praying with your step leader/ sponsor (and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive).

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



WORKSHOP

BREAK 2

This is not a step. This is a point where we take a break from the step questions to do two workshops (one each week for the next two weekly sessions). These will be one on one sessions with your step leader. You will not need to prepare for them. Your step leader will guide you through them at each meeting time. Pick any one workshop in this section and notify your step leader of which one you chose. Your step leader will select the other one.



Spiritual Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **Before Amen** (Max Lucado) — Simple, powerful prayer practices. A practical prayer framework they can use daily to reduce anxiety, increase conscious contact with God, and experience peace in the midst of recovery struggles.
- **Bondage Breaker, The** (Neil T. Anderson) — Spiritual freedom from strongholds. Tools to identify and tear down lies/strongholds, steps to walk in Christ’s victory, and renewed confidence that freedom is possible now.
- **Empowered by the Spirit** (Derek Prince) — Gifts of the Holy Spirit. Understanding of how the Holy Spirit empowers daily living and recovery, plus discernment to recognize and steward spiritual gifts.
- **Facing Your Giants** (Max Lucado) — Facing fears through David’s story. Courage to confront personal “giants” (addiction, shame, relapse triggers) with faith instead of fear.
- **Fearless** (Max Lucado) — Overcoming fear with faith. Practical ways to replace fear-based thinking with trust in God, reducing anxiety-driven decisions in recovery.
- **Not a Fan** (Kyle Idleman) — Moving from fan to follower. Clarity on the cost of true discipleship and motivation to move from casual faith to full surrender.
- **Prayer of Jabez, The** (Bruce Wilkinson) — Bold, daily prayer. A simple, memorable prayer they can pray daily for blessing, influence, protection, and God’s presence.
- **Problem of Pain, The** (C.S. Lewis) — Suffering and God’s goodness. A biblical framework for making sense of pain without losing faith, helping prevent resentment or relapse during hard seasons.
- **Screwtape Letters, The** (C.S. Lewis) — Recognizing temptation. Insight into subtle spiritual attacks and practical strategies to resist them.
- **When the Body Remembers** (Bessel van der Kolk) — Trauma and the body. Understanding of how trauma lives in the body and faith-based hope for healing.
- **Why Am I Like This?** (Kobe Campbell) — Trauma roots and patterns. Compassionate insight into why they repeat certain patterns and the first steps toward breaking cycles.
- **You’ll Get Through This** (Max Lucado) — Hope in crisis. Encouragement and biblical perspective that God redeems pain, helping them endure tough seasons without giving up.

Emotional Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **Anxious for Nothing** (Max Lucado) — C.A.L.M. plan for anxiety. Immediate, Scripture-based tools to manage anxiety and worry.

- **Approval Addiction** (Joyce Meyer) — Breaking people-pleasing. Freedom from needing everyone's approval and courage to live authentically.
- **Every Woman's Battle** (Shannon Ethridge) — Emotional and sexual integrity (women). Practical help for guarding the heart and mind in relationships.
- **Guilt & Shame** — Addressing guilt and shame. Distinction between guilt and shame plus biblical release from both
- **Human Magnet Syndrome, The** (Ross Rosenberg) — Codependent patterns. Awareness of unhealthy attraction patterns and how to break them.
- **Overcoming Disappointment and Discouragement** (Kathy Spampinato) — Renewing hope. Tools to process disappointment without sliding into despair.
- **PRIDE in Recovery** — Humility vs. pride. Recognition of pride as a recovery saboteur and the path of humility.
- **Soul of Shame, The** (Curt Thompson) — Healing shame. Understanding of shame's power and the healing that comes from being known.
- **Steady in the Storm** (Spampinato + Carlson) — Handling daily stressors. Practical emotional regulation for everyday life.

Relational Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **5 Apology Languages, The** (Chapman & Thomas) — Healthy apologies. Skills to repair relationships through effective apologies (key for Step 8–9 work).
- **Boundaries** (Cloud & Townsend) — Healthy limits. Clarity on what is “my responsibility” vs. “not mine,” reducing resentment and enabling better relationships.
- **Every Man's Battle** (Arterburn & Stoeker) — Sexual integrity (men). Accountability tools and honesty for sexual purity.
- **Making Sense of Forgiveness** (Brad Hambrick) — The forgiveness journey. Freedom from bitterness without pressure for premature reconciliation.
- **Safe People** (Cloud & Townsend) — Choosing healthy relationships. Discernment to build safe community and avoid toxic ones.
- **The Book of Forgiving** (Tutu & Tutu) — Fourfold path to forgiveness. A clear process for healing personal and relational wounds.
- **Unpacking Forgiveness** (Chris Brauns) — Biblical forgiveness. Release from bitterness while honoring justice and safety.

Physical Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **Carnivore Diet, The** (Shawn Baker) — Elimination diet exploration. A clear understanding of how an animal-based elimination diet can stabilize energy, reduce inflammation, and support brain

health, along with practical next steps for experimenting safely while stewarding their body as God's temple.

- **Fat Chance** (Robert Lustig) — Sugar, metabolism, and grace. Eye-opening knowledge about hidden sugars and their impact on the brain and body, combined with grace-filled encouragement to make sustainable changes without shame.
- **Metabolical** (Robert Lustig) — Processed food awareness. Tools to identify ultra-processed foods that drive cravings and metabolic dysfunction, along with practical strategies for choosing real food that supports long-term recovery.
- **Plant Paradox, The** (Steven Gundry) — Gut health and lectins. Understanding of how certain plant compounds affect gut health and inflammation, with actionable ways to reduce digestive issues and improve overall physical well-being.

Mental Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **Change Your Diet, Change Your Mind** (Georgia Ede) — Nutrition and brain health. Science-backed insight into how food affects mood, cravings, and mental clarity, plus simple dietary shifts that can support emotional stability and reduce addictive eating patterns.
- **Get Out of Your Head** (Jennie Allen) — Breaking toxic thought spirals. Skills to interrupt negative rumination and replace lies with truth.
- **Every Thought Captive** (Kyle Idleman) — Renewing the mind. Biblical strategies from 2 Corinthians 10:5 to take thoughts captive, replace toxic thinking patterns, and experience greater mental freedom and peace. .
- **Heal Your Hurting Mind** (Craig Groeschel) — Tools for anxiety, depression, anger, trauma. Honest, practical steps for emotional honesty and healing.

Cultural / Practical Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **God Pocket, The** (Bruce Wilkinson) — Generosity and availability. A simple, life-changing practice of being ready to bless others daily, shifting focus from self-centeredness to service and building a habit of generosity.
- **How to Test Negative for Stupid** (John Kennedy) — Wisdom and common sense. Humorous yet practical discernment tools to make wiser daily decisions and avoid common pitfalls that sabotage recovery.
- **Total Money Makeover, The** (Dave Ramsey) — Financial peace plan. Clear “Baby Steps” for getting out of debt, building emergency savings, and gaining financial peace — reducing stress that often fuels relapse.
- **The 360° Leader** (John C. Maxwell) — Influence from anywhere. Leadership principles for influencing others positively regardless of title or position, helping participants become assets in their recovery community and workplace.



STEP

FIVE





STEP FIVE

STEP 5: We examine & confess our faults — to ourselves, to God, and to someone we trust.

- “Confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so God can heal you. When a believing person prays, great things happen.” — James 5:16

HEBREWS IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® — STARTING IN THE BOOK OF HEBREWS

Choose TWO items (A–L) to implement while working Step 5. Select items NOT already in practice.

First Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

Second Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

TOOLS I ACQUIRE WORKING STEP 5

- **Confession as a Healing Practice** — Not a one-time event but an ongoing discipline experienced and understood firsthand in this step
- **Shame Reduction Through Honest Disclosure** — Being fully known and not rejected rewires how you see yourself
- **Safe Relationships and Accountability** — Identifying, choosing, and trusting safe people to protect recovery going forward
- **Self-Honesty as a Daily Posture** — Practices and habits that prevent drifting back into minimizing, rationalizing, or concealing



RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

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Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP FIVE — Essential Questions & Prayer

STEP 5 ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS

I	What did I learn in Step 4 about myself?
II	Who would I be willing to share this with beside my sponsor?
III	Who should I confess these things to (the Bible mentions three confessions)?
IV	What do I think now about Sponsors, Accountability Partners?
V	How does (did) it feel for me to share this?

STEP 5 PRAYER

Heavenly Father,

Thank you for taking me this far in my recovery journey. Soon I will pray for Your help in making me be entirely ready to change my struggles, shortcomings, or sabotaging behaviors.

Now I ask that You give me the strength and the courage to share what I have learned in Step 4.

Now please give me the strength to deal with these struggles, shortcomings, or sabotaging behaviors that I've turned over to You. Please allow me to accept all the changes that You want to make in me. Help me be the person that You want me to be.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ the Son of the Living God. Amen.



STEP FIVE — KEY TERMS & DEFINITIONS

We examine & confess our faults — to ourselves, to God, and to someone we trust.

The following terms are foundational to your work in Step Five. Read through them before meeting with your sponsor or accountability partners. Understanding these concepts will deepen your ability to engage the step honestly and to receive the healing it is designed to bring.

1. Confession

The intentional, courageous act of speaking your faults, failures, and hidden wrongs aloud — to yourself, to God, and to a trusted person. Confession is not a courtroom moment; it is a healing moment. Neurologically, naming what shames us rewires the brain's threat response. Spiritually, what is spoken in honesty loses the power it once held in secrecy. James 5:16 does not merely suggest this — it declares it as the pathway to healing. Confession is not weakness; it is the bravest thing a recovering person will ever do.

2. Accountability Partner

A person — apart from family and romantic relationships — who has earned enough trust to hear your inventory and hold your progress. Accountability is not surveillance; it is a covenant of honest witness. Cloud and Townsend remind us that we need 'safe people' who tell us the truth and still choose to walk with us. An accountability partner is not your judge. They are a fellow traveler who agrees to help you see yourself clearly and call you forward into the person you are becoming.

3. Sponsor

A guide who has personally worked the steps and can lead you through them from lived experience rather than theory. The sponsor relationship is one of the most powerful forms of mentoring available in recovery. Maxwell would call this a 'lid-lifter' — someone who raises your ceiling by walking ahead of you. A good sponsor does not rescue you from hard work; they sit across from you while you do it, bearing witness to your courage and holding space for your transformation.

4. Moral Inventory (Step 4 Summary)

The written record produced in Step Four that names your resentments, fears, relational harms, character defects, and self-sabotaging patterns. In Step Five, this inventory moves from paper into voice. Anderson's work in 'The Bondage Breaker' underscores that what is unspoken remains spiritually and emotionally empowered over us. Reading your inventory aloud is not a ritual — it is a declaration that you refuse to remain a prisoner of what you have never fully named.

5. Shame

The corrosive internal belief that you are not merely someone who has done wrong things, but that you are a wrong thing — fundamentally flawed, disqualifiable, and unworthy of belonging. Recovery research and Scripture both identify shame as the engine of relapse and the enemy of healing. Russell Brand frames it as the core wound beneath most addictive behavior. Groeschel would say shame speaks in first person ('I am') while guilt speaks in second person ('I did'). The antidote to shame is not more willpower; it is being fully known and fully accepted — which is exactly what a well-done Step Five produces.



6. Vulnerability

The deliberate choice to lower your defenses and allow another person to see the unedited version of your story. Cloud and Townsend write that growth happens 'in the context of relationship,' and relationship cannot exist without vulnerability. It is the bridge between isolation and community, between pretending and healing. Vulnerability in Step Five is not emotional exposure for its own sake — it is strategic honesty in service of your recovery. What feels like weakness in the moment is, in fact, the most powerful move available to you.

7. Secrecy (The Power of)

The hidden force that keeps wounds infected and patterns entrenched. Secrets do not protect us — they imprison us. Arterburn and Stoeker describe the way unconfessed sexual and relational sin operates like a double life, splitting identity and draining integrity. Brand frames addiction itself as a disease of disconnection sustained by shame and concealment. Step Five is a direct assault on secrecy. When a trusted witness hears your story and remains present, the secret loses its grip. Secrecy requires darkness; Step Five turns on the light.

8. Safe Person / Safe Relationship

As defined by Cloud and Townsend, a safe person is someone who draws you closer to who God designed you to be, accepts you without shaming you, and is honest enough to call out what is harmful in your life. Choosing a safe person for your Step Five presentation is not optional — it is essential. The wrong listener can re-traumatize. The right listener can become an agent of profound transformation. Safety does not mean someone who never challenges you; it means someone who is for you even when the truth is hard.

9. Honest Disclosure

The full, unexpurgated truth about yourself — told without minimizing, rationalizing, or strategically omitting the parts that make you look worst. Berry would note that the body itself keeps score of unprocessed stress and dishonesty; honest disclosure is part of the metabolic process of healing. Anderson frames it theologically: you cannot walk in the freedom Christ purchased while hiding in the darkness of half-truths. Honest disclosure in Step Five is not about punishment — it is about precision. You cannot heal what you will not name.

10. Inventory Presentation

The 10-to-20 minute oral or written summary of your Step Four work, delivered to your sponsor and accountability partners. This is the act that moves your inventory from a private document into a communal covenant. Maxwell's principle applies here: 'You cannot improve what you do not evaluate, and you cannot own what you do not say aloud.' The presentation is not a performance — it is a milestone. It marks the moment you stopped hiding from your story and started telling it on your terms.

11. The Threefold Confession

The biblical framework embedded in Step Five that calls for confession to three distinct recipients: to yourself (self-honesty), to God (vertical transparency), and to another trusted person (horizontal accountability). Each dimension of confession serves a different function. Confessing to yourself breaks the mechanism of denial. Confessing to God realigns you with your Creator's perspective on your life. Confessing to another human being breaks shame's power and seals the work in community. All three are necessary; none is sufficient alone.



12. Self-Honesty

The foundational discipline of seeing yourself as you actually are — neither worse than the truth nor better than the truth. Townsend and Cloud identify self-deception as the primary blocker of growth: 'The person who has no awareness of their patterns is powerless to change them.' Self-honesty in Step Five means reviewing your Step Four work and resisting the urge to retroactively justify, minimize, or reframe what you found. It means standing in the mirror of your inventory and letting it tell you the truth. This is the beginning of authentic identity — and the prerequisite for everything that follows.

13. Resentment

Unresolved anger held over time — often unconsciously — toward a person, institution, or circumstance that you believe has wronged you. Anderson describes resentment as a 'root of bitterness' (Hebrews 12:15) that defiles not only the holder but those around them. Resentment is one of the most consistently identified relapse triggers in recovery. Step Four surfaces it; Step Five voices it to a witness. The act of naming resentments aloud — and hearing them received without judgment — begins the defusing process that no private journaling alone can fully achieve.

14. Fear Inventory

The written and spoken accounting of your fears — the anxieties, phobias, insecurities, and dread that have driven decisions, relationships, and behaviors across your lifetime. Groeschel teaches that courage is not the absence of fear — it is acting in the presence of fear because you trust something bigger. The fear inventory in Step Five externalizes what has operated internally as a hidden architect of your choices. When you hear your own fears spoken aloud to a trusted witness, many of them lose the outsized power they held in the dark.

15. Character Defects (Shortcomings)

The persistent patterns of thought, attitude, and behavior that consistently work against your relationships, your integrity, and your recovery. These are distinct from struggles (what you battle from the outside) and self-sabotaging behaviors (what you do that undermines your progress). In the RnR framework, shortcomings represent the character gaps that became part of your operating system — pride, dishonesty, people-pleasing, control, avoidance. Naming them in Step Five is the first step toward addressing them in Steps Six and Seven.

16. Readiness (Being Entirely Ready)

The internal posture of willingness — an honest openness to allow God to change not just your behavior, but your character. Arterburn and Stoeker speak of this as 'every man's battle' moving from a battle of conduct to a battle of the will. Maxwell would frame it as the moment a leader finally submits their greatest weakness to a greater authority. Readiness in the context of Step Five means being willing to hear your inventory received without self-rescue, and then being willing to let it lead you into the change work ahead.

17. Healing Through Community

The biblical and clinical truth that lasting recovery does not happen in isolation — it happens in the context of chosen, trusted, honest relationships. Brand's recovery framework centers on 'connection as the opposite of addiction.' Cloud and Townsend built an entire therapeutic model on it. James 5:16 grounds it in Scripture: pray for each other, confess to each other, so that healing comes. Step Five is the step that most fully embodies this truth. It requires two people — and in that requirement, it both demands and produces community.

STEP 5: We examine & confess our faults ❶ to ourselves, ❷ to God, and ❸ to someone we trust.

1. After working through the fourth step questions, what do you realize about your limitations and capabilities?

✝ Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now. ✎

2. What qualities do you think a sponsor should have?

3. What qualities should an accountability partner have?

4. Describe any person who has helped you to see yourself more clearly and objectively in your process of recovery and of life.

5. Write down the names of the most trustworthy people that you know (not family, nor boyfriends/ girlfriends). Do you think that they would be willing or interested in being an accountability partner for you?

6. List other people that you can think of that you might share your summary with. Write whether you think that they are a safe, risky or a bad choice to work your 5th step with.

+

Person	Safe, Risky or Bad choice
1	Safe Risky Bad
2	Safe Risky Bad
3	Safe Risky Bad
4	Safe Risky Bad
5	Safe Risky Bad

STEP FIVE QUESTIONS

Before continuing this step, ask yourself:

1 Have I been entirely honest in this inventory?

2 Have I been clear about the motives beneath my behavior?

3 Have I reached into my innermost self and asked for truth to be revealed?

4 Am I open to a new truth?

5 Am I willing to take full responsibility for my feelings, perceptions, and my behavior?

† *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 

6 Am I willing to fully disclose the most intimate and previously concealed nature of myself to another person?



CONFESSING TO ANOTHER HUMAN BEING

The people we choose to be accountability partners should themselves have undertaken this process and may have the same desire to help us that a sponsor would have.

1. We are asked to give our inventory three times. Who are we to confess it to and why?
(Hint look at Resilients and Recovery Step 5)

2. Most of us find it easier to confess our wrongs to ourselves and God. We seem to have more difficulty in sharing them with another person. What is the most difficult part for you? Why?

3. What is your biggest fear of sharing your inventory with another person?
✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 

5. Pick a quiet location and a time to share your inventory with an accountability partner (this could be in addition to your sponsor meeting where you review your inventory with your sponsor). List three places and circle the best one.

ASK YOURSELF:

-  Why am I doing Step 5?

-  Why am I doing it with the sponsor that I have chosen?

-  Am I willing to invite an accountability partner (or two) to be present at my next sponsor meeting when I present my step five project? Who?

Prepare a 10-to-20-minute presentation for your sponsor and accountability partners you may wish to invite- summarizing your step 4 work and what you learned by working Resilients in Recovery step 4. (Use your STEP FOUR PROJECT AND PRESENTATION notes from previous step).

[illegible]



10-to-20-minute presentation for your sponsor and an accountability partner (Page 2 of Essay)

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.



ANSWER THESE QUESTIONS AFTER READING YOUR STEP FIVE PRESENTATION

1. Describe what it was like sharing the fifth step.
2. How did you feel before, after and during the process?
3. Are you glad that you have done this?
4. Describe any celebrations or activities that you have done or will do in honor of completing the fifth step.
5. What is the function of Step 5?

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY

Step Five Comprehension Review

We examine & confess our faults — to ourselves, to God, and to someone we trust.

Instructions: Answer each question in the space provided. Your answers should come from the Step Five material — Key Terms & Definitions, the Step Five questions, and the reflection sections. If you are unsure of an answer, go back and re-read the step before responding.

Open-Ended Questions

1. According to Step Five, to whom are you asked to confess your inventory — and why is each recipient important?

2. What is the difference between shame and guilt as described in the Step Five key terms?

3. What is a 'safe person,' and why does the material say choosing the right listener for your Step Five presentation is not optional?

4. In your own words, explain what the 'Inventory Presentation' is and what it is meant to accomplish.



5. What role does secrecy play in keeping a person stuck, and how does Step Five directly address it?

6. What qualities should you look for in a sponsor? What qualities should you look for in an accountability partner?

7. What does 'Honest Disclosure' mean in the context of Step Five? What does the material say happens when you refuse to name what needs healing?

8. After completing your Step Five presentation, what are you asked to reflect on? Describe at least three things.



Comprehensive Essay Question — Step 5

Resilients in Recovery® | Step 5 Reflection & Transformation Essay

Essay Prompt:

Step 5 calls us to do one of the most courageous things a person in recovery can do: to examine our faults honestly — to ourselves, to God, and to a trusted person — and then to *speak them aloud*. This step moves your recovery from the private page into a living, breathing act of confession, vulnerability, and community. It is where your inventory stops being a document and becomes a declaration.

In a thoughtful, well-developed essay, reflect on your experience completing Step 5 by addressing **all four parts** below. Write with honesty and depth — this is not a summary of what the step asked you to do, but a personal account of who you were when you entered this step, what happened inside you as you worked through it, and who you are becoming on the other side of it.

Part 1 — What You Carried In: The Weight of Secrecy and Shame

Before you sat down with your sponsor or accountability partner, what were you carrying? Describe the fears, resistances, or emotional barriers you identified as you approached this step. What did shame feel like in your story — not shame in the abstract, but *your* shame, the specific belief about yourself that secrecy had been protecting? Be honest about what felt most difficult to say aloud and why. What did that difficulty reveal to you about the role secrecy had been playing in your life and your patterns?

Part 2 — The Act of Confession: What Happened When You Spoke It Aloud

Describe the experience of presenting your Step 4 inventory to your sponsor and/or accountability partner(s). What was it like *before*, *during*, and *after* you shared? How did it feel to choose a safe person and trust them with the unedited version of your story? Reflect on what happened to the power of your resentments, fears, and character defects when they moved from private writing into spoken words heard by a trusted witness. In what ways did being *fully known and fully accepted* change something in you that no amount of private journaling or prayer alone could have reached?

Part 3 — Transformation: Who You Are After Step 5

Looking back across the full arc of this step — the self-examination, the threefold confession (to yourself, to God, and to another person), the inventory presentation, and the reflection questions you completed afterward — describe the specific ways you have grown or changed. What do you now understand about yourself, about your patterns, about your relationships, and about your recovery that you did not understand before? Where did God meet you in this process? How has completing this step shifted the way you see your past, your present, or your future?



Part 4 — Tools Added to Your Recovery Toolkit

Step 5 equips you with specific tools that you carry forward from this point on. In this final section, identify and reflect on the new tools you have added to your recovery toolkit by completing this step. At minimum, address how you will use the following in your ongoing recovery:

- **Confession as a healing practice** — not as a one-time event, but as a discipline you now understand and have experienced firsthand.
- **Shame reduction through honest disclosure** — describe specifically how the experience of being fully known and not rejected rewired something in how you see yourself.
- **Safe relationships and accountability** — having identified, chosen, and trusted safe people in this step, how will you continue to build and protect those relationships in your recovery?
- **Self-honesty as a daily posture** — what practices or habits will you carry forward to ensure you don't drift back into minimizing, rationalizing, or concealing?
- **Any additional tools** from your personal Top 10 List that you intend to apply going forward — name at least two and explain how you will put them into action.

Your essay should reflect genuine personal engagement, not just a recounting of the step's content. Use your own story. Use the language of your own transformation. The goal is not a perfect essay — it is an honest one. What you write here is evidence that something real happened in you during this step.



TOP 10 THINGS I LEARNED WORKING THIS STEP THAT I CAN APPLY TO MY LIFE.

(Write These in Complete Sentences)

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

10.

As you work through each step you will discover things that you need to ask God to help you with. Write those items on this page as you go.

Also write prayer needs for others.

Refer to this page at your prayer time.

Things to Pray About Regarding my Own Recovery	Others Who Need Prayer (and why)

TO COMPLETE THIS STEP, GO BACK TO THE ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS PAGE AT THE BEGINNING OF THIS STEP, READ THEM AGAIN. THE BACK OF THAT PAGE IS BLANK. WRITE OUT YOUR ANSWERS IN COMPLETE SENTENCES LIKE AND ESSAY OR IN PARAGRAPHS (BUT WRITE THE QUESTION NUMBERS BESIDE EACH ANSWER SO THAT YOU ANSWER EACH QUESTION FULLY ABOUT YOUR SELF).

CHECK HERE WHEN YOU HAVE DO THIS INDICATING THAT THIS STEP IS COMPLETE.

☐


THIS STEP IS COMPLETE INCLUDING ALL ANSWERS, TOP TEN LIST, ESSENTIAL QUESTION ANSWERS)

Day

Date

Participant Signature

Sponsor/ Step Leader Signature



Praying in the Form of Writing

Write a letter to God, asking for clarity and understanding regarding the specific aspect of your life.



Heavenly Father,

Thank you for the learning opportunities you have given me in this step. This week I have realized that I am especially grateful for (you might include some items from your gratitude lists):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

In this Step, with your guidance I have begun to learn (*list those things on your Top 10 list from this Step*)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

I ask now that you give me even more clarity at understanding in these areas, and especially in the area of

You tell me in your Word, The Bible, to come to you with my needs, so that is what I am doing now. I seek your wisdom and guidance with (mention all the things from your prayer request list from the previous page):

I ask that you give me a sense of willingness to allow you to work in my life so that I can heal and so that I may find my purpose and become the person you would have me be.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.

-
- Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise during writing this prayer and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive.
 - Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise as you read this prayer aloud praying with your step leader/ sponsor (and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive).

STEP



SIX





Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP SIX

STEP 6: We become open to the idea that God can guide us to freedom from struggles with character flaws and individual weaknesses.

- *"Humble yourselves before the Lord, and He will lift you up." — James 4:10*
- *"O Lord, you are my lamp. The Lord turns my darkness into light." — 2 Samuel 22:29*

HEBREWS IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® — STARTING IN THE BOOK OF HEBREWS

Choose TWO items (A–L) to implement while working Step 6. Select items NOT already in practice.

First Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

Second Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

TOOLS I ACQUIRE WORKING STEP 6

- **Willingness Practice** — Cultivating the inner posture of readiness to let God lead you to overcome character defects, even deeply entrenched ones
- **Identifying Patterns of Behavior** — Reviewing the Step 4 inventory to recognize recurring cycles and themes across struggles, shortcomings, and sabotaging behaviors



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Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP SIX — Essential Questions & Prayer

STEP 6 ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS

I	Considering all these struggles that I have been admitting, what did I enjoy about them and how did that turn out (in each case)?
II	What exactly have I been doing that lead to struggles and sabotaging behaviors, and how do I specifically turn them over to God?
III	What will I do when these struggles continue to surface as issues for me in the future?
IV	What is the new plan for my life?

STEP 6 PRAYER

Heavenly Father,

I pray for willingness — willingness to evaluate all my past and current relationships. I also pray that You guide me to have a spirit of humbleness and willingness to see patterns of my own behavior and my own thinking.

Please continue to show me the people whom I have hurt and help me to become ready to offer my amends to them. Also, God give me Your strength to become willing to offer forgiveness to those who have hurt me.

I pray for Your perfect timing for taking the action that this step calls for.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ the Son of the Living God. Amen.



STEP 6 — KEY TERMS & DEFINITIONS

We become open to the idea that God can guide us to freedom from struggles with character flaws and individual weaknesses.

01. Willingness

The foundational posture of Step 6 — an inner readiness, not yet action, to invite God into the process of change. Willingness is not the same as having already changed; it is the honest opening of the door. As John Townsend and Henry Cloud teach in *Boundaries*, lasting transformation begins the moment we stop fighting the need for help and start cooperating with it. God does not demand perfection before He enters — He asks only for an open hand.

02. Character Defects (Character Struggles)

The persistent patterns of thought, emotion, and behavior that consistently damage our relationships, our integrity, and our relationship with God. Fred Stoeker, in *Every Man's Battle*, identifies these not as isolated failures but as grooved highways in the soul — roads we have traveled so many times they feel like the only roads available. Character defects are the recurring themes that surface in our inventory: pride, dishonesty, lust, envy, avoidance, and excess. Naming them accurately is the first act of freedom.

03. Pride

The conviction, spoken or unspoken, that we are the center of our own story — and perhaps everyone else's. Pride refuses help, demands to be right, looks down on others, and insulates us from the very feedback that could save us. Craig Groeschel describes pride as a spiritual blindfold: we cannot see what we will not admit. In Step 6, we examine how pride has served us (the short-term payoff) and what it has truly cost us (the long-term damage).

04. Greed and Materialism

An excessive and disordered pursuit of more — more money, more status, more power, more possessions — at the expense of the people and values that actually matter. Stephen Arterburn and the New Life Ministries team note that addiction of any kind, including material addiction, is always rooted in the belief that the next thing will finally be enough. Greed is not simply about money; it is about using the external to fill an internal void that only God can satisfy.

05. Lust

The reduction of a person — or an experience — to an object of gratification. Lust is not limited to sexual desire; it encompasses any obsessive craving that overrides values, damages relationships, and treats others as means rather than ends. Fred Stoeker teaches that lust is a habit of the eyes and the mind long before it becomes a habit of behavior, which is why the battle must be engaged at the level of thought. In Step 6, we ask honestly: what has this struggle given us, and what has it taken away?

06. Dishonesty

A broad pattern of misrepresentation that includes outright lies, half-truths, strategic omissions, and perhaps most destructively, self-deception. Neil T. Anderson, in *The Bondage Breaker*, teaches that the enemy's primary weapon is deception — and he cannot operate without our cooperation. When we are dishonest with others, we damage trust; when we are dishonest with ourselves, we forfeit the clarity needed to heal. Step 6 invites radical self-honesty as an act of spiritual courage.

07. Excess and Compulsion

The pattern of using any behavior — eating, drinking, spending, working, screen use, relationships — to numb pain, escape reality, or fill an emptiness that the behavior can never actually address. Russell Brand,

in Recovery: Freedom from Our Addictions, describes compulsion as the soul's misdirected attempt to get somewhere real using a road that loops. Ken D. Berry, M.D., would add the physiological dimension: many compulsive cycles are anchored in biochemistry and stress response, not simply moral failure — healing therefore must address the whole person.

08. Envy and Jealousy

Envy is the pain we feel at another person's blessing — the corrosive sense that their gain diminishes our worth. Jealousy is the fear of losing what we already have. Both are rooted in a scarcity mindset: the belief that there is not enough love, success, beauty, or worth to go around. John Maxwell teaches that comparison is the enemy of contentment and the thief of purpose. In recovery, envy keeps us focused on other people's stories rather than our own, which is precisely where the enemy wants our attention.

09. Avoidance and Irresponsibility

The pattern of sidestepping accountability — for our actions, our relationships, our health, our spiritual life — whether through distraction, delay, blame-shifting, or outright refusal to engage. Henry Cloud, in Necessary Endings, describes avoidance as a form of slow self-destruction: the problems we refuse to face do not disappear; they compound. Avoidance often feels like safety, but it is actually the most dangerous posture available to a person in recovery, because it freezes them exactly where they are.

10. Readiness

The spiritual and psychological state of being prepared — not necessarily eager, but genuinely available — to cooperate with God's transforming work. Readiness is the goal of Step 6. It is not the same as change; it is the precondition for it. As Craig Groeschel puts it, we cannot force a breakthrough, but we can posture ourselves for one. Readiness requires honesty about what our struggles have cost us, humility to admit we cannot fix ourselves, and trust that God's way forward is better than our current path.

11. Patterns of Behavior

Recurring cycles of thought and action that have become so familiar they operate largely on autopilot. Where a single failure is an event, a pattern is a lifestyle. John Maxwell teaches that we do not rise to the level of our intentions; we fall to the level of our habits. Step 6 works from the inventory of Step 4 to identify these patterns — not to produce shame, but to produce clarity. You cannot surrender what you have not named, and you cannot change what you refuse to see.

12. Sabotaging Behaviors

The specific actions — often unconscious — by which we undermine our own progress, relationships, and healing. Sabotage frequently disguises itself as logic: the reason we picked a fight, isolated ourselves, skipped a meeting, or returned to a harmful habit almost always felt reasonable in the moment. Stephen Arterburn identifies self-sabotage as one of the most insidious dynamics in recovery, because it operates from the inside. Recognizing these behaviors — and naming the unmet need or fear behind them — is essential groundwork for lasting change.

13. Humility

Accurate self-perception in the presence of God — neither inflated nor deflated, but honest. Humility is not self-contempt; it is the willingness to see ourselves clearly and to receive help we could not generate on our own. Neil T. Anderson describes humility as the soil in which all genuine spiritual growth occurs: without it, no real work can take root. In Step 6, humility means admitting the full cost of our struggles without minimizing them and without using them to define us permanently.

14. Forgiveness (Readiness to Offer)

The conscious choice to release another person from the debt we feel they owe us — not because what they did was acceptable, but because carrying that debt is destroying us. Step 6 asks us to become ready to offer forgiveness, which is distinct from having already fully forgiven. Henry Cloud and John Townsend clarify in How People Grow that forgiveness is a process, not a moment — but it must begin with a decision

of the will. Holding resentment, as the Step 6 prayer notes, is a block not only to our relationships but to our own freedom.

15. Amends (Readiness to Offer)

The intention, cultivated in Step 6 and acted upon in later steps, to repair what our character defects have broken. Readiness for amends means honestly identifying who we have harmed and becoming willing — before we know how or when — to make it right. This readiness must be preceded by genuine acknowledgment of the harm caused, not a strategic apology designed to relieve our own discomfort. Amends-readiness is an act of spiritual integrity: it places the other person's healing ahead of our own comfort.

16. God's Timing

The Step 6 prayer explicitly asks for God's perfect timing in taking action — a recognition that readiness and right timing are both gifts we receive, not schedules we dictate. Craig Groeschel teaches that one of the most faith-stretching practices in recovery is learning to move when God moves, rather than forcing outcomes on our own timetable. This is not passivity; it is active trust — continuing to prepare, pray, and cooperate while releasing control over the when and how of God's work in our lives.

STEP 6: We become open to the idea that God can guide us to freedom from struggles with character flaws and individual weaknesses.

◆ PART ONE: GETTING READY TO LET GOD DEAL WITH MY STRUGGLES

Before we can become willing to change, we need to honestly look at where we are. Use the questions below to help you prepare your heart for this step.

1. Are there any fairy tales, myths, legends, TV personalities, or movie characters you can relate to? Why? (For example: a character who wouldn't ask for help, who sought power, or who got lost chasing something that didn't satisfy.)

2. Describe situations and events where you have been full of pride — needing to be right, refusing help, or looking down on others.

3. What has this pride brought into your life that felt good or gave you something you wanted?

4. What problems or costs has this pride created for you?



5. Describe activities you genuinely enjoy — things that give you energy, peace, or a sense of purpose (not addictive behaviors).

6. What healthy habits — in eating, sleep, exercise, or self-care — could you begin moving toward? What small first step is realistic for you right now?

7. What unhealthy habits — eating, sleep, screen use, or other patterns — are you ready to begin releasing? What makes it hard to let them go?

8. Am I willing to stop blaming others and let go of resentment? What would it feel like to truly release a resentment you've been holding onto?

9. Describe some secret good deeds you have done or would like to do. How does giving without recognition connect to your recovery and character growth?



◆ PART TWO: STEP SIX POINTS — EXAMINING CHARACTER STRUGGLES

For each area below, honestly reflect on your experience. Use the sub-questions to explore what each struggle has cost you — and whether you are ready to invite God's help.

Pride

Describe situations and events where you have been full of pride — thinking of yourself as better than others, refusing help, or needing to be right.

a. What has this struggle brought into your life that you liked, wanted, or felt you needed?

b. What problems or pain has this caused you — in your relationships, health, work, or sense of self?

c. Are you ready to ask God to help you begin to overcome this struggle?



Prayer Prompt: *Take a moment to write a prayer about your struggle with pride. Be honest. God already knows — this is about opening your heart.*

Record your response on the Prayer Request page at the end of this step.



Greed & Materialism

Describe situations and events where you have been overly focused on getting more — money, possessions, status, or power — at the expense of relationships or your values.

a. What has this struggle brought into your life that you liked, wanted, or felt you needed?

b. What problems or pain has this caused you — in your relationships, health, work, or sense of self?

c. Are you ready to ask God to help you begin to overcome this struggle?



Prayer Prompt: *Take a moment to write a prayer about your struggle with greed & materialism. Be honest. God already knows — this is about opening your heart.*

Record your response on the Prayer Request page at the end of this step.

Lust

Describe situations where sexual desires, romantic obsession, or the need for physical/emotional intimacy led you to disregard others or your own values.

a. What has this struggle brought into your life that you liked, wanted, or felt you needed?

b. What problems or pain has this caused you — in your relationships, health, work, or sense of self?

c. Are you ready to ask God to help you begin to overcome this struggle?



Prayer Prompt: *Take a moment to write a prayer about your struggle with lust. Be honest. God already knows — this is about opening your heart.*

Record your response on the Prayer Request page at the end of this step.

Dishonesty

Describe situations and events where you have been dishonest — with others, or with yourself. Include half-truths, strategic silence, and self-deception.

a. What has this struggle brought into your life that you liked, wanted, or felt you needed?

b. What problems or pain has this caused you — in your relationships, health, work, or sense of self?

c. Are you ready to ask God to help you begin to overcome this struggle?



Prayer Prompt: *Take a moment to write a prayer about your struggle with dishonesty. Be honest. God already knows — this is about opening your heart.*

Record your response on the Prayer Request page at the end of this step.

Excess & Compulsion

Describe situations where you gave into excessive behaviors — not just eating, drinking, or shopping, but any behavior you used to numb, escape, or fill a void.

a. What has this struggle brought into your life that you liked, wanted, or felt you needed?

b. What problems or pain has this caused you — in your relationships, health, work, or sense of self?

c. Are you ready to ask God to help you begin to overcome this struggle?



Prayer Prompt: *Take a moment to write a prayer about your struggle with excess & compulsion. Be honest. God already knows — this is about opening your heart.*

Record your response on the Prayer Request page at the end of this step.

Envy & Jealousy

Describe situations where you have been deeply envious of others' success, relationships, appearance, or lifestyle — and how that shaped your behavior.

a. What has this struggle brought into your life that you liked, wanted, or felt you needed?

b. What problems or pain has this caused you — in your relationships, health, work, or sense of self?

c. Are you ready to ask God to help you begin to overcome this struggle?



Prayer Prompt: *Take a moment to write a prayer about your struggle with envy & jealousy. Be honest. God already knows — this is about opening your heart.*

Record your response on the Prayer Request page at the end of this step.

Avoidance & Irresponsibility

Describe situations where you avoided responsibility — for your actions, your relationships, your health, or your recovery — whether through action or inaction.

a. What has this struggle brought into your life that you liked, wanted, or felt you needed?

b. What problems or pain has this caused you — in your relationships, health, work, or sense of self?

c. Are you ready to ask God to help you begin to overcome this struggle?



Prayer Prompt: *Take a moment to write a prayer about your struggle with avoidance & irresponsibility. Be honest. God already knows — this is about opening your heart.*

Record your response on the Prayer Request page at the end of this step.

Prayer Request Page — Step 6

As you worked through this step, you were invited to bring each struggle to God in prayer. Use this page to record those prayers, your honest responses, and any sense of God's answer or guidance you have received.

✦ *Remember: This step is not about perfection — it is about willingness. God does not ask you to fix yourself before coming to Him. He asks only that you come.*

Pride

Greed & Materialism

Lust

Dishonesty



Excess & Compulsion

Envy & Jealousy

Avoidance & Irresponsibility

List your major struggles, shortcomings, or sabotaging behaviors.

What do you plan to do when these major struggles, shortcomings, or sabotaging behaviors begin to become evident again?

List each struggle, shortcoming, or sabotaging behavior individually along with the proposed preventative behavior and how you will allow God to help you in your battle against these defects. (Add an additional sheet if you need it to write out this plan).



Am I willing to use this program as the new plan for my life?

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® | STEP 6 COMPREHENSION CHECK

Answer each question in your own words. Your answers should show that you have read and reflected on the Step 6 material. If you are unsure of an answer, go back and read the material again.

SECTION 1 — THE FOUNDATION OF STEP 6

1. In your own words, what is Step 6 asking you to become ready to do?

2. What is the difference between willingness and actually changing? Why does Step 6 focus on willingness rather than change itself?

3. What is the Step 6 prayer asking God for, and why is timing important in this step?

SECTION 2 — KEY TERMS & DEFINITIONS

4. How does Step 6 define pride, and what are two specific ways pride can show up in a person's life?

5. What is the difference between envy and jealousy as described in the Step 6 material?

6. According to Step 6, what makes avoidance so dangerous for someone in recovery?

7. How does Step 6 define dishonesty? Give at least two forms of dishonesty mentioned in the material.

8. What does "readiness to offer amends" mean in Step 6? Is this the same as actually making amends? Explain.

SECTION 3 — PUTTING IT INTO PRACTICE

9. Step 6 lists several character struggles (pride, greed, lust, dishonesty, excess, envy, avoidance). For each one, you were asked three sub-questions. What were those three questions?

10. What is a "sabotaging behavior," and why does the material say it can be so hard to recognize?

11. According to Step 6, what is humility — and what is it NOT? Why is humility important to genuine growth?

12. The Step 6 Essential Questions ask: "What is the new plan for my life?" Based on the step material, what elements should that plan address?



Comprehensive Essay Question — Step 6

"Becoming Ready: From Self-Deception to Spiritual Openness"

Step 6 calls us to move from merely *knowing* our struggles to becoming genuinely *willing* for God to work on them. It is a step about inner transformation — the shift from self-protection to spiritual openness, from blame to ownership, from avoidance to readiness.

In a well-developed essay of at least five substantial paragraphs, reflect thoughtfully and honestly on your personal journey through Step 6 by addressing all of the following:

Part One — Naming What Was Hidden Begin by describing the specific character struggles — whether pride, dishonesty, lust, greed, envy, avoidance, or excess — that you examined in this step. Be honest about what those struggles *gave* you (the short-term payoff or perceived comfort) and what they ultimately *cost* you in your relationships, your integrity, your health, and your walk with God. How did working through the Step 6 inventory change the way you see yourself? What did radical self-honesty feel like, and what did it produce in you?

Part Two — Patterns You Now Recognize Describe the specific *patterns of behavior* and *sabotaging behaviors* you identified in yourself during this step. How did you come to see these not as isolated failures but as recurring grooves that had shaped your life? What is different about the way you understand your own behavior now compared to before you worked this step? How has naming these patterns — rather than avoiding or minimizing them — given you a new kind of clarity and freedom?

Part Three — The Shift Toward Willingness and Readiness Step 6 does not demand that change is complete — it asks only that you become *ready*. Describe the spiritual and emotional movement you experienced from resistance or denial toward genuine willingness. What made that shift difficult? What helped make it possible? How do you understand *readiness* differently now than you did before this step — particularly as something distinct from perfection or immediate change? How did prayer factor into your growing openness?

Part Four — Readiness for Forgiveness and Amends Reflect on the two relational dimensions of Step 6: your readiness to *offer forgiveness* to those who have hurt you, and your readiness to *make amends* to those you have harmed. Which of these was harder for you, and why? What does it mean to you that Step 6 asks you to *become ready* for these things before you are required to act on them? How has even this inner posture of readiness begun to change you?

Part Five — New Tools for Your Recovery Toolkit Conclude by identifying and explaining the specific new tools, practices, and perspectives you are carrying forward from Step 6. Your answer should include:

- How you will use honest self-examination and pattern recognition going forward when struggles resurface;
- How prayer — including written, honest prayer — has become a tool you can return to when character struggles flare up again;
- How the discipline of humility (accurate self-perception without shame or inflation) now functions as an active recovery skill;
- What it means practically to trust God's timing rather than forcing your own solutions;

- Any new healthy habits — physical, relational, or spiritual — that you identified in this step and have begun to cultivate.

Your essay should reflect genuine personal engagement with the material, not simply a summary of the step's content. Graders and sponsors are looking for evidence that you have moved — that the person writing this essay is not identical to the person who began Step 6. Write from that place of real transformation.



TOP 10 THINGS I LEARNED WORKING THIS STEP THAT I CAN APPLY TO MY LIFE.

(Write These in Complete Sentences)

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

10.

As you work through each step you will discover things that you need to ask God to help you with. Write those items on this page as you go.

Also write prayer needs for others.

Refer to this page at your prayer time.

Things to Pray About Regarding my Own Recovery	Others Who Need Prayer (and why)

TO COMPLETE THIS STEP, GO BACK TO THE ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS PAGE AT THE BEGINNING OF THIS STEP, READ THEM AGAIN. THE BACK OF THAT PAGE IS BLANK. WRITE OUT YOUR ANSWERS IN COMPLETE SENTENCES LIKE AND ESSAY OR IN PARAGRAPHS (BUT WRITE THE QUESTION NUMBERS BESIDE EACH ANSWER SO THAT YOU ANSWER EACH QUESTION FULLY ABOUT YOUR SELF).

CHECK HERE WHEN YOU HAVE DO THIS INDICATING THAT THIS STEP IS COMPLETE.

☐


THIS STEP IS COMPLETE INCLUDING ALL ANSWERS, TOP TEN LIST, ESSENTIAL QUESTION ANSWERS)

Day

Date

Participant Signature

Sponsor/ Step Leader Signature

Praying in the Form of Writing

Write a letter to God, asking for clarity and understanding regarding the specific aspect of your life.



Heavenly Father,

Thank you for the learning opportunities you have given me in this step. This week I have realized that I am especially grateful for (you might include some items from your gratitude lists):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

In this Step, with your guidance I have begun to learn (*list those things on your Top 10 list from this Step*)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

I ask now that you give me even more clarity at understanding in these areas, and especially in the area of

You tell me in your Word, The Bible, to come to you with my needs, so that is what I am doing now. I seek your wisdom and guidance with (mention all the things from your prayer request list from the previous page):

I ask that you give me a sense of willingness to allow you to work in my life so that I can heal and so that I may find my purpose and become the person you would have me be.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.

-
- Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise during writing this prayer and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive.

Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise as you read this prayer aloud praying with your step leader/ sponsor (and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive).

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



STEP SEVEN



STEP SEVEN

STEP 7: We humbly ask God for wisdom to equip us to overcome our shortcomings.

- “Do any of you need wisdom? Ask God for it. He is generous and enjoys giving to everyone. So, he will give you wisdom.” — James 1:5
- “God is faithful and reliable. If we confess our sins, he forgives them and cleanses us from everything we’ve done wrong.” — 1 John 1:9

HEBREWS IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® — STARTING IN THE BOOK OF HEBREWS

Choose TWO items (A–L) to implement while working Step 7. Select items NOT already in practice.

First Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

Second Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

TOOLS I ACQUIRE WORKING STEP 7

- **Humble Petition** — The ongoing practice of specifically and humbly asking God for wisdom and strength to overcome shortcomings — not by willpower, but by divine equipping
- **Tool Chest Inventory** — Actively identifying and taking stock of what recovery tools have been accumulated through the steps so far, as a personal resource for ongoing use



RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

12 Step TRANSFORMATION Curriculum • VER 7.1

Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP SEVEN — Essential Questions & Prayer

STEP 7 ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS

I	What tools am I stocking my recovery tool chest with?
II	What patterns can I see in my addictive behaviors of the past?
III	What does the Book of Romans say about addictive behavior patterns?
IV	What do I need to start doing?
V	What do I need to stop doing?

STEP 7 PRAYER

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for taking me this far in my recovery journey. Now I pray for Your help in making me entirely ready to change all my struggles, shortcomings, and sabotaging behaviors.

Give me the strength to deal with my struggles, shortcomings, and sabotaging behaviors that I have turned over to You. Help me begin to identify patterns in my behavior and my thinking that are impacting my recovery.

Guide me and give me strength Lord. Allow me to willingly and patiently accept all the changes that You would want in me. Help me be the person that You want me to be.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.



STEP 7 — KEY TERMS & DEFINITIONS

The following terms appear throughout Step 7 and are central to the work of this step. Read through these definitions before and after completing the Essential Questions. Return to them whenever a concept feels unclear. These are not just vocabulary — they are tools.

Shortcomings

The character defects, habitual sins, flaws, and ingrained patterns of thinking or behavior that get in the way of our healing, our relationships, and our calling. Shortcomings are not simply bad habits — they are distortions of God-given drives that have been bent by pain, pride, or fear. As Henry Cloud and John Townsend note in *Boundaries*, we are not responsible for the wounds we received, but we are responsible for what we do with them. Step 7 invites us to stop managing our shortcomings and start surrendering them.

Humility

The honest, grounded posture of a person who knows who they are — strengths, limits, and all — and is therefore open to God's transformation. Humility is not self-hatred or weakness; it is accurate self-knowledge. John Maxwell teaches that great leaders are willing to be taught, and Neil T. Anderson (*The Bondage Breaker*) reminds us that humility is the precondition for breaking free from strongholds. In Step 7, humility means releasing our white-knuckled grip on self-management and asking God to do what we cannot do for ourselves.

Humbly Ask

The active, deliberate, ongoing practice of coming before God with specific requests — not as a one-time transaction, but as a lifestyle. Stephen Arterburn and Fred Stoeker (*Every Man's Battle*) describe this as 'bringing your battle to God daily.' It means naming what you need, being honest about your inability to fix yourself, and remaining open to God's timing and methods. Humbly asking is the opposite of demanding, bargaining, or trying to negotiate with God about which shortcomings you are willing to give up.

Sabotaging Behaviors

The self-defeating actions, responses, or patterns that undermine our own recovery, relationships, and God-given potential — often without our conscious awareness. Russell Brand (*Recovery: Freedom From Our Addictions*) calls these 'the old tapes' — the automatic scripts we run that keep us locked in cycles of destruction. Sabotaging behaviors are the behavioral expression of deeper shortcomings and beliefs. They include self-neglect, procrastination, impulse-driven decisions, and any repeated action that moves us away from the life we say we want.

Divine Equipping

The spiritual reality that God does not simply command change — He provides the resources, strength, and wisdom necessary to actually make it. In Step 7, the word 'equip' is central: we are not asking God merely to forgive our shortcomings but to actively equip us to overcome them. Craig Groeschel (*Winning the War in Your Mind*) describes this as God 'rewiring the brain' through His Word and Spirit. Divine equipping means we bring our willingness and God supplies the power — the change is genuinely collaborative.



Willpower vs. God's Will

The crucial distinction between self-reliance and Spirit-reliance in recovery. Willpower is the human attempt to overcome compulsion through personal determination alone — and it consistently fails over the long term, especially in addiction and deep character work. God's will, by contrast, is the transformative power available when we align our desires with His and stop trying to be our own higher power. Ken D. Berry, M.D. would note that willpower is a finite biological resource; it depletes under stress. Recovery that lasts requires a resource that does not run out.

Patterns (Addictive / Behavioral)

The repeated sequences of thought, feeling, and action that form the grooves of our addictive or destructive lives. Patterns are not random — they follow predictable triggers, emotional states, and environments. Neil T. Anderson teaches that patterns rooted in false beliefs must be broken at the level of the mind, not just the behavior. Recognizing patterns — as Step 7 specifically asks us to do — is the first step toward interrupting them. A pattern you can name is a pattern you can begin to change.

Romans 12:1–2 Transformation

The biblical anchor of Step 7 and the theological framework for lasting change. Paul's instruction to offer our 'everyday, ordinary lives' to God as an offering, and to refuse conformity to the surrounding culture in favor of a 'renewing of the mind,' describes precisely what this step is asking for. John Maxwell calls this principle 'intentional living.' The transformation Paul describes is not cosmetic — it is from the inside out, producing a new mind that can discern and freely choose God's good and perfect will.

Recovery Tool Chest

The growing personal collection of spiritual, relational, emotional, and practical resources a person actively assembles throughout the recovery process. Just as a skilled craftsman does not tackle every job with a single tool, sustainable recovery requires a variety of tools deployed wisely. Step 7 asks us to take inventory of what is already in our tool chest — including what we've learned in previous steps — and to identify what we still need. This concept reflects John Maxwell's emphasis on intentional personal growth: we develop what we deliberately practice.

Humble Petition

A focused, specific, and repeatable act of prayer in which a person comes before God — not with vague spiritual language, but with clear and honest requests for help with named shortcomings. Humble petition is the engine of Step 7. It differs from casual prayer in its intentionality and its honesty: we are telling God exactly what we are struggling with and asking Him to do what we are unable to do. Fred Stoeker describes this as 'target-specific prayer' — aiming at the actual enemy, not a general spiritual fog.

Regress / Regression

The return to earlier, less healthy patterns of thinking or behavior during the recovery process — commonly known as relapse in the context of addiction. Regression is not the end of recovery; it is a predictable hazard that must be prepared for. Stephen Arterburn emphasizes in New Life Live that regression often follows stress, loss, or overconfidence. Understanding what conditions increase vulnerability to regression

allows us to build safeguards, practice prevention, and respond to slips with self-compassion rather than shame-fueled abandonment of the recovery process.

Surrender

The ongoing spiritual act of releasing control — of outcomes, of self-image, of shortcomings — into God's hands. Surrender is not passive resignation; it is the active, courageous decision to stop fighting God's work in us and to cooperate with it. Craig Groeschel describes surrender as 'the strongest thing a person can do' because it requires defeating the ego. In the recovery framework, surrender is not a one-time event at the beginning of a program — it is a daily posture renewed every morning, especially regarding the shortcomings we find most humiliating or most dear.

Character Defects

The specific, named flaws in a person's character — pride, resentment, dishonesty, fear, selfishness, and others — that are identified throughout the 12-step process and brought to God in Step 7 for removal and transformation. Cloud and Townsend note that character is not fixed — it is shaped by experience, and it can be reshaped by grace, community, and honest work. Character defects are not a verdict on a person's worth; they are a diagnosis that points toward a prescription: humbly asking God for the wisdom and strength to change.

Gratitude

The practiced discipline of recognizing and acknowledging what is good, right, and provided in one's life — even in the middle of difficulty. Gratitude is not a feeling to wait for; it is a practice to choose. Russell Brand, in his account of recovery, describes gratitude as a 'revolutionary act' for the addicted mind, which is wired to focus on lack and craving. Step 7 integrates gratitude deliberately because it reorients the heart toward what God has already done, which sustains the hope required to keep asking Him for what still needs to change.

Hope

The confident expectation that change is possible, that God is working, and that recovery is worth continuing — even on the hardest days. Hope is not optimism (a mood) nor wishful thinking (a fantasy); it is a theological anchor. Neil T. Anderson defines biblical hope as certainty about what God has promised, not uncertainty about what might happen. In Step 7, participants are asked to identify what restores hope and how to maximize those influences — because sustained recovery requires a sustained supply of hope, particularly when progress is slow or invisible.

Action Plan

The written, specific, and concrete set of behavioral commitments that translate Step 7's spiritual intentions into daily life. An action plan answers three questions: What do I need to stop doing? What do I need to start doing? What am I already doing that I need to improve? John Maxwell's leadership philosophy is built on this principle: vision without execution is hallucination. The Step 7 action plan makes recovery tangible, accountable, and measurable — turning a prayer into a plan and a plan into a practice.

Here are the lists of **Struggles, Shortcomings, and Sabotaging Behaviors** that you reviewed in Step 4 Review them again as you begin step 7 circling or marking the ones that you need to work on now, those that describe you (this is likely different from the three you worked on in Step 4..

Emotional

- **anger** — Intense displeasure or rage that flares up quickly and clouds judgment, often leading to outbursts or suppressed resentment.
- **anxiety / worry** — Chronic unease or catastrophic thinking about uncertain future events.
- **bitterness** — Lingering resentment from past hurts that poisons current outlook and relationships.
- **contempt** — Feeling superior disdain toward others or their actions, often shown through eye-rolling or dismissal.
- **cowardice** — Allowing fear to prevent taking necessary or courageous action in difficult situations.
- **despair / hopelessness** — Deep emotional resignation that makes positive change feel impossible.
- **emotional numbness / detachment** — Shutting down feelings as a defense against pain or vulnerability.
- **envy / enviousness** — Resentful longing for what others have (possessions, success, relationships), breeding dissatisfaction.
- **fear** — Overwhelming anxiety about potential harm, rejection, or failure that paralyzes decision-making.
- **guilt** — Persistent remorse or self-blame that lingers and creates feelings of unworthiness.
- **hate** — Deep, sustained hostility toward people, groups, or ideas, fueling destructive thoughts or actions.
- **impatience** — Frustration with delays or others' pace, leading to irritability and poor decisions under pressure.
- **insecurity** — Underlying feelings of inadequacy or unworthiness that fuel self-doubt.
- **jealousy** — Fear of losing something valuable (status, love, attention) to another person, often triggering suspicion.
- **malice** — Desire to see others harmed or suffer, even in subtle ways.
- **negative thinking** — Habitual focus on the worst-case scenarios or flaws in every situation.
- **over-sensitivity** — Taking neutral comments or events personally, resulting in emotional overreactions.
- **rage** — Explosive or intensely suppressed anger that overwhelms rational control.
- **resentment** — Holding onto grudges from perceived wrongs, replaying them mentally and blocking forgiveness.
- **self-pity** — Dwelling on one's own misfortunes with a "poor me" mindset that avoids responsibility.
- **shame (hurt pride)** — Painful feeling of humiliation or worthlessness triggered when ego is wounded.
- **timidity** — Excessive shyness or hesitation that prevents asserting oneself or pursuing opportunities.

- **vulgar immoral thinking** — Entertaining crude, degrading, or unethical thoughts that erode personal integrity.

Relational

- **bigotry** — Intolerant prejudice against people based on race, beliefs, or background.
- **blaming others** — Shifting responsibility for problems onto people around you.
- **boundary violations** — Disregarding others' personal limits or needs.
- **criticizing** — Habitually pointing out flaws in others, often to feel superior or deflect attention from self.
- **cruelty** — Deliberately causing emotional or physical pain to others without remorse.
- **defensiveness** — Automatically rejecting feedback or blame-shifting to protect ego.
- **domination** — Controlling or overpowering others to get one's own way in relationships.
- **exclusionary behavior** — Deliberately leaving others out or creating cliques.
- **gossiping** — Spreading rumors or private information about others, damaging trust.
- **insensitivity** — Failing to recognize or care about others' feelings or needs.
- **intolerance** — Refusing to accept differences in opinions, lifestyles, or beliefs.
- **judgmentalism** — Harshly evaluating or condemning others' worth or choices.
- **lack of empathy** — Difficulty understanding or caring about others' feelings.
- **manipulation** — Subtly controlling or exploiting others for personal gain.
- **meanness** — Being unkind or spiteful in words and actions toward others.
- **passive-aggressiveness** — Expressing hostility indirectly through sarcasm, silence, or procrastination.
- **people pleasing** — Over-accommodating others at the expense of one's own values or needs to gain approval.
- **pettiness** — Focusing on small slights or minor issues instead of what truly matters.
- **pugnacity (quarrelsome / combative)** — Being eager to argue or fight over trivial matters.
- **quarrelsome** — Frequently starting or engaging in unnecessary conflicts.
- **retaliation** — Responding to perceived wrongs with revenge or payback.
- **sarcasm** — Using cutting, mocking humor that hurts others under the guise of joking.
- **snobbery** — Looking down on others perceived as inferior in status, taste, or background.
- **violation of confidence** — Breaking trust by sharing secrets or betraying private information.

Behavioral

- **avoidance** — Dodging responsibilities, difficult conversations, or important tasks.
- **blame-shifting** (as a repeated action) — Habitually avoiding accountability through external excuses.
- **compulsive behaviors** — Repetitive actions driven by urges (e.g., scrolling, shopping, eating).

- **denial** — Refusing to acknowledge problems, mistakes, or realities that are uncomfortable.
- **disobedience** — Willfully ignoring rules, authority, or commitments.
- **gluttony** — Excessive overindulgence in food, drink, or consumption beyond healthy limits.
- **hoarding** — Compulsively holding onto possessions or resources out of fear of scarcity.
- **impulsivity** — Acting without thinking through consequences, leading to risky or regrettable choices.
- **inconsistency / unreliability** — Failing to follow through on commitments.
- **laziness / lack of discipline / undisciplined** — Avoiding effort or structure needed for growth and responsibilities.
- **lying / dishonesty** — Deliberately deceiving others or oneself to avoid consequences or gain advantage.
- **minimizing** — Downplaying the seriousness of one's actions, problems, or their impact.
- **obsession** — Fixating intensely on a single idea, person, or goal to the exclusion of balance.
- **overscheduling** — Packing too many activities into limited time, leading to burnout and stress.
- **over-ambition** — Pursuing success or status so aggressively that it harms health or relationships.
- **overworking / workaholism** — Using constant busyness to escape feelings or problems.
- **passivity** — Failing to take initiative or stand up for oneself when action is needed.
- **perfectionism** — Setting impossibly high standards that lead to paralysis or constant dissatisfaction.
- **procrastination** — Delaying important tasks, often until consequences become severe.
- **rumination** — Repeatedly dwelling on negative thoughts or past events without resolution.
- **self-neglect** — Failing to care for one's own physical, mental, or emotional needs.
- **stinginess** — Being unwilling to share time, money, or resources with others.
- **wastefulness** — Squandering resources, time, or opportunities carelessly.

Spiritual / Attitudinal

- **arrogance** — Haughty sense of superiority that dismisses others' value or input.
- **avarice (greed)** — Excessive desire for wealth or material gain at any cost.
- **covetousness** — Strong craving for what belongs to someone else.
- **cynicism** — Habitual distrust or negative assumptions about people and life.
- **distrust / lack of trust** — General suspicion of others' motives or reliability.
- **egotism** — Excessive focus on one's own importance or superiority.
- **entitlement** — Believing one deserves special treatment or outcomes without corresponding effort.
- **false pride** — Inflated self-image not based on reality, often masking insecurity.
- **grandiosity** — Inflated sense of self that alternates with feelings of inferiority.



- **greed** — Insatiable desire for more (money, power, attention) regardless of need.
- **impenitence** — Refusal to feel remorse or change harmful behavior.
- **indifference** — Apathy or lack of concern toward important moral or relational issues.
- **ingratitude** — Failure to appreciate what one has or what others do.
- **lack of humility** — Resistance to admitting limitations or needing help.
- **legalism** — Rigid adherence to rules while missing the spirit of compassion or grace.
- **low self-worth / worthlessness** — Core belief that one is fundamentally flawed or undeserving.
- **lust** — Uncontrolled craving for sexual gratification or other sensual excesses.
- **phoniness** — Pretending to be something one is not to impress or manipulate.
- **pride** — Excessive focus on self-importance that blocks humility and growth.
- **prudery** — Excessive or hypocritical modesty that judges others' normal behaviors harshly.
- **rigidity / stubbornness** — Unwillingness to consider new ideas, change, or feedback.
- **self-centeredness** — Viewing the world primarily through how it affects oneself.
- **self-condemnation** — Harsh, ongoing self-judgment that erodes self-worth.
- **self-importance** — Exaggerated belief in one's own significance or specialness.
- **self-justification** — Constantly rationalizing or excusing one's own faults or behaviors.
- **selflessness (in the sense of unhealthy or performative self-denial)** — Sacrificing oneself in ways that are manipulative, codependent, or avoidant of personal responsibility.
- **sentimentality** — Excessive or superficial emotional attachment that avoids real issues.
- **spiritual bypass** — Using spiritual concepts to avoid dealing with real emotions or issues.
- **vanity** — Excessive concern with appearance, admiration, or superficial image.



STEP 7: We humbly ask God for wisdom to equip us to overcome our shortcomings.

My Struggles, Shortcomings, and Sabotaging Behaviors

1. What Struggles, Shortcomings, and Sabotaging Behaviors will be most difficult to give up? In what order do you plan to give them up?
2. What kind of situations, stressors or pressures might cause you to regress back into your struggles, shortcomings, or sabotaging behaviors?
3. Where do you feel most supported and helped as you work your recovery?
4. What kinds of situations make you lose hope?

Can you avoid such situations? If so, then how?

5. What (person, situation, event, thought) restores your hope?

Is there a way to maximize those influences? If so, then how?

6. "What feelings from your past do you find yourself longing to recapture in your life?"

✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 

7. What can you do to lessen the likelihood of stress occurring? (You may want to refer to the 30 Tools to Build A Capacity For Stress [near the front of this notebook] as you thoughtfully and carefully answer this question.)

8. As you humble yourself in this step, what do you notice you're grateful for?

✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 

9. When do you think that life has been especially good for you? When did you have the greatest joy?

10. What would you wish for if you were granted three wishes? *{You can't wish for three more wishes}.*

1).

2).

3).

11. Describe what your typical day's activities would be if you knew that you had only one year to live.
12. Identify any barriers or distractions during the day(s) that hinder your recovery. How can you overcome these obstacles (What do you need to do or change?)
13. Have you made the correct decisions in the past about how to spend time with loved ones, in solitude and with your discretionary time? If not, how would you like to change it?
14. As you ask God to remove your shortcomings, what are you grateful He's already done?
15. What do you think that you can do to leave the world a better place and accomplish your mission in life? ✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 

AN ACT-PLAN TO FOR Struggles, Shortcomings, and Sabotaging Behaviors

Romans 12 ¹⁻² So here's what I want you to do, God helping you: Take your everyday, ordinary life—your sleeping, eating, going-to-work, and walking-around life—and place it before God as an offering. Embracing what God does for you is the best thing you can do for him. Don't become so well-adjusted to your culture that you fit into it without even thinking. Instead, fix your attention on God. You'll be changed from the inside out. Readily recognize what he wants from you and quickly respond to it. Unlike the culture around you, always dragging you down to its level of immaturity, God brings the best out of you, develops well-formed maturity in you.

1. As you voluntarily submit to every change God wants you to make in your recovery, how does Romans 12:1-2 help you know that real, positive change is possible?

 Write out the verses in your own words:

2. The first I in RESILIENTS says **Identify changes God wants me to make in my life and humbly ask for his wisdom to use the tools that He equips me with to make positive changes and overcome my struggles.**

You have identified them. Which Changes do you want to work on first? (Look back over your step 4 work, step 4 Top 10 list, and Step 4 Prayer requests to formulate this answer.)

 Will you work on them?

3. God's word teaches us that real change comes from the changing of our minds. We must take the positive action required to follow God's directions.

List the actions that you need to take to begin working on struggles, shortcomings, and sabotaging behaviors that you listed in question 2.

ACTION PLAN Refer back to your defects of character/ struggles, shortcomings, and sabotaging behaviors lists in steps 4, 6 and 7 :

I need to stop doing:

I need to start doing:

What do I need to improve that I may already be doing:

Explain what you think this quote means? ***“If you think you can be in control with your own willpower try eating a half a box of laxatives and see how that works out for you?”***

5. List the specific ways that you have turned from relying on your own willpower and are relying on God's will for your life.

6. What does the phrase "One day at a time" mean to you at this point in your recovery?

- How has this changed since you started this 12 Step Program?

- How can that apply to this step?

7. It has been stated that, "Recovery is not perfection; it is a process." Do you agree with that? Why?

8. What does humility mean to you?

9. How will being humble allow you to change?

✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 



RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

Step 7 Reading Comprehension Assessment

We humbly ask God for wisdom to equip us to overcome our shortcomings.

Name: _____ Date: _____ Step Leader: _____

Directions: Answer each question in your own words using what you read in Step 7. There are no trick questions — if you have read the material carefully, you will be able to answer each one. If you find yourself unsure, go back and re-read before answering.

SECTION 1 — CORE CONCEPTS

1. In your own words, what does Step 7 ask you to do? What is the difference between asking God to forgive your shortcomings and asking Him to equip you to overcome them?

2. Step 7 defines humility in a specific way. What is that definition, and why is humility described as necessary before real change can happen?

3. What is the difference between willpower and God's will as described in Step 7? Why does willpower alone tend to fail in long-term recovery?

4. What are "sabotaging behaviors"? Give two examples of what that might look like in everyday life.

SECTION 2 — KEY TERMS

5. What is a "Recovery Tool Chest"? Why does Step 7 ask you to take inventory of it?



6. How does Step 7 define "Humble Petition"? How is it different from casual, everyday prayer?

7. What is regression (also called relapse), and what does the material say about how to respond to it when it happens?

8. Step 7 says gratitude is "a practice to choose" rather than a feeling to wait for. Why is gratitude included as part of this step?

SECTION 3 — SCRIPTURE & APPLICATION

9. What passage of Scripture is called the "biblical anchor" of Step 7, and what does it say we must do in order for real change to happen?

10. The Step 7 Action Plan asks three specific questions. What are they? Why does the material say that vision without execution is "hallucination"?

11. Looking back at the Essential Questions at the beginning of Step 7, list them in your own words. Which one do you feel is most important for where you are right now in recovery, and why?



SECTION 4 — PERSONAL REFLECTION

12. From the lists of Struggles, Shortcomings, and Sabotaging Behaviors in Step 7, name at least three that you circled or marked as ones you need to work on. Why those?

13. What two tools were added to your tool chest in Step 7? Briefly describe each one in your own words.

If you were unable to answer any question above, return to the Step 7 material, find the answer, and write it in before submitting this assessment to your step leader.

Resilients In Recovery® Transformation Curriculum | Step 7 Assessment

Step 7 Comprehensive Essay Question

Resilients in Recovery® — Step 7 Essay Assessment *We humbly asked God for wisdom to equip us to overcome our shortcomings.*

Essay Prompt:

Step 7 is one of the most inward and transformative steps of the entire Resilients in Recovery program. It called you to move beyond identifying your struggles, shortcomings, and sabotaging behaviors — and into the courageous, humble posture of surrendering them to God and actively building the resources needed to overcome them. In a well-developed, thoughtful essay, respond to *all four parts* below, writing in complete sentences and drawing specifically from your own experience working this step.

Part 1 — Surrender and Humility: The Heart of Step 7

Describe the moment or process of humbling yourself before God in this step. What did it mean for you personally to move from *managing* your shortcomings to genuinely *surrendering* them? Identify at least two specific struggles, shortcomings, or sabotaging behaviors from your Step 7 work that you brought before God in humble petition. How did practicing *humble petition* — naming specific shortcomings honestly and repeatedly

in prayer rather than relying on willpower alone — change your approach to those areas? What did you discover about the difference between your own willpower and God's will as you worked through this step?

Part 2 — Patterns, the Renewing Mind, and Your Action Plan

Step 7 asked you to recognize the *patterns* in your addictive and destructive behaviors — the repeated sequences of thought, feeling, and action that form the grooves of old ways of living. Describe at least two patterns you were able to identify and name through this step's work. Why is naming a pattern so important to changing it? Then, drawing from your Action Plan, explain what you committed to *stop doing*, what you committed to *start doing*, and what you are working to *improve*. How does Romans 12:1–2 — the anchor scripture of this step — give you confidence that the inside-out transformation your action plan is aimed at is genuinely possible?

Part 3 — Recovery Tool Chest: What You Added

A core concept in Step 7 is the *Recovery Tool Chest* — the growing personal collection of spiritual, relational, emotional, and practical resources you build throughout the recovery process. Skilled recovery, like skilled craftsmanship, requires the right tools deployed at the right time. In this section, do two things:

First, inventory what tools you brought *into* Step 7 — that is, identify at least two meaningful tools or insights you carried forward from your previous steps that helped you do the work of Step 7.

Second, describe in your own words the two tools that Step 7 specifically added to your tool chest: **Humble Petition** and **Tool Chest Inventory**. How do you intend to use each of these tools going forward in your recovery? Give a concrete, real-life example of a situation or trigger where you could deploy one of these tools instead of reverting to an old pattern.

Part 4 — Growth, Gratitude, and Hope

Looking back at where you started this step and where you stand now, describe the transformation or growth you experienced — spiritually, emotionally, mentally, or behaviorally. What are you most grateful that God has already done in your recovery, and how has practicing gratitude in this step reoriented your heart? What specific people, situations, thoughts, or practices restore your hope on the hard days — and what have you done or will you do to maximize those influences? Finally, in one or two sentences, write a personal statement of commitment that captures what you are carrying out of Step 7 and into the rest of your recovery journey.

Your essay should be written thoughtfully and honestly, in your own voice. There are no perfect answers — only true ones. Length should reflect the depth of your work in this step



TOP 10 THINGS I LEARNED WORKING THIS STEP THAT I CAN APPLY TO MY LIFE.

(Write These in Complete Sentences)

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

10.

As you work through each step you will discover things that you need to ask God to help you with. Write those items on this page as you go.

Also write prayer needs for others.

Refer to this page at your prayer time.

Things to Pray About Regarding my Own Recovery	Others Who Need Prayer (and why)

TO COMPLETE THIS STEP, GO BACK TO THE ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS PAGE AT THE BEGINNING OF THIS STEP, READ THEM AGAIN. THE BACK OF THAT PAGE IS BLANK. WRITE OUT YOUR ANSWERS IN COMPLETE SENTENCES LIKE AND ESSAY OR IN PARAGRAPHS (BUT WRITE THE QUESTION NUMBERS BESIDE EACH ANSWER SO THAT YOU ANSWER EACH QUESTION FULLY ABOUT YOUR SELF).

CHECK HERE WHEN YOU HAVE DO THIS INDICATING THAT THIS STEP IS COMPLETE.

☐


THIS STEP IS COMPLETE INCLUDING ALL ANSWERS, TOP TEN LIST, ESSENTIAL QUESTION ANSWERS)

Day

Date

Participant Signature

Sponsor/ Step Leader Signature

Praying in the Form of Writing

Write a letter to God, asking for clarity and understanding regarding the specific aspect of your life.



Heavenly Father,

Thank you for the learning opportunities you have given me in this step. This week I have realized that I am especially grateful for (you might include some items from your gratitude lists):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

In this Step, with your guidance I have begun to learn (*list those things on your Top 10 list from this Step*)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

I ask now that you give me even more clarity at understanding in these areas, and especially in the area of

You tell me in your Word, The Bible, to come to you with my needs, so that is what I am doing now. I seek your wisdom and guidance with (mention all the things from your prayer request list from the previous page):

I ask that you give me a sense of willingness to allow you to work in my life so that I can heal and so that I may find my purpose and become the person you would have me be.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.

-
- Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise during writing this prayer and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive.

Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise as you read this prayer aloud praying with your step leader/ sponsor (and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive).

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



STEP

EIGHT



Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP EIGHT

STEP 8: We make a list of all persons we have harmed & we become willing to make amends to them all.

- *“Do to others as you would have them do to you.” — Luke 6:31*
- *“God blesses those people who make peace. They will be called his children!” — Matthew 5:9*

HEBREWS IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® — STARTING IN THE BOOK OF HEBREWS

Choose *TWO* items (A–L) to implement while working Step 8. Select items *NOT* already in practice.

First Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

Second Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

TOOLS I ACQUIRE WORKING STEP 8

- **Amends List** — Writing a complete, honest list of all persons harmed, building capacity for accountability, relational honesty, and willingness to repair
- **Willingness to Make Amends** — Developing the heart posture of readiness to make things right, even before the actual amends take place

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

12 Step TRANSFORMATION Curriculum • VER 7.1

Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP EIGHT — Essential Questions & Prayer

STEP 8 ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS

I	What is Grace?
II	Who have I harmed due to my addictive behaviors (or ever in my life)?
III	What have I learned about forgiveness?
IV	What does it mean to make amends?
V	What hurts am I still holding on to?

STEP 8 PRAYER

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for today. Thank You for giving me the tools to work my program and live my life differently, centered in Your will. Make me aware of the times that I need to make things right in relationships and interactions with others.

I renounce ancestral addictions per Exodus 20:5, breaking their hold through Christ's blood.

Lord, help me to make my amends promptly and ask for forgiveness. In all my relationships today help me to do my part in making them healthy.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.



RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® | STEP 8 — KEY TERMS & DEFINITIONS

We make a list of all persons we have harmed and become willing to make amends to them all.

The following terms are foundational to your work in Step Eight. Read through them before meeting with your sponsor. Understanding these concepts will deepen your honesty as you build your amends list and cultivate the willingness that this step requires. These are not merely vocabulary — they are the framework through which healing, accountability, and restored relationships become possible.

1. Amends

A deliberate, concrete action taken to repair harm done to another person — going beyond an apology to make things as right as possible. An amends is not merely saying "I'm sorry"; it is a behavioral and relational repair. Where an apology addresses the speaker's guilt, an amends addresses the injury the other person actually suffered. Stephen Arterburn describes authentic amends as the moment recovery moves from internal work to external integrity — where the inner transformation becomes visible in restored relationships and repaired damage. Step Eight begins the preparation for this; Step Nine is the execution.

2. Willingness

The internal posture of readiness to act rightly — even before you feel fully prepared, comfortable, or certain of the outcome. Willingness is not the absence of fear; it is the decision to move in the right direction despite it. Step Eight does not ask you to make amends yet; it asks you to become willing. Russell Brand describes willingness as the cracking open of the old, ego-defended self — the moment we stop protecting our comfort and start prioritizing our integrity. Craig Groeschel would say willingness is the gateway to transformation: nothing God does in us happens until we are open to it.

3. Harm

Any damage — emotional, relational, financial, physical, or spiritual — caused to another person through our addictive behaviors, our dishonesty, our selfishness, or our neglect. Harm in Step Eight is examined honestly and without minimizing. It includes what we did directly, what we failed to do, and the ripple effects our behavior had on people who depended on or trusted us. Neil T. Anderson reminds us that unacknowledged harm leaves both the harmed and the one who caused the harm bound — confession and repair break that bondage in both directions. Facing the full scope of harm honestly is itself an act of courage and spiritual health.

4. Grace

The unearned, unconditional favor of God — freely given not because of merit, but because of His character. Grace is the theological foundation of Step Eight: it is what makes it possible to look honestly at a list of people you have harmed without collapsing into shame or abandoning the process in despair. Grace does not minimize harm; it creates the safety in which harm can be fully acknowledged. Henry Cloud and John Townsend describe grace as the relational environment in which growth actually occurs — truth without grace crushes; grace without truth enables. Step Eight depends on both: the grace to look clearly, and the truth to look completely.

5. Forgiveness

The intentional decision to release another person — or oneself — from the debt created by harm, and to relinquish the right to hold that harm as leverage. The Step Eight material identifies three dimensions of forgiveness that must all be engaged: receiving God's forgiveness, forgiving those who have harmed you, and forgiving yourself. Skipping any one of these three leaves a person emotionally and spiritually stuck. Forgiveness does not erase consequences or deny that real harm occurred — it releases the weight of resentment that continues to injure the one carrying it. As John 19:30 declares, "It is finished" — the debt has been paid at the cross, and forgiveness becomes possible for every honest person who reaches for it.

6. Resentment

Unresolved anger, bitterness, or grievance held against a person, institution, or situation perceived as having caused harm. Resentment is one of the most dangerous forces in recovery — it is consistently identified as a primary relapse trigger. Neil T. Anderson describes it as a "root of bitterness" (Hebrews 12:15) that defiles not only the holder but everyone in their orbit. Step Eight requires examining resentments toward people on the amends list, because unprocessed resentment distorts willingness: it is very difficult to become willing to repair harm to someone you are still actively resenting. Naming resentments honestly — and working toward releasing them — is part of becoming truly willing.

7. Guilt

The honest recognition that you have done something wrong — that a specific action, behavior, or pattern has caused real harm to yourself or others. Guilt is healthy when it is proportionate and truth-based; it is the signal that integrity has been violated. It differs from shame in that guilt says "I did something wrong" rather than "I am something wrong." In the recovery framework, guilt is not an enemy — it is a compass. Craig Groeschel notes that guilt is the precondition for repentance and repair: you cannot make right what you will not acknowledge was wrong. Step Eight requires sitting honestly with guilt about specific people and specific harms rather than either numbing it or weaponizing it against yourself.

8. Shame

The toxic, corrosive belief that you are not merely someone who has done wrong things, but that you are fundamentally defective, unworthy, and disqualified from belonging. Shame differs from guilt in its target: guilt addresses behavior; shame attacks identity. Russell Brand identifies shame as the core wound beneath most addictive behavior — the engine that drives compulsive use and relentless self-destruction. In Step Eight, shame is the force that tries to prevent honest list-making: it convinces us that looking clearly at the harm we've caused is too devastating to survive. The antidote to shame is not avoidance — it is being fully known (by God, by a sponsor, by oneself) and fully accepted anyway. Grace makes that possible.

9. Ancestral Patterns

The inherited, generational tendencies toward specific addictions, relational dysfunctions, or destructive behaviors that are transmitted through family systems across multiple generations. Exodus 20:5 addresses this reality directly: the consequences of sin can ripple through "three or four generations." Step Eight's invitation to map your family tree and renounce ancestral addictions through Christ's blood is not superstitious — it is a holistic acknowledgment that our struggles did not begin with us, and that healing which addresses only the individual may leave deeper roots untouched. Neil T. Anderson's framework in *The Bondage Breaker* and *The Steps to Freedom in Christ* speaks directly to breaking generational strongholds as part of genuine, lasting recovery.



10. Amends List

The written, specific inventory of persons harmed — compiled honestly and without omission — that forms the core work product of Step Eight. The amends list is not a list of apologies; it is a relational accounting. For each person listed, the step asks you to name how they were harmed as an individual and how your behavior damaged your relationship with them. It then asks you to identify possible amends — what repair might look like in each case — and to prioritize the list by level of difficulty. John Maxwell's principle applies here: "You cannot improve what you do not evaluate." The amends list makes accountability concrete, visible, and actionable.

11. Prioritization

The process of ordering your amends list by difficulty, risk, or relational sensitivity — so that you and your sponsor can approach the work of Step Nine in a thoughtful, prepared, and sustainable sequence. Step Eight does not require you to complete all amends at once; it requires you to become willing to make all of them, and to begin thinking through them with wisdom. Prioritization also involves honestly examining the consequences you fear: What is the worst that can happen? What is the best? What is most likely? Sitting with these questions — rather than avoiding them — is one of the most important forms of emotional and spiritual preparation this step asks of you.

12. Reconciliation

The restoration of a broken or damaged relationship to a state of mutual goodwill — a possible outcome of the amends process, but not a guaranteed one and not required for the amends to be valid. Reconciliation requires a willing response from the other party; an amends requires only honesty and willingness from you. Cloud and Townsend draw this distinction clearly: you are responsible for your side of the relationship, not for the other person's response. Making an amends that is received with hostility or indifference is still a valid amends. The goal of Step Eight and Nine is integrity and repair — not the management of how others respond to your honesty.

13. Self-Forgiveness

The process of releasing the self from the ongoing condemnation, punishment, and self-contempt that linger after guilt and shame have done their work. Self-forgiveness is one of the three dimensions of forgiveness identified in Step Eight — and often the most difficult. Many people in recovery find it easier to believe God has forgiven them than to forgive themselves. Stephen Arterburn and Neil T. Anderson both address this: self-condemnation that persists after genuine repentance is not humility — it is a refusal to receive the grace that Christ purchased. The work of becoming willing to make amends includes becoming willing to forgive yourself, because a person who cannot accept their own forgiveness struggles to extend genuine amends to others.

14. Holistic Healing

Recovery that addresses not only the surface behavior of addiction but its relational, spiritual, emotional, generational, and physical roots — so that healing is comprehensive rather than cosmetic. Step Eight contributes to holistic healing by asking participants to face not just what the addiction cost them, but what it cost others — and to include generational patterns (Exodus 20:5) in their healing work. Ken D. Berry, M.D. would note that the body itself carries the weight of unprocessed harm and unrepaired relationships; healing that bypasses the relational and spiritual dimensions never reaches the roots. Holistic healing is the goal of the RnR curriculum as a whole, and Step Eight is one of its most powerful contributors.

STEP 8: We make a list of all persons we have harmed & we become willing to make amends to them all.

WHAT ABOUT GRACE?

1. How have you hurt yourself by practicing your addiction?

2. What important relationships did you destroy or damage because of your addictive behaviors?

3. How much time and energy have you lost from your addictive behaviors?

4. Interpret what this scripture means to you: "You are not to bow down and serve any image, for I, the Eternal your God, am a jealous God. As for those who are not loyal to Me, their children will endure the consequences of their sins for three or four generations." Exodus 20:5

5. Map your family tree and pray: "**I renounce ancestral addictions per Exodus 20:5, breaking their hold through Christ's blood.**" Include these in your amends list for holistic healing.

Make a list of all those that you have possibly harmed by your addictive behaviors. List the effect on them as individuals and on your relationship.

Take the list of people that you have harmed and make a list of possible amends for each one of them.

From the list of possible amends, choose the ones that seem most appropriate, and mark them according to level of difficulty. Prioritize them.



- What consequences do you fear in making amends?
✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.*

- What is the worst thing that can happen?

- What is the best thing that can happen?

- What is likely to happen?

- Do you feel angry or resentful towards any people on your amends list? If so, write them a letter of anger, **but don't send it to them.**

- Describe here any other ways that you have used to get rid of anger and resentment towards anyone on your list.

- Describe any dreams that relate to making amends to others.

What does forgiveness mean to you?

There are three areas of forgiveness. If you miss or skip one area of forgiveness you will never be free of your resentment, anger, fears, shame, or guilt. Answer these three questions:

- Have you accepted God's forgiveness? He paid the intimate price for sin on the cross...

YES NO

- Have you forgiven those who have hurt you? Forgiving does not excuse the harm they have done. It simply allows you to let go and move on...

YES NO

- Have you forgiven yourself?

YES NO

- The act of forgiveness sounds simple and for the most part, it is. The hard part comes in arriving at the decision to forgive. But until you make the conscious decision to accept God's forgiveness, grant forgiveness to others and yourself you will remain stuck. Are you ready to embrace forgiveness?

YES NO

1. As you look at the three areas of forgiveness, which one of them is the easiest for you to accept? Why?
2. Which area of forgiveness is the most difficult for you to accept? Why?

3. What do the words of Christ found in John 19:30 “It is finished” mean to you?

4. What hurt(s) from a past relationship are you still holding on to?

5. How can you begin to let go of the hurt(s)? Be specific.
✠ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.*

6. How have you been blaming God for harmful actions that others took against you?

7. Do you owe God an amends? When will you give it?
✠ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.*

8. What past actions in your life do you still feel guilt or shame about? List them, pray for them, and work on them in the next lesson.
✠ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.*

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

Step 8 —Comprehension Assessment

Answer each question in complete sentences based on what you read in Step 8.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Directions: All answers must come directly from the Step 8 material. If you are unsure of an answer, go back and re-read the step before continuing.

1. What is the statement of Step 8 in its own words? (The step itself defines what you are called to do — write it out.)

2. According to the material, what are the three areas of forgiveness that must ALL be addressed in order to be free from resentment, anger, fear, shame, or guilt?

3. What does the Step 8 material say about what forgiveness does NOT do — and what it does allow you to do?

4. The material references Exodus 20:5. What does this scripture address, and how does the curriculum connect it to recovery work?



5. What two tools are listed in the 'Tools Added to My Tool Chest' section for Step 8, and what does each one build?

6. The material instructs you to prioritize your amends list by level of difficulty and then asks three questions about consequences. What are those three questions?

7. What scripture references are listed at the opening of Step 8, and what theme do they share?

8. The material asks whether you owe God an amends. In your own words, explain what you think this means based on your reading of the step.

Step 8 Comprehensive Essay Question

Resilients in Recovery® — Step 8: "We make a list of all persons we have harmed, and we become willing to make amends to them all."

Essay Prompt:

Step 8 invites you into one of the most courageous and spiritually grounding seasons of your recovery — the work of honest reckoning, forgiveness, and willingness. In a well-developed, thoughtful essay, reflect on your personal journey through this step by addressing each of the following dimensions in your own words:



Part 1 — Facing the Harm with Honesty and Grace Describe the process of creating your amends list. What did it mean for you personally to honestly face the ways your addictive behaviors harmed yourself, damaged important relationships, and cost you time, energy, and opportunity? What did you discover about yourself as you examined the full scope of your impact on others? How did the concept of *grace* — both receiving it from God and extending it to yourself — shape your ability to look clearly at this list without collapsing into shame or denial?

Part 2 — Confronting the Roots: Ancestral Patterns and Personal Accountability Reflect on Exodus 20:5 and the exercise of mapping your family tree. What did you discover about generational patterns of addiction or broken relationships in your family history? How did renouncing ancestral addictions through Christ's blood — and including these in your amends list — bring a new depth or dimension to your understanding of your own struggle and your path toward holistic healing?

Part 3 — The Three Dimensions of Forgiveness Step 8 teaches that forgiveness must move in three directions — receiving God's forgiveness, forgiving those who have hurt you, and forgiving yourself — and that skipping any one of them leaves a person stuck. Which of these three was the most difficult for you, and why? How did Christ's words in John 19:30, "*It is finished*," speak into the guilt, shame, or resentment you were still carrying? Describe what you are releasing and what you are choosing to embrace as a result of this step.

Part 4 — Becoming Willing Willingness is at the heart of Step 8 — you are not yet making the amends, but you are becoming *willing*. Describe your process of working through the fears and resentments connected to your amends list. What consequences did you fear? What did you discover when you honestly asked, "What is the worst that can happen? What is the best that can happen? What is likely to happen?" How has this process of becoming willing — even before acting — changed the condition of your heart?

Part 5 — New Tools Added to Your Recovery Toolkit As a result of completing Step 8, identify and explain the new tools you have added to your recovery toolkit. At minimum, reflect on the two tools specifically highlighted in this step — *building a complete Amends List* and *cultivating Willingness to Make Amends* — and describe how each one equips you to walk in greater accountability, relational honesty, and spiritual freedom going forward. Are there any additional insights, practices, or perspectives from this step that you would add to your personal toolkit? Explain why each one matters for your continued recovery.

Part 6 — Your Top 10 and Looking Forward Drawing from your Top 10 list, summarize the most significant lessons from this step that you intend to carry into your daily life. Close your essay with a reflection on how the prayer of Step 8 — asking God to make you aware when you need to make things right in your relationships and interactions — represents a new posture you are committing to in your life and recovery.

Write in complete sentences and full paragraphs. Be specific and personal — this is your story, your transformation, and your testimony of growth.

This question is designed to draw out not only what the participant *did* in the step but what genuinely shifted inside them — covering accountability, ancestral healing, forgiveness theology, fear-facing, and the practical tools they now carry forward.



TOP 10 THINGS I LEARNED WORKING THIS STEP THAT I CAN APPLY TO MY LIFE.

(Write These in Complete Sentences)

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

10.

As you work through each step you will discover things that you need to ask God to help you with. Write those items on this page as you go.

Also write prayer needs for others.

Refer to this page at your prayer time.

Things to Pray About Regarding my Own Recovery	Others Who Need Prayer (and why)

TO COMPLETE THIS STEP, GO BACK TO THE ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS PAGE AT THE BEGINNING OF THIS STEP, READ THEM AGAIN. THE BACK OF THAT PAGE IS BLANK. WRITE OUT YOUR ANSWERS IN COMPLETE SENTENCES LIKE AND ESSAY OR IN PARAGRAPHS (BUT WRITE THE QUESTION NUMBERS BESIDE EACH ANSWER SO THAT YOU ANSWER EACH QUESTION FULLY ABOUT YOUR SELF).

CHECK HERE WHEN YOU HAVE DO THIS INDICATING THAT THIS STEP IS COMPLETE.

☐


THIS STEP IS COMPLETE INCLUDING ALL ANSWERS, TOP TEN LIST, ESSENTIAL QUESTION ANSWERS)

Day

Date

Participant Signature

Sponsor/ Step Leader Signature



Praying in the Form of Writing

Write a letter to God, asking for clarity and understanding regarding the specific aspect of your life.



Heavenly Father,

Thank you for the learning opportunities you have given me in this step. This week I have realized that I am especially grateful for (you might include some items from your gratitude lists):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

In this Step, with your guidance I have begun to learn (*list those things on your Top 10 list from this Step*)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

I ask now that you give me even more clarity at understanding in these areas, and especially in the area of

You tell me in your Word, The Bible, to come to you with my needs, so that is what I am doing now. I seek your wisdom and guidance with (mention all the things from your prayer request list from the previous page):

I ask that you give me a sense of willingness to allow you to work in my life so that I can heal and so that I may find my purpose and become the person you would have me be.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.

-
- Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise during writing this prayer and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive.

Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise as you read this prayer aloud praying with your step leader/ sponsor (and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive).

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



STEP NINE



Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP NINE

STEP 9: We make direct amends to such people whenever possible, except when doing so would injure them or others.

- “23 So if you are about to place your gift on the altar and remember that someone is angry with you 24 leave your gift there in front of the altar. Make peace with that person, then come back and offer your gift to God.” — Matthew 5:23–24

HEBREWS IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® — STARTING IN THE BOOK OF HEBREWS

Choose *TWO* items (A–L) to implement while working Step 9. Select items *NOT* already in practice.

First Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

Second Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

TOOLS I ACQUIRE WORKING STEP 9

- **Direct Amends** — Making face-to-face, concrete repair of harm done to others wherever possible, which releases guilt and rebuilds integrity
- **Discernment in Amends** — Learning to determine when making amends might cause further harm to innocent third parties and responding wisely



RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

12 Step TRANSFORMATION Curriculum • VER 7.1

Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP NINE — Essential Questions & Prayer

STEP 9 ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS

I	How have I experienced grace in my recovery?
II	How do I show that same grace to others?
III	What amends have you already made before starting the steps?
IV	Exactly how did I harm the people who I listed in Step 8?
V	What do I need to say and do for each amend?
VI	How did it go and how did I feel making amends?

STEP 9 PRAYER

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for Your love, for your freely given grace. Help me model Your ways when I make amends to those who I've hurt and offer my forgiveness to those who have injured me.

Help me to set aside my selfishness and speak the truth in Love. I pray that You would help me and guide me to focus only on my part, my responsibility in the issue.

I know that there will be some on my list to who it will be difficult for me to make amends. I ask for Your courage leading me to be willing to make amends.

Help me to become willing to forgive others just as You first forgave me. Thank You for loving me.

I ask that when time comes for me to make amends that You guide me and my sponsor as we discuss how and when to make amends. I trust you to guide us in this process.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.



RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

Step 9 — Key Terms & Definitions

"We make direct amends to such people whenever possible, except when doing so would injure them or others."

The following terms are foundational to your work in this step. Read through them before meeting with your sponsor. Understanding these concepts will deepen your engagement with Step Nine and equip you to do its work honestly, courageously, and thoroughly.

1. Direct Amends

The personal, face-to-face act of acknowledging the specific harm caused to another person and taking concrete action to repair it — going beyond an apology to actual restitution where possible. A direct amends is distinguished from an apology in that an apology addresses the speaker's guilt, while an amends addresses the injury the other person actually suffered. Stephen Arterburn describes authentic amends as the moment recovery moves from internal work to external integrity — where the inner transformation becomes visible in restored relationships and repaired damage. Step Eight begins the preparation; Step Nine is the execution.

2. Willingness

The internal posture of readiness to act rightly — even before you feel fully prepared, comfortable, or certain of the outcome. Willingness is not the absence of fear; it is the decision to move in the right direction despite it. Russell Brand describes willingness as the cracking open of the old, ego-defended self — the moment we stop protecting our comfort and start prioritizing our integrity. Craig Groeschel frames it as the gateway to transformation: nothing God does in us happens until we are open to it. In Step Nine, willingness moves from the theoretical (Step Eight) into active, lived engagement.

3. Harm

Any damage — emotional, relational, financial, physical, or spiritual — caused to another person through addictive behaviors, dishonesty, selfishness, or neglect. In Step Nine, harm is no longer merely catalogued — it is directly addressed. Neil T. Anderson reminds us that unacknowledged harm leaves both the harmed and the one who caused the harm spiritually and emotionally bound. The act of making amends breaks that bondage in both directions. Facing the full scope of harm and moving toward repair is itself an act of courage and spiritual health.

4. Grace

The unearned, unconditional favor of God — freely given not because of merit, but because of His character. Grace is the theological foundation that makes Step Nine possible: it provides the courage to stand before someone you have hurt, confess the harm, and offer repair without demanding a particular response. Henry Cloud and John Townsend describe grace as the relational environment in which genuine growth occurs. Romans 5:2 grounds Step Nine in grace — we have been brought into "this place of highest privilege" not by our performance but by God's freely given love, and it is from that position of security that we make our amends.

5. Amends

A deliberate, specific act of repair offered to a person you have harmed — encompassing acknowledgment, accountability, and where possible, concrete restitution. Amends is not synonymous with apology. An apology can be a performance; an amends is a commitment to change. The Step Nine material instructs participants to write out their amends, read them to a sponsor, role-play the encounter, and then make them in person. Fred Stoeker's work on integrity highlights that genuine amends requires bringing your whole self — not a curated, defensive version — to the moment of repair.

6. Exception Clause

The critical qualifier embedded in Step Nine's statement: "except when doing so would injure them or others." Not every amends can or should be made directly. Some would reopen wounds, expose others to harm, or create damage greater than the original injury. John Townsend and Henry Cloud's boundaries framework applies here — discernment is required to determine whether an amends protects or harms. This clause is not an escape hatch for avoiding discomfort; it is a safeguard against well-intentioned but harmful action. This distinction must be worked through honestly with a sponsor.



7. Accountability

The willingness to own the full weight of your actions — their causes, their consequences, and their impact on others — without deflection, minimization, or shifting blame. In Step Nine, accountability becomes relational and visible: it is no longer enough to acknowledge harm privately; it must be acknowledged to the person harmed. John Maxwell's principle applies: "You cannot improve what you do not evaluate." Accountability is the engine of sustainable recovery because it closes the gap between who you were and who you are becoming. Neil T. Anderson frames it as standing in the truth about yourself before God and others.

8. Restitution

The act of restoring — to the degree possible — what was taken, damaged, or destroyed through your addictive behaviors. Restitution is the most concrete expression of an amends: repaying money borrowed or stolen, replacing what was broken, fulfilling neglected responsibilities, or returning what was withheld. Ken D. Berry, M.D. would note that the body and mind carry the unresolved weight of unpaid debts — emotional, relational, and material — and that the act of restitution produces a physiological and psychological release that confession alone cannot. Where full restitution is impossible, a genuine acknowledgment and a commitment to change serves as its functional equivalent.

9. Integrity

The alignment of your inner life — your values, beliefs, and commitments — with your outer life — your words, actions, and relationships. Integrity is the ultimate goal of Step Nine: not merely making peace with others, but becoming a person whose inner and outer worlds are no longer divided. Stephen Arterburn describes authentic recovery as moving from internal transformation to external integrity. Craig Groeschel would add that integrity is not what you do when people are watching — it is what you do when no one is. Step Nine closes the gap opened by years of double living and begins to build the unified self that genuine recovery requires.

10. Forgiveness

The intentional decision to release another person — or oneself — from the debt created by harm, and to relinquish the right to hold that harm as leverage. Forgiveness in Step Nine operates in three directions simultaneously: receiving God's forgiveness, extending forgiveness to those who have hurt you, and forgiving yourself. Skipping any one of these three leaves a person emotionally and spiritually stuck in ways that eventually threaten sobriety. Forgiveness does not erase consequences or deny that real harm occurred — it releases the weight of resentment. As John 19:30 declares, "It is finished" — the debt has been paid, and forgiveness becomes possible for every honest person who reaches for it.

11. Reconciliation

The restoration of a broken or damaged relationship to a state of mutual goodwill — a possible outcome of the amends process, but not a guaranteed one, and not required for the amends to be valid. Reconciliation requires a willing response from the other party; an amends requires only honesty and willingness from you. Cloud and Townsend draw this boundary clearly: you are responsible for your side of the relationship, not for the other person's response. Making an amends that is received with hostility, indifference, or refusal is still a valid amends. The goal of Step Nine is integrity and repair — not the management of how others respond to your honesty.

12. Avoidance

The conscious or unconscious strategy of delaying, circumventing, or rationalizing your way out of making an amends that needs to be made — often disguised as concern for the other person's wellbeing. Step Nine asks the confronting question directly: "Am I avoiding some by pretending that it might do harm?" Avoidance is the most sophisticated form of self-protection in recovery because it wears the costume of wisdom. Russell Brand identifies avoidance as the ego's last stand — the refusal to be fully exposed and fully accountable. Avoidance is addressed in Step Nine by preparation with a sponsor, role-playing, and honest self-examination about what fears are actually driving the delay.

13. Creative Amends

Alternate forms of repair made when a direct amends is impossible — because the person has died, cannot be located, is in a protected relationship, or would be harmed by direct contact. Creative amends may include writing a letter that is never sent, making a contribution in the person's name, performing acts of service to honor the relationship, or living differently in ways that repair the relational damage indirectly. John Maxwell's leadership principle is instructive: when the ideal path is blocked, creative leaders find another path that honors the same destination. A creative amends is not a lesser amends — it is the full expression of accountability adapted to real-world constraints.

14. Self-Ownership

The discipline of focusing exclusively on your part in a harmful situation — without minimizing your role, without referencing the other person's wrongs, and without using the amends encounter as an opportunity to air grievances or assign blame. Step Nine instructs clearly: focus only on your part, your responsibility. Henry Cloud and John Townsend would describe self-ownership as one of the most fundamental capacities of emotional health — the ability to hold your own space without encroaching on another person's. Neil T. Anderson frames it spiritually: you stand before another person as someone already fully known and fully forgiven by God, which makes you free to own your part completely without needing to defend yourself.

15. Relational Repair

The gradual, sustained process of rebuilding trust, safety, and goodwill in a relationship that has been damaged by addictive behavior — extending beyond the single act of an amends into a commitment to consistent, changed conduct over time. Cloud and Townsend are explicit: trust is not rebuilt by declarations but by demonstrated patterns of behavior sustained over time. Step Nine initiates relational repair; continued sobriety and changed character sustain it. Craig Groeschel would note that the words of an amends plant a seed, but only the fruit of a changed life proves the root has actually changed. Relational repair is the long game of recovery — and it is among the most powerful testimonies of transformation.



STEP 9: We make direct amends to such people whenever possible, except when doing so would injure them or others.

HOW DO I MAKE AMENDS?

Step 9 says we make direct amends to such people whenever possible, except when doing so would injure them or others.

Therefore, if you bring your gift to the altar and there remember that your brother or sister has something against you, 24 leave your gift at the altar and go. First make things right with your brother or sister and then come back and offer your gift. Matthew 5:23-24

Now apologize. Unless that would make things worse. -Russell Brand

Ask yourself:

- | | | |
|---|------------|-----------|
| 1 Am I willing to change? | YES | NO |
| 2 Am I willing to change in ways I may not be aware of or in control of? | YES | NO |
| 3 Am I willing to address each harm that I am aware of? | YES | NO |
| 4 Am I being completely honest with my mentor about the nature of the harm? | YES | NO |
| 5 Will I thoroughly prepare / review each amends with my sponsor? | YES | NO |
| 6 Am I willing to complete all my amends using creative solutions for individuals I can't meet? | YES | NO |
| 7 Is finishing my amends a top priority in my life? | YES | NO |
| 9 Am I avoiding some by pretending that it might do harm? | YES | NO |

1. How has God used your weaknesses and turned them into strengths?

2. How can you receive God's gift of grace? (Romans 5:2)

For because of our faith, he has brought us into this place of highest privilege where we now stand, and we confidently and joyfully look forward to actually becoming all that God has had in mind for us to be.

✠ Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now. ✍

3. How can you model God's gift of grace in making your amends?
4. In what ways have you experienced God's grace in your recovery?
5. God loved and accepted us while we were still sinners (Ephesians 2:5). How can you model that acceptance to those whom you need to offer forgiveness or make amends?
6. Why is it important that you focus only on your part in making amends or offering forgiveness?
7. List some things God has shown you so far through working this step.
8. *What amends do you think that you have already made?*

 *How did you go about making these amends?*

From your list of amends, if there are apologies that you need to make, write them down here first.

A. Who have YOU hurt?

- | | | |
|----|----|-----|
| 1. | 5. | 9. |
| 2. | 6. | 10. |
| 3. | 7. | 11. |
| 4. | 8. | 12. |

B. How did you hurt them?

- | | | |
|----|----|-----|
| 1. | 5. | 9. |
| 2. | 6. | 10. |
| 3. | 7. | 11. |
| 4. | 8. | 12. |

C. Indicate whether it was intentional or not intentional.

- | | | |
|----|----|-----|
| 1. | 5. | 9. |
| 2. | 6. | 10. |
| 3. | 7. | 11. |
| 4. | 8. | 12. |

Write Letters to those to who we owe amends

Write your letters on copies of the following sheets of paper (or rewrite the letters in your own words and put them in the notebook binder here after this page. You can print them or write them on notebook paper but insert the sheets of paper in your notebook.)

- Read one or more letters of amends to a friend and ask them:
 - if it sounds sincere (This will likely require you rewrite them in your own words, but don't leave anything out).
 - if it sounds defensive or like an attack on the other person.
- Record here what response he or she has to your letters.

NEXT MEETING WITH SPONSOR (BRING LETTERS OF AMENDS THAT YOU HAVE WRITTEN TO READ ALOUD).

- Role play with your sponsor or friends for anything that you are going to say when making amends.
- Record here how these practice sessions went and what you learned.
- CHOOSE WITH YOUR SPONSOR which amends you are going to actually make this week. You will make that amends before your next sponsor meeting (fill out the next section before the meeting).



Dear _____,

Regarding the situation/time where/when I _____

_____ Describe the situation

_____ & behaviors in detail.

I have been holding feelings of _____ Label the specific feelings.

And I have been holding these feelings ever since _____

Holding on to these feelings has cost me _____

And what these feelings have done to me is _____

My payoff in keeping these feelings has been _____

The possible difference it could make in my life if I could let these feelings go is _____

The fears I have in letting go of these feelings are _____

I am hopeful that you can forgive me for the hurt I caused you,

The behaviors I want to show you are _____

And the words I want to say are _____

Thank you.

NEXT MEETING WITH SPONSOR AFTER MAKING ONE AMENDS (Read your answers to the following questions)

After you have had your first encounter making amends, record what happened here.

a. How did you feel about it?

b. How did the other person respond?

c. What have you learned from this?

d. What would you do differently next time?

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



Date: _____

Dear _____,

Regarding the situation/time where/when I _____

_____ (Describe the situation & behaviors in detail).

I have been holding feelings of _____ (Label the specific feelings).

And I have been holding these feelings ever since _____

Holding on to these feelings has cost me _____

And what these feelings have done to me is _____

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The behaviors I want to show you are

And the words I want to say are

Thank you.

Signature _____



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Thank you.

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Thank you.

Signature _____



Date: _____

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The behaviors I want to show you are

And the words I want to say are

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Signature _____



Date: _____

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Thank you.

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The behaviors I want to show you are

And the words I want to say are

Thank you.

Signature _____



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The possible difference it could make in my life if I could let these feelings go is _____

The fears I have in letting go of these feelings are _____

I am hopeful that you can forgive me for the hurt I caused you,

The behaviors I want to show you are

And the words I want to say are

Thank you.

Signature _____

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		

NEXT MEETING WITH SPONSOR AFTER MAKING OTHER AMENDS

After you have done your first several encounters for making amends (for example, after 5 times of making amends), record your overall impressions here).

1. Is there anything in common?
2. Has anything surprised you?
3. Has anything disappointed you?
4. How do you feel about the process and how has it affected you?

5. What amends do you have the most difficulty making?
6. What did you need to do to be able to make these amends?
7. How has making amends affected your relationship with others?
8. How are you dealing with the feedback from others after making amends?
9. How are you feeling about the amends you've made so far?
10. How are you dealing with the desire to defend yourself?
11. Write down any other amends that you found that you needed to make after starting the process of making amends.
11. How can you celebrate or honor the completion of your making amends (step 9)?
12. Have you had any MORE dreams about making amends? If so, describe them in detail.
13. Have I finished my amends? Am I avoiding some?



RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® Step 9 Comprehension Review

Name: _____ Date: _____ Sponsor/Step Leader: _____

Answer each question in your own words. All answers can be found in Step 9 of your RnR curriculum. If you are unsure of an answer, go back and re-read the material before responding.

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

1.	In your own words, what does Step 9 say we are to do, and what is the one exception given?
2.	What scripture passage from Matthew does Step 9 reference, and what does it tell you to do before bringing your gift to the altar?
3.	The material lists several self-check questions before making amends. Name at least three things you are asked to be willing to do.
4.	According to Romans 5:2 as referenced in Step 9, what has God's grace brought us into, and how does that relate to making amends?
5.	Why does the material say it is important to focus only on YOUR part when making amends or offering forgiveness?
6.	Describe the process outlined in Step 9 for preparing a letter of amends. What are you supposed to do with it before delivering it?

7. After making your first amends, the material asks you to reflect on four things. What are those four reflection questions?

8. Step 9 warns against one specific way of avoiding an amends. What is it, and why is it considered dishonest?

PERSONAL REFLECTION

9. How has God used your weaknesses and turned them into strengths? (This is directly from the Step 9 study questions.)

10. List at least one thing God has shown you through working Step 9 so far.

Step 9 — Transformation Essay

Making Direct Amends: A Reflection on Growth, Grace, and Restored Relationships

"We make direct amends to such people whenever possible, except when doing so would injure them or others."

Name: _____	Date: _____	Sponsor / Step Leader: _____
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Purpose of This Essay

Step 9 is one of the most courageous acts in recovery — standing face-to-face with those we have hurt and making it right. This essay is your opportunity to reflect deeply on that journey. In your response below, you will tell the full story of your transformation through Step 9: what you discovered about yourself, how you experienced God's grace in action, what it cost you, what it freed you from, and what new tools you now carry in your recovery toolkit.

Write your response as a unified, personal narrative — not a list of bullet points. Be honest, be specific, and be thorough. This is your story.

Essay Question

Reflect on your journey through Step 9 and write a comprehensive personal essay that addresses all of the following areas. Your response should demonstrate meaningful growth and transformation — not merely what you did, but who you became through doing it.

Part 1 — Grace Received and Grace Modeled

Describe how you personally experienced God's grace during the process of working Step 9. How did that experience of receiving grace transform the way you approached the people on your amends list? In what specific ways were you able to model that same grace — especially toward those it was most difficult to face? Reference Romans 5:2 and Ephesians 2:5 as you reflect on how God's unconditional acceptance shaped your willingness to offer acceptance and repair to others.

Part 2 — The Amends You Made: Courage, Preparation, and Honesty

Walk through the process of making your amends. Describe the preparation you did with your sponsor — the role-playing, the letter writing, and the honest self-examination. What did you discover about the specific harms you had caused when you were forced to name them in detail? Reflect on the self-assessment questions from this step: Were you willing to change? Were you being completely honest? Were you focusing only on your part? How did that discipline of focusing on your own responsibility — rather than defending yourself or shifting blame — change the nature of your encounters? Describe at least one amends that was especially challenging and walk the reader through what happened.

Part 3 — What You Learned from the Process



After completing your amends encounters, what surprised you most? What patterns did you notice across your experiences? Describe how the responses of those you approached — whether they were warm, cold, indifferent, or unexpected — affected your own growth. How did making amends change your relationships with others? How has it affected your relationship with God and with yourself? What did you need to do internally to follow through on the most difficult ones, and what did completing them teach you about your own character?

Part 4 — New Tools Added to Your Recovery Toolkit

Step 9 introduces two specific tools into your recovery toolkit: (1) Direct Amends — the practice of face-to-face, concrete repair of harm done to others, which releases guilt and rebuilds integrity; and (2) Discernment in Amends — the skill of determining when making a direct amends might cause further harm to innocent third parties, and responding with wisdom rather than compulsion. In your essay, explain what each of these tools means to you personally, based on what you lived through in this step. How do you now understand and define them from the inside out? Beyond these two, describe any additional tools, insights, or disciplines you discovered through this step that you will carry forward in your ongoing recovery.

Part 5 — The Person You Are Becoming

Conclude your essay by reflecting on how completing Step 9 has changed you at the level of character and identity. How has God used the work of this step to turn your weaknesses into strengths? In what ways do you now live differently — in your relationships, your honesty, your willingness to take responsibility? What does Step 9 mean for the daily life you are building in recovery? How will you continue to practice the principle of amends on an ongoing basis so you do not have to revisit a long list again? Write this final section as a statement of who you are now — and who, by God's grace, you are continuing to become.

Writing Instructions

- Write in complete paragraphs. Do not use bullet points or numbered lists in your response.
 - Be specific and personal. General statements are not enough — name what you experienced, felt, and discovered.
 - Aim for a minimum of 500 words. There is no upper limit — thoroughness is encouraged.
 - All five parts should be addressed, but your essay should read as a cohesive narrative, not five separate answers.
 - Review your Step 9 Essential Questions, your amends letters, your sponsor meeting notes, and your Top 10 List before you begin writing.
-



TOP 10 THINGS I LEARNED WORKING THIS STEP THAT I CAN APPLY TO MY LIFE.

(Write These in Complete Sentences)

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

10.

As you work through each step you will discover things that you need to ask God to help you with. Write those items on this page as you go.

Also write prayer needs for others.

Refer to this page at your prayer time.

Things to Pray About Regarding my Own Recovery	Others Who Need Prayer (and why)

TO COMPLETE THIS STEP, GO BACK TO THE ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS PAGE AT THE BEGINNING OF THIS STEP, READ THEM AGAIN. THE BACK OF THAT PAGE IS BLANK. WRITE OUT YOUR ANSWERS IN COMPLETE SENTENCES LIKE AND ESSAY OR IN PARAGRAPHS (BUT WRITE THE QUESTION NUMBERS BESIDE EACH ANSWER SO THAT YOU ANSWER EACH QUESTION FULLY ABOUT YOUR SELF).

CHECK HERE WHEN YOU HAVE DO THIS INDICATING THAT THIS STEP IS COMPLETE.

☐


THIS STEP IS COMPLETE INCLUDING ALL ANSWERS, TOP TEN LIST, ESSENTIAL QUESTION ANSWERS)

Day

Date

Participant Signature

Sponsor/ Step Leader Signature



Praying in the Form of Writing

Write a letter to God, asking for clarity and understanding regarding the specific aspect of your life.



Heavenly Father,

Thank you for the learning opportunities you have given me in this step. This week I have realized that I am especially grateful for (you might include some items from your gratitude lists):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

In this Step, with your guidance I have begun to learn (*list those things on your Top 10 list from this Step*)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

I ask now that you give me even more clarity at understanding in these areas, and especially in the area of

You tell me in your Word, The Bible, to come to you with my needs, so that is what I am doing now. I seek your wisdom and guidance with (mention all the things from your prayer request list from the previous page):

I ask that you give me a sense of willingness to allow you to work in my life so that I can heal and so that I may find my purpose and become the person you would have me be.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.

-
- Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise during writing this prayer and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive.
 - Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise as you read this prayer aloud praying with your step leader/ sponsor (and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive).

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
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	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



WORKSHOP

BREAK 3

This is not a step. This is a point where we take a break from the step questions to do two workshops (one each week for the next two weekly sessions). These will be one on one sessions with your step leader. You will not need to prepare for them. Your step leader will guide you through them at each meeting time. Pick any one workshop in this section and notify your step leader of which one you chose. Your step leader will select the other one.





Spiritual Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **Before Amen** (Max Lucado) — Simple, powerful prayer practices. A practical prayer framework they can use daily to reduce anxiety, increase conscious contact with God, and experience peace in the midst of recovery struggles.
- **Bondage Breaker, The** (Neil T. Anderson) — Spiritual freedom from strongholds. Tools to identify and tear down lies/strongholds, steps to walk in Christ's victory, and renewed confidence that freedom is possible now.
- **Empowered by the Spirit** (Derek Prince) — Gifts of the Holy Spirit. Understanding of how the Holy Spirit empowers daily living and recovery, plus discernment to recognize and steward spiritual gifts.
- **Facing Your Giants** (Max Lucado) — Facing fears through David's story. Courage to confront personal "giants" (addiction, shame, relapse triggers) with faith instead of fear.
- **Fearless** (Max Lucado) — Overcoming fear with faith. Practical ways to replace fear-based thinking with trust in God, reducing anxiety-driven decisions in recovery.
- **Not a Fan** (Kyle Idleman) — Moving from fan to follower. Clarity on the cost of true discipleship and motivation to move from casual faith to full surrender.
- **Prayer of Jabez, The** (Bruce Wilkinson) — Bold, daily prayer. A simple, memorable prayer they can pray daily for blessing, influence, protection, and God's presence.
- **Problem of Pain, The** (C.S. Lewis) — Suffering and God's goodness. A biblical framework for making sense of pain without losing faith, helping prevent resentment or relapse during hard seasons.
- **Screwtape Letters, The** (C.S. Lewis) — Recognizing temptation. Insight into subtle spiritual attacks and practical strategies to resist them.
- **When the Body Remembers** (Bessel van der Kolk) — Trauma and the body. Understanding of how trauma lives in the body and faith-based hope for healing.
- **Why Am I Like This?** (Kobe Campbell) — Trauma roots and patterns. Compassionate insight into why they repeat certain patterns and the first steps toward breaking cycles.
- **You'll Get Through This** (Max Lucado) — Hope in crisis. Encouragement and biblical perspective that God redeems pain, helping them endure tough seasons without giving up.

Emotional Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **Anxious for Nothing** (Max Lucado) — C.A.L.M. plan for anxiety. Immediate, Scripture-based tools to manage anxiety and worry.

- **Approval Addiction** (Joyce Meyer) — Breaking people-pleasing. Freedom from needing everyone's approval and courage to live authentically.
- **Every Woman's Battle** (Shannon Ethridge) — Emotional and sexual integrity (women). Practical help for guarding the heart and mind in relationships.
- **Guilt & Shame** — Addressing guilt and shame. Distinction between guilt and shame plus biblical release from both
- **Human Magnet Syndrome, The** (Ross Rosenberg) — Codependent patterns. Awareness of unhealthy attraction patterns and how to break them.
- **Overcoming Disappointment and Discouragement** (Kathy Spampinato) — Renewing hope. Tools to process disappointment without sliding into despair.
- **PRIDE in Recovery** — Humility vs. pride. Recognition of pride as a recovery saboteur and the path of humility.
- **Soul of Shame, The** (Curt Thompson) — Healing shame. Understanding of shame's power and the healing that comes from being known.
- **Steady in the Storm** (Spampinato + Carlson) — Handling daily stressors. Practical emotional regulation for everyday life.

Relational Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **5 Apology Languages, The** (Chapman & Thomas) — Healthy apologies. Skills to repair relationships through effective apologies (key for Step 8–9 work).
- **Boundaries** (Cloud & Townsend) — Healthy limits. Clarity on what is “my responsibility” vs. “not mine,” reducing resentment and enabling better relationships.
- **Every Man's Battle** (Arterburn & Stoeker) — Sexual integrity (men). Accountability tools and honesty for sexual purity.
- **Making Sense of Forgiveness** (Brad Hambrick) — The forgiveness journey. Freedom from bitterness without pressure for premature reconciliation.
- **Safe People** (Cloud & Townsend) — Choosing healthy relationships. Discernment to build safe community and avoid toxic ones.
- **The Book of Forgiving** (Tutu & Tutu) — Fourfold path to forgiveness. A clear process for healing personal and relational wounds.
- **Unpacking Forgiveness** (Chris Brauns) — Biblical forgiveness. Release from bitterness while honoring justice and safety.

Physical Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **Carnivore Diet, The** (Shawn Baker) — Elimination diet exploration. A clear understanding of how an animal-based elimination diet can stabilize energy, reduce inflammation, and support brain

health, along with practical next steps for experimenting safely while stewarding their body as God's temple.

- **Fat Chance** (Robert Lustig) — Sugar, metabolism, and grace. Eye-opening knowledge about hidden sugars and their impact on the brain and body, combined with grace-filled encouragement to make sustainable changes without shame.
- **Metabolical** (Robert Lustig) — Processed food awareness. Tools to identify ultra-processed foods that drive cravings and metabolic dysfunction, along with practical strategies for choosing real food that supports long-term recovery.
- **Plant Paradox, The** (Steven Gundry) — Gut health and lectins. Understanding of how certain plant compounds affect gut health and inflammation, with actionable ways to reduce digestive issues and improve overall physical well-being.

Mental Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **Change Your Diet, Change Your Mind** (Georgia Ede) — Nutrition and brain health. Science-backed insight into how food affects mood, cravings, and mental clarity, plus simple dietary shifts that can support emotional stability and reduce addictive eating patterns.
- **Get Out of Your Head** (Jennie Allen) — Breaking toxic thought spirals. Skills to interrupt negative rumination and replace lies with truth.
- **Every Thought Captive** (Kyle Idleman) — Renewing the mind. Biblical strategies from 2 Corinthians 10:5 to take thoughts captive, replace toxic thinking patterns, and experience greater mental freedom and peace. .
- **Heal Your Hurting Mind** (Craig Groeschel) — Tools for anxiety, depression, anger, trauma. Honest, practical steps for emotional honesty and healing.

Cultural / Practical Dimension (One-Hour Sessions)

- **God Pocket, The** (Bruce Wilkinson) — Generosity and availability. A simple, life-changing practice of being ready to bless others daily, shifting focus from self-centeredness to service and building a habit of generosity.
- **How to Test Negative for Stupid** (John Kennedy) — Wisdom and common sense. Humorous yet practical discernment tools to make wiser daily decisions and avoid common pitfalls that sabotage recovery.
- **Total Money Makeover, The** (Dave Ramsey) — Financial peace plan. Clear “Baby Steps” for getting out of debt, building emergency savings, and gaining financial peace — reducing stress that often fuels relapse.
- **The 360° Leader** (John C. Maxwell) — Influence from anywhere. Leadership principles for influencing others positively regardless of title or position, helping participants become assets in their recovery community and workplace.



STEP TEN



We continue to take personal inventory and when we are wrong, promptly admit it.

The following terms are foundational to your work in this step. Read through them before meeting with your sponsor. Understanding these concepts will deepen your engagement with the step and equip you to do its work honestly and thoroughly.

1. Continuing Personal Inventory

The ongoing, lifelong practice of honest self-examination — examining thoughts, attitudes, behaviors, and relational impact on a daily, weekly, and periodic basis. Step Ten marks a fundamental shift in the program: the Steps are no longer a project to complete, but a way of life to inhabit. John Maxwell's principle that 'you cannot improve what you do not evaluate' becomes the operational philosophy of this step. A continuing inventory is not a punishment or a sign that something is wrong; it is the recovery equivalent of regular physical exercise — the maintenance practice that keeps what was gained in Steps Four through Nine from gradually eroding through neglect.

2. Daily Inventory

A brief, consistent end-of-day (or throughout-the-day) self-examination that asks: What did I do well? Where did I fall short? Do I owe anyone an amends? Do I need to forgive anyone? What are my prayer requests? The daily inventory is the most immediate of the three inventory types in Step Ten, designed to prevent the buildup of unprocessed resentments, unacknowledged wrongs, and accumulating emotional debt that led to the dysfunction and relapse of the pre-recovery years. Ken D. Berry, M.D. would note that the body processes stress best when it is addressed in real time rather than stored; the daily inventory applies that same principle to the emotional and relational dimension of recovery.

3. Weekly Inventory

A more structured, broader self-examination conducted once a week — often with a sponsor or accountability partner — that steps back from the daily details to look at patterns, themes, and trajectory. The weekly inventory asks: What has been true of me this week? Where am I making progress? Where am I sliding? Are there resentments or behaviors I haven't yet named? The Step Ten material incorporates the 2 Peter 1:5-7 virtues (faith, goodness, knowledge, self-control, perseverance, godliness, mutual affection, love) as a framework for the weekly inventory — measuring not just what you did or didn't do, but who you are becoming. Cloud and Townsend would identify this as the kind of structured reflection that accelerates genuine character growth.

4. Periodic Inventory

A deeper, less frequent examination — monthly, quarterly, or after significant life events — that evaluates the broader arc of your recovery, your relationships, your spiritual condition, and your alignment with your values and mission. The periodic inventory is the 'big picture' lens. It catches what the daily and weekly inventories might miss because they are too close to specific events. Craig Groeschel describes this as the kind of honest audit that forces us to confront comfortable self-deception — the slow drift that doesn't feel dramatic enough to notice day by day but that, over months, can quietly undo significant work.

5. Prompt Admission of Wrong

The discipline of acknowledging error, harm, or moral failure quickly — without delay, defensiveness, or self-condemnation — as soon as you become aware of it. 'Promptly' is a key word in Step Ten, and the curriculum treats it seriously. Delay allows rationalization to set in. Defensiveness converts an opportunity for repair into a second injury. Self-condemnation, while feeling like humility, is actually a form of self-focus that delays the repair work. Prompt admission of wrong is the daily-level application of the amends process from Steps Eight and Nine. It keeps the relational slate clean and prevents the kind of accumulated debt that requires a full inventory process to address.

6. Vigilance



The sustained, alert awareness of the specific patterns, triggers, behaviors, and thinking traps that are most likely to lead you back into addictive behavior or destructive patterns. Step Ten explicitly asks what behaviors and attitudes you need to be most vigilant against, and what your specific triggers are. Neil T. Anderson would frame vigilance as spiritual alertness — the posture of 1 Peter 5:8, 'Be sober-minded; be watchful. Your adversary the devil prowls around like a roaring lion.' Vigilance in recovery is not anxiety; it is informed, targeted self-awareness. You cannot guard what you have not mapped.

7. Journaling

The practice of writing regularly — daily or weekly — as an act of self-examination, emotional processing, and spiritual attentiveness. The RnR curriculum offers two journal formats for Step Ten: a traditional daily inventory format (feelings, victories, struggles, amends owed, prayer requests) and a Fruits of the Spirit format (examining the day through the lens of love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control from Galatians 5:22-23). Berry would note that writing engages the prefrontal cortex in ways that purely emotional processing does not — it creates narrative, imposes structure on chaos, and makes patterns visible. Journaling is not optional decoration in Step Ten; it is the primary mechanism of the daily inventory.

8. Addictions vs. Addictive Behaviors

A critical distinction introduced in Step Ten: addictions are the specific substances or compulsive processes (alcohol, drugs, gambling, pornography, etc.) that have been identified and addressed through the earlier steps, while addictive behaviors are the broader patterns of thought, emotion, and conduct — pride, dishonesty, people-pleasing, resentment, avoidance — that can fuel relapse and dysfunction even in the absence of the original addiction. Step Ten asks you to watch not only for your named addiction but for the addictive behaviors that created the soil in which it grew. This is the difference between surface-level sobriety and genuine transformation. Anderson's framework in *The Bondage Breaker* addresses precisely these deeper behavioral strongholds.

9. Daily Time with God

The regular, unhurried, intentional period set aside each day for self-examination, Scripture reading, and prayer — the spiritual foundation on which all of Step Ten's other practices rest. The curriculum frames this daily appointment not as a religious obligation but as the power source for the recovery life: 'Reserve a daily time with God for self-examination, Bible reading, and prayer in order to know God and His will for my life and to gain the power to follow His will.' Groeschel describes it as the difference between trying to live the Christian life on a depleted battery and living it with a full charge. Without a consistent daily time with God, the other inventory practices become mere self-analysis rather than Spirit-guided transformation.

10. Progress Over Perfection

The foundational recovery principle that the goal of Step Ten — and of recovery as a whole — is not to achieve a flawless daily record but to sustain honest self-examination, continuous correction, and genuine forward movement. The curriculum quotes a recovery elder: 'Nothing changes if nothing changes' — and the corollary is that change does not require perfection, only honesty and persistence. Brand's recovery framework is grounded in this: recovery is not a performance of impeccability; it is a practice of ongoing return to the right path after every deviation. Step Ten's daily and weekly inventories are tools for honest course correction, not scorecards for judgment.

11. Crossroads Awareness

The ongoing recognition that every day presents choice points — moments where the old patterns and the new recovery commitments pull in opposite directions — and that conscious, deliberate choosing is required at each one. The Step Ten material explicitly frames this as 'I am at a crossroads,' grounding it in 1 Corinthians 10:12: 'So, if you think you are standing firm, be careful that you don't fall!' Crossroads awareness is the antidote to the complacency that often follows early success in recovery — the subtle drift from active engagement to passive assumption that the work is done. Maxwell would call this the discipline of not believing your own press: continued progress requires continued intentionality.

12. Fruits of the Spirit (as Inventory Framework)

The nine qualities listed in Galatians 5:22-23 — love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control — used in Step Ten as a framework for daily self-examination. Rather than asking only 'What did I do wrong today?', the Fruits of the Spirit inventory asks 'Who was I today?' and 'Where did God's character show up in my words and actions, and where was it absent?' This reframes inventory from a deficit audit to a character development practice. Townsend and Cloud would recognize this as the kind of holistic self-assessment that measures growth not just in behavior but in the deeper character that produces behavior.

STEP 10: We continue to take personal inventory and when we are wrong, promptly admit it.

A DAILY TIME FOR REFLECTION

1. What new behaviors would you like to try- to make your program more effective?

2. How would you go about implementing these?

Should you put regular reminders on your calendar?

3. What kind of behaviors and attitudes do you need to be most vigilant against- to keep from your addictive behaviors?

✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 

4. What are your triggers for this addictive behavior? How can you guard against them or prepare for them?

✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 

5. What are some amends or remedies that you should make when you find out that you are wrong?

Keep a Journal for 1 week while working on this step.



You have a choice of 2 journal options for the next week:

- The following (seven) sheets are front and back.
- You decide if you will do the front pages or the back pages.
- The front pages are traditional step 10 “daily inventory” questions.
- Or you may choose to use the back of each sheet instead, these address your daily inventory using the “Fruits of the Spirit”.

You can do some of each if you want. Just complete 7 days.

Date: _____ Time: _____

 How have I been feeling today? (What was my overall feeling today?)

 What did I do right today?

 What struggles did I experience today?

 Do I owe anyone an amends (from today or prior to today) ?

 If so, how will I “make it right”?

 Do I need to forgive anyone?

 What are my prayer requests?

 Who should I ask to also pray about this? And how/ when will I ask them?

 What is the next action I need for my recovery?



Date: _____ Time: _____

1. Was I loving toward anyone today?

 Did anyone see God's Love in my life? If so, how? If not, why not?

2. Was I joyful today?

 How did I respond in situations that tested my joy?

3. How is my serenity?

 Did I allow anything to steal my peace?

4. Was I patient with others today? and with myself?

 Did anything cause me to lose my patience?

5. How kind was I today?

 Did I act in an unkind way toward anyone?

6. Could I describe this day as “good”?

 Have I demonstrated God’s goodness to others?

7. How was my faith today?

 Did I act unfaithfully? act in sin? act in a way that I did not show faith?

8. How was my gentleness?

 If I needed to have a confrontation, was I gentle?

9. How was my self-control?

 Did I give in to something instead of standing firm?

10. Is there anything I need to make right with anyone else about today?

 If so when will I do it?

Date:_____ Time:_____

 How have I been feeling today? (What was my overall feeling today?)

 What did I do right today?

 What struggles did I experience today?

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 If so, how will I “make it right”?

 Do I need to forgive anyone?

 What are my prayer requests?

 Who should I ask to also pray about this? And how/ when will I ask them?

 What is the next action I need for my recovery?



Date: _____ Time: _____

1. Was I loving toward anyone today?

 Did anyone see God's Love in my life? If so, how? If not, why not?

2. Was I joyful today?

 How did I respond in situations that tested my joy?

3. How is my serenity?

 Did I allow anything to steal my peace?

4. Was I patient with others today? and with myself?

 Did anything cause me to lose my patience?

5. How kind was I today?

 Did I act in an unkind way toward anyone?

6. Could I describe this day as “good”?

 Have I demonstrated God’s goodness to others?

7. How was my faith today?

 Did I act unfaithfully? act in sin? act in a way that I did not show faith?

8. How was my gentleness?

 If I needed to have a confrontation, was I gentle?

9. How was my self-control?

 Did I give in to something instead of standing firm?

10. Is there anything I need to make right with anyone else about today?

 If so when will I do it?

Date:_____ Time:_____

 How have I been feeling today? (What was my overall feeling today?)

 What did I do right today?

 What struggles did I experience today?

 Do I owe anyone an amends (from today or prior to today) ?

 If so, how will I “make it right”?

 Do I need to forgive anyone?

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STEP TEN DISCUSSION ABOUT MY DIRECTION GOING FORWARD

Reserve a daily time with God for self-examination, Bible reading, and prayer in order to know God and His will for my life and to gain the power to follow His will.

ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS AFTER YOU HAVE COMPLETED YOUR 7 DAY STEP TEN JOURNAL

1. Before you continue working on Step 10, take a moment to reflect and list some of the changes in your life that have come from working the steps and principles with God as your Higher Power.

a. How has your behavior changed?

b. What specific relationships have been restored or improved?

c. How has your relationship with God grown since you began your journey of recovery?

d. List the new relationships that you have made along your journey.

2. In your own words, what does Step 10 mean to you?

- The what: **"We continued to take a personal inventory ..."**

- The why: **"... and when we were wrong ..."**

- The then what: **"... promptly admitted it."**

3. What did you learn by keeping your journal?

5.. What areas did you identify as strengths? Try to List 10.

- 1.
- 2
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.
- 6.
- 7.
- 8.
- 9.
- 10.

6. What areas do you need to work on? Try to List 10.

- 1.
- 2
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.
- 6.
- 7.
- 8.
- 9.
- 10.

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



I AM AT A CROSSROADS

 **What are some of the advantages of each of the three types of inventories in your recovery? How can they help you to “be careful that you don’t fall”?**

1. Ongoing
2. Daily
3. Periodic

 **What do the following verses mean to you & how can they help you in this step?**

1. “From a wise mind comes careful and persuasive speech.” Proverbs 16:23
2. “Don’t use bad language. Say only what is good and helpful to others you are talking to, and what will give them a blessing.” Ephesians 4:29
3. “The wise man is known by his common sense, and a pleasant teacher is the best.” Proverbs 16:21
4. Anxious hearts are very heavy, but a word of encouragement does wonders.” Proverbs 12:25
5. “If I had a gift of being able to speak in other languages without learning them and could speak in every language there is in all the heaven and earth, but didn’t love others, I would only be making noise.” 1 Corinthians 13:1

6. “Watch with me and pray lest the Tempter overpower for though the spirit is willing enough, the body is weak. Mark 14:34

7. What is your daily action plan for Step 10? Can you think of a better way that works for you than addressing these questions in a daily journal?

8. What are the recurring events or issues that you are constantly needing to make amends for?

a. With your family?

b. With your friends?

c. With those you work with?

d. With those in your church or recovery program?

Are there any others?



This might be useful to you.

100 BEST JOURNALING IDEAS

 **These journaling ideas will equip you whether you want to ease your anxiety, find clarity, or get motivated.**

● If you want to start a daily journaling routine, there's nothing as daunting as a blank page that you don't know how to fill.

● And you can easily fall into a rut if you've been journaling for years. The inspiration runs dry and your daily journaling session feels like a chore.

● Here are some journaling ideas and prompts to inspire you – and make you fall in love with those blank pages again.

◆ You'll also find fresh ideas for things to do with your blank notebooks – and creative ways to fill them that will change the way you look at journaling.

100 Sometimes you want to write but need an idea of what to write about here are 100 ideas.



1. Write freely for 10 minutes. Write about whatever comes into your head. This kind of “free writing” might seem frivolous at first, but it’s an incredible tool to help you gain clarity.

2. Write about how you’re feeling. Check in with yourself and list your joys, anxieties, and worries.

3. Do Morning Pages. Popularized by the creativity manual *The Artist’s Way*, this technique means writing three full pages of stream of consciousness longhand right after you wake up.

4. Make a list of things you’d like to accomplish. Write down your goals for one, five and ten years from now.

5. Keep a log to track your daily routine. Log any good habits (like exercising or reading) that you’d like to maintain.

6. Keep a book log. Make a list of your favorite books, your current reads, your reviews, and recommendations you’d like to read next.

7. Keep a list of the films and TV series you’ve watched. Jot down your ratings and reviews. Add any films and directors you’d like to dig into next.

8. Start a food journal. List your favorite meals, recipes, restaurants and dishes to try.

9. Keep a log of what’s in your closet. Write about your daily outfits and what you need to buy, donate, or sell.

10. Write down your favorite quotes and inspiring sayings. Look back at this list whenever you need some inspiration.

11. Journal about your thoughts on newsworthy items. Write about current events and any thought-provoking stories you’ve read.

12. Jot down notes from your children’s daily life. Include anything memorable or funny they’ve said, how they’re doing at school, their hobbies and friends. These kinds of journals make incredible mementos for your children when they grow up.

13. Keep a journal as a budget tracker. Keep a record of where you’re spending your money – and where you could be saving. Include any long-term financial goals and plans.

14. Start a home improvement or renovation log. Include any inspiring magazine clippings, supplies to buy, and to-do lists.

15. Journal to plan your next trip. Write about where you’d like to visit, what foods you’d like to try and which museums you’ve love to see. Read about your dream destination and use your journal to keep notes.

16. Keep an art journal. Fill the pages with your sketches, quick drawings, and notes if you’re a more visual person. These can be anything from quick doodles to plans for your next creative project.

17. Write an unsent letter. Address it (without ever mailing it) to your ex-boyfriend, parent, a loved one who’s passed away or anyone else that you’d like closure from.

18. Start a dream journal to explore your subconscious. Keep it on your nightstand and jot down a few lines in the morning about

whatever you remember.

19. Start a bullet journal. Use it for brainstorming, keeping to-do lists and keeping track of your schedule and meetings.

20. Plan your day in threes. Write down 3 goals you’re working towards, 3 things you’re letting go of and 3 things you’re grateful for every morning.

21. Do some nighttime journaling. Reflect back on your day. What went well, and what do you regret? What can you do better tomorrow?

22. Take 15 minutes to make a list of everything you’re grateful for.

23. Take 15 minutes to make a list of everything that makes you smile – from a morning cappuccino to fresh flowers from the grocery store. Think about ways to bring more of these pleasures into your everyday life.

24. Write in detail about the happiest moments in your life. Describe the scene with all your senses – how did you feel, what did you smell?

25. Take 15 minutes to list the people who’ve had the biggest impact in your life. How have they influenced you, and how can you keep their inspiration going?

26. Start a one-line-a-day journal. If you want to kickstart your journaling (or if you’ve never journalled before), writing a single line is an incredible way to get into the writing habit.

27. Write about the best thing that’s happened to you today.

28. Write about your biggest tasks, challenges and worries for



tomorrow.

29. Keep a gratitude journal. Jot down everything you're thankful for daily.

30. Write about the worst-case scenario for something you're worried about. Journaling about the worst-case scenario will help you realize that many of your anxieties are exaggerated and irrational.

31. Write a to-do list for 5 minutes before bed. Writing down a list of specific loose ends has been proven to help you sleep better.

32. Write a haiku or turn a thought into a simple poem.

33. Describe the scene in front of you. Include any small details, noises and smells. Setting the scene will calm you and boost mindfulness.

34. Take 15 minutes to write a list of everything you like about yourself.

35. Write an alternate ending to a movie you've seen.

36. Write down your top 3 priorities and goals in the morning.

37. Take 15 minutes to write a list of everything you enjoy about your job – no matter how small.

38. Jot down a list of pros and cons for a dilemma or difficult decision that you're facing.

39. Get your stress out. Take a few minutes when you're angry to write about what's bothering you – use the journal page to rant and let it all out.

40. Take a minute before bed to write about the best thing that's happened to you today.

41. Write a list of positive, daily affirmations.

42. Write a compassionate letter to yourself. Fill it with reassuring words that you'd say to a best friend who needs your encouragement and support.

43. Keep a personal development journal. Track your productivity, creative goals, and burn-out levels. List some ways to inspire yourself and stay motivated.

44. Keep a fitness log. Track your exercise routine, daily meditation, and any health goals.

45. Use your journal to describe your perfect day.

46. Keep a log for self care. List your goals and track any daily habits you'd like to start or maintain.

47. Write a daily diary. Narrate the events in your everyday life, your feelings and any memorable moments and quotes.

48. Track your meals and the foods you eat. Note down any fitness goals, recipes you'd like to try or foods you'd like to maintain.

49. Keep a travel journal. Write your impressions when you're visiting new destinations or just exploring a new neighborhood. Write about the galleries you've seen, any new cafes you've tried and any locals you met.

50. Keep notes on anything new you learn – whether that's from a TED talk or a novel you're reading. Keep a list of any questions that come up, or subjects you'd like to research further.

51. Take 15 minutes to write about the things you're looking forward

to – whether that's a family reunion, a weekend getaway, or a staycation.

52. Take 15 minutes to write about your regrets. What would you do differently today?

53. Write about a few people you admire. What can you learn from them, and how did they get to where they're at?

54. Make a bucket list of everything you'd like to do in your lifetime.

55. Write out an imagined dialogue for a conversation that you're too nervous to have. Write out a dialogue about a topic you're afraid to bring up.

56. Write a letter to a person that you'd like to forgive.

57. Take 15 minutes to describe your perfect day – from morning to night. Write down all the details about your ideal day.

58. Take 15 minutes to describe your ideal future self. What have you accomplished, how do you feel, what's around you?

59. Take 15 minutes to write about the things you appreciate in a family member or partner.

60. Make a list of the favorite compliments you've received in your life.

61. Write about what you'd like to change in your life – and about any bad habits you'd like to cut out.

62. Make a list of any distractions that are keeping you from achieving your goals.

63. Make a list of moments when you feel your happiest and most authentic self.



64. Describe what you're feeling, and what's causing your current emotions.

65. Make a list of simple things you can do to make yourself feel better. Reach for this list whenever you're feeling anxious or depressed.

66. Describe your home. Write about what you love about your living space, and what you'd like to change.

67. Keep a journal as an ongoing mood or vision board. Include images, scraps and quotes that you find inspiring.

68. Start a music journal. List your favorite Spotify lists, song lyrics and albums you'd love to hear.

69. Use your journal as a scrapbook. Gather together stamps, receipts, stickers, and any other small bits that you come across in your everyday life.

70. Write some flash fiction and short stories. Use some creative writing prompts to get going.

71. Write about everything you'd do – if you had all the time in the world.

72. Make a list of five things you'd like to do more.

73. Write about a book that has influenced your life.

74. Make a list of your favorite places – and everything you love about them. Describe each place with vivid details.

75. Write about how you've changed in the past year.

76. Write a letter to your teenage self. Include any advice you'd give.

77. Describe yourself and how you were a decade ago. How have you changed, and why?

78. Write about how you'd like people to describe you. How would you like to be perceived?

79. Write about what you'd love to do, if money was no object.

80. Write about what motivates you. What gets you out of bed every morning?

81. Make a list of date night ideas. Include any fun activities to do with your partner.

82. Write about the best pieces of advice you've ever been given. How have they impacted your life?

83. Write about a person you really miss.

84. Write about the last time you did something for the first time.

85. Write about a time you felt brave and conquered your fears.

86. Write about the last time you lost track of time.

87. Make a list of reasons why you're not being fully honest in your journal.

88. Make a list of 3 things you'd like to change in the world.

89. Make a list of 3 things that drain your energy.

90. Write about your favorite traditions and holidays. What do you love about that time of year, and what emotions do you feel?

91. Make a list of things you'd love to do – but are too afraid to try.

92. Write about the last time you couldn't sleep. What thoughts and worries kept you up?

93. Write about your childhood heroes and crushes. What did you admire about them?

94. Write about the 3 most significant friendships that have changed your life.

95. Describe what you love about your morning and evening routines.

96. Write about the 3 most memorable gifts you've received in your life. What made them so special?

97. Write about a culture that you find fascinating. What attracts you to that region?

98. Write about the last time you had a conversation with a stranger.

99. Write about the last time you had a great conversation with your partner.

100. Describe how you procrastinate. How do you distract yourself, and what feelings are you trying to avoid?

Step 10 Weekly Inventory Questions

for Measuring Virtues in 2 Peter 1:5-7 for 12 Step Recovery

This inventory is designed to help individuals in 12 Step Recovery reflect on and assess their growth in the virtues listed in 2 Peter 1:5-7: faith, goodness, knowledge, self-control, perseverance, godliness, mutual affection, and love. Each section includes questions tailored to the context of recovery, encouraging honest self-examination and alignment with the principles of the 12 Steps.

- **Weekly Reflection:** Use these questions as part of a weekly inventory (Step 10) to assess your growth in these virtues.
- **Journaling:** Write your responses to these questions in a journal to track progress and identify patterns over time.
- **Discussion with Sponsor:** Share your answers with your sponsor to gain feedback and guidance on areas for growth.

(Meeting Focus: Use these questions as a discussion prompt in 12 Step meetings to explore how these virtues support recovery.)

1. Faith

- How have I relied on Jesus Christ in my recovery journey this week?

- What specific actions have I taken to trust in Jesus Christ when facing challenges or cravings?

- Have I been consistent in prayer, meditation, or other spiritual practices to strengthen my faith?

- Are there areas in my recovery where I struggle to surrender control to Jesus Christ?

2. Goodness (Moral Excellence)

- Have I made choices this week that align with my values and the principles of the 12 Steps?

- In what ways have I acted with integrity in my interactions with others, including my sponsor, sponsees, or recovery group?

- Have I been honest in my Step work, particularly in my inventories (Steps 4 and 10)?

- Are there situations where I compromised my moral standards, and what can I do to make amends?

3. Knowledge

- Have I actively sought to learn more about the 12 Steps, the Big Book, or other recovery literature?

- What new insights have I gained from attending meetings, listening to others, or working with my sponsor?

- Have I applied the knowledge I've gained to improve my recovery or help others in the program?

- Are there areas of the 12 Steps or recovery principles I need to study or understand better?

4. Self-Control

- How have I managed triggers or temptations to use substances or engage in harmful behaviors this week?

- Have I practiced pausing and seeking guidance from my Higher Power or sponsor before reacting to difficult situations?

- In what ways have I demonstrated discipline in maintaining my recovery routines (e.g., meetings, Step work, self-care)?

- Are there moments where I lost self-control, and what steps can I take to address these lapses?

5. Perseverance

- How have I continued to show up for my recovery, even when faced with setbacks or discouragement?

- What challenges have I overcome in my recovery journey, and how have they strengthened my commitment?

- Have I been consistent in working the 12 Steps, even when progress feels slow or difficult?

- Are there areas where I feel tempted to give up, and how can I seek support to keep moving forward?

6. Godliness

- In what ways have I sought to align my thoughts, words, and actions with the will of my Higher Power?

- Have I practiced humility by admitting my shortcomings and seeking to grow spiritually?

- How have I carried the message of recovery to others in a way that reflects spiritual principles?

- Are there behaviors or attitudes in my life that feel out of alignment with godliness, and how can I address them?

7. Mutual Affection (Brotherly Kindness)

- How have I shown support, encouragement, or kindness to others in my recovery community?

- Have I reached out to newcomers or struggling members in my 12 Step group to offer help or fellowship?

- In what ways have I built healthy, supportive relationships with others in recovery?

- Are there relationships in my recovery community where I need to practice forgiveness or make amends?

8. Love

- How have I demonstrated unconditional love and compassion toward myself and others in my recovery?

- Have I practiced Step 9 by making amends to those I've harmed, showing love through action?

- In what ways have I expressed gratitude for the love and support I've received in my recovery journey?

- Are there areas where I struggle to show love, such as resentment or judgment, and how can I work on these through the Steps?



Why Progress Stalls

(This is not a Step—no questions—but read, discuss, and understand it as you near completion of the Steps.)

As you finish the Steps, embrace sponsoring newcomers. Your role is to guide them through the principles, walking alongside—not carrying—they. Slow them if they rush; encourage them when stuck.

Here are **eight** common areas where people stall in recovery progress. Know them to help others (and yourself) get unstuck:

1. **Incomplete work on the previous principle** Rushing ahead blocks God's process. Slow down and stay in step with the Spirit. *"Since we live by the Spirit, let us keep in step with the Spirit."* (Galatians 5:25)
2. **Incomplete surrender of life and will to God** Trusting Him with "big" things but not "small" ones. *"Trust in the Lord completely; don't trust yourself. In everything put God first, and he will direct you and crown your efforts with success."* (Proverbs 3:5-6, TLB)
3. **Unaccepted forgiveness through Jesus' death** Believing your sins are too big for forgiveness. *"If we confess our sins... he can be depended on to forgive us... from every wrong."* (1 John 1:9, TLB) *"His kindness... took away all our sins through the blood of his Son."* (Ephesians 1:7, TLB)
4. **Failure to forgive yourself** *"There is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."* (Romans 8:1)
5. **Unforgiveness toward others** Holding past harm keeps you imprisoned. Release it for freedom and strength. *"After you have suffered a little while, our God... will... make you stronger than ever."* (1 Peter 5:10-11, TLB)
6. **Fear of change or risk** Fear of failure, rejection, hurt, or the unknown paralyzes growth. *"Fear not, for I am with you... I will strengthen you; I will uphold you."* (Isaiah 41:10, TLB) *"The Lord is my Helper; I am not afraid..."* (Hebrews 13:6, TLB)
7. **Refusal to own responsibility** Avoid blaming others for damaged relationships or harm caused. Examine yourself. *"Examine me, O God... if there is any evil in me and guide me..."* (Psalm 139:23, GNB)
8. **Lack of a strong support team** No sponsor, accountability partner, group contacts, or service commitment. *"Be with wise men and become wise..."* (Proverbs 13:20, TLB) *"Share each other's troubles... obey our Lord's command."* (Galatians 6:2, TLB)

Next steps: After completing the 12-Step Curriculum, choose and begin a Resilients in Recovery® Transformational Pathway immediately. Momentum matters—delays make restarting harder.



Daily Action Plan for Serenity

1. Take daily inventory; promptly admit wrongs.
2. Study God's Word and pray daily for guidance to apply His will.
3. Live the RESILIENTS principles daily, seeking ways to help and serve others—in meetings and all life areas.

A wise recovery elder often said: **“Nothing changes if nothing changes.”**

Put that in your own words:

When will it be important to remember these words?

How can you use this truth to equip yourself for success?



TRANSFORMATIONAL PATHWAYS

Transformational Pathways in the **Resilients in Recovery®** program represent the ongoing, post-12-Step phase of your journey. After completing the core 12-Step Curriculum (which focuses on working the Steps with a Christ-centered, resilience-building approach), these Pathways provide structured next steps to deepen transformation, maintain momentum, and apply the principles to sustained, holistic recovery and growth.

Why They Matter

The curriculum emphasizes that recovery isn't a finish line—it's a lifelong process. Completing the Steps equips you with foundational tools (surrender, inventory, amends, service, etc.), but true resilience and freedom require continued intentional work. The section you shared urges: **"Don't procrastinate on the next step. Start immediately. It is not as easy to get started back after a time lapse."** Momentum is key—delaying can make re-engagement harder, while jumping in right away builds on the spiritual and emotional gains you've already made.

What Transformational Pathways Typically Involve

While specific Pathways may vary by group, facilitator, or local Resilients in Recovery ministry (often church-based or faith-integrated support groups), they generally focus on advanced application of the RESILIENTS principles beyond the initial Steps. Common themes include:

- **Deeper Spiritual Formation** — Building a more intimate walk with God, perhaps through extended Bible study, prayer disciplines, or exploring spiritual gifts in service.
- **Ongoing Accountability & Community** — Strengthening your support team (sponsor, accountability partners, small group involvement) and committing to regular service or mentoring others.
- **Life Application & Maintenance** — Addressing specific life areas for ongoing healing, such as:
 - Relationships & family reconciliation
 - Emotional health & mental wellness
 - Vocational or purpose-driven living
 - Preventing relapse through advanced trigger management
- **Resilience-Building Practices** — Integrating daily habits from the Serenity Action Plan (inventory, Scripture/prayer, serving others) into real-world challenges.
- **Specialized Focus Areas** — Some Pathways might target common post-Step growth needs, like forgiveness deepening, fear/confronting change, self-compassion, or leadership in recovery ministry.

These Pathways help transition from "working the Steps" to "living the Steps" as a transformed lifestyle, aligning with the program's emphasis on resilience (bouncing back stronger) and Christ-centered change.

How to Get Started

1. **Discuss with your sponsor or group leader** — They can guide you toward the available Pathways in your Resilients in Recovery setting.
2. **Pray & reflect** — Ask God to reveal the next area of growth or service He has for you.
3. **Choose & commit immediately** — Pick one Pathway (or create a personalized plan if options are flexible) and begin right after finishing the curriculum.
4. **Track progress** — Use journaling, accountability check-ins, and the Daily Action Plan to stay engaged.

This phase turns recovery from a program into a lifelong, Spirit-led adventure of becoming more like Christ—resilient, surrendered, and equipped to help others

Overview of the Transformational Pathways

1) *Core Recovery & Personal Growth Pathways*

- a) **Foundations in Transformational Recovery Path** Reinforces core recovery principles post-12 Steps, focusing on ongoing application of resilience, spiritual disciplines, and preventing relapse through deeper foundational work.
- b) **Overcoming & Personal Healing Path** Targets emotional and spiritual wounds, promoting forgiveness, inner healing, trauma processing, and personal breakthroughs for sustained freedom.
- c) **Individualized Personal Development Path** A customizable track tailored to your unique needs, allowing flexible focus on personal goals like character development, habits, or life skills.
- d) **Obstacles that Sabotage Recovery Path** Identifies and dismantles hidden barriers (e.g., self-sabotage, limiting beliefs, unaddressed sin patterns) that hinder progress.

2) *Spiritual & Faith-Based Pathways*

- a) **God's Teachings Path** Deep dive into Scripture and biblical teachings for spiritual maturity, applying God's Word directly to recovery and daily living.
- b) **Spiritual Warfare Path** Equips participants to recognize and combat spiritual attacks, strongholds, and opposition that can derail recovery, using prayer, authority in Christ, and biblical armor.

3) *Purpose, Leadership & Service Pathways*

- a) **Finding Life's Purpose Path** Helps discover God's calling, passions, and vocational direction, shifting from survival to purposeful, impactful living.
- b) **Leadership Path** Prepares individuals to lead in recovery ministry, sponsor others, facilitate groups, or serve in church/community roles.
- c) **Coaching Certification for Resilients in Recovery®** Formal training to become a certified coach/facilitator in the Resilients program, enabling you to guide newcomers and expand the ministry.

4) *Relational & Health-Focused Pathways*

- a) **Relationship Building Path** Focuses on healthy connections—family reconciliation, marriage, friendships, boundaries, communication, and trust restoration.
- b) **Nutrition and Wellness Path** Integrates physical health (diet, exercise, sleep) with recovery, recognizing body-mind-spirit connection for holistic resilience.

- c) **Understanding the Human Brain Path** Explores neuroscience basics (e.g., addiction's impact on the brain, neuroplasticity, emotional regulation) to empower informed, science-informed recovery strategies aligned with faith.

5) Specialized Awakening & Awareness Pathways

- a) **Financial Resilients Path** Addresses financial stewardship, debt, generosity, and biblical principles for economic resilience and freedom.
- b) **Resilient Awakening in Health Care Deceptions Path** Examines potential misconceptions or deceptions in modern healthcare, promoting discernment, informed choices, and faith-based wellness.
- c) **Resilient Awakening in Historical Deceptions Path** Investigates historical narratives or "deceptions" through a biblical lens, building critical thinking and resilience against misleading worldviews.

These Pathways reflect the program's holistic approach: addressing spirit, mind, body, relationships, finances, and worldview. Many groups offer them in small-group format, with workbooks, discussions, and accountability. Your sponsor, group leader, or local Resilients ministry can help select the best starting Pathway (or multiple over time) based on your needs.

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

Step 10 Comprehension Questions

Instructions: Answer each question in your own words based on your reading of Step 10. If you are unsure of an answer, go back and re-read the material before responding.

SECTION A — THE STEP & ITS MEANING

1. What is the statement for Step 10? Write it out in full.

2. In your own words, explain the three parts of Step 10: the WHAT, the WHY, and the THEN WHAT.

3. What scripture verse is used at the opening of Step 10, and what does it warn us about?

SECTION B — PERSONAL INVENTORY

4. What are the three types of inventories described in Step 10? Name and briefly describe each one.

5. What are two journal options offered during the 7-day Step 10 journal week? What is the difference between them?

6. What does the Step 10 material say you should do when you find out you are wrong? Why is it important to do this quickly?

SECTION C — APPLICATION & REFLECTION

7. What is the difference between addictions and addictive behaviors, as discussed in the Step 10 Essential Questions?

8. How does the Step 10 material say journaling can help you in your recovery?



9. What does Step 10 say about reserving a daily time with God? What is the purpose of this time?

10. According to Step 10, what kinds of behaviors and thinking do you need to stay most vigilant against? Why does this ongoing awareness matter?

If you could not answer a question, go back and read Step 10 again before turning this in to your sponsor.

STEP 10

Transformation & Growth Essay Assignment

“So, if you think you are standing firm, be careful that you don’t fall!” — 1 Corinthians 10:12

Assignment Overview

Step 10 marks the transition from working the steps to living them. Rather than a one-time event, this step is a daily and lifelong practice — the discipline of honest self-examination, prompt admission of wrong, and continuous alignment with God’s will. This essay is your opportunity to demonstrate that the work you did in Step 10 has produced real, measurable growth in your character, your relationships, and your recovery.

You are not being asked to summarize the step. You are being asked to show who you are becoming because of it. Write personally, specifically, and honestly. Your response should reflect genuine reflection, not general statements.

The Essay Prompt

In a well-developed essay, describe the personal growth and transformation you experienced as a result of completing Step 10 of the RnR REBOUND STUDY curriculum. Your essay must address all four of the following areas:

1. Understanding and Living the Step

Explain, in your own words, what Step 10 means to you — not just as a definition, but as a way of life. Describe how you understand the three parts of the step: taking a continuing personal inventory, recognizing when you are wrong, and promptly admitting it. How has practicing this step daily changed how you move through each day? How does living this step help protect you from the patterns and consequences you experienced before recovery?

2. Evidence of Personal Growth and Transformation

Identify and describe specific, concrete ways you have grown as a person through working this step. Consider your behavior, your character, your relationships, and your relationship with God. What has changed in how you think, how you respond to others, and how you handle conflict, failure, or temptation? What does your life look like differently today than it did before you began this step? Be honest about both the progress you have made and the areas where God is still working in you.



3. What Your Journal Revealed

Reflect on what your seven-day journal revealed about yourself. What patterns did you notice in your emotions, reactions, or behaviors across the week? What did the daily inventory practice — whether using the standard format or the Fruits of the Spirit format — show you about where you are strong and where you are still vulnerable? What did you learn about yourself through this practice that you could not have seen without slowing down to examine your days honestly?

4. Tools Added to Your Recovery Toolkit

Describe the specific tools you have added to your recovery toolkit by completing Step 10. These include the daily personal inventory, the weekly inventory practice, the discipline of promptly admitting wrongs, and journaling as an ongoing recovery habit. For each tool, explain not just what it is, but how you have already begun using it and how you intend to keep using it going forward. How do these tools work together to help you maintain your recovery, guard against your triggers and addictive behaviors, and continue growing as a person?

A Note Before You Write

The goal of this essay is not to impress your sponsor or to say the right things. The goal is to give an honest, personal account of your journey through this step. A person who writes two pages of genuine self-reflection will always demonstrate more growth than someone who writes five pages of general statements. Be real. Be specific. Be honest. That is exactly what Step 10 asks of you.



TOP 10 THINGS I LEARNED WORKING THIS STEP THAT I CAN APPLY TO MY LIFE.

(Write These in Complete Sentences)

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

10.

As you work through each step you will discover things that you need to ask God to help you with. Write those items on this page as you go.

Also write prayer needs for others.

Refer to this page at your prayer time.

Things to Pray About Regarding my Own Recovery	Others Who Need Prayer (and why)

TO COMPLETE THIS STEP, GO BACK TO THE ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS PAGE AT THE BEGINNING OF THIS STEP, READ THEM AGAIN. THE BACK OF THAT PAGE IS BLANK. WRITE OUT YOUR ANSWERS IN COMPLETE SENTENCES LIKE AND ESSAY OR IN PARAGRAPHS (BUT WRITE THE QUESTION NUMBERS BESIDE EACH ANSWER SO THAT YOU ANSWER EACH QUESTION FULLY ABOUT YOUR SELF).

CHECK HERE WHEN YOU HAVE DO THIS INDICATING THAT THIS STEP IS COMPLETE.

☐

THIS STEP IS COMPLETE INCLUDING ALL ANSWERS, TOP TEN LIST, ESSENTIAL QUESTION ANSWERS)

Day

Date

Participant Signature

Sponsor/ Step Leader Signature



Praying in the Form of Writing

Write a letter to God, asking for clarity and understanding regarding the specific aspect of your life.



Heavenly Father,

Thank you for the learning opportunities you have given me in this step. This week I have realized that I am especially grateful for (you might include some items from your gratitude lists):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

In this Step, with your guidance I have begun to learn (*list those things on your Top 10 list from this Step*)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

I ask now that you give me even more clarity at understanding in these areas, and especially in the area of

You tell me in your Word, The Bible, to come to you with my needs, so that is what I am doing now. I seek your wisdom and guidance with (mention all the things from your prayer request list from the previous page):

I ask that you give me a sense of willingness to allow you to work in my life so that I can heal and so that I may find my purpose and become the person you would have me be.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.

-
- Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise during writing this prayer and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive.
 - Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise as you read this prayer aloud praying with your step leader/ sponsor (and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive).



STEP ELEVEN



STEP ELEVEN

STEP 11: We continually seek through prayer and meditation to improve our conscious contact with God, praying only for knowledge of His will for us, and power to carry that out.

■ *“The word of Christ must live in you richly. Teach and warn each other with all wisdom by singing psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs. Sing to God with gratitude in your hearts.” — Colossians 3:16*

HEBREWS IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® — STARTING IN THE BOOK OF HEBREWS

Choose TWO items (A–L) to implement while working Step 11. Select items NOT already in practice.

First Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

Second Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

TOOLS I ACQUIRE WORKING STEP 11

- **Meditation Practice** — Developing the discipline of quieting the mind and listening for God’s direction alongside regular prayer
- **Conscious Contact with God** — A daily, intentional relational connection with God through prayer and Scripture that sustains the foundation of recovery
- **Personal Mission Statement** — Writing and owning a clear statement of purpose and calling that guides decisions, service, and life direction going forward



RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

12 Step TRANSFORMATION Curriculum • VER 7.1

Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP ELEVEN — Essential Questions & Prayer

STEP 11 ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS

I	What has been my greatest source of healing in recovery?
II	How do I see myself making the world a better place?
III	How can I check my own feelings at any given moment?
IV	What is the difference between prayer and meditation?
V	Am I under spiritual attack every time I try to draw nearer to God?
VI	What am I going to do about spiritual attacks in the future?

STEP 11 PRAYER

Dear Lord,

I pray to keep my connection with You open and clear from the confusion of daily life.

Through my prayers and meditation, I ask especially for freedom from self-will, rationalization, and wishful thinking.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ the Son of the Living God. Amen.



RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® | STEP 11 — KEY TERMS & DEFINITIONS

We continually seek through prayer and meditation to improve our conscious contact with God, praying only for knowledge of His will for us, and power to carry that out.

The following terms are foundational to your work in this step. Read through them before meeting with your sponsor. Understanding these concepts will deepen your engagement with the step and equip you to do its work honestly and thoroughly.

1. Conscious Contact with God

The deliberate, sustained, daily awareness of God's presence and engagement in one's life — not a feeling that comes and goes, but a relational posture of attentiveness cultivated through prayer, Scripture, and intentional spiritual practice. Step Eleven names this as the primary goal of the step: 'to improve our conscious contact with God.' Neil T. Anderson describes our union with God through Christ as a settled reality — conscious contact is not establishing what isn't there, but becoming aware of what already is. Groeschel would frame it as rewiring the mind to be God-oriented rather than self-oriented: a daily, deliberate turning of attention toward the One who is always present and always speaking.

2. Prayer

The intentional, personal, conversational communication directed toward God — speaking honestly, asking specifically, confessing openly, and expressing gratitude. Step Eleven distinguishes prayer from meditation and treats it as the active, speaking dimension of the person's relationship with God. The step narrows the focus of prayer specifically: we pray 'only for knowledge of His will for us, and power to carry that out' — not for specific outcomes, not for God to arrange circumstances the way we prefer, but for alignment with His purposes and the strength to act on them. Arterburn and Stoeker describe this kind of targeted, honest prayer as 'bringing your battle to God daily.' The Step Eleven prayer is not vague; it is an act of specific, humble dependence.

3. Meditation

The practice of quieting the mind, stilling the noise of self-will and external distraction, and creating interior space to hear God's direction — as distinct from prayer, which is speaking to God. In the RnR framework, meditation is not passive emptying or Eastern mindfulness disconnected from Scripture; it is the act of sitting with God's Word, slowing down enough to listen, and allowing what has been read and prayed to settle into the heart. Colossians 3:16 captures the spirit of this: 'Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly.' Meditation is the discipline of making room for that dwelling. Groeschel's neuroscience-informed spirituality would note that meditation literally changes the brain — it builds attentional capacity, reduces stress reactivity, and trains the mind toward stillness.

4. Self-Will

The deeply ingrained human tendency to rely on one's own plans, instincts, and preferences rather than seeking and aligning with God's will — the root disposition that recovery, and specifically Step Eleven, is designed to address. Self-will is not simply doing wrong things; it is the posture of running one's life independently of God, even in pursuit of good outcomes. Brand describes the addicted life as essentially defined by self-will: the compulsive pursuit of relief and pleasure on one's own terms. Step Eleven asks for 'freedom from self-will, rationalization, and wishful thinking' — and that freedom only comes through consistent, genuine prayer and meditation that reorients the will from self-direction to Spirit-direction.

5. Knowledge of God's Will

The practical, progressive, daily discernment of what God is calling you to think, say, and do — not a mystical state accessible only to the spiritually advanced, but a relational awareness that grows through consistent time in prayer, Scripture, and community with other believers. Step Eleven specifies that we seek knowledge of God's will — not certainty

about every future event, not a five-year plan handed down from heaven, but directional clarity for the present day. Anderson grounds this in the sufficiency of Scripture: God's will is substantially revealed in His Word, and meditation on that Word trains the discernment to apply it in daily decisions. Groeschel would add that the renewed mind — shaped by God's truth rather than the world's patterns — is itself the primary instrument of discerning God's will.

6. Power to Carry It Out

The Spirit-provided strength, courage, and capacity to actually do what God calls you to do — including the things that your own human effort, willpower, or resolve cannot sustain. Step Eleven pairs 'knowledge of God's will' with 'power to carry that out' because knowledge without power produces only more defeat. This pairing is theologically precise: the Christian life is not a self-improvement project powered by good intentions; it is a Spirit-empowered life available to those who remain in close conscious contact with God. Berry would note that willpower is a biologically finite resource — it depletes under stress, fatigue, and emotional load. The power Step Eleven seeks is a different order of resource entirely: inexhaustible, available, and given to those who ask.

7. Spiritual Warfare

The real, active opposition of spiritual forces — using your specific weaknesses and even your strengths — to prevent you from drawing nearer to God, growing in recovery, and advancing in the purposes He has for your life. Step Eleven explicitly addresses this: 'Any time you try to draw nearer to God, or any time you try to make a move toward having the life that God wants for you, the enemy tries to trip you or distract you.' Anderson's *The Bondage Breaker* and *The Steps to Freedom in Christ* are foundational here: spiritual warfare is not metaphor — it is the practical reality of the believer's daily life, and it requires active response strategies: prayer, Scripture, community, and awareness of the specific entry points the enemy has historically used in your life.

8. REFLECT Check

The daily self-examination tool developed in the RnR curriculum to identify emotional and spiritual states that threaten recovery before they become crises: Resentful, Exhausted, Fearful/Anxious, Lonely/Isolated, Easily Angered, Carrying Guilt or Shame, Tense or Stressed. The REFLECT Check is directly connected to Step Eleven's invitation to ongoing conscious contact with God — it is a brief, grace-oriented diagnostic that invites honesty rather than demanding performance. A 'yes' to any of the REFLECT indicators is not failure; it is data. The curriculum frames it as an invitation to bring whatever is true to God, to a sponsor, and to the principles of the program. Brand would recognize this kind of honest checking-in as fundamental to the relational, attentive lifestyle that recovery requires.

9. Personal Mission Statement

A concise, written declaration of a person's core values, purpose, strengths, and life direction — developed in Step Eleven as an expression of the God-given calling that recovery has made visible and accessible. The personal mission statement is not a corporate vision statement or an aspirational slogan; it is a character-grounded commitment to live intentionally in alignment with who God has made you to be and what He is calling you to do. Maxwell's leadership philosophy is foundational here: 'A leader without a vision is a leader without direction.' The mission statement produced in Step Eleven becomes the compass for Step Twelve's service work and for all of the participant's ongoing recovery decisions. It is the answer to the question: now that I am free, what am I free for?

10. Listening Prayer

The practice of slowing down after speaking to God in prayer to create space for His response — remaining quiet, attentive, and receptive rather than treating prayer as a one-way monologue. The Step Eleven material asks directly: 'After you pray, do you slow down long enough to hear God's answer?' Listening prayer is the relational counterpart to petition prayer; it treats the conversation with God as genuinely dialogical. Anderson would ground this in the believer's direct access to God through the indwelling Spirit — the still small voice that Elijah encountered (1 Kings 19:12) is the same Spirit available to every believer who creates the stillness to receive what He speaks.



11. Spiritual Disciplines

The intentional, regular practices through which a person creates the conditions for God's transforming work in their life — including prayer, Scripture reading, meditation, journaling, fasting, silence, solitude, worship, and community. Step Eleven is the step most directly concerned with the spiritual disciplines, treating them not as religious duties but as the recovery practices of the inner life. John Maxwell describes the daily disciplines as the difference between the person who grows and the person who stagnates — not because the disciplines themselves produce transformation, but because they position the person to receive the work that only God can do. The spiritual disciplines of Step Eleven are the maintenance system of conscious contact.

12. Surrender of Self-Will

The ongoing, daily, moment-by-moment release of the demand to control outcomes, relationships, and circumstances — choosing God's agenda over one's own and His timeline over one's impatience. Surrender is not passivity; it is the active, courageous decision to stop being one's own god. The Step Eleven prayer captures it precisely: 'freedom from self-will, rationalization, and wishful thinking.' Groeschel describes surrender as 'the strongest thing a person can do' because it defeats the deepest human instinct — the insistence on self-determination. In recovery, surrender of self-will is not a one-time event at Step Three; it is the daily renewal of the decision that made recovery possible in the first place.

STEP 11: We continually seek through prayer and meditation to improve our conscious contact with God, praying only for knowledge of His will for us, and power to carry that out.

STEP ELEVEN DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Recall a time that your life was heading in the wrong direction. What brought you back? Describe this in detail.
2. How would you describe your beliefs about God and a Higher Power to a child?
3. What are your favorite sources of wisdom and knowledge about healthy values?
4. Has anything you ever read convinced you to change in some fundamental or deep way?
5. If you were stranded on a desert island with only one book, which book would you take? Why?

6. If you had only one week to live and unlimited resources, who would you gather around you and how would you pass the time?

7. Write out a complete form of what you would like your obituary to say.

8. What do you believe will happen to you after you die?

9. Am I willing to live in service of this Higher Self, this Ulterior Realm? (Do I want to be more than a tangle of greed, need and fear?)

✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 

10. Create your own incantation, your own 'tune-in code' and use it daily.

E.g., I know I cannot be happy pursuing instinct and will. I devote myself to channeling love, to serving beauty.



REFLECT Check (Resilients in Recovery)

"Search me, O God, and know my heart; test me and know my anxious thoughts." — Psalm 139:23 (NIV)

The **REFLECT** check is a simple, grace-filled tool to help you pause, examine your heart, and bring what you find to God — before small struggles become bigger ones.

Ask yourself honestly:

R — Am I Resentful? Am I holding onto bitterness or unforgiveness toward someone? Resentment left unchecked can quietly fuel relapse. Bring it to God and consider sharing it with your sponsor or accountability partner.

E — Am I Exhausted? Am I physically, emotionally, or spiritually depleted? Exhaustion lowers our defenses and clouds our judgment. Rest is not weakness — it is wisdom and good stewardship of the body God gave you.

F — Am I Fearful or Anxious? Am I operating from fear rather than faith? Am I worried about outcomes I cannot control? Philippians 4:6 reminds us to bring our anxieties to God in prayer rather than carry them alone.

L — Am I Lonely or Isolated? Have I pulled away from my community, sponsor, or accountability partners? Isolation is one of the greatest threats to recovery. We were not designed to walk this road alone.

E — Am I Easily Angered? Have I been irritable, short-tempered, or reactive today? Anger itself is not sin, but unaddressed anger becomes a doorway to old patterns. Name it, own it, and surrender it.

C — Am I Carrying Guilt or Shame? Am I weighed down by something I've done or left undone? Guilt and shame thrive in darkness. Bring them into the light — to God and to someone you trust.

T — Am I Tense or Stressed? Is there pressure building up that I haven't acknowledged? Tension is often the body's signal that something in the heart needs attention. Slow down and take it to God.

How to Use REFLECT

This is not a tool for self-condemnation — it is an invitation to honesty and healing. If you answer *yes* to any of these questions, that is not failure. That is awareness, and awareness is where recovery grows.

When you identify something, respond with the tools Resilients in Recovery has given you:

- **Pray** and surrender it to God's care and control
- **Share** it with your sponsor or an accountability partner
- **Apply** the principle or step that speaks to what you're carrying
- **Rest** in the truth that God who began a good work in you will be faithful to complete it (*Philippians 1:6*)

6. After you pray, do you slow down long enough to hear God's answer?

7. What does the word "meditation" in this step mean to you?

8. What are some of the other things that you do in your recovery to help you on the journey and prevent relapse? ✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.*

9. We all agree that recovery is a joy, but it also requires hard work. What do you do to celebrate your recovery - even the small victories?



SPIRITUAL WARFARE AND STEP ELEVEN

By now you have learned that any time you try to draw nearer to God, or any time you try to make a move toward having the life that God wants for you the enemy tries to trip you or distract you. This probably happened many times in our step study, many times when you planned to go to a meeting, many times when you planned to go to church, or any time that you started to do something to glorify God.

- A. Think of examples of how the enemy has used your weakness(es) to keep you from being successful.

✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* ✎

- B. Can you think of a time when the enemy has used your strengths to keep you from being successful or advancing in your growth?

- C. What are the people, places and things that still trigger you?

✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* ✎

- D. What can you do when you notice this spiritual attack, and what are some strategies that you can use to counter these spiritual attacks?

✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* ✎



Personal Mission Statement Worksheet

This worksheet will guide you through the process of creating your own personal mission statement. A personal mission statement defines your purpose, values, and goals, serving as a compass for your decisions and actions. Take your time to reflect deeply on each section.

1: Reflect on Your Core Values

Your core values are the principles that guide your life and decisions. They reflect what matters most to you.

Instructions:

- List 3-5 values that resonate deeply with you (e.g., integrity, compassion, growth, creativity, family).
- For each value, write a brief sentence explaining why it's important to you.

Example:

- Value: Integrity – I believe in being honest and doing what's right, even when it's difficult.
- Value: Growth – I strive to continuously learn and improve myself.

Your Turn:

1. Value: _____

Why it's important: _____

2. Value: _____

Why it's important: _____

3. Value: _____

Why it's important: _____

4. Value: _____

Why it's important: _____

5. Value: _____

Why it's important: _____



2: Identify Your Strengths and Passions

Understanding what you're good at and what excites you can help shape your mission.

Instructions:

- List 3-5 of your strengths (e.g., problem-solving, empathy, communication).
- List 3-5 activities or causes you're passionate about (e.g., helping others, creating art, environmental advocacy).

Example:

- Strengths: Creative thinking, leadership, active listening.
- Passions: Mentoring others, writing, sustainable living.

Your Turn:

Strengths:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.

Passions:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.

3: Define Your Purpose

Your purpose is the “why” behind your actions. It’s the impact you want to have on the world or those around you.

Instructions:

- Answer the following questions to clarify your purpose. Be honest and specific.
- Write a short paragraph summarizing your purpose based on your answers.

Questions:

1. What kind of impact do you want to have on the world or your community?

2. What legacy do you want to leave behind?

3. What activities or roles make you feel most fulfilled?

Your Purpose Statement:

4: Set Your Goals

Goals give your mission statement direction by defining what you want to achieve in the short or long term.

Instructions:

- List 2-3 specific goals that align with your values, strengths, passions, and purpose.
- Make sure they are meaningful and measurable.

Example:

- Goal 1: Volunteer 10 hours a month to support local youth programs.
- Goal 2: Publish a blog post every month to share my creative writing.

Your Turn:

1. Goal: _____
2. Goal: _____
3. Goal: _____

5: Write Your Personal Mission Statement

Now, combine your reflections into a concise personal mission statement. It should capture your purpose, values, strengths, and goals in 1-2 sentences.

Instructions:

- Use the following template as a guide, but feel free to adapt it to sound like you.
- Keep it clear, inspiring, and authentic.

Template:

“I am [your strengths/passions] and strive to [your purpose] by [actions or goals], guided by my core values of [your values].”

Example:

“I am a compassionate and creative leader who strives to empower others by mentoring and sharing knowledge, guided by my core values of integrity, growth, and community.”

Your Personal Mission Statement:



6: Reflect and Refine

A mission statement evolves over time. Revisit and refine it as your goals and values shift.

Instructions:

- Answer the following questions to ensure your mission statement feels right.
- Make any adjustments as needed.

Questions:

1. Does this statement inspire and motivate you? Why or why not?

2. Does it reflect who you are and who you want to become?

3. How can you use this mission statement to guide your daily decisions?

Refined Mission Statement (if needed):

Final Notes

- Keep your mission statement somewhere visible (e.g., on your desk, in your journal) to remind you of your purpose.
- Revisit this worksheet annually or when you experience major life changes to ensure your mission statement stays aligned with your goals and values.

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY

Step 11 Reading Comprehension

Name: _____

Date: _____

Instructions: Answer each question in your own words. Your answers should reflect that you have read and understood the Step 11 material. If you are unsure of an answer, go back and re-read the relevant section before responding.

SECTION 1: The Step & Conscious Contact

1. In your own words, what does Step 11 ask you to seek through prayer and meditation?

2. What is the difference between prayer and meditation as described in the Step 11 material?

3. What does "conscious contact with God" mean to you, based on what you read?

4. According to the material, what are you supposed to pray for — and what are you NOT supposed to pray for?

SECTION 2: Prayer & Listening

5. The material asks you to reflect on your prayer time. When and where do you pray, and why does consistency in this matter?

6. After you pray, do you slow down long enough to hear God's answer? What does the material suggest about listening in prayer?

7. What is the REFLECT Check, and what does each letter stand for? Why is this tool connected to Step 11?



SECTION 3: Spiritual Warfare

8. According to the Spiritual Warfare section, what happens when you try to draw nearer to God? Give an example from your own experience.

9. The material asks whether the enemy can use your strengths — not just your weaknesses — against you. Explain what this means.

10. What strategies does Step 11 encourage you to use when you recognize a spiritual attack?

SECTION 4: Mission & Purpose

11. What are the three "tools" the material says you added to your tool chest in Step 11? Briefly describe each one.

12. The Personal Mission Statement worksheet walks you through identifying your core values, strengths, passions, and purpose. Write the personal mission statement you developed — or a draft of it — below.



STEP 11 — TRANSFORMATION ESSAY

"We continually seek through prayer and meditation to improve our conscious contact with God, praying only for knowledge of His will for us, and power to carry that out."

WRITTEN ASSIGNMENT

Instructions: Write a comprehensive, reflective essay responding to the prompt below. Your response should be thoughtful, honest, and specific to your personal journey through Step 11. This is not a quiz — it is an opportunity to articulate your transformation and demonstrate real growth. There are no wrong answers, but your response should show deep engagement with the work of this step.

Essay Prompt

Step 11 invites us into one of the most personal and transformative dimensions of recovery: deepening our conscious contact with God through prayer and meditation, and surrendering our self-will in exchange for knowledge of His will and the power to carry it out. In a well-developed essay, describe the journey you have taken through this step and the meaningful ways it has changed you.

Begin by reflecting on **where you were spiritually when you started this step** — what was your relationship with prayer and meditation like before? What barriers, fears, or patterns of self-will were keeping you from genuine conscious contact with God? How did the REFLECT Check, the Step 11 discussion questions, and the work of examining your own spiritual state help you see what was getting in the way?

Next, describe **what changed as you worked through this step**. How has your understanding of prayer deepened — and how has your understanding of meditation grown beyond what you expected? How did the work of identifying spiritual attacks and naming the ways the enemy has used your weaknesses and even your strengths against you change how you approach your recovery? What does it look like now when you experience spiritual warfare, and what strategies have you developed to counter it?

Then, speak to **your Personal Mission Statement**. What does it say, and what does it mean to you? How did the process of identifying your core values, strengths, passions, and purpose shape the person you are becoming in recovery? How does having a mission statement change the way you make decisions, serve others, and navigate your daily life? In what ways does your mission statement reflect a version of yourself that could not have existed before the work of recovery?

Finally, discuss **the new tools you have added to your recovery tool kit** by completing Step 11. Step 11 equips you with three specific tools: a **Meditation Practice** (the discipline of quieting the mind and listening for God's direction), **Conscious Contact with God** (a daily, intentional relational connection with God through prayer and Scripture), and your **Personal Mission Statement** (a clear statement of purpose and calling that guides your decisions, service, and life direction). Describe how you understand each of these tools, how you have already begun using them, and how you intend to keep them active and growing in your recovery going forward. Be specific — give real examples from your life where these tools are already making a difference or where you plan to put them to work.

What a Strong Response Will Include

A strong, complete essay will address all of the following:

- A personal and honest reflection on your spiritual life before beginning Step 11 — including specific struggles with self-will, prayer, or connection with God.
- A description of how your prayer life has changed — including when, where, and how you pray now versus before, and what it means to slow down and listen after you pray.
- A clear explanation of what meditation means to you in the context of your recovery, and how the practice of quieting the mind is different from simply praying.
- A discussion of spiritual warfare: how you have seen the enemy use your weaknesses and/or strengths against your growth, and the specific strategies you now use to counter spiritual attacks.
- Your completed Personal Mission Statement, quoted in full, followed by a thoughtful explanation of what it means and how it came to be.
- A description of each of the three tools added to your recovery tool kit in Step 11 (Meditation Practice, Conscious Contact with God, and your Personal Mission Statement) and concrete examples of how you are using — or plan to use — each one.
- A closing reflection on how working Step 11 has changed who you are, how you see yourself in recovery, and what kind of future you believe God is calling you toward.

Note to Participant: *This essay is not about having the perfect answers — it is about telling your truth. Write from your heart. The more honest and specific you are, the more powerful this assignment will be — both for your own growth and for your shared journey with your sponsor. There is no length requirement, but take the time your transformation deserves.*



TOP 10 THINGS I LEARNED WORKING THIS STEP THAT I CAN APPLY TO MY LIFE.

(Write These in Complete Sentences)

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

10.

As you work through each step you will discover things that you need to ask God to help you with. Write those items on this page as you go.

Also write prayer needs for others.

Refer to this page at your prayer time.

Things to Pray About Regarding my Own Recovery	Others Who Need Prayer (and why)

TO COMPLETE THIS STEP, GO BACK TO THE ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS PAGE AT THE BEGINNING OF THIS STEP, READ THEM AGAIN. THE BACK OF THAT PAGE IS BLANK. WRITE OUT YOUR ANSWERS IN COMPLETE SENTENCES LIKE AND ESSAY OR IN PARAGRAPHS (BUT WRITE THE QUESTION NUMBERS BESIDE EACH ANSWER SO THAT YOU ANSWER EACH QUESTION FULLY ABOUT YOUR SELF).

CHECK HERE WHEN YOU HAVE DO THIS INDICATING THAT THIS STEP IS COMPLETE.

☐


THIS STEP IS COMPLETE INCLUDING ALL ANSWERS, TOP TEN LIST, ESSENTIAL QUESTION ANSWERS)

Day

Date

Participant Signature

Sponsor/ Step Leader Signature

Praying in the Form of Writing

Write a letter to God, asking for clarity and understanding regarding the specific aspect of your life.



Heavenly Father,

Thank you for the learning opportunities you have given me in this step. This week I have realized that I am especially grateful for (you might include some items from your gratitude lists):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

In this Step, with your guidance I have begun to learn (*list those things on your Top 10 list from this Step*)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

I ask now that you give me even more clarity at understanding in these areas, and especially in the area of

You tell me in your Word, The Bible, to come to you with my needs, so that is what I am doing now. I seek your wisdom and guidance with (mention all the things from your prayer request list from the previous page):

I ask that you give me a sense of willingness to allow you to work in my life so that I can heal and so that I may find my purpose and become the person you would have me be.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.

-
- Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise during writing this prayer and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive.
 - Describe the feelings or thoughts that arise as you read this prayer aloud praying with your step leader/ sponsor (and reflect on any insights or guidance you receive).

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



STEP TWELVE



Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP TWELVE

STEP 12: Having had a spiritual experience as the result of these steps, we try to carry this message to others and practice these principles in all our affairs.

■ *“Brothers and sisters, if a person is caught doing something wrong, you who are spiritual should restore someone like this with a spirit of gentleness. Watch out for yourselves so you won’t be tempted too.” — Galatians 6:1*

HEBREWS IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® — STARTING IN THE BOOK OF HEBREWS

Choose TWO items (A–L) to implement while working Step 12. Select items NOT already in practice.

First Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

Second Choice (Letter): _____

Hebrews Item: _____

Start Date: _____

TOOLS I ACQUIRE WORKING STEP 12

- **Testimony Writing and Sharing** — Crafting and delivering one’s own recovery story as both a personal integration exercise and an outreach tool for others
- **Service and Sponsorship** — Reaching back to help newcomers through the steps as the primary means of keeping one’s own recovery
- **Practicing Principles in All Affairs** — Applying the tools and values of the 12 Steps to every area of daily life — relationships, work, community, and faith — as a permanent new way of living



RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

12 Step TRANSFORMATION Curriculum • VER 7.1

Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson, Program Directors

STEP TWELVE — Essential Questions & Prayer

STEP 12 ESSENTIAL QUESTIONS

I	How do I reach out to other addicts?
II	How does it help me to help others?
III	What am I going to do to take my recovery to others?
IV	How will I take care of myself and my own recovery while giving back to others?
V	How will I use this program as a new plan for life (and not just something I did)?

STEP 12 PRAYER

Dear God,

My spiritual awakening continues to unfold. I know that I can keep it by giving it away. Guide me with ideas and opportunities — with help I have received I shall pass on & give to others.

I am truly grateful for this opportunity. I pray that I may continue walking day by day on the road of spiritual progress.

I pray for Your strength & wisdom to practice these principles in all I do & say.

I need You, my friends, & the program every hour of every day. Thank You for bringing others into my life showing me a better way to live. Now use me for that purpose as I encounter those You put in my path in life.

I pray that You guide my thinking and guide my decisions regarding what's next in my transformation.

I Pray this in the Name of Christ, the Son of the Living God. Amen.

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® | STEP 12 — KEY TERMS & DEFINITIONS

Having had a spiritual experience as the result of these steps, we try to carry this message to others and practice these principles in all our affairs.

The following terms are foundational to your work in this step. Read through them before meeting with your sponsor. Understanding these concepts will deepen your engagement with the step and equip you to do its work honestly and thoroughly.

1. Spiritual Experience

The cumulative, real inner transformation — a changed relationship with God, a new orientation of the self, a shift from self-centered living toward God-centered living — that results from honestly and completely working the twelve steps. A spiritual experience in the RnR framework is not necessarily a dramatic single event; more often it is the gradual, step-by-step reorientation of a person's character, priorities, and identity through the work of surrender, honesty, inventory, confession, amends, and prayer. Anderson would describe it as the progressive freedom from the lies and strongholds that bound the person before recovery. Brand frames it as the natural consequence of the recovery process: 'We're all just a few clear ideas and a little honesty away from the life we were meant to live.'

2. Carrying the Message

The active, intentional sharing of what happened in your recovery — your story, your experience, your tools, and your hope — with others who are still suffering from addiction or its consequences. Carrying the message is Step Twelve's primary assignment: not giving advice, not managing other people's programs, but bearing honest witness to transformation. Matthew 10:8 — 'Freely you have received; freely give' — is the theological grounding. The message that is carried is not a theory or a technique; it is a life. The testimony you develop in this step is the narrative form of that life. Maxwell would say that the most powerful form of teaching is not instruction but demonstration.

3. Service

The deliberate investment of time, energy, and attention in the recovery and wellbeing of others — sponsoring, facilitating, volunteering, mentoring, and showing up consistently for people who are where you once were. Service is not optional in Step Twelve — it is the mechanism by which your own recovery is sustained. The paradox the curriculum names directly: 'You can't keep it unless you give it away.' Ecclesiastes 4:9 grounds it: 'Two are better than one.' Service moves recovery from a personal project to a communal covenant. Cloud and Townsend would recognize service as the fullest expression of the relational health that the entire program has been building toward — healthy giving from a healthy self, rather than codependent rescuing from a depleted one.

4. Sponsorship

The relational commitment to walk alongside a newcomer through the steps — guiding, not carrying; challenging, not rescuing; sharing experience, not dispensing instructions. A sponsor in the RnR framework is someone who has personally completed the steps and can lead from lived experience rather than theory. Maxwell's mentoring philosophy is operative here: the most effective development happens in close, honest, ongoing relationship — the mentor walking alongside the learner rather than lecturing from a distance. Sponsorship protects the sponsor's own recovery by keeping them anchored in the work; it protects the sponsee by giving them a human witness who is for them and will not let them minimize, avoid, or pretend.

5. Testimony

The written and spoken personal account of a person's life before recovery, their journey through the steps, and the transformation God has worked in them — crafted with care, reviewed with a sponsor, and shared in community as both a personal integration exercise and an outreach tool for those who have not yet found hope. The RnR curriculum is specific

about the structure and purpose of testimony: it is not a recounting of how bad things were (no more than one-third of the testimony should address the past), but a declaration of what God has done and is doing. The goal is to give the newcomer — 'the person sitting there not believing life can get any better' — hope that change is possible. Testimony is both the completion of the step work and the beginning of a lifetime of giving it away.

6. Practicing Principles in All Affairs

The commitment to apply the values, habits, and spiritual postures developed through the twelve steps — honesty, humility, accountability, service, surrender, prayer, amends — to every area of daily life, not just to recovery meetings or step work. 'All affairs' is expansive and intentional: relationships, family, work, finances, church, community. James 1:22 — 'Be doers of the Word' — captures the call precisely. This is the step that closes the gap between recovery as a program and recovery as a life. Maxwell would call it the difference between knowing and growing: principles known but not practiced produce no transformation; principles practiced in 'all affairs' become character.

7. Spiritual Awakening

The broadened, deepened awareness of God, of oneself, and of one's relationship to others that emerges from honestly working the twelve steps — a perceptual and relational shift that makes possible a way of living that was not accessible before. A spiritual awakening is not the same as a single peak experience; it is the accumulated result of surrender, inventory, confession, amends, and ongoing prayer and meditation. Anderson grounds this in the biblical language of 'walking in the light' (1 John 1:7) — a sustained, relational, transparent orientation toward God that replaces the hiding and pretending of the addictive life. The spiritual awakening of Step Twelve is both the fruit of the steps and the seedbed for the service that follows.

8. Boundaries in Service

The clear, healthy limits that protect a person's own recovery, family, health, and spiritual condition while they are engaged in service to others. Step Twelve makes this explicit: as you sponsor and serve, you must protect your own recovery. You cannot give what you do not have, and a depleted, overextended sponsor is not a resource to newcomers — they are a liability. Cloud and Townsend's foundational teaching in Boundaries is directly applicable: saying yes to service without saying no to unsustainable demands is not generosity — it is a setup for burnout, resentment, and relapse. Healthy service has structure, rhythm, accountability, and limits — and it is more sustainable and more powerful for having them.

9. Legacy

The enduring impact — on individuals, families, communities, and the next generation of recovering people — that a person leaves behind through their faithfulness in recovery and service. Step Twelve asks directly: what kind of legacy do you want to leave? The 'dear end-of-life self' letter exercise makes this visceral: you are asked to look back from the end of your life on how you lived and what it produced. Maxwell's leadership teaching is grounded in legacy — the measure of a life is not its comfort or its accomplishments but what it left for those who came after. In the RnR framework, legacy is not abstract; it is built one honest step, one faithful amends, one well-walked sponsorship at a time.

10. Transformational Pathway

The structured, post-twelve-step phase of ongoing growth and recovery available through the RnR program — pathways focused on spiritual formation, relational health, vocational purpose, leadership, neuroscience, financial resilience, and other dimensions of a holistic, transformed life. A Transformational Pathway represents the shift from 'working the steps' to 'living the steps' as a permanent way of life. The curriculum urges beginning a Pathway immediately upon completing Step Twelve: 'Don't procrastinate. Momentum matters — delays make restarting harder.' The Pathway is the answer to the question Step Twelve implicitly asks: now that you have been transformed, what are you building? What is the next chapter of the life God is calling you toward?

11. Giving It Away

The recovery paradox that the only reliable way to keep your sobriety, your serenity, and your spiritual growth is to invest them in someone else's recovery. The curriculum states it directly: 'You can't keep it unless you give it away.' This is not

merely motivational language; it is a clinical and spiritual observation. People who serve others in recovery show significantly lower relapse rates than those who only receive. Brand grounds this in the relational foundation of recovery: connection is the opposite of addiction. Giving it away — through sponsorship, testimony, service, and ongoing community — maintains and deepens the very connections that make recovery sustainable.

12. Doers of the Word

The James 1:22 call to be people whose lives are shaped by Scripture in practical, visible action — not hearers who absorb truth intellectually without translating it into behavior, but practitioners whose recovery, relationships, work, and service are concretely changed by what they believe. Step Twelve is the step that most fully embodies this call: having worked the steps, you now live them — in your family, in your recovery group, in your church, at work, and in your community. Anderson would frame this as the integration of identity and conduct: you are who Christ says you are, and therefore you live in the way that flows from that identity. Maxwell would call it the difference between aspiration and execution — the doer is the one who closes the gap.



STEP 12: Having had a spiritual experience as the result of these steps, we try to carry this message to others and practice these principles in all our affairs.

- 1) Have you been able to reach out to another recovering addict? If so, describe the situation and how it feels to you.
- 2) What would you say if someone asked how the 12 Step program has worked for you?
- 3) How do you usually handle conflict now (this may be a very different answer than how you handled conflict before starting your recovery)?
- 4) Do you know of any way to be more effective in conflict resolution?

- If so, how would you become more effective?

- What would be the steps?

5) How much time do you want to allow (are able to allow) for working with others on their program?

6) How will you go about setting that time aside?

7) What outside resources can you call on when you need help as a sponsor?

8) How do you know if you are suited to help another person work a 12 Step program?

4. What are some of your recent victories that you could share with a newcomer?

5. In James 1:22 we are told to be "doers of the Word." How can you be a doer of the Word?

a. among family and friends?

b. in your recovery group?

c. in your church?

d. on the job?

e. in your community?

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		

LOGISTICAL PLAN FOR STEP TWELVE

1. Copy your mission statement the form at the end of step 11 here.

2. One of the scriptures driving Resilients in Recovery® tells us *“Instead, you must worship Christ as Lord of your life. And if someone asks about your hope as a believer, always be ready to explain it.”* 1 Peter 3:15 What does that verse mean for you?

3. If you knew that you couldn't fail, what would you like to do most for God in helping others?

✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 

4. What are some ways you can pick up the Lord's towel (John 13:14-15) today and start serving others?

✝ *Also write your response to this question on the prayer request page at the end of this step now.* 

a. This Week

b. This Month

c. This Year

d. Next Year

5. Are you willing to complete one of the Resilients in Recovery® Transformational Pathway as the next step in your recovery growth? Which Pathway interests you the most? (Get list from your step leader, sponsor, or Resilients in Recovery TEAM leader).
6. In the words of Step 12, how will you "practice these principles in all your affairs?"
7. Describe what the phrase "You can't keep it unless you give it away" means in your recovery.
8. Create your own action plan for Step 12. Put dates on it.
9. Is there anything that I am putting before my recovery?
10. Am I willing to practice what I have learned in this program as the new plan for my life?

On the following page:

- Write a letter to yourself, imagining yourself at the end of your life reflecting on how you lived your life.
- Describe the Legacy you hope to leave behind an impact you want to make on others and the world.
- Imagine yourself with the end of your life, looking back on time you spent here on earth.
- Write about the
 - accomplishments,
 - relationships,
 - experiences

that you hope to cherish as you embrace the temporariness of life.

Dear _____

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

TESTIMONY PREPARATION

Your testimony is a fluid thing that is never actually going to be finished. It will forever change.

In step 12 we learn that taking your recovery to others is how you keep your recovery. We speak in cliches in recovery saying that the only way to keep your recovery is by giving it away. Now it is time to start giving it away.

It is time to write your testimony.

After you have your testimony written, we will identify the first group to have the honor of hearing it.

List some possible places where you might eventually share your testimony:

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

10.



Important Points in Writing your Testimony.

- I. The key to a good testimony is not to glorify the past, which the outline says should not be more than 1/3 of the testimony. We should neither glorify sin, nor be arrogant about our past. The objective of testimonies is to provide hope for changed lives.
- II. As you are telling your story, use your age at the time when telling your story, rather than telling the year. For example, say, "When I was 27..." instead of "In 2015..." That will make your testimony more timeless to those hearing it.
- III. Review your TOP 10 lists for each of the steps. You might mention the most important thing that you learned at each step.
- IV. Review the tools you acquired as you completed each step. Those are mentioned again in one long list in an appendix after Step 12.
- V. Always think of the newcomer sitting there not believing life can get any better.
- VI. Emphasize what worked for you, what inspired you and which step impacted you and why.
- VII. Give those with struggles hope that change is possible; not by focusing on how horrible life was, but how great it is.
- VIII. The last third should be where you are today, what is God still doing (remember we are not fixed); where is God leading you?
- IX. What is your mission statement that you developed at the end of step 11
- X. Where is he challenging you and calling you to go?
- XI. How are you planning to continue your growth? Will you complete a Resilients in Recovery Transformational Path? Which one?



REPARING TO WRITE MY TESTIMONY



Writing My Testimony

Resilients In Recovery®

"It is a proof of your faith. Many people will praise God because you obey the Good News of Christ—the gospel you say you believe—and because you freely share with them and with all others."

2 Corinthians 9:13 (NCV)

"Come close and listen, all you who honor God; I will tell you what God has done for me."

Psalm 66:16 (CEB)

My Commitment

**I will complete my testimony
by:**

My accountability partner:



Before You Write: Key Principles

Read through these principles before you begin. They will shape not only what you write, but how you deliver it.

Tone & Purpose

- Begin with prayer. Ask God for the words to share.
- Your goal is to give hope, not to impress or to shock. The objective is changed lives.
- Do not glorify the past or be arrogant about it. The past should occupy no more than one-third of your testimony.
- Always picture the newcomer sitting there who doesn't believe life can get better. Write to that person.
- Be honest. Be yourself. Don't use religious clichés.
- Remember: you are not cured. Your testimony is about an ongoing journey, not a finished product.

Content & Length

- Your written testimony should be 7–20 double-spaced pages in 12-point font (approximately 15–45 minutes when read aloud).
- Use your age when telling your story, not the year. Say “When I was 27...” rather than “In 2015...” This keeps your testimony timeless.
- Review your Top 10 lists from each step and highlight what mattered most to you.
- Include your favorite scriptures.
- Identify which step(s) impacted you most and explain why.
- Include your mission statement from the end of Step 11 and your plans for a Resilients in Recovery Transformational Path.
- Consider reading your Dear Younger Me letter (from the Pre-Step) as part of the opening.

Delivery

- In Resilients in Recovery, testimonies are read from a written script—word for word. Let your listeners know this at the start.
- Read slowly. Don't let your voice drop at the end of sentences.
- Stay on script. Do not deviate or add commentary in the moment.
- If you video your testimony, be mindful of backgrounds. Seasonal or holiday decorations can make it feel dated.
- You may print your testimony in a larger font for easier reading aloud to groups.



Testimony Structure: The Four Parts

Your testimony follows four movements. Each part builds on the last, moving from where you were to where God is taking you.

Part 1: The Old Me

- a. Open with prayer.
- b. Introduce yourself: "I'm a believer who struggles with _____."
- c. Explain that you will be reading your testimony word for word, as required by Resilients in Recovery.
- d. What was the insanity of your life before recovery?
- e. What circumstances will others relate to?
- f. What was your relationship with God like? Your attitude toward others?
- g. What was your rock bottom?
- h. Optional: Read your Dear Younger Me letter from the Pre-Step.

Part 2: My Experiences and Changes in the Program

- a. How did you get into recovery?
- b. How has your growing relationship with God influenced your recovery?
- c. What spiritual warfare or interference did you encounter?
- d. Which scriptures were most important in your journey?
- e. How did working the program help you? Be specific. Which step touched your heart most, and why?
- f. How do you plan to continue growing? Which Resilients in Recovery Transformational Path will you pursue?

Part 3: The New Me

- a. What changes has God made in your relationships with others?
- b. What areas of your old life are gone, and how have they changed?
- c. How has your walk with God changed?
- d. What tools do you now have in your recovery toolkit? (Refer to the appendix after Step 12.)
- e. Share your mission statement from Step 11.
- f. Where is God leading you? What is He challenging you to do next?
- g. What Resilients in Recovery Transformational Path are you undertaking, and why does it interest you?

Part 4: Outreach

- a. What encouragement do you have for someone sitting where you once sat?
- b. Close with an invitation: challenge listeners to meet with you or another member today to learn how life change is possible through Resilients in Recovery.

RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

Step 12 Comprehension

Having had a spiritual experience as the result of these steps, we try to carry this message to others and practice these principles in all our affairs.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Instructions: Answer each question in your own words based on what you read in Step 12. If you are unsure of an answer, go back and re-read the material before responding.

Section 1 — The Step 12 Statement & Service

1. In your own words, write out the Step 12 statement and explain what it means to you.

2. Step 12 teaches that "you can't keep it unless you give it away." What does this phrase mean in the context of your recovery?

3. What does the curriculum identify as the three tools added to your tool chest in Step 12?

Section 2 — Carrying the Message

4. According to Step 12, what are some ways you can reach out to another recovering addict?

5. How does helping others benefit your own recovery? What did the material say about this?

6. What does the curriculum say about how much time you should allow for working with



others on their program, and how should you protect your own recovery while doing so?

Section 3 — Practicing Principles in All Affairs

7. What does it mean to "practice these principles in all your affairs"? Give at least two areas of life the material mentions.

8. According to the "How Can I Give Back?" section, what does Matthew 10:8 say and how does it apply to your recovery?

9. What does James 1:22 call us to be, and what are two specific areas mentioned where you can live this out?

Section 4 — Your Testimony

10. What are the four major parts of a Resilients in Recovery® testimony?

11. The curriculum says your testimony should not glorify the past — what should be its primary purpose instead?

12. According to the testimony guidelines, what practical tip is given about how you deliver your testimony to an audience?

Section 5 — The Logistical Plan & Moving Forward

- 13.** What does 1 Peter 3:15 say, and how does the Step 12 Logistical Plan apply it to your life going forward?

- 14.** In your own words, describe what your action plan for Step 12 should include, according to the curriculum.

- 15.** Is there anything you are currently putting before your recovery? What does the curriculum challenge you to do about that?

STEP 12

TRANSFORMATION & GROWTH ESSAY ASSIGNMENT

“Having had a spiritual experience as the result of these steps, we try to carry this message to others and practice these principles in all our affairs.”

— Step 12

Assignment Overview

This assignment is designed to help you reflect on the full scope of your transformation through Step 12 of the Resilients in Recovery® REBOUND STUDY curriculum. Your response should demonstrate both the depth of your personal growth and your readiness to live out the principles of recovery in every area of your life. Write thoughtfully, honestly, and with the conviction of someone who has genuinely been changed by this journey.

Essay Question

Step 12 marks not just the end of a curriculum, but the beginning of a new way of life. Reflecting on your entire experience with the Resilients in Recovery® REBOUND STUDY program as it culminates in Step 12, write a comprehensive essay that addresses the following three dimensions of your transformation:

Part I: Your Spiritual Awakening and Personal Transformation

Describe the spiritual experience or awakening that occurred as a result of working through the twelve steps. How has your relationship with God changed from where you started to where you are today? Reflect on who you were before entering recovery — your attitudes, habits, patterns of thinking, and the condition of your relationships — and contrast that clearly with the person you are now. Be specific: identify the step or steps where you experienced the most significant breakthrough and explain why those moments were pivotal. How has your understanding of surrender, honesty, accountability, and service shaped a new identity for yourself? In what ways has your walk with God become the foundation of your transformation rather than simply a component of it?

Part II: Carrying the Message — Service, Outreach, and the Call to Give Back

Step 12 calls us to carry the message to others. Explain what that call means to you personally and practically. Have you already had the opportunity to reach out to a newcomer, a struggling peer, or someone who needs hope? If so, describe that experience and what it revealed to you about your own recovery. If not yet, describe your concrete plan for doing so — including where with whom, and in what capacity you intend to serve. Drawing from the principle that “you can’t keep it unless you give it away,” reflect on how the act of helping others strengthens your own sobriety and spiritual growth. Discuss how you will protect your own recovery while giving back, and identify the boundaries and outside resources you will lean on as a sponsor or recovery support.

Part III: Your Recovery Toolbox — What You Now Carry Into the Rest of Your Life

The Resilients in Recovery® program is not just something you completed — it is the new plan for your life. Identify and describe the specific tools you have added to your recovery toolkit through Step 12, including testimony writing and sharing, the practice of service and sponsorship, and the commitment to applying the principles of the twelve steps in every area of your daily life — your relationships, your work, your community, and your faith. Beyond Step 12 specifically, reflect on the most powerful tools you gained throughout the entire program and explain how you will use each one going forward. Conclude by stating your personal mission statement (developed in Step 11) and articulating your vision for continued growth — including whether you plan to pursue a Resilients in Recovery® Transformational Pathway and what legacy you hope to leave for those who come after you.

Writing Guidelines

Your essay should be written in first person and reflect genuine personal reflection — not simply a summary of curriculum content. Responses that are vague, theoretical, or impersonal will not demonstrate the growth this assignment is designed to reveal. Be honest, be specific, and be bold in telling your story.

Use scripture where it is meaningful to you. Reference specific steps, exercises, or experiences from the REBOUND STUDY that shaped you. Draw from your Top 10 Lists for each step as a resource for recalling key moments and lessons.

Suggested length: 7–15 double-spaced pages (12-point font). Quality and depth matter more than length.

Remember: *the goal of this essay is not to prove that you are finished — it is to show that you are transformed, equipped, and ready to take your recovery into the world.*



There are 2 More Meetings after Step 12

With your sponsor, put the following items on both your calendars.

MEETING IN ONE WEEK (Date_____)

Evaluation meeting *where you will have evaluated the program by having filled out the Evaluation section.*

MEETING IN TWO WEEKS (Date_____)

You will have a practice dry run of your testimony with just your sponsor present to hear it.

- Use the guides at the end of step 12 in this notebook to help you write.
- Use your Top 10 Lists for preparation of your testimony.
- You may find that much of your testimony is already written in those Top 10 Lists.
- You just have to organize it your way.

Resilients in Recovery® Action List

(to be used during each weekly meeting with sponsor or step leader)

(take this sheet out and keep handy for notes and tasks to be assigned during this meeting with sponsor/ step leader)

Date: _____

Date	Tasks Do Get Done This Week	✓	→
	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
	4.		
	5.		
	6.		
	7.		
	8.		
	9.		
	10.		



Tool Kit

Summary



Here is a compiled list of **recovery tools we believe you have** gained for your recovery tool chest through working the 12 Steps (plus Pre-Step) in the Resilients in Recovery® Curriculum.

Recovery Tools Gained Through the 12 Steps

Resilients in Recovery® Transformation Curriculum

this list reflects the full arc of the curriculum: from the first raw acts of honesty and surrender in the early steps, through the deep inner work of inventory and amends, to the outward-facing practices of daily maintenance, prayer, and service that carry recovery forward for life.

-Pre-Step

- **Gratitude List** — The practice of daily identifying and writing down things you are thankful for; sharing it with a sponsor or trusted person
 - **Trigger Identification** — Learning to name the people, places, emotions, and situations that activate cravings or destructive patterns
 - **The Mental Light Switch Technique** — A visualization tool used to interrupt cravings and urges before they build
 - **Stress Toolkit** — A personalized set of immediate-response strategies (e.g., diaphragmatic breathing, walking, positive self-talk) for use during high-risk moments
 - **ANT Interruption (Killing Automatic Negative Thoughts)** — The practice of noticing, writing down, and replacing automatic negative thoughts with evidence-based truths
 - **Diaphragmatic (Belly) Breathing** — A calming breathwork practice to lower cortisol and activate the parasympathetic nervous system
 - **Idle Time Planning** — Intentionally filling unstructured time with healthy hobbies, service, and purposeful activity to protect recovery
 - **Sponsor/Accountability Partner Relationship** — Establishing structured relational accountability with a step guide and a peer support partner
 - **Sleep Hygiene Practices** — Developing consistent sleep routines to support brain health, neuroplasticity, and emotional stability
 - **Personal Stress Inventory** — Identifying current mental and physical stresses and the times of day that were previously high-risk for use
-



Step 1

- **Breaking Denial** — The practiced ability to honestly name and acknowledge the reality of one's struggles, failures, and powerlessness — spoken aloud, to oneself, to God, and to another person
 - **Admission of Powerlessness** — Accepting that willpower alone is insufficient to overcome addictive behaviors; this becomes an ongoing touchpoint in recovery
 - **Surrender** — The intentional decision to stop fighting one's own truth and release the illusion of self-control; foundational to all that follows
 - **Defensiveness Awareness** — Learning to notice when and why one becomes defensive as a form of self-honesty and denial detection
 - **Sponsor Contract** — A formal commitment to accountability and structure that governs the entire step study journey
-

Step 2

- **Prayer** — Beginning and sustaining a daily, honest communication practice with God — the lifeline through which strength and guidance flow
 - **The Serenity Prayer** — A specific, daily prayer tool for accepting what cannot be changed, changing what can, and gaining wisdom to know the difference
 - **Spiritual Identity Anchoring** — Replacing shame-based self-perception with Scripture-grounded identity (e.g., *child of God*, *new creation*, *God's masterpiece*)
 - **Spiritual Warfare Awareness** — The ability to recognize the enemy's lies and tactics as distinct from personal truth, and to resist them with discernment
 - **Virtues Assessment (2 Peter 1)** — An honest self-inventory of the eight qualities of spiritual growth (faith, virtue, knowledge, self-control, endurance, godliness, kindness, love) as a roadmap for transformation
 - **Hope as a Daily Practice** — Choosing forward-leaning trust in God's promises as a discipline, not just a feeling
-

Step 3

- **Daily Surrender Practice** — Making the ongoing, repeated decision to turn one's will and life over to God's care rather than relying on self-will
 - **Regular Spiritual Disciplines Plan** — Committing to a personal plan of church attendance, prayer, Bible reading, and community involvement as a structured support system
-

Step 4

- **Written Moral Inventory** — A thorough, written self-examination that surfaces resentments, fears, relational harms, struggles, shortcomings, and self-sabotaging behaviors
 - **Resentment Processing** — Identifying and naming unresolved anger toward people, institutions, and circumstances in order to break their power over behavior
 - **Fear Inventory** — Writing out fears honestly to understand how they have driven destructive decisions and relational patterns
 - **Forgiveness Work** — Beginning the intentional work of extending forgiveness to those who have caused harm, as part of moral inventory
 - **Identifying the Three Core Lists** — Distinguishing between *Struggles* (what you battle), *Shortcomings* (character defects), and *Self-Sabotaging Behaviors* (patterns that undermine recovery) — a framework used in Steps 4, 6, and 7
-

Step 5

- **Confession to God, Self, and Another Person** — Speaking one's inventory and faults aloud to God and a trusted person; breaking the power of secrecy and shame
 - **Shame Reduction through Honest Disclosure** — Experiencing the healing that comes from being fully known and fully accepted, which cannot happen in isolation
-

Step 6

- **Willingness Practice** — Cultivating the inner posture of readiness to let God remove character defects, even deeply entrenched ones
 - **Identifying Patterns of Behavior** — Reviewing the inventory from Step 4 to recognize recurring cycles and themes across struggles, shortcomings, and sabotaging behaviors
-

Step 7

- **Humble Petition (Asking God for Help)** — The ongoing practice of specifically and humbly asking God for wisdom and strength to overcome shortcomings — not by willpower, but by divine equipping
 - **Tool Chest Inventory** — Actively identifying and taking stock of what recovery tools one has accumulated through the steps so far, as a personal resource for ongoing use
-

Step 8

- **Amends List** — Writing a complete, honest list of all persons harmed, which builds the capacity for accountability, relational honesty, and willingness to repair
 - **Willingness to Make Amends** — Developing the heart posture of readiness to make things right, even before the actual amends take place
-

Step 9

- **Direct Amends** — Making face-to-face, concrete repair of harm done to others wherever possible, which releases guilt and rebuilds integrity
 - **Discernment in Amends** — Learning to determine when making amends might cause further harm (e.g., to innocent third parties) and responding wisely
-

Step 10

- **Daily Personal Inventory** — The habit of examining one's thoughts, attitudes, and behaviors each day and promptly admitting wrongs — keeping a clean relational and spiritual slate
 - **Weekly Inventory Practice** — A structured, regular self-examination routine to prevent resentments, pride, and old patterns from quietly building again
 - **Prompt Admission of Wrong** — The skill of quickly and honestly owning mistakes without delay, defensiveness, or self-condemnation
-

Step 11

- **Meditation Practice** — Developing the discipline of quieting the mind and listening for God's direction alongside regular prayer
 - **Conscious Contact with God** — A daily, intentional relational connection with God through prayer and Scripture that sustains the foundation of recovery
 - **Personal Mission Statement** — Writing and owning a clear statement of purpose and calling that guides decisions, service, and life direction going forward
-

Step 12

- **Testimony Writing and Sharing** — Crafting and delivering one's own recovery story as both a personal integration exercise and an outreach tool for others
 - **Service and Sponsorship** — Reaching back to help newcomers through the steps as the primary means of *keeping* one's own recovery
 - **Practicing Principles in All Affairs** — Applying the tools and values of the 12 Steps to every area of daily life — relationships, work, community, and faith — as a permanent new way of living
-



STEP STUDY FEEDBACK



- **EVALUATION AND FEEDBACK of RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY PROGRAM**

1. Did you have a Resilients in Recovery® coach or sponsor?
2. What has been the most helpful benefit of having a Resilients in Recovery® sponsor/coach?
3. In your opinion, is there any way that your sponsor/coach can/could have been more supportive?
4. Are the questions in the step workbook materials clear and easily understood?
5. What recommendations do you have to improve any of the questions?
6. What has changed in your personal relationships since you have been working the Resilience in Recovery® program? (Describe what has changed.)
7. Would you recommend the Resilients in Recovery® program to someone else who may have a struggle?
8. What can we do better?

9. Do you feel like the Resilients in Recovery® program has equipped you with tools to assist in maintaining your commitment to sobriety and freedom from compulsive and addictive behaviors?

10. How will you incorporate your 12th step action plan into your life going forward?

11. What changes would you recommend in future publications of our step study book?

12. Was there any confusion along the way as you worked your recovery? (Anything that the sponsor or step leaders should have or could have explained better.)

13. What would you have done differently as a step leader or Sponsor?

14. What will you plan to do differently as a sponsor when leading someone through the steps?

15. What step was the most important for you? (Explain)



16. What Bible verse(s) are the most significant in your recovery? (Explain)
17. Did you carefully work your steps pacing yourself throughout the week answering the questions or did you mainly try to get the questions answered immediately before your next step meeting?
18. Were you always prepared for your step meetings with written answers to each question?
19. Did you Complete at least six other workshops from RnR (Workshop Break 1, Workshop Break 2, and Workshop Break 3)?
20. How many outside meetings did you attend per week while completing the step study?

21. Which of those meetings helped you the most with your recovery?
22. At what point(s) did you consider quitting the step study?
23. Why did you consider quitting?
24. What kept you going/ kept you from quitting?
25. What are your thoughts about online/ zoom/ voice call meetings as opposed to in-person meetings?
26. Will you be starting a Resilients in Recovery® Transformational Pathway now? Which one?



LISTS, TABLES & REFERENCE PAGES WORTH REVISITING

These pages contain forms, inventories, and reference tools that participants often return to throughout the program.

REFERENCE ITEM	PAGE(S)
Curriculum Completion Checklist	13–14
Weekly Meeting Planner	15
Significant Milestones to Celebrate	16
Serenity Prayer	17
RnR Principles (with Scriptural Support)	32
Inner Healing Prayers for Soul Wounds	30
How to Use the RnR Curriculum Notebook	25
Strengthening Your Recovery: Essential Tools	50–59
Addictive Behavior Checklist (YES/NO/MAYBE)	117
Addictive Behavior Inventory Sheets	120–125
Preparing Myself for Real Change (Mind/Body/Church)	113–115
Diet, Brain Function & Mood Journal (7 Days)	104–111
Sponsor Agreement	46
Step 2 — My Spiritual Identity Scriptures	181–186
Step 2 — Spiritual Warfare Scriptures (Duval)	175
Step 4 — Character Defects & Assets Rating Chart	234–235
Step 4 — Traits I Despise (in Others & Myself)	233
Step 4 — Resentment & Fear: People Inventory List	271
Step 4 — Myths About Forgiveness	273
Step 4 — Personal Inventory Worksheets (10 sheets)	275–313
Step 4 — My Top 10 Lies, Scripture & Biblical Truths	253–256
Step 4 — Fruits of the Spirit	258
Step 7 — Struggles, Shortcomings & Sabotaging Behaviors	387–390
Step 7 — ACT Plan for Shortcomings	394–395
Step 9 — Amends Encounter Record Pages	441–451
Step 10 — Weekly Inventory (2 Peter 1 Virtues)	497–501
Step 10 — Daily Action Plan for Serenity	503
Step 10 — Journaling Prompts (100 prompts)	493–496
Step 11 — Personal Mission Statement Worksheet	527–531



RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY® CURRICULUM TRANSCRIPT & TRAINING LOG

Milestones & Accomplishments — Record the date each item is completed, and initial with your Sponsor / Step Leader.

MILESTONE / ASSIGNMENT	PAGE(S)	DATE COMPLETED	INITIALS
GETTING STARTED / INTAKE			
Getting to Know You / Getting to Know Your Step Leader-Sponsor	6		
Pre-Assessment Completed	11		
Pre-Sponsor Lesson — “Dear Younger Me” Letter	12		
Letter of Release (Keeping / Releasing / Filling)	13–14		
Sponsor Agreement Signed	46		
Meetings I Will Attend Sheet Completed	—		
Significant Milestones to Celebrate Sheet Started	16		
PRE-READING SECTION			
Key Terms Reviewed	35		
Top 10 Things I Learned Completed	59		
Comprehension & Progress Review Completed	84		
PRE-STEP			
Key Terms Reviewed	64		
Top 10 Things I Learned Completed	87		
TURNING POINT / EARLY RECOVERY MARKERS			
The Day You Said to Yourself, “This Isn’t Working.”	—		
One Week Clean and Sober from Struggle, Habit, or Substance	—		
Identified 3+ Accountability Partners (Daily Check-In; No Family/Girlfriend/Boyfriend)	—		
Shared First Gratitude List with 3+ People	—		
Step 1 — Admitting Powerlessness			
Key Terms Reviewed	96		
Comprehension & Essay Completed	141		
Top 10 Things I Learned Completed	147		
STEP 1 COMPLETE — Sponsor / Step Leader Sign-Off			
FIRST TIMES			
First Time Getting Through a Major Holiday Without Drinking or Using	—		
First Time Achieving a Personal Goal	—		
First Time Holding Myself Accountable	—		





MILESTONE / ASSIGNMENT	PAGE(S)	DATE COMPLETED	INITIALS
First Time Getting Through a Sports Event Without Drinking or Using	—		
First Time Getting Through a Social Gathering Without Drinking or Using	—		
First Time Celebrating Your Own Birthday Without Drinking or Using	—		
First Time Telling a Loved One That You Are Not Drinking or Using	—		
First Time Saying “No” to Someone When Putting Your Sobriety First	—		
First Time Getting a New Job After Starting Your Recovery	—		
First Time Calling an Out-of-State Friend to Say Congratulations	—		
WORKSHOP BREAK 1 — ONE-ON-ONE SESSIONS WITH STEP LEADER			
Workshop A Completed (participant's choice)	153		
Workshop B Completed (participant's choice)	153		
Step 2 — Believing in a Higher Power			
Key Terms Reviewed	160		
Comprehension & Essay Completed	192		
Top 10 Things I Learned Completed	196		
STEP 2 COMPLETE — Sponsor / Step Leader Sign-Off			
Step 3 — Turning Will Over to God			
Key Terms Reviewed	204		
Comprehension & Essay Completed	214		
Top 10 Things I Learned Completed	218		
STEP 3 COMPLETE — Sponsor / Step Leader Sign-Off			
Step 4 — Moral Inventory			
Key Terms Reviewed	226		
Comprehension & Essay Completed	317		
Top 10 Things I Learned Completed	323		
STEP 4 COMPLETE — Sponsor / Step Leader Sign-Off			
WORKSHOP BREAK 2 — ONE-ON-ONE SESSIONS WITH STEP LEADER			
Workshop A Completed (participant's choice)	329		
Workshop B Completed (participant's choice)	329		
Step 5 — Examining & Confessing Faults			
Key Terms Reviewed	336		



MILESTONE / ASSIGNMENT	PAGE(S)	DATE COMPLETED	INITIALS
Comprehension & Essay Completed	345		
Top 10 Things I Learned Completed	349		
STEP 5 COMPLETE — Sponsor / Step Leader Sign-Off			
Step 6 — Openness to Change			
Key Terms Reviewed	356		
Comprehension & Essay Completed	371		
Top 10 Things I Learned Completed	376		
STEP 6 COMPLETE — Sponsor / Step Leader Sign-Off			
Step 7 — Humbly Asking God			
Key Terms Reviewed	384		
Comprehension & Essay Completed	398		
Top 10 Things I Learned Completed	402		
STEP 7 COMPLETE — Sponsor / Step Leader Sign-Off			
Step 8 — Making an Amends List			
Key Terms Reviewed	410		
Comprehension & Essay Completed	418		
Top 10 Things I Learned Completed	421		
STEP 8 COMPLETE — Sponsor / Step Leader Sign-Off			
Step 9 — Making Direct Amends			
Key Terms Reviewed	430		
Comprehension & Essay Completed	454		
Top 10 Things I Learned Completed	458		
STEP 9 COMPLETE — Sponsor / Step Leader Sign-Off			
WORKSHOP BREAK 3 — ONE-ON-ONE SESSIONS WITH STEP LEADER			
Workshop A Completed (participant's choice)	465		
Workshop B Completed (participant's choice)	465		
Step 10 — Continuing Inventory			
Key Terms Reviewed	470		
Comprehension & Essay Completed	509		
Top 10 Things I Learned Completed	512		
STEP 10 COMPLETE — Sponsor / Step Leader Sign-Off			
THE NEW YOU			



MILESTONE / ASSIGNMENT	PAGE(S)	DATE COMPLETED	INITIALS
90 Days in Your New Job	—		
Experiencing a Repaired Relationship	—		
Resuming or Rekindling a Sober Interest or Hobby You Truly Enjoyed	—		
Developing a Habit of Writing in Your Personal Journal	—		
Taking a Vacation Without Alcohol, Substances, or Old Destructive Habits	—		
Step 11 — Prayer & Meditation			
Key Terms Reviewed	520		
Comprehension & Essay Completed	534		
Top 10 Things I Learned Completed	538		
Personal Mission Statement Worksheet Completed	529–533		
STEP 11 COMPLETE — Sponsor / Step Leader Sign-Off			
Step 12 — Carrying the Message			
Key Terms Reviewed	546		
Comprehension & Essay Completed	563		
Top 10 (embedded within Comprehension section)	563		
Personal Testimony Written (Four Parts)	561–562		
STEP 12 COMPLETE — Sponsor / Step Leader Sign-Off			
COMPLETION & GRADUATION			
Evaluation Section Completed	568–581		
Practice Testimony Dry Run with Sponsor	—		
Full Testimony Delivered to Group	—		
CURRICULUM COMPLETE — Graduation Date			





RESILIENTS IN RECOVERY®

12 Step Transformation Curriculum

Master Glossary of Key Terms & Definitions

Compiled from Version 7.2 (Steps 1–12, plus Pre-Reading and Pre-Step)

Program Directors: Ariella Robertson & Stanton Robertson | Athens, GA

How to Use This Glossary

This glossary consolidates the Key Terms & Definitions sections that appear at the start of the Pre-Reading section, the Pre-Step, and each of the Twelve Steps in the Resilients in Recovery® curriculum. Terms are listed alphabetically for quick reference. The page number(s) following each definition refer to the printed page(s) in the base curriculum (RnR_12_Step_Transformation_Curriculum_ver_7-2) where the term is introduced or defined — the first page listed is where the definition below originates; additional pages indicate the term is revisited in a later Step's Key Terms section.

A number of terms — Surrender, Boundaries, Resentment, and Amends among them — are defined more than once across the curriculum because their meaning deepens and sharpens as a participant progresses through the Steps. Where this occurs, the earliest definition is presented here as the anchor definition, with every later page reference noted for facilitators who want to trace how a term develops.

Facilitators may use this glossary as a stand-alone quick-reference sheet, a pre-group vocabulary primer, or a companion index alongside the full curriculum.

A

Accountability — p. 97, p. 160, p. 430

Step 1 · Step 2 · Step 9

The practice of giving another trusted person — a sponsor, step leader, or spiritual mentor — ongoing access to the truth of your inner life, your behaviors, and your progress. Accountability is not surveillance; it is relationship in the service of transformation. Townsend and Cloud's foundational teaching on boundaries is inseparable from accountability: we need the honest input of safe people to stay tethered to reality and moving in the right direction.

Accountability Partner — p. 63, p. 335

Pre-Step · Step 5

A trusted peer — often in the same stage of recovery — who provides regular, honest, mutual support and check-ins. Unlike a sponsor (who leads from experience), an accountability partner walks beside you as a companion. Dr. Cloud and Dr. Townsend describe this relationship as essential for maintaining healthy growth; isolation is the enemy of transformation.

Accountability Partnership — p. 35

Pre-Reading

A committed relationship with one or more trusted individuals who agree to walk alongside you in truth and love, providing consistent check-ins, honest feedback, and prayerful support. True accountability is not surveillance—it is covenant. As John Townsend and Henry Cloud describe in *Boundaries*, healthy accountability combines grace and truth, creating the safe container where real change becomes possible.

Action Plan — p. 385

Step 7

The written, specific, and concrete set of behavioral commitments that translate Step 7's spiritual intentions into daily life. An action plan answers three questions: What do I need to stop doing? What do I need to start doing? What am I already doing that I need to improve? John Maxwell's leadership philosophy is built on this principle: vision without execution is

hallucination. The Step 7 action plan makes recovery tangible, accountable, and measurable — turning a prayer into a plan and a plan into a practice.

Addiction — p. 35, p. 95

Pre-Reading · Step 1

A compulsive pattern of behavior—whether involving substances, relationships, food, sex, technology, or other sources—that temporarily fills emotional or spiritual voids but ultimately deepens them. Stephen Arterburn (Life Recovery Bible) frames addiction as 'medicating pain God never intended us to carry alone.' It is not a moral failure but a spiritual and neurological condition requiring integrated healing.

Addictions vs. Addictive Behaviors — p. 470

Step 10

A critical distinction introduced in Step Ten: addictions are the specific substances or compulsive processes (alcohol, drugs, gambling, pornography, etc.) that have been identified and addressed through the earlier steps, while addictive behaviors are the broader patterns of thought, emotion, and conduct — pride, dishonesty, people-pleasing, resentment, avoidance — that can fuel relapse and dysfunction even in the absence of the original addiction. Step Ten asks you to watch not only for your named addiction but for the addictive behaviors that created the soil in which it grew. This is the difference between surface-level sobriety and genuine transformation. Anderson's framework in *The Bondage Breaker* addresses precisely these deeper behavioral strongholds.

Addictive Behavior — p. 95

Step 1

Any repeated pattern of behavior that involves excessive allocation of time, energy, or focus to short-term rewards at the expense of long-term well-being. Unlike substance addiction, addictive behaviors may include gambling, pornography, social media, work, conflict-seeking, victim mentality, or food. The behavior becomes addictive when it produces salience, mood modification, tolerance, withdrawal, conflict, and relapse. Stephen Arterburn reminds us that anything we turn to for comfort instead of God can become a behavioral chain.

Admission — p. 95

Step 1

The courageous act of openly acknowledging the truth about your own struggles, failures, and powerlessness — spoken aloud, to yourself, to God, and to at least one other person. Admission is not defeat; it is the first act of genuine courage in recovery. As John Townsend teaches, we cannot heal what we refuse to name. Admission breaks the cycle of pretending and opens the door to real help.

Amends — p. 97, p. 357, p. 409, p. 429

Step 1 · Step 6 · Step 8 · Step 9

The act of acknowledging harm done to others and making genuine effort to repair what has been broken — addressed more fully in later steps but first recognized in Step One. Making amends is not merely an apology but a commitment to changed behavior. It is introduced here as a concept to begin taking inventory of relationships that have been damaged by addictive behavior. In Step One, the work is simply to see clearly — the making of amends comes later, in proper sequence.

Amends List — p. 411

Step 8

The written, specific inventory of persons harmed — compiled honestly and without omission — that forms the core work product of Step Eight. The amends list is not a list of apologies; it is a relational accounting. For each person listed, the step asks you to name how they were harmed as an individual and how your behavior damaged your relationship with them. It then asks you to identify possible amends — what repair might look like in each case — and to prioritize the list by level of difficulty. John Maxwell's principle applies here: "You cannot improve what you do not evaluate." The amends list makes accountability concrete, visible, and actionable.

Ancestral Patterns — p. 410

Step 8

The inherited, generational tendencies toward specific addictions, relational dysfunctions, or destructive behaviors that are transmitted through family systems across multiple generations. Exodus 20:5 addresses this reality directly: the consequences of sin can ripple through "three or four generations." Step Eight's invitation to map your family tree and renounce ancestral

addictions through Christ's blood is not superstitious — it is a holistic acknowledgment that our struggles did not begin with us, and that healing which addresses only the individual may leave deeper roots untouched. Neil T. Anderson's framework in *The Bondage Breaker* and *The Steps to Freedom in Christ* speaks directly to breaking generational strongholds as part of genuine, lasting recovery.

ASSETS — p. 225

Step 4

The God-given strengths, positive traits, and Fruits of the Spirit already operating in us (love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, etc.). Naming them prevents self-loathing and reminds us recovery is not only about what is broken but what is being redeemed. (Cloud: healthy self-view includes both shadow and light.)

Automatic Negative Thoughts (ANTs) — p. 63

Pre-Step

Habitual patterns of distorted, self-defeating thinking that arise automatically in response to stress, failure, or uncertainty — often without conscious awareness. These internal scripts ("I always fail," "Nothing ever changes") reinforce shame and trigger relapse. The work of recovery includes identifying, challenging, and replacing these thoughts with evidence-based truth.

Avoidance — p. 430

Step 9

The conscious or unconscious strategy of delaying, circumventing, or rationalizing your way out of making an amends that needs to be made — often disguised as concern for the other person's wellbeing. Step Nine asks the confronting question directly: "Am I avoiding some by pretending that it might do harm?" Avoidance is the most sophisticated form of self-protection in recovery because it wears the costume of wisdom. Russell Brand identifies avoidance as the ego's last stand — the refusal to be fully exposed and fully accountable. Avoidance is addressed in Step Nine by preparation with a sponsor, role-playing, and honest self-examination about what fears are actually driving the delay.

Avoidance and Irresponsibility — p. 356

Step 6

The pattern of sidestepping accountability — for our actions, our relationships, our health, our spiritual life — whether through distraction, delay, blame-shifting, or outright refusal to engage. Henry Cloud, in *Necessary Endings*, describes avoidance as a form of slow self-destruction: the problems we refuse to face do not disappear; they compound. Avoidance often feels like safety, but it is actually the most dangerous posture available to a person in recovery, because it freezes them exactly where they are.

B

Behavioral Relapse — p. 35

Pre-Reading

The gradual drift back toward addictive thinking patterns, emotional dysregulation, and old coping behaviors that precedes a return to physical use. As outlined in this curriculum, relapse rarely happens suddenly—it builds over time through subtle shifts in perception, attitude, and behavior. Recognizing early warning signs is essential to prevention.

Belief / Coming to Believe — p. 160

Step 2

The gradual, often messy journey from skepticism, confusion, or spiritual emptiness toward genuine trust that God exists, that He is good, and that He is powerful enough to restore you. Step Two does not demand you arrive with iron-clad faith — it asks only that you open the door. 'Coming to believe' is a process, not a single moment. It may begin with a small willingness, a quiet prayer, or a moment of honesty with another person. Over time, as God proves faithful, belief deepens into conviction.

Blood Sugar Instability — p. 98

Step 1

A physiological state in which blood glucose rises and falls rapidly — typically in response to consumption of sugar, refined carbohydrates, and processed foods — producing mood swings, anxiety, brain fog, irritability, and intensified cravings. Dr. Ken Berry's work in the Step One curriculum establishes that blood sugar rollercoasters are not merely a dietary issue; they are a

recovery issue, because they biochemically produce the very internal states — impulsivity, restlessness, craving — that make powerlessness feel inescapable.

Boundaries — p. 35, p. 64, p. 205

Pre-Reading · Pre-Step · Step 3

Personal limits—emotional, relational, physical, and spiritual—that define where you end and another person begins. Drawing from Drs. Cloud and Townsend's foundational work, healthy boundaries are not walls of self-protection but property lines of the soul that enable genuine love and responsible living. In recovery, learning to set and respect boundaries is foundational to healing.

Boundaries in Service — p. 546

Step 12

The clear, healthy limits that protect a person's own recovery, family, health, and spiritual condition while they are engaged in service to others. Step Twelve makes this explicit: as you sponsor and serve, you must protect your own recovery. You cannot give what you do not have, and a depleted, overextended sponsor is not a resource to newcomers — they are a liability. Cloud and Townsend's foundational teaching in Boundaries is directly applicable: saying yes to service without saying no to unsustainable demands is not generosity — it is a setup for burnout, resentment, and relapse. Healthy service has structure, rhythm, accountability, and limits — and it is more sustainable and more powerful for having them.

BOUNDARY VIOLATIONS — p. 225

Step 4

Ways we have allowed others to harm us without consequence, or have pushed into others' lives without permission. Healthy recovery requires learning biblical boundaries that protect both ourselves and others. (Townsend & Cloud: boundaries are not walls but gates.)

C

Carrying the Message — p. 545

Step 12

The active, intentional sharing of what happened in your recovery — your story, your experience, your tools, and your hope — with others who are still suffering from addiction or its consequences. Carrying the message is Step Twelve's primary assignment: not giving advice, not managing other people's programs, but bearing honest witness to transformation. Matthew 10:8 — 'Freely you have received; freely give' — is the theological grounding. The message that is carried is not a theory or a technique; it is a life. The testimony you develop in this step is the narrative form of that life. Maxwell would say that the most powerful form of teaching is not instruction but demonstration.

CHARACTER DEFECTS — p. 225, p. 337, p. 355, p. 385

Step 4 · Step 5 · Step 6 · Step 7

Deep-rooted traits (pride, resentment, fear, selfishness, etc.) that produce harm to ourselves and others — the "logs in our own eye" (Matt. 7:3-5) that must be owned before we can see clearly or offer genuine amends.

Compulsive Behavior — p. 96

Step 1

An action driven by an irresistible internal urge rather than conscious choice, often performed to relieve anxiety, shame, or emotional discomfort — even when the person knows it causes harm. Compulsive behavior differs from simple habit in that it persists despite negative consequences and despite repeated attempts to stop. Neil T. Anderson notes that compulsive patterns often have spiritual roots: strongholds built over time that require both truth and surrender to break.

Confession — p. 335

Step 5

The intentional, courageous act of speaking your faults, failures, and hidden wrongs aloud — to yourself, to God, and to a trusted person. Confession is not a courtroom moment; it is a healing moment. Neurologically, naming what shames us rewires the brain's threat response. Spiritually, what is spoken in honesty loses the power it once held in secrecy. James 5:16 does not merely suggest this — it declares it as the pathway to healing. Confession is not weakness; it is the bravest thing a recovering person will ever do.

Conscious Contact with God — p. 519

Step 11

The deliberate, sustained, daily awareness of God's presence and engagement in one's life — not a feeling that comes and goes, but a relational posture of attentiveness cultivated through prayer, Scripture, and intentional spiritual practice. Step Eleven names this as the primary goal of the step: 'to improve our conscious contact with God.' Neil T. Anderson describes our union with God through Christ as a settled reality — conscious contact is not establishing what isn't there, but becoming aware of what already is. Groeschel would frame it as rewiring the mind to be God-oriented rather than self-oriented: a daily, deliberate turning of attention toward the One who is always present and always speaking.

Continuing Personal Inventory — p. 469

Step 10

The ongoing, lifelong practice of honest self-examination — examining thoughts, attitudes, behaviors, and relational impact on a daily, weekly, and periodic basis. Step Ten marks a fundamental shift in the program: the Steps are no longer a project to complete, but a way of life to inhabit. John Maxwell's principle that 'you cannot improve what you do not evaluate' becomes the operational philosophy of this step. A continuing inventory is not a punishment or a sign that something is wrong; it is the recovery equivalent of regular physical exercise — the maintenance practice that keeps what was gained in Steps Four through Nine from gradually eroding through neglect.

Control — p. 203

Step 3

The illusion that we can manage all variables of life through our own effort, intelligence, or manipulation. Control is often rooted in fear — fear that if we let go, everything will fall apart. But the compulsive need to control others and circumstances is itself a form of bondage. Recovery calls us to recognize the limits of our control, release what was never ours to hold, and trust that God's sovereignty is more reliable than our grip.

Creative Amends — p. 430

Step 9

Alternate forms of repair made when a direct amends is impossible — because the person has died, cannot be located, is in a protected relationship, or would be harmed by direct contact. Creative amends may include writing a letter that is never sent, making a contribution in the person's name, performing acts of service to honor the relationship, or living differently in ways that repair the relational damage indirectly. John Maxwell's leadership principle is instructive: when the ideal path is blocked, creative leaders find another path that honors the same destination. A creative amends is not a lesser amends — it is the full expression of accountability adapted to realworld constraints.

Crossroads Awareness — p. 470

Step 10

The ongoing recognition that every day presents choice points — moments where the old patterns and the new recovery commitments pull in opposite directions — and that conscious, deliberate choosing is required at each one. The Step Ten material explicitly frames this as 'I am at a crossroads,' grounding it in 1 Corinthians 10:12: 'So, if you think you are standing firm, be careful that you don't fall!' Crossroads awareness is the antidote to the complacency that often follows early success in recovery — the subtle drift from active engagement to passive assumption that the work is done. Maxwell would call this the discipline of not believing your own press: continued progress requires continued intentionality.

D

Daily Inventory — p. 469

Step 10

A brief, consistent end-of-day (or throughout-the-day) self-examination that asks: What did I do well? Where did I fall short? Do I owe anyone an amends? Do I need to forgive anyone? What are my prayer requests? The daily inventory is the most immediate of the three inventory types in Step Ten, designed to prevent the buildup of unprocessed resentments, unacknowledged wrongs, and accumulating emotional debt that led to the dysfunction and relapse of the pre-recovery years. Ken D. Berry, M.D. would note that the body processes stress best when it is addressed in real time rather than stored; the daily inventory applies that same principle to the emotional and relational dimension of recovery.

Daily Time with God — p. 470

Step 10

The regular, unhurried, intentional period set aside each day for self-examination, Scripture reading, and prayer — the spiritual foundation on which all of Step Ten's other practices rest. The curriculum frames this daily appointment not as a religious obligation but as the power source for the recovery life: 'Reserve a daily time with God for self-examination, Bible reading, and prayer in order to know God and His will for my life and to gain the power to follow His will.' Groeschel describes it as the difference between trying to live the Christian life on a depleted battery and living it with a full charge. Without a consistent daily time with God, the other inventory practices become mere self-analysis rather than Spiritguided transformation.

Deception (Demonic) — p. 160

Step 2

The enemy's primary weapon: the introduction of lies into the mind and spirit in order to distort reality, undermine identity, promote isolation, and block recovery. Satan's deceptions often feel like your own thoughts. They say things like: 'You're too far gone.' 'God won't forgive this.' 'You don't need a group — you can handle this alone.' 'Recovery isn't working.' Spiritual discernment — the ability to test thoughts against Scripture and to recognize the enemy's voice — is a critical weapon in staying free. As 1 Timothy 4:1 warns, deceiving spirits are actively at work in this age.

Decision — p. 203

Step 3

A firm, intentional commitment of the mind and will — not merely a feeling or a wish. Step Three hinges on a decision, not an emotion. You may not feel like turning your life over to God; the decision comes anyway. Decisions precede feelings in recovery. When you decide to live differently, the feelings, the relief, and the freedom often follow. A decision made in the presence of others and written down carries weight that private intentions rarely do.

DEEP DIVE PLANNING — p. 225

Step 4

A practical, Spirit-led action plan built from Scripture, trusted Christian authors, and accountability that turns awareness of a struggle into measurable steps of obedience and freedom.

Defensiveness — p. 97

Step 1

An emotional and behavioral reaction that deflects, minimizes, or redirects honest confrontation about one's struggles. Defensiveness is denial in action — the wall going up the moment truth gets too close. In Step One work, noticing when and why you become defensive is critical self-examination. Defensiveness protects the ego at the cost of growth. Craig Groeschel reminds us that we cannot build the life we want while defending the life we have.

Denial — p. 95, p. 159

Step 1 · Step 2

The psychological defense mechanism by which a person refuses to acknowledge the reality, severity, or consequences of their own destructive patterns. Henry Cloud describes denial as a wall we build to protect ourselves from pain — but that same wall traps us inside the very prison we are trying to escape. Denial manifests as minimizing, rationalizing, blaming others, forgetting, or simply refusing to discuss what is true. Step One begins with breaking denial.

Direct Amends — p. 429

Step 9

The personal, face-to-face act of acknowledging the specific harm caused to another person and taking concrete action to repair it — going beyond an apology to actual restitution where possible. A direct amends is distinguished from an apology in that an apology addresses the speaker's guilt, while an amends addresses the injury the other person actually suffered. Stephen Arterburn describes authentic amends as the moment recovery moves from internal work to external integrity — where the inner transformation becomes visible in restored relationships and repaired damage. Step Eight begins the preparation; Step Nine is the execution.

Dishonesty — p. 355

Step 6

A broad pattern of misrepresentation that includes outright lies, half-truths, strategic omissions, and perhaps most destructively, self-deception. Neil T. Anderson, in *The Bondage Breaker*, teaches that the enemy's primary weapon is deception — and he cannot operate without our cooperation. When we are dishonest with others, we damage trust; when we are dishonest with ourselves, we forfeit the clarity needed to heal. Step 6 invites radical self-honesty as an act of spiritual courage.

Divine Equipping — p. 383

Step 7

The spiritual reality that God does not simply command change — He provides the resources, strength, and wisdom necessary to actually make it. In Step 7, the word 'equip' is central: we are not asking God merely to forgive our shortcomings but to actively equip us to overcome them. Craig Groeschel (*Winning the War in Your Mind*) describes this as God 'rewiring the brain' through His Word and Spirit. Divine equipping means we bring our willingness and God supplies the power — the change is genuinely collaborative.

Doers of the Word — p. 547

Step 12

The James 1:22 call to be people whose lives are shaped by Scripture in practical, visible action — not hearers who absorb truth intellectually without translating it into behavior, but practitioners whose recovery, relationships, work, and service are concretely changed by what they believe. Step Twelve is the step that most fully embodies this call: having worked the steps, you now live them — in your family, in your recovery group, in your church, at work, and in your community. Anderson would frame this as the integration of identity and conduct: you are who Christ says you are, and therefore you live in the way that flows from that identity. Maxwell would call it the difference between aspiration and execution — the doer is the one who closes the gap.

Dopamine — p. 98

Step 1

A neurotransmitter — a chemical messenger in the brain — associated with reward, motivation, and pleasure. Addictive substances and behaviors hijack the brain's dopamine system, creating artificial spikes of reward that over time flatten the brain's natural response to normal pleasures. Dr. Ken Berry teaches that diet, particularly sugar and processed carbohydrates, can destabilize the dopamine system in ways that directly mirror and amplify addictive cravings — making the biochemical dimension of recovery impossible to ignore.

Dry Drunk Syndrome — p. 35

Pre-Reading

A condition in which a person abstains from substances but continues to exhibit the emotional and behavioral patterns that fueled the addiction—including anger, dishonesty, restlessness, resentment, and irritability. Russell Brand (*Recovery*) and the 12-Step tradition both emphasize that sobriety without inner transformation is a fragile and incomplete healing. True recovery addresses the roots, not just the fruit.

E

Encouragement — p. 206

Step 3

The intentional act of coming alongside another person in their struggle and infusing them with courage, hope, and truth. Recovery is not a solo project — it was never designed to be. In the Resilients community, encouraging others is not just a nice idea; it is a recovery tool. When you reach back to help someone who is behind you on the road, you reinforce your own commitment to the path. Encouragement given returns to the giver in ways that cannot be manufactured any other way.

Envy and Jealousy — p. 356

Step 6

Envy is the pain we feel at another person's blessing — the corrosive sense that their gain diminishes our worth. Jealousy is the fear of losing what we already have. Both are rooted in a scarcity mindset: the belief that there is not enough love, success, beauty, or worth to go around. John Maxwell teaches that comparison is the enemy of contentment and the thief of purpose. In recovery, envy keeps us focused on other people's stories rather than our own, which is precisely where the enemy wants our attention.



Exception Clause — p. 429

Step 9

The critical qualifier embedded in Step Nine's statement: "except when doing so would injure them or others." Not every amends can or should be made directly. Some would reopen wounds, expose others to harm, or create damage greater than the original injury. John Townsend and Henry Cloud's boundaries framework applies here — discernment is required to determine whether an amends protects or harms. This clause is not an escape hatch for avoiding discomfort; it is a safeguard against well-intentioned but harmful action. This distinction must be worked through honestly with a sponsor.

Excess and Compulsion — p. 355

Step 6

The pattern of using any behavior — eating, drinking, spending, working, screen use, relationships — to numb pain, escape reality, or fill an emptiness that the behavior can never actually address. Russell Brand, in *Recovery: Freedom from Our Addictions*, describes compulsion as the soul's misdirected attempt to get somewhere real using a road that loops. Ken D. Berry, M.D., would add the physiological dimension: many compulsive cycles are anchored in biochemistry and stress response, not simply moral failure — healing therefore must address the whole person.

F

Fail Forward — p. 64

Pre-Step

The recovery-minded approach to mistakes and setbacks that treats failure not as a final verdict but as instructive data for growth. John Maxwell popularized this principle: every failure contains a lesson that, when extracted and applied, moves you further along the path than if you had never stumbled. Shame says "I am a failure"; failing forward says "I learned something."

False Belief / Lie — p. 35

Pre-Reading

A distorted thought or deeply held internal message—often rooted in trauma, abandonment, abuse, or shame—that shapes how we see ourselves, others, and God. Neil T. Anderson (*The Bondage Breaker*) teaches that spiritual and emotional captivity is sustained by believing lies (e.g., 'I am unworthy,' 'I am alone,' 'I am beyond help'). Freedom begins when these lies are identified, renounced, and replaced with biblical truth.

Family Secret — p. 98

Step 1

An unspoken but collectively maintained denial within a family system about dysfunction, abuse, addiction, or shame that 'everyone knows but no one says.' Family secrets create a culture of silence that trains children to deny reality as a survival skill — a training that often follows them directly into their own addictive patterns. Townsend and Cloud's work on dysfunctional family systems shows that until the secret is named, it continues to exercise power over every member of the family who carries it.

FEAR — p. 225

Step 4

The paralyzing belief that God will not protect, provide, or be enough. It drives control, people-pleasing, isolation, and relapse. (Townsend: fear is the enemy of boundaries and intimacy with God.)

Fear Inventory — p. 337

Step 5

The written and spoken accounting of your fears — the anxieties, phobias, insecurities, and dread that have driven decisions, relationships, and behaviors across your lifetime. Groeschel teaches that courage is not the absence of fear — it is acting in the presence of fear because you trust something bigger. The fear inventory in Step Five externalizes what has operated internally as a hidden architect of your choices. When you hear your own fears spoken aloud to a trusted witness, many of them lose the outsized power they held in the dark.

FORGIVENESS — p. 225, p. 356, p. 409, p. 430

Step 4 · Step 6 · Step 8 · Step 9

The deliberate choice to release another person from the debt they owe us — not because they deserve it, but because we refuse to let their sin define our future. It is never "forgetting" or approving the harm; it is canceling the debt so we can walk free.

Foundation — p. 63

Pre-Step

The spiritual, relational, and practical bedrock upon which lasting recovery is built. Dr. Henry Cloud and Dr. John Townsend teach that a healthy foundation includes clear boundaries, honest relationships, and a secure connection to God. Without this foundation, progress remains fragile.

FRUITS OF THE SPIRIT — p. 225, p. 471

Step 4 · Step 10

The nine qualities (love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control) the Holy Spirit produces in us when we surrender. Step Four measures our defects against these fruits and asks: "What do I really want to become?"

G

Giving It Away — p. 546

Step 12

The recovery paradox that the only reliable way to keep your sobriety, your serenity, and your spiritual growth is to invest them in someone else's recovery. The curriculum states it directly: 'You can't keep it unless you give it away.' This is not merely motivational language; it is a clinical and spiritual observation. People who serve others in recovery show significantly lower relapse rates than those who only receive. Brand grounds this in the relational foundation of recovery: connection is the opposite of addiction. Giving it away — through sponsorship, testimony, service, and ongoing community — maintains and deepens the very connections that make recovery sustainable.

Gluconeogenesis — p. 35

Pre-Reading

The body's built-in metabolic process of producing glucose from non-carbohydrate sources such as proteins and fats, used especially when dietary carbohydrates are low. Dr. Ken Berry's work challenges the myth that the brain requires dietary carbohydrates to function—the body manufactures what it needs. This is foundational to understanding why a low-carb, ketogenic approach can reduce cravings and stabilize mood during recovery.

God's Timing — p. 357

Step 6

The Step 6 prayer explicitly asks for God's perfect timing in taking action — a recognition that readiness and right timing are both gifts we receive, not schedules we dictate. Craig Groeschel teaches that one of the most faith-stretching practices in recovery is learning to move when God moves, rather than forcing outcomes on our own timetable. This is not passivity; it is active trust — continuing to prepare, pray, and cooperate while releasing control over the when and how of God's work in our lives.

God's Will — p. 204

Step 3

God's purposes, direction, and design for your life — a path characterized by love, growth, service, and wholeness. Discerning God's will requires stillness, prayer, Scripture, and the counsel of trustworthy community. God's will is not a hidden puzzle designed to confuse you; it is a relationship to be walked daily. In recovery, choosing God's will over our own is the practical outworking of Step Three every single day.

Grace — p. 409, p. 429

Step 8 · Step 9

The unearned, unconditional favor of God — freely given not because of merit, but because of His character. Grace is the theological foundation of Step Eight: it is what makes it possible to look honestly at a list of people you have harmed without collapsing into shame or abandoning the process in despair. Grace does not minimize harm; it creates the safety in which harm can be fully acknowledged. Henry Cloud and John Townsend describe grace as the relational environment in which

growth actually occurs — truth without grace crushes; grace without truth enables. Step Eight depends on both: the grace to look clearly, and the truth to look completely.

Gratitude — p. 63, p. 385

Pre-Step · Step 7

A daily, deliberate practice of recognizing and giving thanks for what is good, present, and provided — even in the midst of difficulty. Craig Groeschel teaches that gratitude rewires the mind away from scarcity and complaint toward abundance and trust. A gratitude list is not a sentiment but a spiritual discipline that shifts the lens through which you see your life.

Greed and Materialism — p. 355

Step 6

An excessive and disordered pursuit of more — more money, more status, more power, more possessions — at the expense of the people and values that actually matter. Stephen Arterburn and the New Life Ministries team note that addiction of any kind, including material addiction, is always rooted in the belief that the next thing will finally be enough. Greed is not simply about money; it is about using the external to fill an internal void that only God can satisfy.

Guilt — p. 410

Step 8

The honest recognition that you have done something wrong — that a specific action, behavior, or pattern has caused real harm to yourself or others. Guilt is healthy when it is proportionate and truth-based; it is the signal that integrity has been violated. It differs from shame in that guilt says "I did something wrong" rather than "I am something wrong." In the recovery framework, guilt is not an enemy — it is a compass. Craig Groeschel notes that guilt is the precondition for repentance and repair: you cannot make right what you will not acknowledge was wrong. Step Eight requires sitting honestly with guilt about specific people and specific harms rather than either numbing it or weaponizing it against yourself.

H

Harm — p. 409, p. 429

Step 8 · Step 9

Any damage — emotional, relational, financial, physical, or spiritual — caused to another person through our addictive behaviors, our dishonesty, our selfishness, or our neglect. Harm in Step Eight is examined honestly and without minimizing. It includes what we did directly, what we failed to do, and the ripple effects our behavior had on people who depended on or trusted us. Neil T. Anderson reminds us that unacknowledged harm leaves both the harmed and the one who caused the harm bound — confession and repair break that bondage in both directions. Facing the full scope of harm honestly is itself an act of courage and spiritual health.

Healing Through Community — p. 337

Step 5

The biblical and clinical truth that lasting recovery does not happen in isolation — it happens in the context of chosen, trusted, honest relationships. Brand's recovery framework centers on 'connection as the opposite of addiction.' Cloud and Townsend built an entire therapeutic model on it. James 5:16 grounds it in Scripture: pray for each other, confess to each other, so that healing comes. Step Five is the step that most fully embodies this truth. It requires two people — and in that requirement, it both demands and produces community.

Higher Power — p. 159, p. 204

Step 2 · Step 3

The God of the Bible — the all-knowing, all-powerful Creator who stands infinitely above human ability and understanding. In Step Two, we begin to loosen our grip on the illusion of self-sufficiency and open ourselves to the reality that real, lasting change flows from a source beyond our own willpower. As Philippians 2:13 declares, God is working in you — giving both the desire and the power to do what pleases Him. This is not a vague spiritual force but a personal Father who knows your name, hears your cry, and is fully capable of doing what you cannot do for yourself.

Holistic Healing — p. 411

Step 8

Recovery that addresses not only the surface behavior of addiction but its relational, spiritual, emotional, generational, and physical roots — so that healing is comprehensive rather than cosmetic. Step Eight contributes to holistic healing by asking participants to face not just what the addiction cost them, but what it cost others — and to include generational patterns (Exodus 20:5) in their healing work. Ken D. Berry, M.D. would note that the body itself carries the weight of unprocessed harm and unrepaired relationships; healing that bypasses the relational and spiritual dimensions never reaches the roots. Holistic healing is the goal of the RnR curriculum as a whole, and Step Eight is one of its most powerful contributors.

Honest Disclosure — p. 336

Step 5

The full, unexpurgated truth about yourself — told without minimizing, rationalizing, or strategically omitting the parts that make you look worst. Berry would note that the body itself keeps score of unprocessed stress and dishonesty; honest disclosure is part of the metabolic process of healing. Anderson frames it theologically: you cannot walk in the freedom Christ purchased while hiding in the darkness of half-truths. Honest disclosure in Step Five is not about punishment — it is about precision. You cannot heal what you will not name.

Hope — p. 160, p. 385

Step 2 · Step 7

The confident, forward-leaning expectation that God is not finished with you — that healing is possible, that change is real, and that your story is not over. Biblical hope is not wishful thinking; it is a secure anchor for the soul (Hebrews 6:19), grounded in the character of God and the promises of His Word. Jeremiah 29:11 declares that God has plans to give you a future and a hope. In recovery, hope is both a gift and a practice — something you receive from God and something you choose to hold onto, one day at a time.

Humble Petition — p. 384

Step 7

A focused, specific, and repeatable act of prayer in which a person comes before God — not with vague spiritual language, but with clear and honest requests for help with named shortcomings. Humble petition is the engine of Step 7. It differs from casual prayer in its intentionality and its honesty: we are telling God exactly what we are struggling with and asking Him to do what we are unable to do. Fred Stoeker describes this as 'target-specific prayer' — aiming at the actual enemy, not a general spiritual fog.

Humbly Ask — p. 383

Step 7

The active, deliberate, ongoing practice of coming before God with specific requests — not as a one-time transaction, but as a lifestyle. Stephen Arterburn and Fred Stoeker (Every Man's Battle) describe this as 'bringing your battle to God daily.' It means naming what you need, being honest about your inability to fix yourself, and remaining open to God's timing and methods. Humbly asking is the opposite of demanding, bargaining, or trying to negotiate with God about which shortcomings you are willing to give up.

Humility — p. 356, p. 383

Step 6 · Step 7

Accurate self-perception in the presence of God — neither inflated nor deflated, but honest. Humility is not self-contempt; it is the willingness to see ourselves clearly and to receive help we could not generate on our own. Neil T. Anderson describes humility as the soil in which all genuine spiritual growth occurs: without it, no real work can take root. In Step 6, humility means admitting the full cost of our struggles without minimizing them and without using them to define us permanently.

I

Identity — p. 204

Step 3

Who you fundamentally are — not what you have done, not what has been done to you, and not what the world has labeled you. In Christ, your identity is rewritten. You are no longer defined by your addiction, your failures, or your worst moments. Understanding your true identity is not a luxury in recovery — it is a necessity. When you know who you are, you know what you are worth, and you stop settling for less.

**Idle Time** — p. 64*Pre-Step*

Unstructured, unoccupied hours that — without intentional filling — become fertile ground for temptation, rumination, and relapse. In recovery, the danger of too much free time is real: the mind left without direction drifts toward old patterns. Replacing idle time with purposeful activities (service, creativity, exercise, community) is a recovery strategy, not just a preference.

Inner Healing — p. 35*Pre-Reading*

A prayerful, Spirit-led process of inviting Jesus Christ into unresolved traumatic memories to reveal His presence, replace lies with truth, and release emotional and spiritual wounds. Unlike cognitive therapy alone, inner healing addresses the spiritual dimension of pain—recognizing that only the Healer Himself can fully restore what was broken (Psalm 147:3). It is a foundational pre-step practice in the Resilients in Recovery program.

Integrity — p. 430*Step 9*

The alignment of your inner life — your values, beliefs, and commitments — with your outer life — your words, actions, and relationships. Integrity is the ultimate goal of Step Nine: not merely making peace with others, but becoming a person whose inner and outer worlds are no longer divided. Stephen Arterburn describes authentic recovery as moving from internal transformation to external integrity. Craig Groeschel would add that integrity is not what you do when people are watching — it is what you do when no one is. Step Nine closes the gap opened by years of double living and begins to build the unified self that genuine recovery requires.

Intentionality — p. 36*Pre-Reading*

The deliberate, proactive choice to pursue growth, healing, and recovery rather than simply reacting to life's circumstances. John Maxwell defines intentional living as making every day count by aligning your choices with your values and goals. In recovery, intentionality means scheduling your writing, attending your meetings, and doing the work—before you feel like it.

Inventory Presentation — p. 336*Step 5*

The 10-to-20 minute oral or written summary of your Step Four work, delivered to your sponsor and accountability partners. This is the act that moves your inventory from a private document into a communal covenant. Maxwell's principle applies here: 'You cannot improve what you do not evaluate, and you cannot own what you do not say aloud.' The presentation is not a performance — it is a milestone. It marks the moment you stopped hiding from your story and started telling it on your terms.

Isolation — p. 97*Step 1*

The pattern of withdrawing from safe community, relationships, and accountability — often as a way to protect the addiction or to avoid the shame associated with it. Isolation is one of addiction's most powerful tools. It removes the mirrors that help us see ourselves clearly and eliminates the voices that might speak truth into our lives. John Townsend teaches that healing never happens in isolation — it happens in relationship, in community, with others who are trustworthy and willing to tell us the truth in love.

J**Journaling** — p. 470*Step 10*

The practice of writing regularly — daily or weekly — as an act of self-examination, emotional processing, and spiritual attentiveness. The RnR curriculum offers two journal formats for Step Ten: a traditional daily inventory format (feelings, victories, struggles, amends owed, prayer requests) and a Fruits of the Spirit format (examining the day through the lens of love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control from Galatians 5:22-23). Berry would note that writing engages the prefrontal cortex in ways that purely emotional processing does not — it creates narrative,

imposes structure on chaos, and makes patterns visible. Journaling is not optional decoration in Step Ten; it is the primary mechanism of the daily inventory.

K

Ketogenic / Low-Carb Nutrition — p. 36

Pre-Reading

A dietary approach that prioritizes healthy fats, proteins, and non-starchy vegetables while minimizing refined sugars, grains, and starches. Dr. Ken Berry demonstrates that this way of eating stabilizes blood sugar, reduces neurological inflammation, supports healthy dopamine and serotonin function, and significantly lowers cravings—making it a powerful companion to 12-Step recovery. It is an act of stewardship over the body as God's temple (1 Corinthians 6:19).

Knowledge of God's Will — p. 519

Step 11

The practical, progressive, daily discernment of what God is calling you to think, say, and do — not a mystical state accessible only to the spiritually advanced, but a relational awareness that grows through consistent time in prayer, Scripture, and community with other believers. Step Eleven specifies that we seek knowledge of God's will — not certainty about every future event, not a five-year plan handed down from heaven, but directional clarity for the present day. Anderson grounds this in the sufficiency of Scripture: God's will is substantially revealed in His Word, and meditation on that Word trains the discernment to apply it in daily decisions. Groeschel would add that the renewed mind — shaped by God's truth rather than the world's patterns — is itself the primary instrument of discerning God's will.

L

Legacy — p. 546

Step 12

The enduring impact — on individuals, families, communities, and the next generation of recovering people — that a person leaves behind through their faithfulness in recovery and service. Step Twelve asks directly: what kind of legacy do you want to leave? The 'dear end-of-life self' letter exercise makes this visceral: you are asked to look back from the end of your life on how you lived and what it produced. Maxwell's leadership teaching is grounded in legacy — the measure of a life is not its comfort or its accomplishments but what it left for those who came after. In the RnR framework, legacy is not abstract; it is built one honest step, one faithful amends, one well-walked sponsorship at a time.

LIE VS. BIBLICAL TRUTH — p. 225

Step 4

Every struggle is fueled by a specific lie we have believed about God, ourselves, or others. Step Four requires us to name the lie, replace it with Scripture, and rehearse the truth daily until it rewires our thinking. (See your Lie/Truth Supplement for each struggle.)

Listening Prayer — p. 520

Step 11

The practice of slowing down after speaking to God in prayer to create space for His response — remaining quiet, attentive, and receptive rather than treating prayer as a one-way monologue. The Step Eleven material asks directly: 'After you pray, do you slow down long enough to hear God's answer?' Listening prayer is the relational counterpart to petition prayer; it treats the conversation with God as genuinely dialogical. Anderson would ground this in the believer's direct access to God through the indwelling Spirit — the still small voice that Elijah encountered (1 Kings 19:12) is the same Spirit available to every believer who creates the stillness to receive what He speaks.

Living Sacrifice — p. 205

Step 3

The image Paul presents in Romans 12:1 — a life fully given over to God, not killed on an altar, but alive and actively devoted. Unlike Old Testament sacrifices that were slain and burned, a living sacrifice keeps getting up and choosing God each day. This is the daily rhythm of Step Three: laying down self-will repeatedly, not as defeat, but as devotion. The challenge Paul notes is that living sacrifices can crawl off the altar — and we must keep climbing back.



Lordship — p. 204

Step 3

The condition of allowing Christ to occupy the CEO position of your life — directing your choices, values, relationships, and priorities. Lordship is the practical outcome of Step Three. When you make the decision to turn your life and will over to the care of God, you are establishing Christ as Lord. Lordship is not about religious performance; it is about daily, honest accountability to a God who loves you too much to leave you the way you are.

Lust — p. 355

Step 6

The reduction of a person — or an experience — to an object of gratification. Lust is not limited to sexual desire; it encompasses any obsessive craving that overrides values, damages relationships, and treats others as means rather than ends. Fred Stoeker teaches that lust is a habit of the eyes and the mind long before it becomes a habit of behavior, which is why the battle must be engaged at the level of thought. In Step 6, we ask honestly: what has this struggle given us, and what has it taken away?

M

Meaning — p. 206

Step 3

The deep sense of purpose, significance, and direction that makes life worth living and recovery worth fighting for. Viktor Frankl observed that those who have a 'why' can endure almost any 'how.' In recovery, finding meaning — in faith, relationships, service to others, and a story being redeemed — is not optional. It is the fuel that sustains the long journey. Step Three connects us to the ultimate source of meaning: a God who does not waste our wounds.

Meditation — p. 519

Step 11

The practice of quieting the mind, stilling the noise of self-will and external distraction, and creating interior space to hear God's direction — as distinct from prayer, which is speaking to God. In the RnR framework, meditation is not passive emptying or Eastern mindfulness disconnected from Scripture; it is the act of sitting with God's Word, slowing down enough to listen, and allowing what has been read and prayed to settle into the heart. Colossians 3:16 captures the spirit of this: 'Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly.' Meditation is the discipline of making room for that dwelling. Groeschel's neuroscience-informed spirituality would note that meditation literally changes the brain — it builds attentional capacity, reduces stress reactivity, and trains the mind toward stillness.

Milestone Celebration — p. 36

Pre-Reading

The intentional marking of progress in recovery—whether a day, a week, 30 days, 90 days, a year, or the completion of a Step—in ways that affirm growth without creating new risks. Celebrations in recovery are reimagined: they are sober, safe, and meaningful, often shared with a sponsor or accountability partner over a meal, a walk, or a moment of prayer.

Mood Modification — p. 96

Step 1

The use of a substance or behavior as a tool to change or regulate one's emotional state — to manufacture a high, escape discomfort, numb pain, or de-stress. Mood modification is one of the six diagnostic markers of addiction. Dr. Ken Berry connects this directly to brain biochemistry: addictive substances and behaviors hijack the brain's natural reward and stress systems, training the person to seek chemical relief rather than real resolution of underlying pain.

Moral Inventory — p. 36, p. 226, p. 335

Pre-Reading · Step 4 · Step 5

A thorough, written self-examination (associated with Step 4) that surfaces resentments, fears, relational harms, and character patterns that have fueled addictive behavior. As Craig Groeschel notes, we cannot change what we are unwilling to honestly confront. The inventory is not an exercise in shame—it is an act of courageous self-awareness that opens the door to genuine transformation.

MY PART — p. 226

Step 4

The honest column on every inventory sheet where we own our selfishness, dishonesty, fear, blame, and wrong. Taking "my part" is the doorway to freedom and the only place real change begins.

N

Neuroplasticity — p. 64

Pre-Step

The brain's God-given ability to change, rewire, and form new patterns of thought and behavior throughout life. Recovery is literally possible at the level of the brain. New habits, new thoughts, and new spiritual practices create new neural pathways. This is the science behind what Neil T. Anderson calls the renewing of the mind (Romans 12:2) — transformation is not just spiritual; it is neurological.

Not Guilty (Justification) — p. 206

Step 3

The legal and spiritual declaration of Romans 8:1 — that those who are in Christ Jesus are no longer judged guilty. Justification is not the same as being told your actions had no consequences; it is the stunning truth that the penalty has been paid and the verdict has been changed. In recovery, understanding that you are not condemned is essential. Shame drives relapse. Freedom from condemnation creates the safe space in which genuine transformation can happen.

O

One Day at a Time — p. 205

Step 3

The recovery principle that sustainable change is not achieved by conquering the future, but by making one right choice today. Worry, anxiety, and overwhelm are often products of projecting our fears into an uncertain future. The invitation of Step Three is to place tomorrow in God's hands and focus your energy on faithful, surrendered living in the present moment. Grace sufficient for today is always available; grace for next year cannot be borrowed in advance.

P

Patterns (Addictive / Behavioral) — p. 384

Step 7

The repeated sequences of thought, feeling, and action that form the grooves of our addictive or destructive lives. Patterns are not random — they follow predictable triggers, emotional states, and environments. Neil T. Anderson teaches that patterns rooted in false beliefs must be broken at the level of the mind, not just the behavior. Recognizing patterns — as Step 7 specifically asks us to do — is the first step toward interrupting them. A pattern you can name is a pattern you can begin to change.

Patterns of Behavior — p. 356

Step 6

Recurring cycles of thought and action that have become so familiar they operate largely on autopilot. Where a single failure is an event, a pattern is a lifestyle. John Maxwell teaches that we do not rise to the level of our intentions; we fall to the level of our habits. Step 6 works from the inventory of Step 4 to identify these patterns — not to produce shame, but to produce clarity. You cannot surrender what you have not named, and you cannot change what you refuse to see.

Periodic Inventory — p. 469

Step 10

A deeper, less frequent examination — monthly, quarterly, or after significant life events — that evaluates the broader arc of your recovery, your relationships, your spiritual condition, and your alignment with your values and mission. The periodic inventory is the 'big picture' lens. It catches what the daily and weekly inventories might miss because they are too close to specific events. Craig Groeschel describes this as the kind of honest audit that forces us to confront comfortable self-deception — the slow drift that doesn't feel dramatic enough to notice day by day but that, over months, can quietly undo significant work.



Personal Mission Statement — p. 520

Step 11

A concise, written declaration of a person's core values, purpose, strengths, and life direction — developed in Step Eleven as an expression of the God-given calling that recovery has made visible and accessible. The personal mission statement is not a corporate vision statement or an aspirational slogan; it is a character-grounded commitment to live intentionally in alignment with who God has made you to be and what He is calling you to do. Maxwell's leadership philosophy is foundational here: 'A leader without a vision is a leader without direction.' The mission statement produced in Step Eleven becomes the compass for Step Twelve's service work and for all of the participant's ongoing recovery decisions. It is the answer to the question: now that I am free, what am I free for?

Power to Carry It Out — p. 520

Step 11

The Spirit-provided strength, courage, and capacity to actually do what God calls you to do — including the things that your own human effort, willpower, or resolve cannot sustain. Step Eleven pairs 'knowledge of God's will' with 'power to carry that out' because knowledge without power produces only more defeat. This pairing is theologically precise: the Christian life is not a self-improvement project powered by good intentions; it is a Spirit-empowered life available to those who remain in close conscious contact with God. Berry would note that willpower is a biologically finite resource — it depletes under stress, fatigue, and emotional load. The power Step Eleven seeks is a different order of resource entirely: inexhaustible, available, and given to those who ask.

Powerlessness — p. 95, p. 160

Step 1 · Step 2

The honest recognition that you do not have, within yourself, the ability to consistently control or stop your addictive behaviors by willpower alone. This is not weakness — it is honesty. Romans 7:18 captures it: 'I can will it, but I can't do it.' John Maxwell teaches that the first step toward transformation is acknowledging the gap between who you are and who you want to be. Powerlessness is not the end of the story; it is the beginning of surrender to a Power greater than yourself.

Practicing Principles in All Affairs — p. 546

Step 12

The commitment to apply the values, habits, and spiritual postures developed through the twelve steps — honesty, humility, accountability, service, surrender, prayer, amends — to every area of daily life, not just to recovery meetings or step work. 'All affairs' is expansive and intentional: relationships, family, work, finances, church, community. James 1:22 — 'Be doers of the Word' — captures the call precisely. This is the step that closes the gap between recovery as a program and recovery as a life. Maxwell would call it the difference between knowing and growing: principles known but not practiced produce no transformation; principles practiced in 'all affairs' become character.

Prayer — p. 161, p. 519

Step 2 · Step 11

Direct, honest, ongoing communication with God — speaking and listening — that forms the backbone of recovery, spiritual warfare, and relationship with your Heavenly Father. Prayer is not a religious performance; it is the lifeline through which God's power flows into your daily life. It is how you surrender control, how you fight the enemy, how you receive guidance, and how you stay connected to the Source of your healing. In Step Two, prayer is both a practice to develop and a posture to maintain: the humility of a person who knows they cannot do this alone. Transformation Curriculum VER 7.0 • For Recovery. For Freedom. For Life.

Pride — p. 97, p. 355

Step 1 · Step 6

The posture of the self that insists on self-sufficiency, refuses to ask for help, and resists accountability. Pride disguises itself as strength but functions as a barrier to healing. Henry Cloud and John Townsend write extensively on how pride — the refusal to need others — is the engine that keeps people stuck in destructive patterns. In Step One, pride must be identified and named, because it is pride that sustains denial and prevents the admission of powerlessness.

Prioritization — p. 411

Step 8

The process of ordering your amends list by difficulty, risk, or relational sensitivity — so that you and your sponsor can approach the work of Step Nine in a thoughtful, prepared, and sustainable sequence. Step Eight does not require you to

complete all amends at once; it requires you to become willing to make all of them, and to begin thinking through them with wisdom. Prioritization also involves honestly examining the consequences you fear: What is the worst that can happen? What is the best? What is most likely? Sitting with these questions — rather than avoiding them — is one of the most important forms of emotional and spiritual preparation this step asks of you.

Progress Over Perfection — p. 470

Step 10

The foundational recovery principle that the goal of Step Ten — and of recovery as a whole — is not to achieve a flawless daily record but to sustain honest self-examination, continuous correction, and genuine forward movement. The curriculum quotes a recovery elder: 'Nothing changes if nothing changes' — and the corollary is that change does not require perfection, only honesty and persistence. Brand's recovery framework is grounded in this: recovery is not a performance of impeccability; it is a practice of ongoing return to the right path after every deviation. Step Ten's daily and weekly inventories are tools for honest course correction, not scorecards for judgment.

Prompt Admission of Wrong — p. 469

Step 10

The discipline of acknowledging error, harm, or moral failure quickly — without delay, defensiveness, or selfcondemnation — as soon as you become aware of it. 'Promptly' is a key word in Step Ten, and the curriculum treats it seriously. Delay allows rationalization to set in. Defensiveness converts an opportunity for repair into a second injury. Selfcondemnation, while feeling like humility, is actually a form of self-focus that delays the repair work. Prompt admission of wrong is the daily-level application of the amends process from Steps Eight and Nine. It keeps the relational slate clean and prevents the kind of accumulated debt that requires a full inventory process to address.

R

Readiness — p. 337, p. 356

Step 5 · Step 6

The internal posture of willingness — an honest openness to allow God to change not just your behavior, but your character. Arterburn and Stoeker speak of this as 'every man's battle' moving from a battle of conduct to a battle of the will. Maxwell would frame it as the moment a leader finally submits their greatest weakness to a greater authority. Readiness in the context of Step Five means being willing to hear your inventory received without self-rescue, and then being willing to let it lead you into the change work ahead.

Reconciliation — p. 411, p. 430

Step 8 · Step 9

The restoration of a broken or damaged relationship to a state of mutual goodwill — a possible outcome of the amends process, but not a guaranteed one and not required for the amends to be valid. Reconciliation requires a willing response from the other party; an amends requires only honesty and willingness from you. Cloud and Townsend draw this distinction clearly: you are responsible for your side of the relationship, not for the other person's response. Making an amends that is received with hostility or indifference is still a valid amends. The goal of Step Eight and Nine is integrity and repair — not the management of how others respond to your honesty.

Recovery — p. 36, p. 63

Pre-Reading · Pre-Step

A lifelong, ongoing process of healing—physical, emotional, relational, and spiritual—that moves a person from the grip of addiction toward freedom, wholeness, and purpose. Recovery is for everyone, whether struggling with substances, behavioral compulsions, trauma, or relational dysfunction. It is not a destination but a direction—and every honest step forward counts.

Recovery Tool Chest — p. 384

Step 7

The growing personal collection of spiritual, relational, emotional, and practical resources a person actively assembles throughout the recovery process. Just as a skilled craftsman does not tackle every job with a single tool, sustainable recovery requires a variety of tools deployed wisely. Step 7 asks us to take inventory of what is already in our tool chest — including what we've learned in previous steps — and to identify what we still need. This concept reflects John Maxwell's emphasis on intentional personal growth: we develop what we deliberately practice.

**REFLECT Check** — p. 520*Step 11*

The daily self-examination tool developed in the RnR curriculum to identify emotional and spiritual states that threaten recovery before they become crises: Resentful, Exhausted, Fearful/Anxious, Lonely/Isolated, Easily Angered, Carrying Guilt or Shame, Tense or Stressed. The REFLECT Check is directly connected to Step Eleven's invitation to ongoing conscious contact with God — it is a brief, grace-oriented diagnostic that invites honesty rather than demanding performance. A 'yes' to any of the REFLECT indicators is not failure; it is data. The curriculum frames it as an invitation to bring whatever is true to God, to a sponsor, and to the principles of the program. Brand would recognize this kind of honest checking-in as fundamental to the relational, attentive lifestyle that recovery requires.

Regress / Regression — p. 384*Step 7*

The return to earlier, less healthy patterns of thinking or behavior during the recovery process — commonly known as relapse in the context of addiction. Regression is not the end of recovery; it is a predictable hazard that must be prepared for. Stephen Arterburn emphasizes in *New Life Live* that regression often follows stress, loss, or overconfidence. Understanding what conditions increase vulnerability to regression allows us to build safeguards, practice prevention, and respond to slips with self-compassion rather than shame-fueled abandonment of the recovery process.

Relapse — p. 96*Step 1*

The return to addictive patterns after a period of abstinence or recovery progress. Relapse is not the end of recovery — but it is always a serious warning. John Maxwell teaches that failure is not final unless you stop learning from it. Neil T. Anderson emphasizes that relapse often signals an unaddressed lie, wound, or stronghold that has not yet been surrendered to God. Understanding the triggers and internal conditions that lead to relapse is essential homework throughout recovery.

Relapse Prevention — p. 36, p. 64*Pre-Reading · Pre-Step*

A proactive set of strategies, spiritual disciplines, and relational structures designed to interrupt the early stages of behavioral and emotional regression before they escalate to physical use. Effective prevention involves knowing your triggers, doubling your meeting attendance during vulnerable seasons, addressing resentments, practicing service, and maintaining close contact with your sponsor and accountability team.

Relational Repair — p. 431*Step 9*

The gradual, sustained process of rebuilding trust, safety, and goodwill in a relationship that has been damaged by addictive behavior — extending beyond the single act of an amends into a commitment to consistent, changed conduct over time. Cloud and Townsend are explicit: trust is not rebuilt by declarations but by demonstrated patterns of behavior sustained over time. Step Nine initiates relational repair; continued sobriety and changed character sustain it. Craig Groeschel would note that the words of an amends plant a seed, but only the fruit of a changed life proves the root has actually changed. Relational repair is the long game of recovery — and it is among the most powerful testimonies of transformation.

Renewal of Mind — p. 205*Step 3*

The ongoing, Spirit-empowered transformation of the way you think — replacing lies, distortions, and addictive thought patterns with truth. Romans 12:2 frames this as refusing conformity to the world's patterns and being 'transformed by the renewing of your mind.' In recovery, we cannot simply stop destructive behavior; we must rewire the thinking that drives it. The renewed mind is not built overnight; it is constructed brick by brick through Scripture, community, and honest self-examination.

Renewal of the Mind — p. 160*Step 2*

The ongoing, Spirit-empowered process of replacing false, destructive, and shame-based thinking with truth rooted in Scripture and identity in Christ. Romans 12:2 calls believers to 'be transformed by the renewing of your mind.' In recovery, the battle is often as much mental as it is physical or behavioral. Old thought patterns — formed by trauma, addiction, false beliefs, and the enemy's lies — must be actively dismantled and rebuilt. This is not behavior modification; it is deep, lasting transformation from the inside out.

Repentance — p. 204

Step 3

More than remorse or regret, repentance is a complete change of direction — a turning away from selfdestructive patterns and a turning toward God. The Greek word metanoia means a transformation of the mind. Repentance is not self-punishment or shame-soaked confession; it is a gift of grace that makes a new beginning possible. In recovery, repentance is the soil in which genuine change takes root and grows.

Resentment — p. 36, p. 97, p. 226, p. 337, p. 410

Pre-Reading · Step 1 · Step 4 · Step 5 · Step 8

Unresolved anger, bitterness, or offense toward a person, situation, or institution that is held internally and rehearsed over time. Often called 'the number one offender' in recovery circles, resentment is both a primary cause and consequence of relapse. Fred Stoeker (Every Man's Battle series) and the 12-Step tradition both emphasize that resentment is a poison we drink while expecting the other person to suffer.

Restitution — p. 430

Step 9

The act of restoring — to the degree possible — what was taken, damaged, or destroyed through your addictive behaviors. Restitution is the most concrete expression of an amends: repaying money borrowed or stolen, replacing what was broken, fulfilling neglected responsibilities, or returning what was withheld. Ken D. Berry, M.D. would note that the body and mind carry the unresolved weight of unpaid debts — emotional, relational, and material — and that the act of restitution produces a physiological and psychological release that confession alone cannot. Where full restitution is impossible, a genuine acknowledgment and a commitment to change serves as its functional equivalent.

Restoration — p. 159

Step 2

The divine process by which God rebuilds and renews what addiction, trauma, sin, and self-will have broken down. Restoration is not simply returning to a former state — it is transformation into something stronger, healthier, and more whole than before. It involves the renewal of the mind (Romans 12:2), the healing of emotional wounds, the rebuilding of relationships, and the recovery of dignity. God does not discard what is broken; He restores it. This is the promise at the heart of Step Two.

Romans 12:1–2 Transformation — p. 384

Step 7

The biblical anchor of Step 7 and the theological framework for lasting change. Paul's instruction to offer our 'everyday, ordinary lives' to God as an offering, and to refuse conformity to the surrounding culture in favor of a 'renewing of the mind,' describes precisely what this step is asking for. John Maxwell calls this principle 'intentional living.' The transformation Paul describes is not cosmetic — it is from the inside out, producing a new mind that can discern and freely choose God's good and perfect will.

S

Sabotaging Behaviors — p. 356, p. 383

Step 6 · Step 7

The specific actions — often unconscious — by which we undermine our own progress, relationships, and healing. Sabotage frequently disguises itself as logic: the reason we picked a fight, isolated ourselves, skipped a meeting, or returned to a harmful habit almost always felt reasonable in the moment. Stephen Arterburn identifies self-sabotage as one of the most insidious dynamics in recovery, because it operates from the inside. Recognizing these behaviors — and naming the unmet need or fear behind them — is essential groundwork for lasting change.

Safe Person / Safe Relationship — p. 336

Step 5

As defined by Cloud and Townsend, a safe person is someone who draws you closer to who God designed you to be, accepts you without shaming you, and is honest enough to call out what is harmful in your life. Choosing a safe person for your Step Five presentation is not optional — it is essential. The wrong listener can re-traumatize. The right listener can become an

agent of profound transformation. Safety does not mean someone who never challenges you; it means someone who is for you even when the truth is hard.

Salience — p. 96

Step 1

A hallmark marker of addiction in which a particular substance or behavior becomes the single most important thing in a person's life — crowding out relationships, responsibilities, and God. When salience is present, the person organizes their entire daily existence around the addictive activity. Fred Stoeker's work on purity and recovery identifies salience as the moment an appetite crosses over into a tyrant, demanding to be fed above all else.

Sanity — p. 159

Step 2

Sound, God-aligned thinking and behavior grounded in truth rather than distorted by fear, addiction, pride, trauma, or self-deception. Insanity, in the recovery context, is continuing the same destructive behaviors and expecting different results. True sanity is not merely the absence of chaos — it is the restoration of the mind to its created purpose: to perceive reality clearly, to make decisions wisely, and to respond to life's challenges from a place of inner peace. 2 Timothy 1:7 reminds us that God has not given us a spirit of fear but of power, love, and self-discipline — all hallmarks of a sane and restored mind.

Secrecy (The Power of) — p. 336

Step 5

The hidden force that keeps wounds infected and patterns entrenched. Secrets do not protect us — they imprison us. Arterburn and Stoeker describe the way unconfessed sexual and relational sin operates like a double life, splitting identity and draining integrity. Brand frames addiction itself as a disease of disconnection sustained by shame and concealment. Step Five is a direct assault on secrecy. When a trusted witness hears your story and remains present, the secret loses its grip. Secrecy requires darkness; Step Five turns on the light.

Self-Care — p. 36

Pre-Reading

The intentional, disciplined practice of tending to your own physical, emotional, and spiritual health—not as indulgence, but as stewardship. In this curriculum, self-care is the organizing principle beneath all recovery disciplines: daily writing, prayer, nutrition, sleep, accountability, and meeting attendance. You cannot give what you do not have. Caring for yourself is an act of faithfulness.

Self-Forgiveness — p. 411

Step 8

The process of releasing the self from the ongoing condemnation, punishment, and self-contempt that linger after guilt and shame have done their work. Self-forgiveness is one of the three dimensions of forgiveness identified in Step Eight — and often the most difficult. Many people in recovery find it easier to believe God has forgiven them than to forgive themselves. Stephen Arterburn and Neil T. Anderson both address this: self-condemnation that persists after genuine repentance is not humility — it is a refusal to receive the grace that Christ purchased. The work of becoming willing to make amends includes becoming willing to forgive yourself, because a person who cannot accept their own forgiveness struggles to extend genuine amends to others.

Self-Honesty — p. 337

Step 5

The foundational discipline of seeing yourself as you actually are — neither worse than the truth nor better than the truth. Townsend and Cloud identify self-deception as the primary blocker of growth: 'The person who has no awareness of their patterns is powerless to change them.' Self-honesty in Step Five means reviewing your Step Four work and resisting the urge to retroactively justify, minimize, or reframe what you found. It means standing in the mirror of your inventory and letting it tell you the truth. This is the beginning of authentic identity — and the prerequisite for everything that follows.

Self-Ownership — p. 430

Step 9

The discipline of focusing exclusively on your part in a harmful situation — without minimizing your role, without referencing the other person's wrongs, and without using the amends encounter as an opportunity to air grievances or assign blame. Step Nine instructs clearly: focus only on your part, your responsibility. Henry Cloud and John Townsend would describe self-

ownership as one of the most fundamental capacities of emotional health — the ability to hold your own space without encroaching on another person's. Neil T. Anderson frames it spiritually: you stand before another person as someone already fully known and fully forgiven by God, which makes you free to own your part completely without needing to defend yourself.

SELF-PITY / ENTITLEMENT — p. 226

Step 4

The twin lies that "no one has suffered like me" and "I deserve better" — both block gratitude, responsibility, and the humility required for genuine forgiveness.

Self-Reliance — p. 204

Step 3

The deeply ingrained habit of trusting yourself above all others — including God — to manage, fix, and navigate life. Self-reliance is not the same as healthy responsibility. It becomes destructive when it excludes God and isolates us from community. Much of addiction, anxiety, and chronic relapse is fueled by self-reliance — the exhausting insistence on doing life alone. Step Three is the direct antidote: choosing God-reliance in place of self-reliance.

Self-Will — p. 519

Step 11

The deeply ingrained human tendency to rely on one's own plans, instincts, and preferences rather than seeking and aligning with God's will — the root disposition that recovery, and specifically Step Eleven, is designed to address. Self-will is not simply doing wrong things; it is the posture of running one's life independently of God, even in pursuit of good outcomes. Brand describes the addicted life as essentially defined by self-will: the compulsive pursuit of relief and pleasure on one's own terms. Step Eleven asks for 'freedom from self-will, rationalization, and wishful thinking' — and that freedom only comes through consistent, genuine prayer and meditation that reorients the will from self-direction to Spiritdirection.

Serenity — p. 160

Step 2

A deep, anchored peace that transcends circumstances — not the absence of difficulty, but the presence of God in the midst of it. Serenity is what happens when we stop trying to control everything and begin trusting the One who actually holds everything. It is the fruit of surrender, prayer, and an ongoing relationship with God. The Serenity Prayer captures it: the wisdom to know what we can and cannot change, and the grace to accept the difference. Serenity is not passivity — it is the calm from which wise and intentional action flows.

Service — p. 545

Step 12

The deliberate investment of time, energy, and attention in the recovery and wellbeing of others — sponsoring, facilitating, volunteering, mentoring, and showing up consistently for people who are where you once were. Service is not optional in Step Twelve — it is the mechanism by which your own recovery is sustained. The paradox the curriculum names directly: 'You can't keep it unless you give it away.' Ecclesiastes 4:9 grounds it: 'Two are better than one.' Service moves recovery from a personal project to a communal covenant. Cloud and Townsend would recognize service as the fullest expression of the relational health that the entire program has been building toward — healthy giving from a healthy self, rather than codependent rescuing from a depleted one.

Shame — p. 36, p. 335, p. 410

Pre-Reading · Step 5 · Step 8

The painful internal experience of believing 'I am bad,' 'I am broken,' or 'I am beyond repair'—as distinct from guilt, which says 'I did something wrong.' John Townsend and Henry Cloud emphasize that shame, when unchecked, drives people deeper into hiding and addiction rather than toward healing. Shame loses its power when brought into the light of honest relationship and the grace of God.

Shortcomings — p. 383

Step 7

The character defects, habitual sins, flaws, and ingrained patterns of thinking or behavior that get in the way of our healing, our relationships, and our calling. Shortcomings are not simply bad habits — they are distortions of God-given drives that have been bent by pain, pride, or fear. As Henry Cloud and John Townsend note in *Boundaries*, we are not responsible for the

wounds we received, but we are responsible for what we do with them. Step 7 invites us to stop managing our shortcomings and start surrendering them.

Sober Living Home — p. 37

Pre-Reading

A structured, abstinence-focused transitional living environment that provides peer accountability, community support, and recovery-oriented structure after inpatient treatment—or as an alternative to it. Research consistently shows that longer stays in sober living environments correlate with greater long-term sobriety rates and improved mental health outcomes.

Soul Wound — p. 37

Pre-Reading

A deep emotional, psychological, or spiritual injury resulting from trauma, betrayal, abandonment, abuse, or other significant pain that remains unhealed and continues to influence behavior, relationships, and recovery. Neil T. Anderson's framework recognizes that unhealed soul wounds become doorways for spiritual oppression and behavioral compulsion. Inner healing prayer specifically targets these wounds.

Spiritual Awakening — p. 546

Step 12

The broadened, deepened awareness of God, of oneself, and of one's relationship to others that emerges from honestly working the twelve steps — a perceptual and relational shift that makes possible a way of living that was not accessible before. A spiritual awakening is not the same as a single peak experience; it is the accumulated result of surrender, inventory, confession, amends, and ongoing prayer and meditation. Anderson grounds this in the biblical language of 'walking in the light' (1 John 1:7) — a sustained, relational, transparent orientation toward God that replaces the hiding and pretending of the addictive life. The spiritual awakening of Step Twelve is both the fruit of the steps and the seedbed for the service that follows.

SPIRITUAL BYPASS — p. 226

Step 4

Using spiritual language or religious activity to avoid facing real pain, sin, or relational damage. Step Four refuses bypass; it demands ruthless honesty before true healing. **STRUGGLES, SHORTCOMINGS & SABOTAGING BEHAVIORS** — The specific patterns, attitudes, and actions (emotional, relational, behavioral, or spiritual) that keep us stuck in addiction, resentment, or self-defeat. These are not just "flaws" but active choices or unaddressed wounds that sabotage the life God intends. These key terms are the language of Step Four. Master them, speak them aloud to your sponsor, and let them guide every inventory sheet and forgiveness letter you write. You are not just listing problems — you are stepping into the freedom that comes when truth replaces every lie.

Spiritual Disciplines — p. 521

Step 11

The intentional, regular practices through which a person creates the conditions for God's transforming work in their life — including prayer, Scripture reading, meditation, journaling, fasting, silence, solitude, worship, and community. Step Eleven is the step most directly concerned with the spiritual disciplines, treating them not as religious duties but as the recovery practices of the inner life. John Maxwell describes the daily disciplines as the difference between the person who grows and the person who stagnates — not because the disciplines themselves produce transformation, but because they position the person to receive the work that only God can do. The spiritual disciplines of Step Eleven are the maintenance system of conscious contact.

Spiritual Experience — p. 545

Step 12

The cumulative, real inner transformation — a changed relationship with God, a new orientation of the self, a shift from self-centered living toward God-centered living — that results from honestly and completely working the twelve steps. A spiritual experience in the RnR framework is not necessarily a dramatic single event; more often it is the gradual, step-bystep reorientation of a person's character, priorities, and identity through the work of surrender, honesty, inventory, confession, amends, and prayer. Anderson would describe it as the progressive freedom from the lies and strongholds that bound the person before recovery. Brand frames it as the natural consequence of the recovery process: 'We're all just a few clear ideas and a little honesty away from the life we were meant to live.'



Spiritual Identity — p. 159

Step 2

Who you truly are as defined by Scripture and by the finished work of Jesus Christ, not by your worst moments, your failures, your diagnosis, or what others have said about you. You are a child of God (John 1:12), a new creation (2 Corinthians 5:17), God's masterpiece (Ephesians 2:10), and a co-heir with Christ (Romans 8:17). Anchoring your life to this truth is not positive thinking — it is the antidote to shame, the foundation of lasting change, and the ground on which recovery is built.

Spiritual Stronghold — p. 98

Step 1

A deeply entrenched pattern of thinking, believing, or behaving that is rooted in deception and has become a point of spiritual, psychological, and behavioral captivity. Neil T. Anderson defines a stronghold as a 'mental fortress' built from lies we have believed over time — about ourselves, about God, and about reality — that now functions as a prison. Breaking a stronghold requires both the renewal of the mind through truth (Romans 12:2) and the authority of prayer and surrender.

Spiritual Warfare — p. 37, p. 64, p. 159, p. 520

Pre-Reading · Pre-Step · Step 2 · Step 11

The ongoing, real conflict between the believer's freedom and the forces of darkness that seek to maintain bondage through temptation, deception, shame, and accusation. Neil T. Anderson (Victory Over the Darkness) and this curriculum both affirm that recovery is not only psychological but spiritual—and that binding temptation in Jesus' name, declaring truth, and putting on the full armor of God are daily practices, not theological abstractions.

Sponsor — p. 63, p. 97, p. 335

Pre-Step · Step 1 · Step 5

An experienced person in recovery who has worked the steps and agrees to walk alongside a newcomer as a guide, mentor, and accountability holder. The sponsor relationship mirrors the biblical model of discipleship: one who has gone before reaching back to help another move forward. A sponsor helps you stay grounded in truth when your own thinking distorts reality.

Sponsor / Step Leader — p. 37

Pre-Reading

A trained, experienced guide who walks alongside a person in recovery—reading the same curriculum, meeting weekly, listening without judgment, asking hard questions, and offering prayerful encouragement. The sponsor does not fix or rescue; they model, witness, and hold space for transformation. As this curriculum's Sponsor Agreement states: 'I will be your biggest encourager—but I cannot work the steps for you.'

Sponsorship — p. 545

Step 12

The relational commitment to walk alongside a newcomer through the steps — guiding, not carrying; challenging, not rescuing; sharing experience, not dispensing instructions. A sponsor in the RnR framework is someone who has personally completed the steps and can lead from lived experience rather than theory. Maxwell's mentoring philosophy is operative here: the most effective development happens in close, honest, ongoing relationship — the mentor walking alongside the learner rather than lecturing from a distance. Sponsorship protects the sponsor's own recovery by keeping them anchored in the work; it protects the sponsee by giving them a human witness who is for them and will not let them minimize, avoid, or pretend.

Step Work — p. 37

Pre-Reading

The active, written engagement with the 12 Steps of recovery under the guidance of a sponsor or step leader. Step work is not passive reading—it requires honest written answers, vulnerability in sharing, and willingness to change. Mike Yorkey and Stephen Arterburn's writing in the Life Recovery Bible tradition frames Step work as the practical expression of surrender to God and self-examination in community.

Stress — p. 63

Pre-Step

The internal and external pressure placed on mind, body, and spirit that — when unmanaged — destabilizes recovery and increases risk of relapse. Dr. Ken D. Berry, M.D., emphasizes the physiological reality of chronic stress: elevated cortisol shrinks

the hippocampus, impairs memory, and fuels the "doom loop" of anxiety and poor decisions. Managing stress is not optional — it is brain-protective medicine.

Surrender — p. 96, p. 159, p. 203, p. 385

Step 1 · Step 2 · Step 3 · Step 7

The intentional decision to stop fighting against your own truth and to release control of your life to God. Surrender is not giving up — it is giving over. Russell Brand describes surrender as the paradoxical moment when you gain real power by releasing your grip on false power. In Step One, surrender begins the moment you stop insisting that you can fix yourself and start asking for help. It is the pivot point between the old life and the new one.

Surrender of Self-Will — p. 521

Step 11

The ongoing, daily, moment-by-moment release of the demand to control outcomes, relationships, and circumstances — choosing God's agenda over one's own and His timeline over one's impatience. Surrender is not passivity; it is the active, courageous decision to stop being one's own god. The Step Eleven prayer captures it precisely: 'freedom from self-will, rationalization, and wishful thinking.' Groeschel describes surrender as 'the strongest thing a person can do' because it defeats the deepest human instinct — the insistence on self-determination. In recovery, surrender of self-will is not a onetime event at Step Three; it is the daily renewal of the decision that made recovery possible in the first place.

T

Testimony — p. 545

Step 12

The written and spoken personal account of a person's life before recovery, their journey through the steps, and the transformation God has worked in them — crafted with care, reviewed with a sponsor, and shared in community as both a personal integration exercise and an outreach tool for those who have not yet found hope. The RnR curriculum is specific about the structure and purpose of testimony: it is not a recounting of how bad things were (no more than one-third of the testimony should address the past), but a declaration of what God has done and is doing. The goal is to give the newcomer — 'the person sitting there not believing life can get any better' — hope that change is possible. Testimony is both the completion of the step work and the beginning of a lifetime of giving it away.

The Threefold Confession — p. 336

Step 5

The biblical framework embedded in Step Five that calls for confession to three distinct recipients: to yourself (selfhonesty), to God (vertical transparency), and to another trusted person (horizontal accountability). Each dimension of confession serves a different function. Confessing to yourself breaks the mechanism of denial. Confessing to God realigns you with your Creator's perspective on your life. Confessing to another human being breaks shame's power and seals the work in community. All three are necessary; none is sufficient alone.

Tolerance — p. 96

Step 1

The progressive requirement for more of a substance or behavior over time in order to achieve the same mood-altering effect. Tolerance is evidence that the brain has adapted to the addictive agent and begun to compensate — raising the floor of 'normal' and requiring escalation to feel anything. What once felt like relief now barely feels like baseline. Tolerance is a biological and behavioral trap that deepens the cycle of addiction over time.

Transformation — p. 37, p. 98

Pre-Reading · Step 1

The deep, lasting change in a person's character, thinking, patterns, and identity that occurs through sustained recovery work, spiritual renewal, and relational healing. John Maxwell distinguishes between change (external, temporary) and transformation (internal, permanent). True transformation—as the Resilients in Recovery mission states—is made possible through 'the power of Jesus Christ,' not willpower alone.

Transformational Pathway — p. 64, p. 546

Pre-Step · Step 12

A structured, intentional course of continued growth beyond the initial 12 Steps — addressing spirit, mind, body, relationships, finances, and worldview. Resilients in Recovery offers multiple Transformational Pathways, recognizing that genuine recovery is not a single destination but a lifelong process of becoming who God designed each person to be.

Trauma — p. 37

Pre-Reading

Any experience—physical, emotional, sexual, relational, or spiritual—that overwhelms a person's capacity to process and integrate it, leaving a lasting imprint on the nervous system, beliefs, and behavior. Trauma is frequently a root cause of addiction: substances and compulsive behaviors often began as attempts to manage the pain that trauma left behind. Addressing trauma directly—rather than only its symptoms—is central to lasting recovery.

Trigger — p. 63

Pre-Step

Any person, place, emotion, memory, time of day, or circumstance that activates the craving or urge to return to a destructive pattern. Russell Brand, in his own recovery writings, emphasizes that triggers must be identified honestly and confronted with both awareness and a prepared response — not merely avoided in weakness, but understood and disarmed through truth.

Trust — p. 203

Step 3

The active, ongoing choice to believe that God is good, present, and capable — even when circumstances suggest otherwise. Trust is not blind optimism; it is faith informed by evidence of God's faithfulness. For many in recovery, trust has been shattered by people who failed them. Rebuilding trust begins with the God who has never failed, and grows outward from there. Trust is the foundation that makes surrender possible.

U

Unmanageability — p. 95

Step 1

The condition in which one's life — relationships, responsibilities, emotional health, finances, spiritual life — has been significantly disrupted or destabilized by addictive behaviors. Unmanageability is the natural consequence of sustained powerlessness. It is not just inconvenience; it is the accumulated wreckage that results when addiction has been the operating system of a life. Craig Groeschel reminds us that we cannot change what we refuse to confront — recognizing unmanageability is the prerequisite to transformation.

Unmanaged Pain — p. 98

Step 1

Emotional, relational, physical, or spiritual hurt that has never been properly acknowledged, processed, or healed — and which therefore continues to drive behavior from below the surface of awareness. Step One invites the person to stop denying the pain they are carrying. As the curriculum states: 'You are ready to take your first step in recovery when your pain is greater than your fear.' Unmanaged pain is the fuel of most addictive behavior — the thing the addiction was originally recruited to silence.

V

Vigilance — p. 469

Step 10

The sustained, alert awareness of the specific patterns, triggers, behaviors, and thinking traps that are most likely to lead you back into addictive behavior or destructive patterns. Step Ten explicitly asks what behaviors and attitudes you need to be most vigilant against, and what your specific triggers are. Neil T. Anderson would frame vigilance as spiritual alertness — the posture of 1 Peter 5:8, 'Be sober-minded; be watchful. Your adversary the devil prowls around like a roaring lion.' Vigilance in recovery is not anxiety; it is informed, targeted self-awareness. You cannot guard what you have not mapped.

Virtues (2 Peter 1) — p. 160

Step 2

The eight qualities that the apostle Peter identifies as essential to spiritual growth and freedom: faith, virtue (moral excellence), knowledge, self-control, patient endurance, godliness, brotherly kindness, and love. These are not character traits that appear overnight — they are cultivated through intentional effort, with the Holy Spirit's help, over time. In Step Two, participants are invited to honestly assess which of these qualities are already growing in them and which ones still need work. This honest self-inventory is not shame-based — it is a roadmap for transformation.

Vulnerability — p. 336

Step 5

The deliberate choice to lower your defenses and allow another person to see the unedited version of your story. Cloud and Townsend write that growth happens 'in the context of relationship,' and relationship cannot exist without vulnerability. It is the bridge between isolation and community, between pretending and healing. Vulnerability in Step Five is not emotional exposure for its own sake — it is strategic honesty in service of your recovery. What feels like weakness in the moment is, in fact, the most powerful move available to you.

W

Weekly Inventory — p. 469

Step 10

A more structured, broader self-examination conducted once a week — often with a sponsor or accountability partner — that steps back from the daily details to look at patterns, themes, and trajectory. The weekly inventory asks: What has been true of me this week? Where am I making progress? Where am I sliding? Are there resentments or behaviors I haven't yet named? The Step Ten material incorporates the 2 Peter 1:5-7 virtues (faith, goodness, knowledge, selfcontrol, perseverance, godliness, mutual affection, love) as a framework for the weekly inventory — measuring not just what you did or didn't do, but who you are becoming. Cloud and Townsend would identify this as the kind of structured reflection that accelerates genuine character growth.

Will — p. 203

Step 3

Your internal drive, desire, and decision-making power — the engine of your choices. In addiction and destructive living, the will becomes hijacked by compulsion, fear, and self-reliance. Step Three invites you to offer your will back to God, not as an act of weakness but as an act of worship. When your will aligns with God's will, you move from reactive survival to purposeful living.

Willingness — p. 63, p. 355, p. 409, p. 429

Pre-Step · Step 6 · Step 8 · Step 9

The inner posture of being open and ready to accept help, change, and direction — even when the full picture is unclear. John Maxwell identifies willingness as the starting point of all growth: you cannot change what you are not first willing to examine. Willingness is not the same as having answers; it is the courage to begin the process.

Willpower — p. 205

Step 3

The human capacity for self-discipline and determination — a resource that is real but limited. Many people enter recovery believing willpower is the solution. Experience teaches that willpower alone is insufficient to break deeply rooted patterns of addiction and self-destruction. Step Three is not a rejection of personal responsibility; it is the honest acknowledgment that human willpower needs to be partnered with God's power to produce lasting transformation. Willpower sets the stage; God's power writes the story.

Willpower vs. God's Will — p. 384

Step 7

The crucial distinction between self-reliance and Spirit-reliance in recovery. Willpower is the human attempt to overcome compulsion through personal determination alone — and it consistently fails over the long term, especially in addiction and deep character work. God's will, by contrast, is the transformative power available when we align our desires with His and stop trying to be our own higher power. Ken D. Berry, M.D. would note that willpower is a finite biological resource; it depletes under stress. Recovery that lasts requires a resource that does not run out.

**Withdrawal** — p. 96*Step 1*

The psychological and/or physical consequences — including irritability, restlessness, anxiety, cravings, and mood instability — that occur when a person is unable to engage in their addictive behavior. Withdrawal symptoms are the body and mind's protest against the absence of what has become 'normal.' They are evidence that the addiction has rewired the nervous system. Recognizing withdrawal symptoms in yourself is a form of honest self-assessment and an act of Step One.

Worship — p. 205*Step 3*

The act of ascribing ultimate worth and value to God through the way we think, speak, and live. Romans 12:1 calls the offering of our bodies — our daily choices and actions — a 'spiritual act of worship.' In recovery, worship is not limited to Sunday services; it is the Monday-through-Saturday decision to live surrendered, grateful, and obedient. Every time you choose God's way over your own, that is worship.

Writing as Self-Care — p. 37*Pre-Reading*

The intentional, regular practice of putting thoughts, feelings, prayers, and reflections into written form as a primary tool of recovery. As outlined in this curriculum, writing is not a school assignment—it is a healing discipline. Journaling externalizes the internal, creates space for honest reflection, builds self-awareness, and helps break the cycle of reactive living. Protect your writing time like you would protect any other form of medicine.